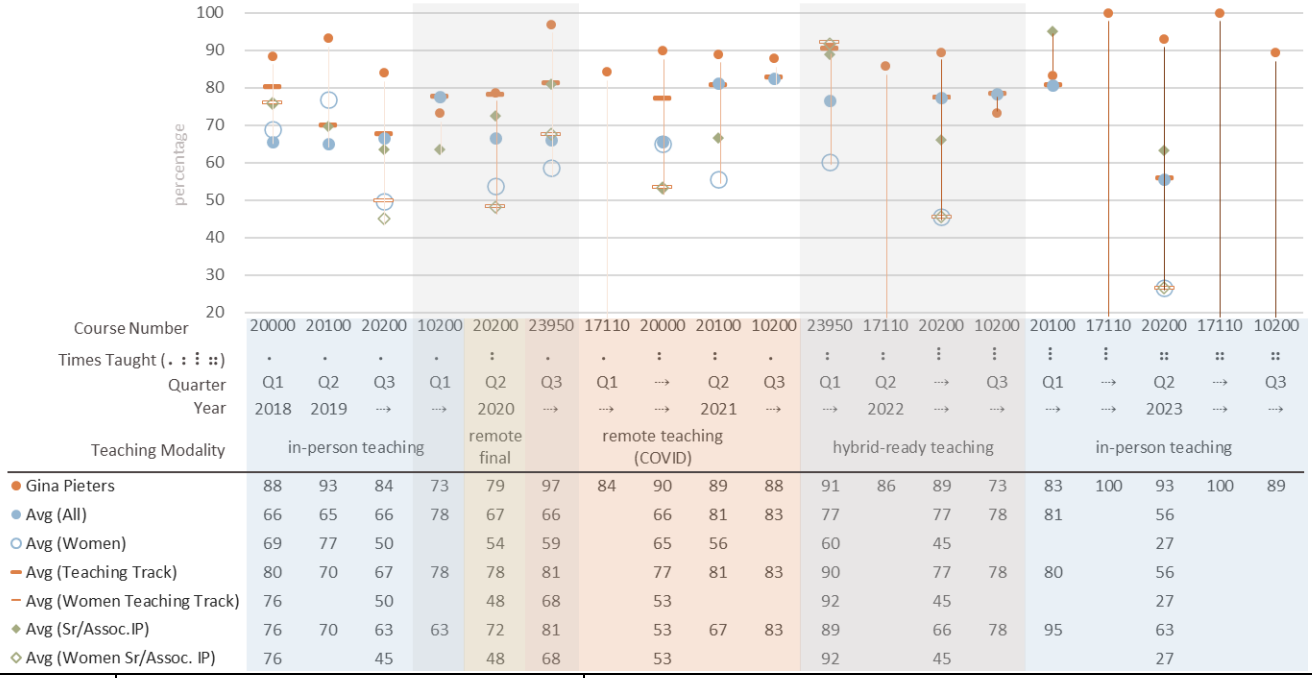
GINA PIETERS
Assistant Instructional Professor
Department of Economics, University of Chicago

(Fig. 1) % *Strongly Agree* or *Agree* with: "Instructor Made a Significant Contribution to Your Learning"



Course Number	20000	20100	20200	10200	20200	23950	17110	20000	20100	10200	23950	17110	20200	10200	20100	17110	20200	17110	10200	
Times Taught (. : ⋮ ::)	.	.	.	.	:	.	.	:	:	.	:	:	⋮	⋮	⋮	⋮	::	::	::	
Quarter	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q1	→	Q2	Q3	Q1	Q2	→	Q3	Q1	→	Q2	→	Q3	
Year	2018	2019	→	→	2020	→	→	→	2021	→	→	2022	→	→	→	→	2023	→	→	
Teaching Modality	in-person teaching				remote final		remote teaching (COVID)				hybrid-ready teaching				in-person teaching					
Gina Pieters	88	93	84	73	79	97	84	90	89	88	91	86	89	73	83	100	93	100	89	
Avg (All)	66	65	66	78	67	66		66	81	83	77		77	78	81		56			
Avg (Women)	69	77	50		54	59		65	56		60		45				27			
Avg (Teaching Track)	80	70	67	78	78	81		77	81	83	90		77	78	80		56			
Avg (Women Teaching Track)	76		50		48	68		53			92		45				27			
Avg (Sr/Assoc.IP)	76	70	63	63	72	81		53	67	83	89		66	78	95		63			
Avg (Women Sr/Assoc. IP)	76		45		48	68		53			92		45				27			

Course	Title	Description
Econ 10200	Principles of Macroeconomics	No pre-requisites. Originally a standalone course, it has become a pre-requisite for the macro-courses in the "Business Economics" major, evolving into a non-calculus "intermediate macro".
Econ 17110	International Monetary Systems	Econ 10200 pre-requisite. Writing intensive, non-calculus-based course in international macroeconomics and international finance markets.
Econ 20000	Elements of Economic Analysis 1	Calculus pre-requisite. Lagrangian-calculus based consumer theory. Static partial equilibrium.
Econ 20100	Elements of Economic Analysis 2	Econ 20000 pre-requisite. Lagrangian-calculus based producer theory and game theory. Static general equilibrium.
Econ 20200	Elements of Economic Analysis 3	Econ 20100 pre-requisite. Lagrangian-calculus based dynamic general equilibrium theory, covering growth and business cycles. Introduces MATLAB simulations.
Econ 23950	Economic Policy Analysis	Econ 20200 pre-requisite. Dynamic general equilibrium theory of fiscal and monetary policy. My section was writing intensive.
Not shown: My summer teaching in Financial Math (FINM 31000: Cryptoasset markets). My other teaching experiences at University of Minnesota or Trinity University were non-calculus based programs, and included teaching international trade. UMinn courses were as large as 382 students, Trinity courses were as small as 8 students.		

Given that I "course-hop" it can be difficult to establish a narrative of continuous teaching improvement. Therefore, for each course I have taught I collect the teaching evaluations between Autumn 2014 and Spring 2023 of instructors who taught the same course regardless of quarter. I create a comparative teaching instance (my first time teaching compared to the first occurrence of any instructor, my second time teaching to all available second occurrence, etc.), and compare the average of those pooled evaluations to my own. I focus on the percentage of students who agreed or strongly agreed with the statement, "Instructor made a significant contribution to my learning". I do not restrict the comparison of my COVID numbers to only instructor ratings during COVID: it should be noted that if I had done so my numbers would be considerably higher than the peer group which had declined on the average.

The collected data provides a comparison of teaching evaluation growth between me and (1) all other instructors with the same course familiarity, (2) only economics lecturers from within group 1, and (3) only women from both group 1 and group 2 to account for the well-known potential of student evaluation bias (clearly visible for all courses with women instructors, with the exception of first-time Econ 20000, consistent with the finding of increasing bias amongst economists as they continue along the major). Missing values indicate that no woman besides me (or in some cases, any other instructor) had available data. The resulting chart shows that out of 14 course iterations, I have outperformed all comparison groups with 3 exceptions, which I am approximately equivalent to the "general" lecturer group instead of outperforming them, though I still more double the rating for the average women instructor of those courses, when available. The exceptions are 2019-Q1 Econ 10200, 2020-Q2 Econ 20200, and 2022-Q1 Econ 23950. The full depth of the comparative data in Fig. 1 is not easily unpacked, at first glance. I provide here an example using the chart to compare my results in Spring 2019 when I taught Econ 20200 for the first time, and Winter 20200 when I taught Econ 20200 for the third time.

Example: In Spring 2019, **84%** of my Econ 202 students indicated agreement or strong agreement to the statement regarding my significant contribution to their learning. The average response to this question for all other first-time instructors for this class was **67%**, which drops to **43%** if the instructor was another woman (almost half of my response value). Narrowing this pool to only other lecturers (removing graduate students, visitors, research faculty, etc), increases the response to **72%,** though decreases it to **23%** for any other instructors who are both lecturers and women on their first available evaluations in Econ 20200 (about one quarter of my response value). This shows that my start was strong even when compared only to other lecturers.

In Winter 2022 I taught Econ 20200 for the third time. The **89%** of Econ 202 students indicating agreement or strong agreement for my course continues to compare favorably to the **77%** expressed in the evaluations for all other instructors who were teaching the course for their third time, and to the **45%** rate expressed for instructors who were women. All instructors teaching the course for the third time were lecturers.

		Analysis	i.
		INDEX	ii.
2018	Fall	ECON 20000 4 - The Elements of Economic Analysis I	1
2019	Winter	ECON 20100 1 - The Elements of Economic Analysis II	10
		ECON 20100 2 - The Elements of Economic Analysis II	18
	Spring	ECON 20200 1 - The Elements of Economic Analysis III	25
		ECON 20200 2 - The Elements of Economic Analysis III	33
	Summer	ECON 20100 91 - The Elements of Economic Analysis II	40
	Fall	ECON 10200 1 - Principles of Macroeconomics	47
2020	Winter	ECON 20200 1 - The Elements of Economic Analysis III	59
		ECON 20200 2 - The Elements of Economic Analysis III	64
	Spring	ECON 23950 1 - Economic Policy Analysis	70
		ECON 23950 2 - Economic Policy Analysis	76
	Fall	ECON 17110 1 - International Monetary Systems	82
		ECON 20000 5 - The Elements of Economic Analysis I	91
		ECON 20000 6 - The Elements of Economic Analysis I	103
2021	Winter	ECON 20100 5 - The Elements of Economic Analysis II	116
	Spring	ECON 10200 1 - Principles of Macroeconomics	126
	Fall	ECON 23950 2 - Economic Policy Analysis	139
		ECON 23950 3 - Economic Policy Analysis	148
2022	Winter	ECON 17110 1 - International Monetary Systems	156
		ECON 20200 1 - The Elements of Economic Analysis III	162
	Spring	ECON 10200 1 - Principles of Macroeconomics	170
	Fall	ECON 17110 1 - International Monetary Systems	181
		ECON 20100 1 - The Elements of Economic Analysis II	187
2023	Winter	ECON 17110 1 - International Monetary Systems	194
		ECON 20200 1 - The Elements of Economic Analysis III	201
	Spring	ECON 10200 1 - Principles of Macroeconomics	207

THE UNIVERSITY OF CHICAGO

ECON 20000 4 - The Elements of Economic Analysis I (Autumn 2018) - Instructor(s): Gina Pieters

Number Enrolled: **50**
Number of Responses: **26**

Report Comments

Opinions expressed in these evaluations are those of students enrolled in the specific course and do not represent the University.

Creation Date: **Tuesday, June 23, 2020**

The Course

What are the most important things that you learned in this course? Please reflect on the knowledge and skills you gained.

Comments
Consumer side economics
Consumer choice theory and its application; UMP and EMP recipe using Lagrangian multipliers.
The fundamentals of the mathematics of economics at UChicago.
Not too many skills learnt, but definitely everything in this course will be useful for the rest of the Econ Core major Sequence
We learned the consumer model of choice, including preferences, utility, budget sets, and applications.
I learned some basics on problem solving in economics
Thinking in terms of economics and consumer behavior. Taking this course made me think of how people operate on a day-to-day basis based on their own needs and wants,
Economic analysis, how to read economic graphs
Applications of economics and interpretation of graphs
Beyond the materials of the course, I learned to manage my time and work in a group to complete psets.
Lots of utility maximization curves of all sorts.
Basic elements of consumer theory.
I learned a great deal about consumer decision making - utility maximization and expenditure minimization, in particular.
LaGrangian multipliers, conceptual microeconomics, demand functions.
Largely the mathematical basis for many prominent ideas in microeconomics as well as attaining a basis for future economic analyses.
UMP and EMP problems, insurance, so much econ
Basics of consumer-side economics.

Describe how aspects of this course (lectures, discussions, labs, assignments, etc.) contributed to your learning.

Comments
Very clear lecturer, good range of probs on the hws.
Lectures were very well-organized, and prof. Pieters did wonderful job giving clear explanations on each concepts. Psets were quite challenging, but great that they introduced me to various applications of economics theories (e.g. crime, education, etc.).
Lectures and assignments were the most useful. The textbook and other materials are far less useful than lecture notes and the relevant assignments especially when it comes to having a deeper understanding of the material
The class handouts contributed most to my learning in the course, although the lectures were also occasionally helpful.
Lectures were the most helpful
Lectures- Prof Pieters is an excellent lecturer. Clear speaking & handwriting, always willing to answer questions, doesn't move at a ridiculous pace. Psets- a little long but interesting. Wish they were due Thursday at midnight instead of Wednesday since we'd have 2 office hours to discuss problems instead of one. Discussions- literally went to 2 discussion sections. Edgar was rlly nice and tried to help but didn't explain things really well and it wasn't an effective use of my time, I found. Note: Autumn 2018 was Pieters' first time teaching @UC and using our methods such as Canvas. As such, she made a few mistakes on homeworks and practice midterms, but I think that's to be expected. The point is that she was rlly understanding and accommodating to these errors, so after adjusting all these errors will go away. That being said, it was annoying to have the answer keys to the HW's/practice midterms wrong- made it difficult to study.
Lectures taught crucial information, and discussion sections reviewed confusing topics.
Lectures were very clear, and assignments were helpful in reinforcing the material, but both often had errors.
Lectures, although not technically mandatory were extremely helpful and organized.
Lectures were very helpful, as were all the resources posted online.
Homeworks and lecture were most helpful.
The lectures and problem sets contributed considerably to my learning.
Lectures were fantastic and crucial to attend, problem sets were long and difficult, but ensured that students could apply everything that was taught in the lectures.
The lectures and the homeworks were very comprehensive and beyond anything I could have asked for from this course.
The lectures were really clear. The notes were really clear. I really appreciate the summaries that she gives for each topic as well as the practice problems. The PSETs were a good culmination of the weeks work. The discussion sessions were a waste of time though.
Lectures and homework assignments forced me to learn the material.

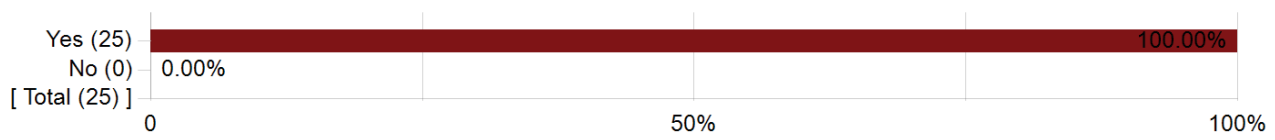
	Mean	Median	N/A	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
This course challenged me intellectually.	4.71	5.00	4.00%	0.00%	0.00%	4.00%	20.00%	72.00%
I understood the purpose of this course and what I was expected to gain from it.	4.42	4.00	4.00%	0.00%	0.00%	4.00%	48.00%	44.00%
I understood the standards for success on assignments.	4.33	4.50	4.00%	0.00%	4.00%	8.00%	36.00%	48.00%
Class time enhanced my ability to succeed in graded assignments.	4.50	5.00	4.00%	0.00%	0.00%	4.00%	40.00%	52.00%
I received feedback on my performance that helped me improve subsequent work.	3.83	4.00	4.00%	4.00%	8.00%	16.00%	40.00%	28.00%
My work was evaluated fairly.	4.25	4.00	4.00%	0.00%	0.00%	12.00%	48.00%	36.00%
I felt respected in this class.	4.33	5.00	4.00%	0.00%	8.00%	8.00%	24.00%	56.00%
Overall, this was an excellent course.	4.21	4.00	4.00%	0.00%	4.00%	12.00%	40.00%	40.00%

Additional Comments about this course:

Comments
Professor Pieters is great!
The course itself is fine.
This course was great!

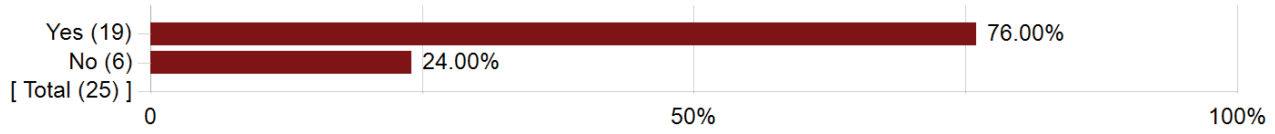
I would recommend this course to highly motivated and well-prepared students

I would recommend this course to highly motivated and well-prepared students



I would recommend this course to anyone interested in the topic

I would recommend this course to anyone interested in the topic



The Instructor

Thinking about your time in class, what aspect of the instructor's teaching contributed most to your learning?

Comments
Lectures were a strong point
Amazing Professor. Clear, concise and always available.
She provided a lot of resources to help students--summary and practice problems for every topic covered in the lecture, and multiple practice exams for midterm and final. They helped me a lot.
Professor Pieters was very clear about what material would be covered in each lecture and emphasized which information was especially important to the course.
Very well crafted assignments that got you thinking about the right things. The assignments seemed to address all of my questions in a way that clarified almost everything about a topic by the assignment end.
Prof Pieters handouts were most helpful in completing this course. I also thought she was good at answering class questions.
lectures were helpful
Explaining things in an INTUITIVE WAY FIRST, then proceeding with the math. If not, the entire class would just get lost during lecture, then wouldn't understand psets. Also her office hours.
Her ability to answer student's questions.
Professor Pieters was a great lecturer and was able to present difficult topics clearly.
Professor Pieters is incredibly organized and experienced in lecturing.
Dr. Pieters was clear, direct, and organized. The homeworks and evaluations were straightforward and fair. There were ample resources available on the internet. Overall, Dr. Pieters was a great example of how to run a core course on basic material.
Very helpful. Answers questions directly and explains material clearly. Makes students more interested in the material. Really appreciate the practice exams as well.
She was really articulate and explained material in a way so that we understood it well. Her lectures were very organized, with class notes to accompany them, so we could refer back to precisely what she taught in each lecture.
Prof. Pieters is a fantastic lecturer. Her office hours are very helpful as well.
She was an incredible professor. She was to the point, organized, and always had an answer to any question even if it was beyond the realms of the class.
Professor Pieters' lectures were extremely clear and well thought out. She is very knowledgable and a great lecturer. Really receptive to questions and really appretiate the topic summaries.
Lecture style/online notes.
Good examples, good with answering questions

What could she/he modify to help you learn more?

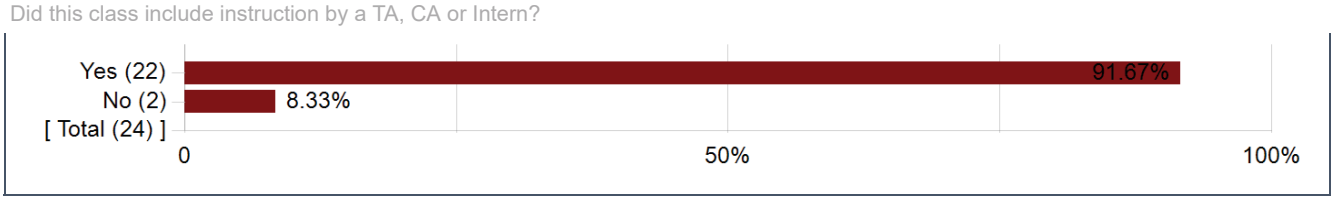
Comments
Sometimes skipped a few steps on the board, but generally good.
Nothing
Pieters could spent a lot of time going over the math during lecture, and then assigned us homework questions which would apply the math to economic concepts. I think students would benefit from her spending more time on how the math applies to the concepts during class, so students would be more prepared to answer the homework questions.
Better out-of-class reference materials. Lima and Varian are OK but they seem to be far more in depth, or in some cases less, on certain topics. It creates confusion as to exactly what I need to review for the exams.
She needs to be more coherent in her lectures. Her frequent mistakes and lack of attention to detail made it difficult to follow the logical progression of what she was teaching. Also, I felt like her teaching lacked any structure and I found it difficult following where she was going with the material.
the topic summaries and answer keys are full of errors; she tells us to let her know if there are mistakes, but how can we tell her what's wrong if we aren't sure of the answers ourselves? with the frequency of mistakes, it often feels pointless to use these resources
Make sure homework and answer keys are correct BEFORE posting them. Was really annoying to do the entire problem then have to analyze the answer key to see if it was correct. Also to not travel to conferences during the quarter.
Plan lectures better so she doesnt have to rush at the end of the period.
Reduce errors in homework/lectures/handouts
Explain the steps of her derivations more, give a better conceptual understanding of the many many equations that we are given, more graphs, more connections between concepts. She should also definitely post answer keys for PSets and midterms.
Be more open to questions and more thoroughly explain topics -- she often assumes that the class understand specific aspects of topics which can be confusing.
Her lectures could be a bit dry, but even then I found her to be fairly humorous and engaging at times.
Post problem sets earlier in the week, fix mistakes on class notes posted on canvas and problem sets. Her wording on the problem sets is also often unclear. Act like she cares more about her students success.
Absolutely nothing.
Less hostile approach to class time.
Make fewer mistakes in practice exams and problem sets, and make it clearer at the beginning of the course that the grades are curved at the end of the course.

The Instructor

	Mean	Median	N/A	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
Organized the course clearly.	4.52	5.00	3.85%	0.00%	0.00%	7.69%	30.77%	57.69%
Presented lectures that enhanced your understanding.	4.52	5.00	3.85%	0.00%	0.00%	11.54%	23.08%	61.54%
Facilitated discussions that were engaging and useful.	4.13	4.00	11.54%	0.00%	7.69%	15.38%	23.08%	42.31%
Stimulated your interest in the core ideas of the course.	4.32	5.00	3.85%	0.00%	3.85%	11.54%	30.77%	50.00%
Challenged you to learn.	4.64	5.00	3.85%	0.00%	0.00%	3.85%	26.92%	65.38%
Helped you gain significant learning from the course content.	4.52	5.00	3.85%	0.00%	0.00%	7.69%	30.77%	57.69%
Was available and helpful outside of class.	4.33	5.00	7.69%	0.00%	0.00%	23.08%	15.38%	53.85%
Motivated you to think independently.	4.20	5.00	3.85%	0.00%	7.69%	15.38%	23.08%	50.00%
Worked to create an inclusive and welcoming environment.	4.32	5.00	3.85%	0.00%	7.69%	11.54%	19.23%	57.69%
Overall, this instructor made a significant contribution to your learning.	4.52	5.00	3.85%	0.00%	0.00%	7.69%	30.77%	57.69%

The Teaching Assistant, Course Assistant, Intern

Did this class include instruction by a TA, CA or Intern?



What aspects of the TA's teaching contributed most to your learning?

Comments
Very good at taking and answering questions, very good at responding to email
He was always willing to give help and try to provide details for each explanation.
Office hours
Did not really engage with the TA too much
Edgar was very nice.
Office hours
He really seemed to care about us and would stay extra hours to help
Answering questions in discussion
The one discussion session on UMP/EMP failures.
The discussion sections by far.
Answer's emails promptly
His discussion sessions each week were really helpful in regards to the homework sets. He was also very available outside of class, and responded to emails with very detailed responses.
Provided some help, but always seemed distant from the class and material.
Nothing, he was pretty unhelpful
Review of basic useful math.
He was very willing to stay after office hours/discussion to answer more questions.

What could she/he modify to help you learn more?

Comments
Ask students what they need to go over during review sessions and discussion instead of just deciding to go over something that no one necessarily needs to go over.
He is very bad at leading discussion sessions. He really needs a lot of work in the fundamentals of teaching--attention to detail, organization, and clearness of communication , should he ever wish to teach a course.
He wasn't very good at answering questions
Unfortunately, he would hesitate a lot when trying to explain. So we would sit there while he tried to figure out the problem for himself. Do the problems and hw's before discussion so you can answer specific questions.
Be more available.
Explain things more clearly
I would prefer that he work more closely with the professor so that he has the answers to the problems that we will likely have.
He could be more organized -- and thus more helpful. He really didn't seem like he had a proper grasp on the class material and thus was not a resource I could go to for help.
To help students learn more, Edgar should actually learn the material. It seems like he doesn't actually understand a lot of what is taught in the class.
Edgar could be more concise in explaining topics. He could also be a bit more knowledgeable about the subject matter.
Would try to solve problems and just abandon them partially through, which was not helpful.
Know the material better so he can answer questions clearer and not further confuse the students
Understand and be able to teach the application/practice problems.

TA/CA or Intern

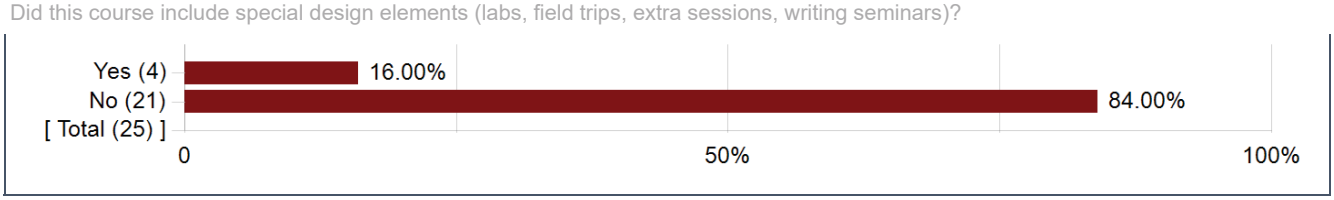
	Mean	Median	N/A	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
Facilitated discussions that supported your learning.	3.19	3.00	8.70%	8.70%	13.04%	30.43%	30.43%	8.70%
Gave you useful feedback on your work.	3.48	4.00	8.70%	0.00%	21.74%	17.39%	39.13%	13.04%
Stimulated your interest in the core ideas of the course.	3.29	3.00	8.70%	0.00%	21.74%	34.78%	21.74%	13.04%
Challenged you to learn.	3.33	3.00	8.70%	0.00%	30.43%	21.74%	17.39%	21.74%
Helped you succeed in the class.	3.38	3.00	8.70%	4.35%	26.09%	17.39%	17.39%	26.09%
Was available and helpful outside of class.	3.90	4.00	8.70%	0.00%	8.70%	21.74%	30.43%	30.43%
Overall, the TA/CA made a significant contribution to your learning.	3.10	3.00	8.70%	8.70%	26.09%	17.39%	26.09%	13.04%

Additional feedback to the TA/CA/Intern:

Comments
Not helpful and made the course harder as he was a resource that our professor assumed we had.

Additional Course Elements

Did this course include special design elements (labs, field trips, extra sessions, writing seminars)?

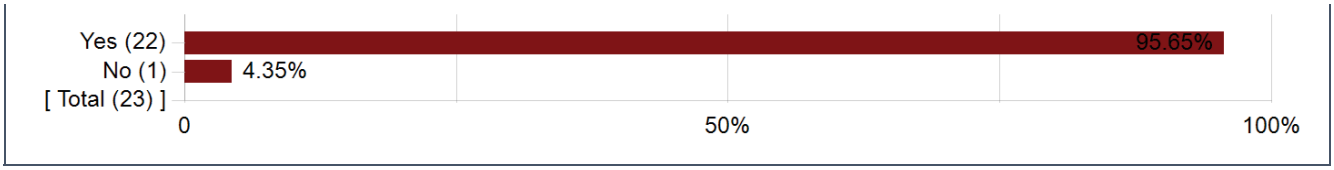


How much did the following elements of the course contribute to your learning gains?

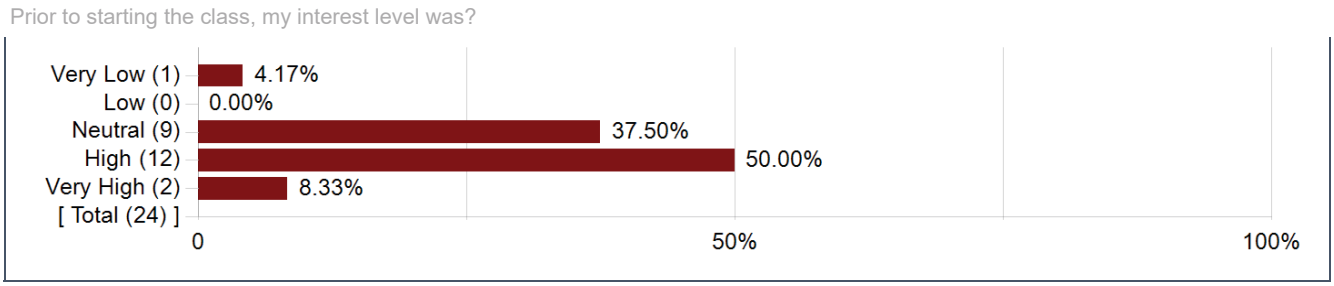
	Mean	Median	N/A	No Gain	A Little Gain	Moderate Gain	Good Gain	Great Gain
Laboratory Experience	N/A	N/A	100.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%
Field Trips	N/A	N/A	100.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%
Library Sessions	N/A	N/A	100.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%
Review sessions	3.75	4.00	46.67%	0.00%	6.67%	13.33%	20.00%	13.33%
Writing Seminars	N/A	N/A	100.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%

Student Information

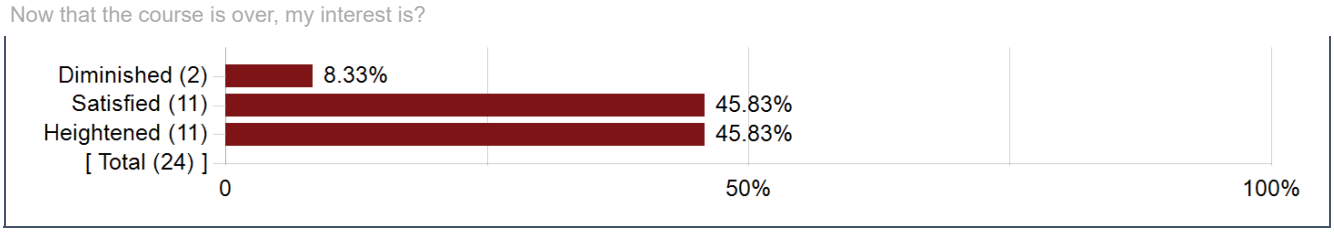
Is this class a requirement of some sort?



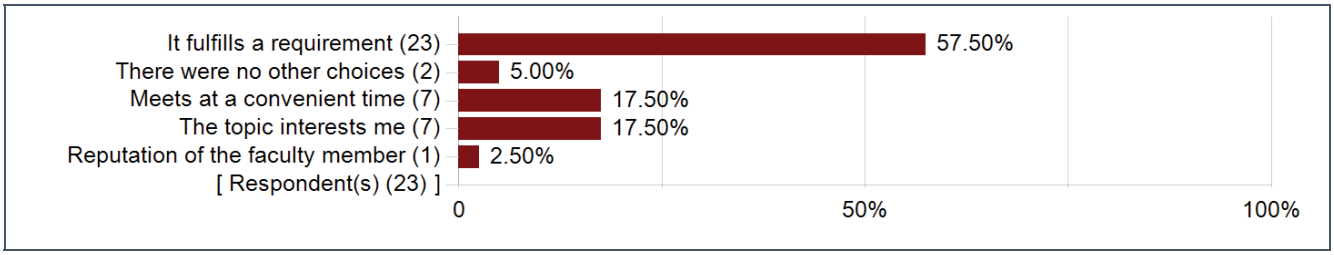
Prior to starting the class, my interest level was?



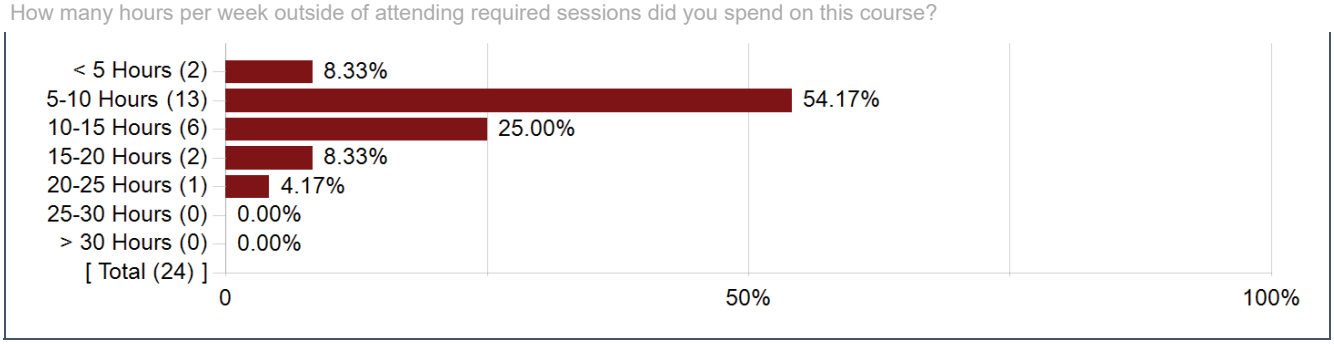
Now that the course is over, my interest is?



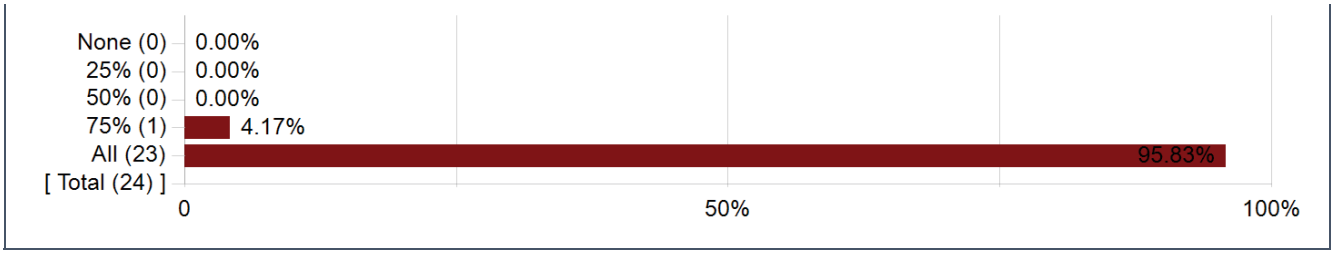
Why, primarily, did you take this course over others?



How many hours per week outside of attending required sessions did you spend on this course?



What proportion of classes did you attend?



Please comment on the level of difficulty of the course relative to your background and experience.

Comments
Math-wise, you'll be fine if you're comfortable with high-school algebra and partial derivatives. Economics-wise, solid background of AP or Intro-level Microeconomics will be helpful. This course involves significantly more math, but the intuitive understanding works in a similar way.
The course was not difficult given my level of background. It was only difficult bc it was very hard to predict the direction the course was going to take.
Took macro senior year of hs, but this is at a different level. Be fluent in partial derivatives, log, derivative and integral rules (chain rule, ln a + ln b = ln ab, etc) because they are the backbone of this class. You do get to see the fusion between math and words with Pieters though, if that makes sense. She talks through the math using intuitive knowledge, which actually gives meaning to all the variables that are on the board.
Difficult if you have not taken an economics course especially at the university.
This class was very difficult. Professor Pieters has very high expectations, but gives you the tools to do well in her course. Part of the difficulty is also her grading scheme. Her tests are uncurved (unlike every other Econ 200s professor), and she tries to set the class average around a C. My biggest complaint could be easily fixed if she just curved the class to a B average.
It was appropriate, as difficult as expected.

Please identify the name of the TA/CA/Intern you are commenting about.

Comments
Edgar
Edgar Braham Herrera
Edgar
Edgar
Edgar Braham Herrera
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Edgar
Edgar
Edgar Braham Herrera
Edgar
Edgar/Jesus Braham Herrera
Edgar
Edgar
Edgar/Jesus (Don't have last name)
Edgar
Edgar
Edgar

THE UNIVERSITY OF CHICAGO

ECON 20100 1 - The Elements of Economic Analysis II (Winter 2019) - Instructor(s): Gina Pieters

Number Enrolled: **50**
Number of Responses: **18**

Report Comments

Opinions expressed in these evaluations are those of students enrolled in the specific course and do not represent the University.

Creation Date: **Tuesday, June 23, 2020**

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The Course

What are the most important things that you learned in this course? Please reflect on the knowledge and skills you gained.

Comments
Extension of 200 subjects
General Equilibrium, how to be an algebra god
Basic problem solving
Cost, profit, firms, and their interaction within partial/general equilibrium
general equilibrium, how labor and capital interact, monopolies, supply and demand functions, oligopolies
I wouldn't recommend taking this class. Professors Pieters constantly makes mistakes on the board, on her homework, and on her practice exams. Students often correct her on the Canvas discussion board up to 5-6 times before everything in the pset/practice exam is corrected. It's actually obscene. Her curve is not at all generous and her exams do not reflect what you are taught in class.
Microeconomics at the firm level, general equilibrium
Micro and math/algebra
General equilibrium, partial equilibrium, economic theory & advanced firm optimization
Time management is necessary.
Basic economic analysis tools, namely the firm as a market player.
How to solve general equilibrium problems. There were a couple of stand-alone topics but most of the quarter felt like it was building up to and then solving general equilibrium problems

Describe how aspects of this course (lectures, discussions, labs, assignments, etc.) contributed to your learning.

Comments
...
Lectures were very useful, assignments reinforced concepts very well
The instructor made the material approachable
Lectures were very organized, blending intuitive understanding and mathematical approach well. Homeworks were also very helpful to review and internalize the concepts learned in the class, especially difficult ones. Topic summaries, practice problems, and practice exams provided by Prof. Pieters were also extremely helpful resources.
lectures were very helpful and were very explicit in explaining the concepts. The homework really allowed you to understand the concepts and put them into practice. They were necessary to learn the material. The discussions were good for reviewing concepts and getting help with the homework.
Lectures and homework were most important to me learning the material
The lectures were fantastic. Professor Pieters is a riot.
Discussions are very helpful because they allow the TAs to answer any remaining questions that students may have left over from the lectures.
Assignments and topic summaries were most helpful. Lectures were helpful, but not always clear.
Lectures were very clear, one of Pieters' greatest strengths is her organization and this made lectures very easy to follow along with. The topic summaries and practice questions were also very helpful. The topic summaries were useful to read before or during lectures to help follow along and for studying purposes. The practice questions were great as they provided simple examples of questions which as someone who learns through examples was very helpful. Homeworks were also good, they were a reasonable level difficulty and drew out some of the nuances of the topics which couldn't be covered in lecture.
Oooh the lectures were very clearly organized, and the problem sets definitely helped to understand the concepts. Usually they were slightly harder than tests, but that made the tests easier to complete in the time frame. ALSO, I really really appreciated the topic summaries, practice problems, and PRACTICE FINALS/MIDTERMS. Those were key.

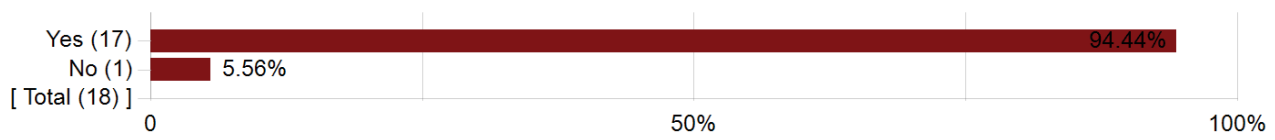
	Mean	Median	N/A	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
This course challenged me intellectually.	4.61	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	38.89%	61.11%
I understood the purpose of this course and what I was expected to gain from it.	4.56	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	5.56%	33.33%	61.11%
I understood the standards for success on assignments.	4.50	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	5.56%	5.56%	22.22%	66.67%
Class time enhanced my ability to succeed in graded assignments.	4.67	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	5.56%	22.22%	72.22%
I received feedback on my performance that helped me improve subsequent work.	4.33	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	22.22%	22.22%	55.56%
My work was evaluated fairly.	4.50	4.50	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	50.00%	50.00%
I felt respected in this class.	4.71	5.00	5.56%	0.00%	0.00%	5.56%	16.67%	72.22%
Overall, this was an excellent course.	4.33	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	5.56%	16.67%	16.67%	61.11%

Additional Comments about this course:

Comments
Very clear notes
Fantastic course. If you choose another professor for 201, you are poorer for it.
Pieters is incredible. Thank you!!

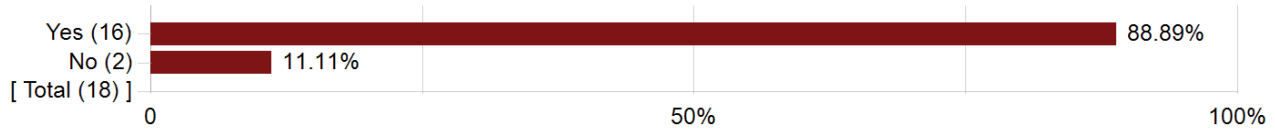
I would recommend this course to highly motivated and well-prepared students

I would recommend this course to highly motivated and well-prepared students



I would recommend this course to anyone interested in the topic

I would recommend this course to anyone interested in the topic



The Instructor

Thinking about your time in class, what aspect of the instructor's teaching contributed most to your learning?

Comments
The assignments, although occasionally filled with errors, were very carefully crafted in a way that it helped you learn more simply by going through the process of the problem. Prof. Pieters knows exactly what you are thinking when you tackle one of her pset problems, and because of that can help guide you to learn more by doing them.
Class notes, topic summaries
Prof. Pieter's delivery was very effective, and she responded to any questions in a kind and constructive way.
writing everything explicitly on the board and having topic summaries and practice problems clearly laid out
Posting practice problems
She organized material into topic summaries and presented topics in a clear, organized manner
Presented clear lectures. Very fair in logistical things
Inconsistencies in the answer keys for the homeworks and practice midterms/finals meant that we had to very thoroughly understand the material in order to identify both the correct answer to the question and any errors in the answer key.
Time spent in Office Hours. She is also good at staying true to the task at hand.
She is incredibly organized which meant that everything was very clear: classes, homework, expectations etc. She was also one of the most accessible professors I've had, although at first, she appeared scary she ended up being one of the friendliest professors I've had. Her office hours were always great, she was patient and offered help without just solving the problems for us. She also really seemed to care about her students, it never felt like she was phoning it in, she had clearly put a lot of thought into the class and seemed to have a very coherent plan for the class.
The lectures were very clearly organized. She walked through problems and was very willing to answer questions, even if they were dumb. The problem sets were great for understanding why things worked - tests were usually different/less proof based, but definitely need the problem sets to understand how to do the problems. LOVED the practice problems each week and also the practice exams!!!!!!!

What could she/he modify to help you learn more?

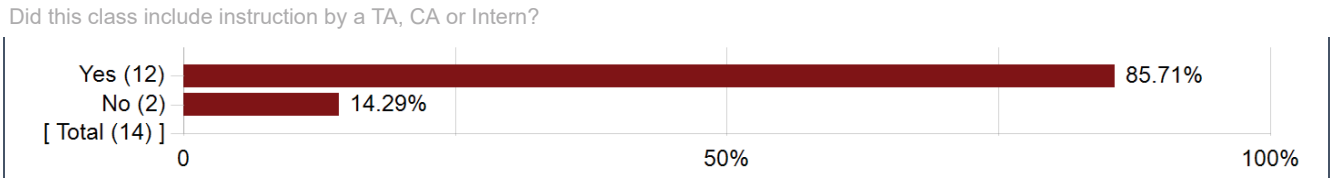
Comments
One more practice test for each exam would be fantastic.
Write the helpful hints in the notes
Can't think of any!
potentially make sure that the last week of class is not rushed, but nothing overall. Dr. Pieters is a wonderful teacher and is very patient and good at explaining abstract economic concepts
I wish she gave more examples in class to show how to apply what we were taught.
Mistakes on the board were frequent to the point of hindering understanding
More consistently correct answer keys, more convenient office hours, could give more thorough/direct answers to in-class questions.
Professor Pieters is a great lecturer, but a lot of the homework and study materials had errors that slowed everyone down and were annoying to correct. Her curve is also brutal. Very few people will get an A.
I would appreciate more of a vision. I feel somewhat unaware of what is going on and don't really understand the process for how she comes to conclusions or how it impacts the next thing she is going to do.
Nothing, she was my favorite professor I've I had at this college.
Hmm. Thinking about it, maybe make the lectures more engaging? Sometimes they got kinda dry.

The Instructor

	Mean	Median	N/A	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
Organized the course clearly.	4.69	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	31.25%	68.75%
Presented lectures that enhanced your understanding.	4.56	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	6.25%	31.25%	62.50%
Facilitated discussions that were engaging and useful.	4.40	4.00	6.25%	0.00%	0.00%	6.25%	43.75%	43.75%
Stimulated your interest in the core ideas of the course.	4.44	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	12.50%	31.25%	56.25%
Challenged you to learn.	4.63	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	6.25%	25.00%	68.75%
Helped you gain significant learning from the course content.	4.63	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	6.25%	25.00%	68.75%
Was available and helpful outside of class.	4.43	5.00	12.50%	0.00%	0.00%	12.50%	25.00%	50.00%
Motivated you to think independently.	4.31	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	6.25%	18.75%	12.50%	62.50%
Worked to create an inclusive and welcoming environment.	4.60	5.00	6.25%	0.00%	0.00%	12.50%	12.50%	68.75%
Overall, this instructor made a significant contribution to your learning.	4.56	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	6.25%	31.25%	62.50%

The Teaching Assistant, Course Assistant, Intern

Did this class include instruction by a TA, CA or Intern?



What aspects of the TA's teaching contributed most to your learning?

Comments
They were always willing to help and addressed any questions from students.
The help they gave during the discussions on the homework
Amazing TA, highly recommend - goes out of his way to teach students and help them understand concepts.
He made himself available to help on difficult homework questions
The Reg office hours during 10th week
Arturo's great. Nice and helpful.
Discussion sections were sometimes useful and he responded fairly promptly to my email.
Arturo was great. Discussions were very helpful because he walked through the problems to really nail-in the process.

What could she/he modify to help you learn more?

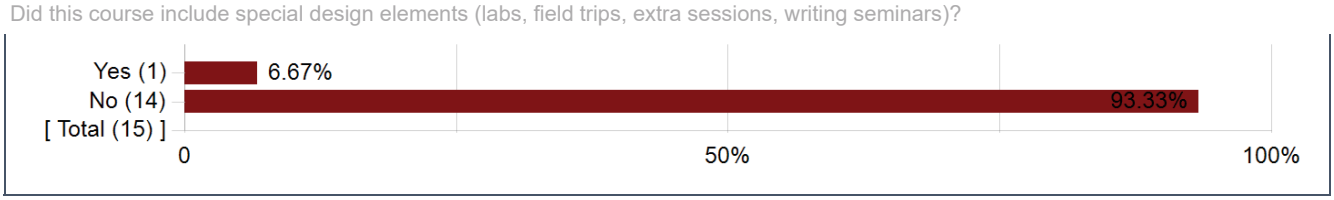
Comments
making sure that discussion reviews are well-planned out (which they were) and giving explicit examples, as that is what is not taught during lecture
Nothing
Nothing.
Both TAs often felt a little dozy, they never particularly felt like they were on top of everything. In office hours they often seemed to just be relying on the professor's answer key rather than trying to answer questions with their own knowledge. This often led to confused answers that did not fully answer the original question. I have seen multiple people, including myself, be more confused after asking one of the TAs. There was also an incident where both TAs gave me a wrong answer to a question I asked which was very frustrating. They needed to be much more familiar with the homework and lectures, they often had not seen a problem before it was brought up in office hours and discussion sections sometimes repeated and/or contradicted lectures.
He could probably spend a bit more time familiarizing himself with the problem sets before the discussion so that when we have questions, he didn't spend like 5 minutes trying to figure out how to solve the question.

TA/CA or Intern

	Mean	Median	N/A	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
Facilitated discussions that supported your learning.	4.14	4.00	12.50%	0.00%	0.00%	25.00%	25.00%	37.50%
Gave you useful feedback on your work.	4.43	5.00	12.50%	0.00%	0.00%	12.50%	25.00%	50.00%
Stimulated your interest in the core ideas of the course.	4.14	4.00	12.50%	0.00%	0.00%	25.00%	25.00%	37.50%
Challenged you to learn.	4.13	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	25.00%	37.50%	37.50%
Helped you succeed in the class.	4.00	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	12.50%	12.50%	37.50%	37.50%
Was available and helpful outside of class.	4.25	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	12.50%	50.00%	37.50%
Overall, the TA/CA made a significant contribution to your learning.	4.00	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	12.50%	12.50%	37.50%	37.50%

Additional Course Elements

Did this course include special design elements (labs, field trips, extra sessions, writing seminars)?

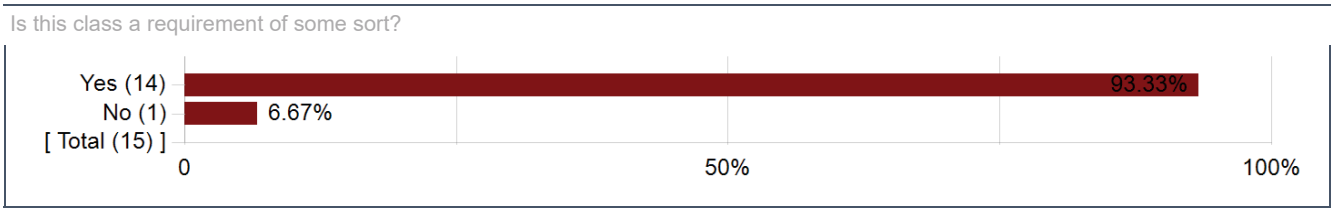


How much did the following elements of the course contribute to your learning gains?

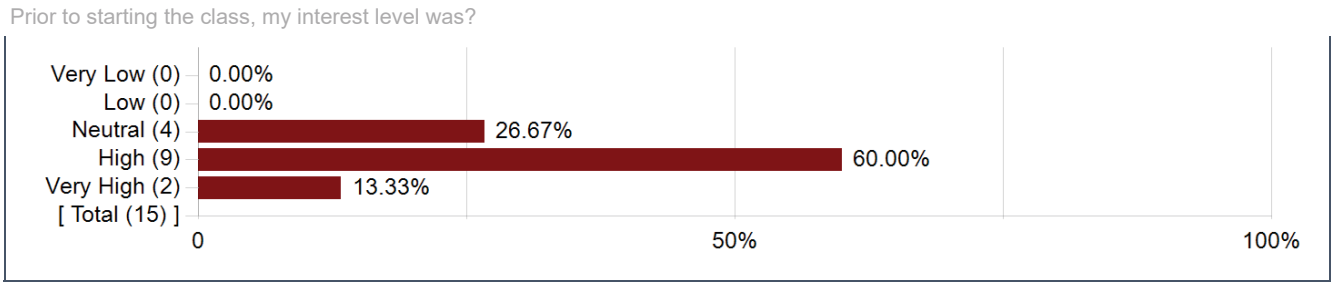
	Mean	Median	N/A	No Gain	A Little Gain	Moderate Gain	Good Gain	Great Gain
Laboratory Experience	N/A	N/A	100.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%
Field Trips	N/A	N/A	100.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%
Library Sessions	N/A	N/A	100.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%
Review sessions	N/A	N/A	100.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%
Writing Seminars	N/A	N/A	100.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%

Student Information

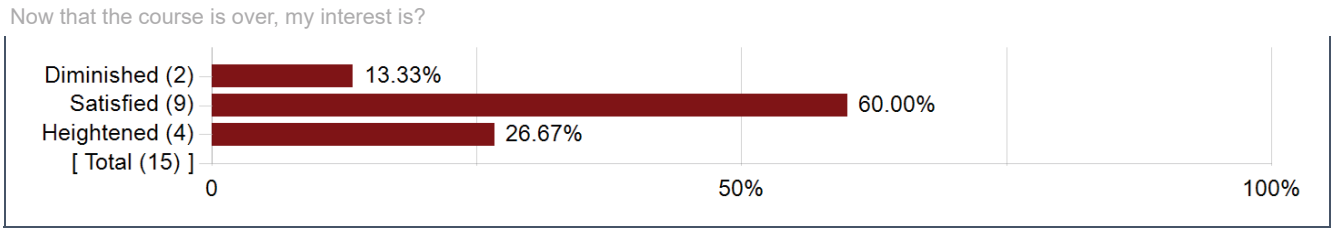
Is this class a requirement of some sort?



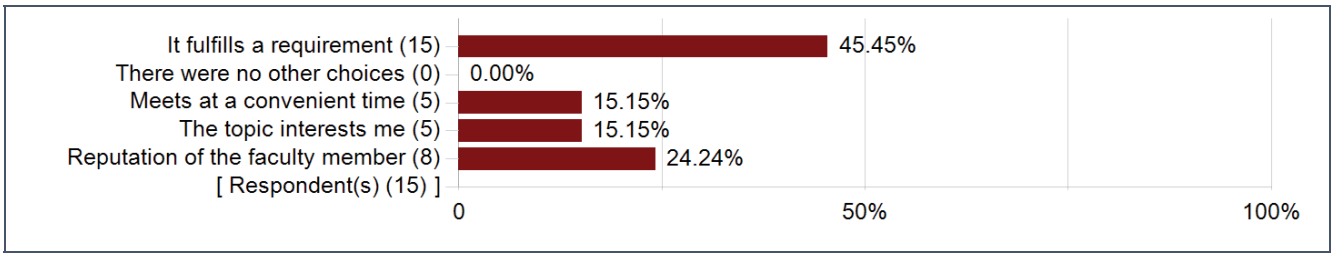
Prior to starting the class, my interest level was?



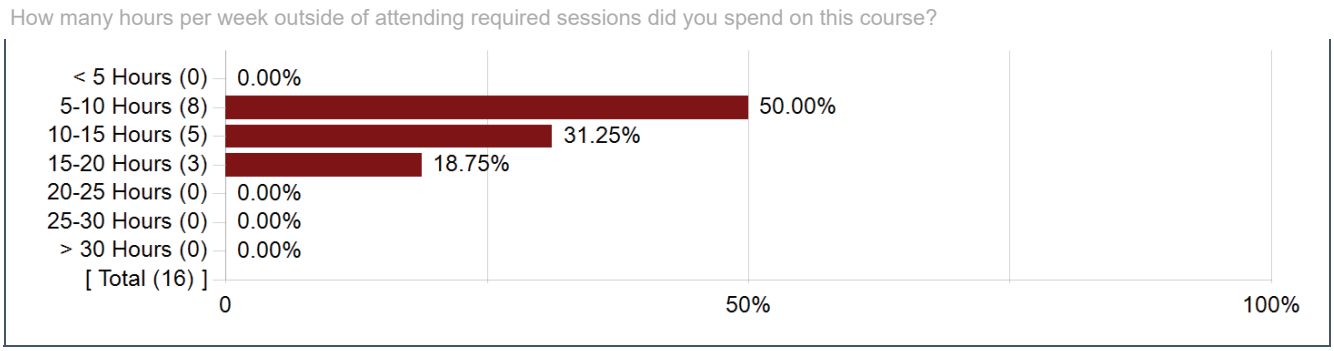
Now that the course is over, my interest is?



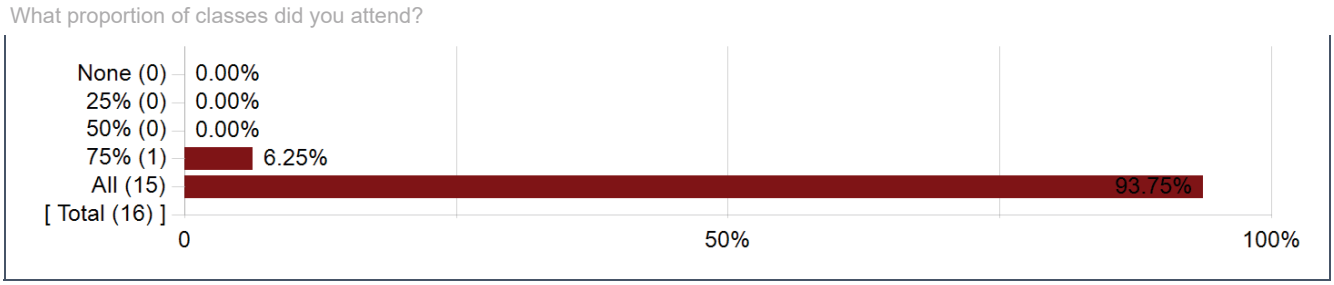
Why, primarily, did you take this course over others?



How many hours per week outside of attending required sessions did you spend on this course?



What proportion of classes did you attend?



Please comment on the level of difficulty of the course relative to your background and experience.

Comments
this was a fair class based off of having taken econ 200. A strong skill in algebra and partial derivatives is helpful. The final was more difficult theoretically and the course challenges you not only to learn but interpret the material and that helped me gain strong foundations. That said, it was difficult and if you slack off even for a week you will be behind
Took honors econ 200 and I found the transition difficult because we spent so little time on theory in this class that it was sometimes difficult to know what we were doing at a higher level
This class felt entirely reasonable given ECON 200
Definitely not easy, but Prof tried to make it fair for students coming from different econ 200 teachers. I don't think that the students that took her 200 section had an advantage, especially because she provided practice exams.

Please identify the name of the TA/CA/Intern you are commenting about.

Comments
Varun, Arturo
Varun and Arturo
Varun
Varun Ahluwalia
Varun Ahlawallia
Arturo
Varun Ahluwalia
Arturo

THE UNIVERSITY OF CHICAGO

ECON 20100 2 - The Elements of Economic Analysis II (Winter 2019) - Instructor(s): Gina Pieters

Number Enrolled: **50**
Number of Responses: **14**

Report Comments

Opinions expressed in these evaluations are those of students enrolled in the specific course and do not represent the University.

Creation Date: **Tuesday, June 23, 2020**

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The Course

What are the most important things that you learned in this course? Please reflect on the knowledge and skills you gained.

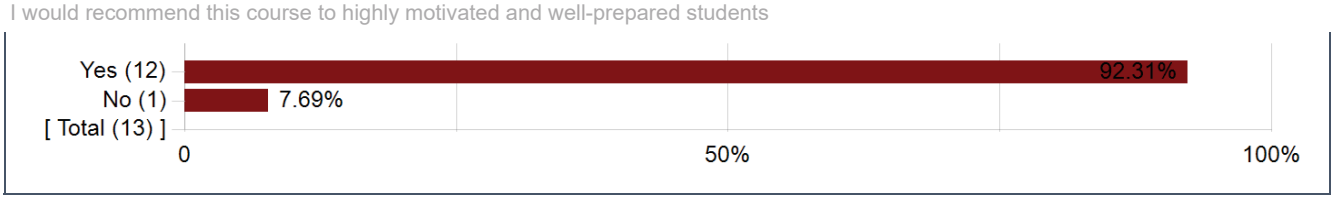
Comments
Theory of the firm. General equilibrium. Oligopolies and monopolies. Introduction to game theory.
General equilibrium, social planner's problem, game theory, price discrimination. These were all new concepts I learned in this course and I appreciated learning how to implement them mathematically.
Continue on with Analysis I
how to solve quantitative problems
The supply side of microeconomics- types of competition between firms, cost minimization, profit maximization etc.
We learned how a firm maximizes profit, and a consumer minimizes cost, and how both combine to find a market equilibrium.
How to truly understand concepts beyond the surface level
structured teaching style and various resource for further studies and preparation

Describe how aspects of this course (lectures, discussions, labs, assignments, etc.) contributed to your learning.

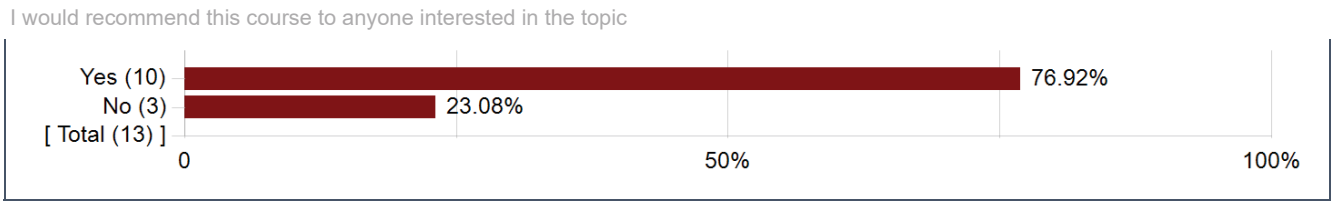
Comments
Lectures and lecture notes are very helpful. Psets are pretty tough, but end up teaching you alot.
Lectures, homework, and office hours with the professor were the most contributive to my learning. Discussions were not so much, because they were a rehash of lectures but in a drier manner.
All learning happened in lecture, homework solidified concepts.
lectures were the most helpful
The lectures were meant to help us understand the background theory and assignments were meant to help us get practice with the quantitative elements of the course. However, it was rather difficult to do assignments/exams that had questions not previously discussed in lecture.
The lectures are necessary, but Professor Pieter's topic summaries and practice problems are super helpful!
The lectures were very helpful, along with the short two-page summaries of the key Topics covered during lectures. The discussion sections were also helpful to varying degrees but I would still recommend them to any student who want to cement their understanding and performance on the assignments. As far as assignments go, they were pretty reasonable and a good indicator of how you'll do on the exams.
Lectures, everything she does on the board is well written and clear. She is able to explain concepts in a way that actually makes sense to someone that is not a grad student.
lectures, review sessions, and office hours are all super helpful

	Mean	Median	N/A	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
This course challenged me intellectually.	4.77	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	23.08%	76.92%
I understood the purpose of this course and what I was expected to gain from it.	4.57	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	7.14%	28.57%	64.29%
I understood the standards for success on assignments.	4.57	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	7.14%	28.57%	64.29%
Class time enhanced my ability to succeed in graded assignments.	4.50	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	7.14%	0.00%	28.57%	64.29%
I received feedback on my performance that helped me improve subsequent work.	3.93	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	14.29%	21.43%	21.43%	42.86%
My work was evaluated fairly.	4.36	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	7.14%	14.29%	14.29%	64.29%
I felt respected in this class.	4.29	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	14.29%	7.14%	14.29%	64.29%
Overall, this was an excellent course.	4.07	4.00	0.00%	7.14%	0.00%	7.14%	50.00%	35.71%

I would recommend this course to highly motivated and well-prepared students



I would recommend this course to anyone interested in the topic



The Instructor

Thinking about your time in class, what aspect of the instructor's teaching contributed most to your learning?

Comments
Prof. Pieters is very good at explaining difficult concepts and always answers peoples questions well.
Office Hours. A lot of the learning comes from the assignments she gives, and if you don't make an effort to attend office hours, it's difficult to do well on them, at least if you're not very mathematically inclined. She's also very approachable during office hours and is willing to help you with anything. I asked her about a concept I should have understood from last quarter, and she helped me out with learning it with no judgement. She also is willing to even stay beyond the time she says she is available for office hours because she cares THAT much about her students.
Structured/organization
lectures
She encourages people to ask questions and meet during office hours.
Professor Pieter's lectures are very well structured and she is always willing to answer any questions we have.
Professor Pieters always came to class well-prepared and gave clear, structured lectures. Overall she was really good at teaching the topics in a way that was easily understandable for the majority of students and she also encouraged class participation while still remaining friendly and approachable.
Lectures, lovely lecturer, everything makes sense and is well written
structured teaching style and various resource for further studies and preparation
Pieters is a good lecturer and explains economic concepts well

What could she/he modify to help you learn more?

Comments
It would help if she could release the homework a little bit earlier, and if with fewer typos. Sometimes lectures feel a bit dry, because we're just watching her do math, e.g. the one where she spent 45 minutes doing a general equilibrium problem, which I felt made the problem seem a lot more complicated than it really was. I think in general, because Pieters is so math heavy, it would help if she explained a little bit more of the intuition behind the math, the set up and execution. Otherwise, the entire class just feels like sink or swim in alphabet soup environment.
Prof. Pieters NEEDS better notation - inconsistency with notation and constant confusion of exponents vs. subscript make following her work on the board difficult.
every single document, including exams, managed to have at least 1 typo, whether it was a missing word or a completely wrong statement. please stop making typos. additionally, towards the end of the course, she stopped showing all the steps in her math, making it harder to follow along.
This wasnt, frankly, a great experience for me. With over a 100 students in class, its impossible to go to office hours and get time to understand complicated assignment questions when we havent done similar examples in lecture. There were always numerous typos on exam questions, homework questions and solutions so one was always confused about what was to be done, until it was clarified by the Prof. The midterm was difficult and featured some questions we had never seen examples of in assignments or lecture. the "i dont know" rule, while meant to be helpful was actually very discouraging and frightened people from even trying to attempt questions.
Could tie in math more clearly when teaching without skipping all the steps

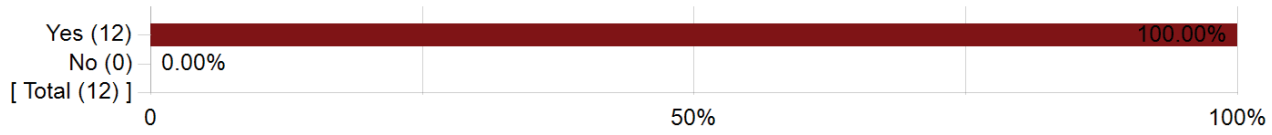
The Instructor

	Mean	Median	N/A	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
Organized the course clearly.	4.86	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	14.29%	85.71%
Presented lectures that enhanced your understanding.	4.69	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	30.77%	69.23%
Facilitated discussions that were engaging and useful.	4.38	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	7.69%	46.15%	46.15%
Stimulated your interest in the core ideas of the course.	4.08	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	7.69%	23.08%	23.08%	46.15%
Challenged you to learn.	4.85	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	15.38%	84.62%
Helped you gain significant learning from the course content.	4.54	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	7.69%	0.00%	23.08%	69.23%
Was available and helpful outside of class.	4.67	5.00	7.69%	0.00%	0.00%	7.69%	15.38%	69.23%
Motivated you to think independently.	4.54	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	7.69%	30.77%	61.54%
Worked to create an inclusive and welcoming environment.	4.15	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	15.38%	7.69%	23.08%	53.85%
Overall, this instructor made a significant contribution to your learning.	4.38	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	7.69%	0.00%	38.46%	53.85%

The Teaching Assistant, Course Assistant, Intern

Did this class include instruction by a TA, CA or Intern?

Did this class include instruction by a TA, CA or Intern?



What aspects of the TA's teaching contributed most to your learning?

Comments
Office hours
TA lead discussion course and helped with grading. He was fine at both.
The TAs were both absolutely fantastic, probably the only reason I'm passing this course. They very available outside class and office hours, met for extra sessions and took questions by email. They really helped break down complicated topics and went over simpler explanations again and again.
His discussion sections were very helpful, in that they retaught the material in a different way.
Discussion
Kind personality and patience with students
Very helpful during office hours in explaining how to approach homework problems

What could she/he modify to help you learn more?

Comments
Make them more engaging. Also, help out in perhaps explaining the concepts taught in class in a way that adds to one's learning and doesn't repeat what has already been said. For instance, I appreciated how Arturo showed us a different but more intuitive way of setting up and solving a general equilibrium problem.
Varun was a great great help and Arturo was wonderful too! They saved us.
He didn't save time in discussion section to answer homework questions which was slightly irritating.

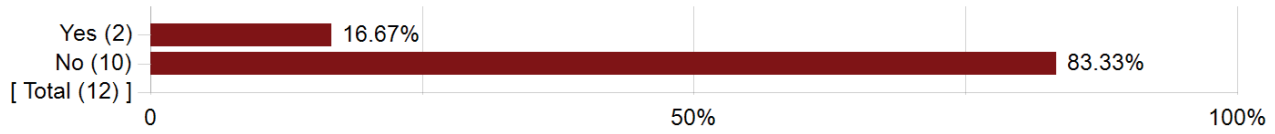
TA/CA or Intern

	Mean	Median	N/A	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
Facilitated discussions that supported your learning.	4.33	5.00	10.00%	0.00%	10.00%	10.00%	10.00%	60.00%
Gave you useful feedback on your work.	4.22	5.00	10.00%	0.00%	10.00%	20.00%	0.00%	60.00%
Stimulated your interest in the core ideas of the course.	4.22	5.00	10.00%	0.00%	10.00%	20.00%	0.00%	60.00%
Challenged you to learn.	4.33	5.00	10.00%	0.00%	0.00%	30.00%	0.00%	60.00%
Helped you succeed in the class.	4.56	5.00	10.00%	0.00%	0.00%	10.00%	20.00%	60.00%
Was available and helpful outside of class.	4.78	5.00	10.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	20.00%	70.00%
Overall, the TA/CA made a significant contribution to your learning.	4.44	5.00	10.00%	0.00%	0.00%	20.00%	10.00%	60.00%

Additional Course Elements

Did this course include special design elements (labs, field trips, extra sessions, writing seminars)?

Did this course include special design elements (labs, field trips, extra sessions, writing seminars)?



How much did the following elements of the course contribute to your learning gains?

	Mean	Median	N/A	No Gain	A Little Gain	Moderate Gain	Good Gain	Great Gain
Laboratory Experience	N/A	N/A	100.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%
Field Trips	N/A	N/A	100.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%
Library Sessions	N/A	N/A	100.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%
Review sessions	4.33	4.00	40.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	40.00%	20.00%
Writing Seminars	N/A	N/A	100.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%

Other course elements not mentioned above:

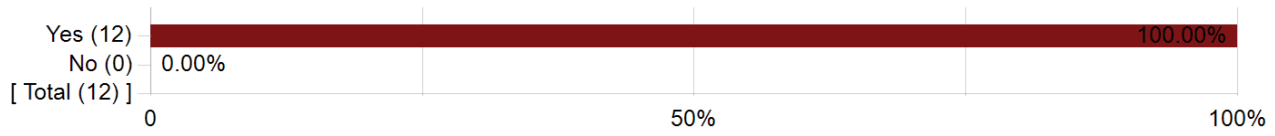
Comments

Review Sessions = TA sessions were great.

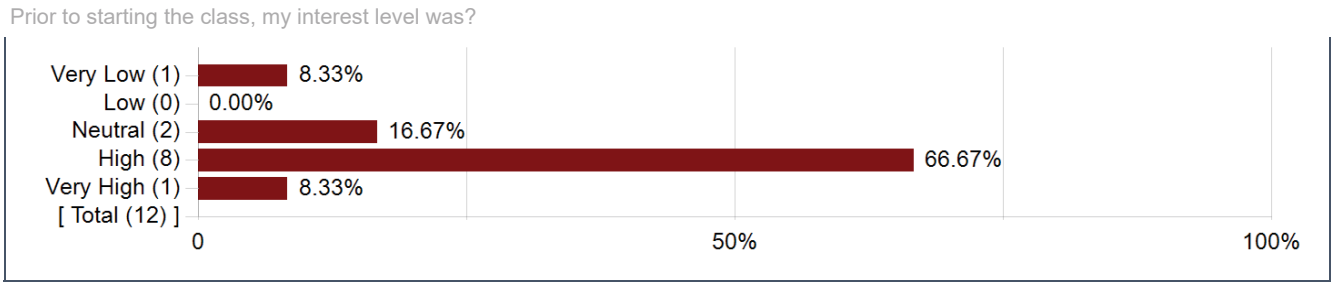
Student Information

Is this class a requirement of some sort?

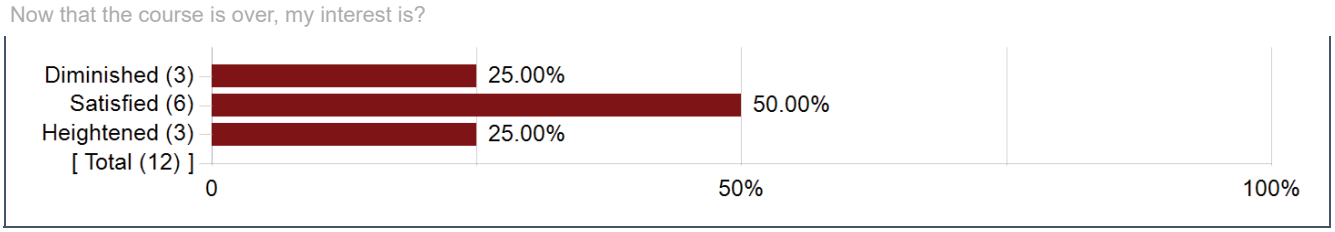
Is this class a requirement of some sort?



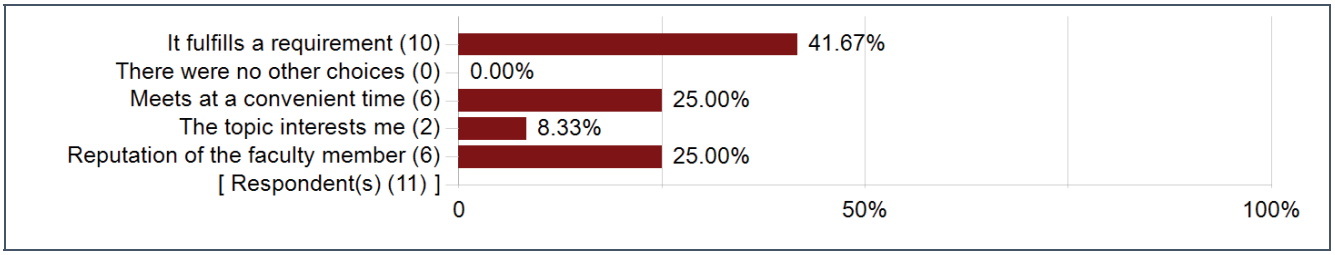
Prior to starting the class, my interest level was?



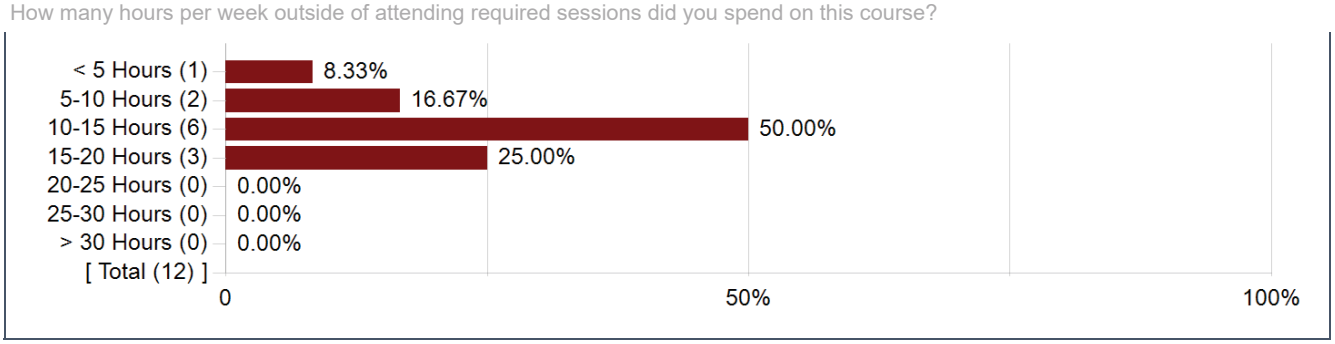
Now that the course is over, my interest is?



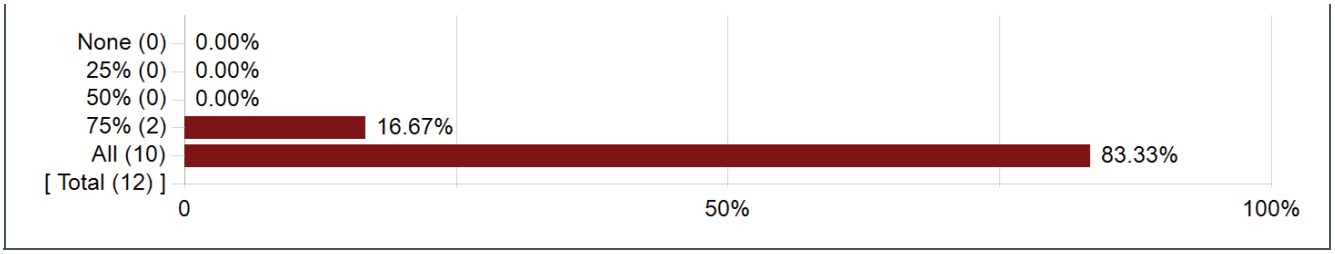
Why, primarily, did you take this course over others?



How many hours per week outside of attending required sessions did you spend on this course?



What proportion of classes did you attend?



Please comment on the level of difficulty of the course relative to your background and experience.

Comments
More difficult than expected but her teaching makes it worth it

Please identify the name of the TA/CA/Intern you are commenting about.

Comments
Varun
Arturo Joachin
Arturo
Arturo
Varun, Arturo
Arturo
Arturo Joachin
Arturo
Arturo

THE UNIVERSITY OF CHICAGO

ECON 20200 1 - The Elements of Economic Analysis III (Spring 2019) - Instructor(s): Gina Pieters

Number Enrolled: **52**
Number of Responses: **18**

Report Comments

Opinions expressed in these evaluations are those of students enrolled in the specific course and do not represent the University.

Creation Date: **Tuesday, June 23, 2020**

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The Course

What are the most important things that you learned in this course? Please reflect on the knowledge and skills you gained.

Comments
Lots of Lagrangians
Solving macroeconomic models.
basic macroeconomics models
I learned basic macroeconomic models
How to think about different economic models and to understand what different models lacked and how we progressed from the beginning models to today. what it means to be in steady state
MATLAB and Dynare
A lot of macro models. So many models.
Many models.
The models. They are very important tools and foundations for later macroeconomics.
How to do a lagrangian, different models of general equilibrium, and combining consumer with the macroeconomy
Very closely related to the rest of the sequence, with the calculus this time just being thematically related to macroeconomics.
How to construct and evaluate different macroeconomic models. Some basic MATLAB skills and understanding of the history of macroeconomics in the 20th century.
The basics of economic models--the intricacies of how they are derived, how they've changed over time and how they are applied in real examples.
Macroeconomic models

Describe how aspects of this course (lectures, discussions, labs, assignments, etc.) contributed to your learning.

Comments
Loved the practice problems, practice midterms, and topic summaries. Homeworks 1-4 were significantly harder than 5-7. HATED the coding.
Lectures are crucial, the problem sets take time, but are necessary to understanding the material.
lectures, topic summaries, homework are helpful
Lectures were dry, but office hours and assignments helped to improve my study of the material
Lecture notes, solutions, and practice tests were immensely helpful in self-review
Office hours are so so important!!!
Lectures and TA discussion sections helped me learn the math, regular Topic Summaries helped me with concepts, and HW assignments were a struggle.
Lectures among topic summaries + practice problems were the most helpful to my learning. Discussions taught by the right TA were helpful in reviewing the material covered in class.
Lectures and office hours are great. HW was challenging but fun, in a way...
lectures are essential to learning the material and TA discussions were very useful for the homeworks and for reviewing class material
Varun's discussion sections were quite helpful. Working on PSETs with my peers helped me grasp the concepts discussed in class more clearly.
Lectures helpful, readings useless, never went to discussion, assignments challenging but prepared you well for exams
Lectures varied between heavy math and talking more broadly about topics in macroeconomics/looking at data. The assignments gave an opportunity to practice solving models and interpreting results.
Lectures were engaging and the basis of the course. Homework assignments and TA sessions were consistent and fair evaluations of the course material and what would be relevant for testing.
Her lectures were very clear and easy to understand.

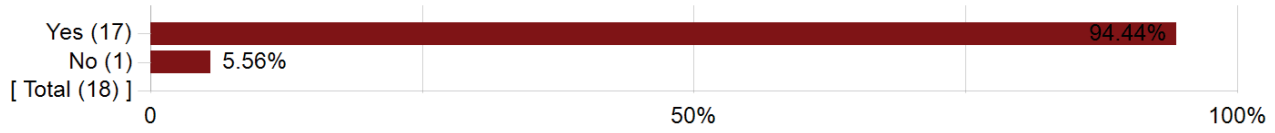
	Mean	Median	N/A	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
This course challenged me intellectually.	4.71	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	29.41%	70.59%
I understood the purpose of this course and what I was expected to gain from it.	4.28	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	5.56%	16.67%	22.22%	55.56%
I understood the standards for success on assignments.	4.33	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	22.22%	22.22%	55.56%
Class time enhanced my ability to succeed in graded assignments.	4.33	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	5.56%	11.11%	27.78%	55.56%
I received feedback on my performance that helped me improve subsequent work.	4.18	4.00	5.56%	0.00%	11.11%	5.56%	33.33%	44.44%
My work was evaluated fairly.	4.39	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	5.56%	11.11%	22.22%	61.11%
I felt respected in this class.	4.39	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	11.11%	5.56%	16.67%	66.67%
Overall, this was an excellent course.	4.06	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	5.56%	16.67%	44.44%	33.33%

Additional Comments about this course:

Comments
Macro (202) is a lot harder than micro (200 and 201)
This is an ideal course for students who need to complete the basic sequence for the economics sequence. I would personally recommend staying with this teacher for all three classes in the sequence, as the consistency between quarters cannot be overstated in its ability to help e succeed in this course.

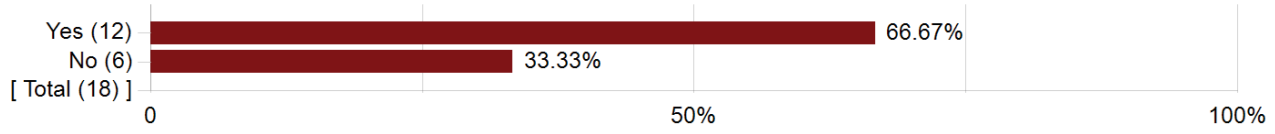
I would recommend this course to highly motivated and well-prepared students

I would recommend this course to highly motivated and well-prepared students



I would recommend this course to anyone interested in the topic

I would recommend this course to anyone interested in the topic



The Instructor

Thinking about your time in class, what aspect of the instructor's teaching contributed most to your learning?

Comments
She is great. Office hours, the amount of practice problems she provide, etc. Also, I love the discussion board idea. One of the best econ professors I've had here.
Pieters is a fantastic lecturer, and teaches material better than any of the other 200s professors. Her assignments and exams are often frustratingly difficult and inconsistent in difficulty, but she does grade fairly. If you really care about coming out of the 200s with the best understanding of economic methods, take her class. It will be very time intensive, and you may not get the best grades, but it will be completely worth it.
lectures
She knows the material very well
Detailed explanations about process. Dedication to students Incredibly flexible of a teacher
Office hours. Dr. Pieters is great at helping and explaining things one on one. Lectures contained a lot of algebra
She's a good lecturer, who makes smart use of board space and presentations. Also, she gave us loads of materials on the course content and before tests.
Prof Pieters is a great lecturer when she does not have to perform "public math" and doesn't have typos in her notes. She is very clear with what she expects from the students and fair with psets and exams.
Her lectures are good. Office hours very good. I like the amount of resources Gina provides - topic summaries, practice problems for each topic, two practice midterms, and two practice finals. A lot of study material!
her lectures were incredibly organized and she was very methodical about her instruction
Strong organization and variety of supplementary materials on the Canvas site. Without the topic summaries and practice problems I would have been absolutely lost (and I'm saying that never having missed a lecture.)
Professor Pieters is extremely organized and gives you all the tools you need to succeed in her class. Her class is challenging because she has high standards for her students, but the class is not impossible by any means. Go to class, take notes, do practice problems, ask lots of questions, and you should not fail. Before this class, I was never particularly keen on going to office hours, but I found myself going to office hours in this class not only to ask clarifying questions about the material but also just to chat. Unlike many in the economics department, Professor Pieters is a highly capable instructor who can do the math and also communicate the concepts effectively, give fair tests and assignments, and treat students with respect. She is one of the best teachers I have ever had.
Professor Pieters provided students with an overwhelmingly amount of useful material. She was consistent, organized, and approachable, as well as humorous and personable when appropriate.
I really liked how she spent time on materials until students get the full grasp of them.

What could she/he modify to help you learn more?

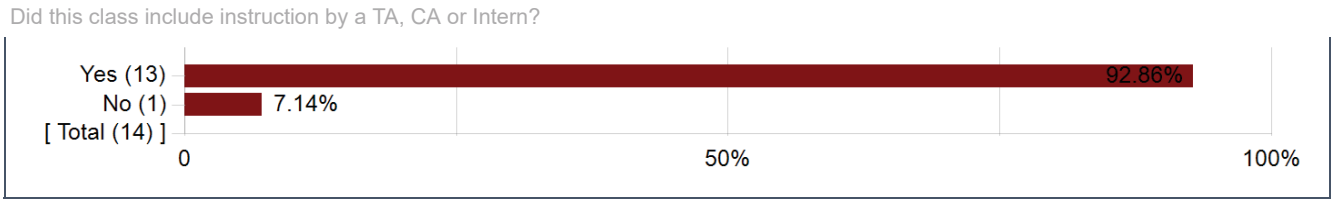
Comments
I think her lectures are a bit dry. Especially when she talked about the business cycles, she would just talk about powerpoint slides, and I really struggled to pay attention.
More consistency with exam difficulty, more generous curve.
stop making so many typos. almost every single document uploaded has a typo.
She needs to better structure her lectures and explain the math behind the material.
Spend less time going through math and post more notes with the math explained, this way class time can be left to learning about the concepts.
I never really understood the point of anything we learned. As in, we learned a bunch of models but I never really knew the advantages of one over another or how things fit together.
She could be less condescending -- I don't understand why she feels the need to make certain comments in class/flaunt her knowledge of economics. For many students this is the beginning sequence of economics so of course we don't know half the things she references.
Maybe assign the hw on the day or day after it's due rather than on Sunday (psets due Wednesday).
nothing
Go over the algebra (crucial component of some models) more slowly. Explain novel concepts in clearer terms.
Relate more to real-world topics and problems, give us a sense of what we have learned/are learning in the field vs what future, more advanced courses will explore
Please check for typos!!
There are usually a fair amount of mistakes in study guides or homework assignments that are usually quickly remedied--but avoiding them in the first place could be an improvement.
Clarify what is being asked in the questions on homework.

The Instructor

	Mean	Median	N/A	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
Organized the course clearly.	4.28	4.50	0.00%	0.00%	5.56%	11.11%	33.33%	50.00%
Presented lectures that enhanced your understanding.	4.28	4.50	0.00%	0.00%	5.56%	11.11%	33.33%	50.00%
Facilitated discussions that were engaging and useful.	3.94	4.00	5.56%	0.00%	11.11%	22.22%	22.22%	38.89%
Stimulated your interest in the core ideas of the course.	4.11	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	11.11%	5.56%	44.44%	38.89%
Challenged you to learn.	4.67	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	5.56%	22.22%	72.22%
Helped you gain significant learning from the course content.	4.56	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	11.11%	22.22%	66.67%
Was available and helpful outside of class.	4.50	5.00	11.11%	0.00%	0.00%	11.11%	22.22%	55.56%
Motivated you to think independently.	4.35	5.00	5.56%	0.00%	5.56%	11.11%	22.22%	55.56%
Worked to create an inclusive and welcoming environment.	3.94	5.00	0.00%	11.11%	5.56%	16.67%	11.11%	55.56%
Overall, this instructor made a significant contribution to your learning.	4.33	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	11.11%	5.56%	22.22%	61.11%

The Teaching Assistant, Course Assistant, Intern

Did this class include instruction by a TA, CA or Intern?



What aspects of the TA's teaching contributed most to your learning?

Comments
Really liked Varun's slides at discussion. Arturo's office hours were incredible.
presentations during discussions breaking down how to solve the problems
His discussion sessions were really great at helping me solidify my previous understanding of concepts.
Varun's discussion sections were very good - presented study guides and presentations that were good supplements to the lectures, no wonder he won an a teaching award... Arturo was very helpful during office hours w/ hw and good at figuring out typos.
His powerpoints of review were insanely helpful and he did a great job delving into class material to help students learn
patient, organized, clear
Varun is the best TA I have ever had. He is extremely helpful and able to organize and explain the material in a way that complements how the professor teaches. His discussion sections are highly productive
Varun was relaxed and approachable, leading discussion sections that were well-organized and efficient.

What could she/he modify to help you learn more?

Comments
They knew nothing about coding, and also sometimes they would answer your question with the answer but not really explain it because they weren't super prepared.
nothing, varun is the best
N/a
He would blow through the math like it was nothing and I wish he would spend more time working through it slowly. Discussion section should be a time to help those, like me, who fell behind on understanding during lectures.
nothing

TA/CA or Intern

	Mean	Median	N/A	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
Facilitated discussions that supported your learning.	4.67	5.00	10.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	30.00%	60.00%
Gave you useful feedback on your work.	4.44	5.00	10.00%	0.00%	0.00%	20.00%	10.00%	60.00%
Stimulated your interest in the core ideas of the course.	4.50	5.00	20.00%	0.00%	0.00%	10.00%	20.00%	50.00%
Challenged you to learn.	4.50	5.00	20.00%	0.00%	0.00%	10.00%	20.00%	50.00%
Helped you succeed in the class.	4.57	5.00	30.00%	0.00%	0.00%	10.00%	10.00%	50.00%
Was available and helpful outside of class.	4.89	5.00	10.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	10.00%	80.00%
Overall, the TA/CA made a significant contribution to your learning.	4.63	5.00	20.00%	0.00%	0.00%	10.00%	10.00%	60.00%

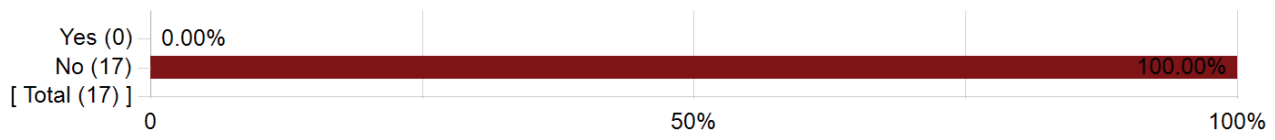
Additional feedback to the TA/CA/Intern:

Comments
varun was a fantastic TA!!
I went to only a few of the discussion sections, but my impression was overly positive and Varun always graded homework and tests in an incredibly timely manner!

Additional Course Elements

Did this course include special design elements (labs, field trips, extra sessions, writing seminars)?

Did this course include special design elements (labs, field trips, extra sessions, writing seminars)?



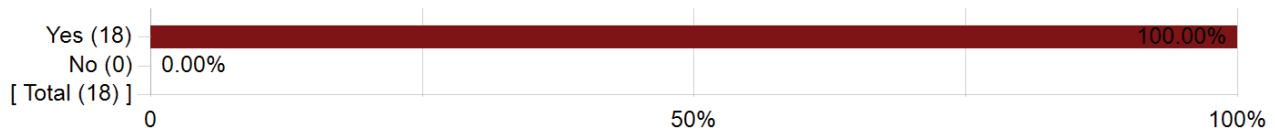
How much did the following elements of the course contribute to your learning gains?

	Mean	Median	N/A	No Gain	A Little Gain	Moderate Gain	Good Gain	Great Gain
Laboratory Experience	N/A	N/A	100.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%
Field Trips	N/A	N/A	100.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%
Library Sessions	N/A	N/A	100.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%
Review sessions	N/A	N/A	100.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%
Writing Seminars	N/A	N/A	100.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%

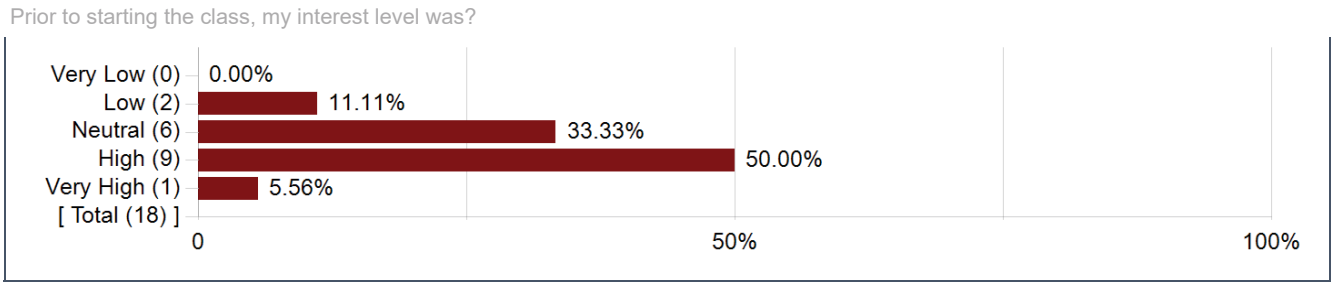
Student Information

Is this class a requirement of some sort?

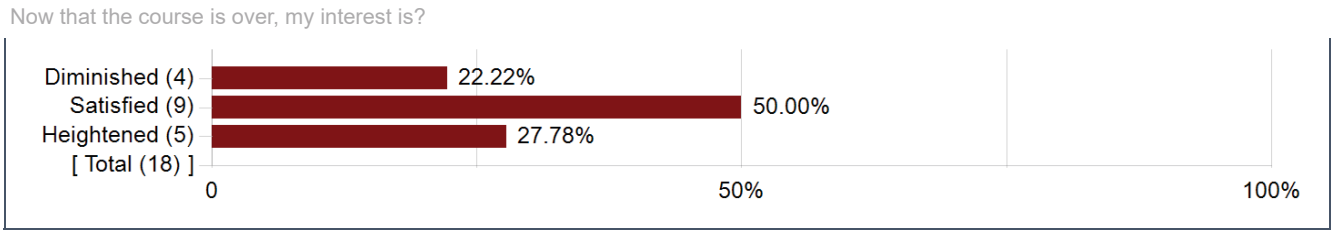
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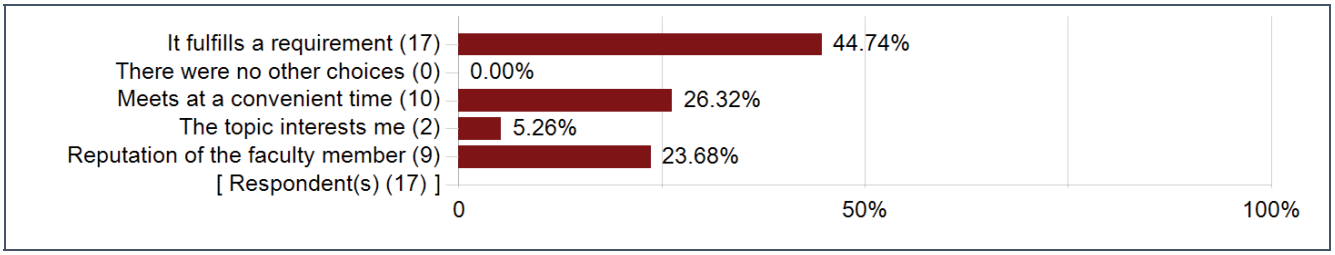
Prior to starting the class, my interest level was?



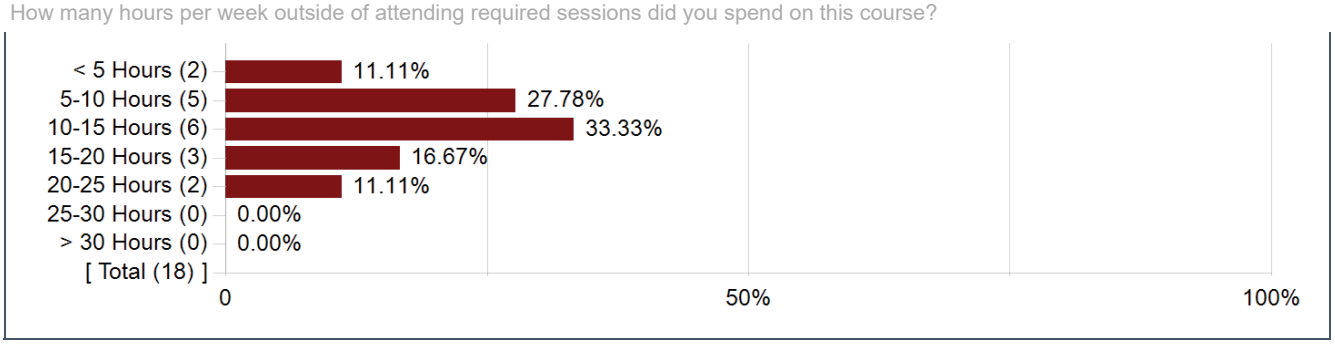
Now that the course is over, my interest is?



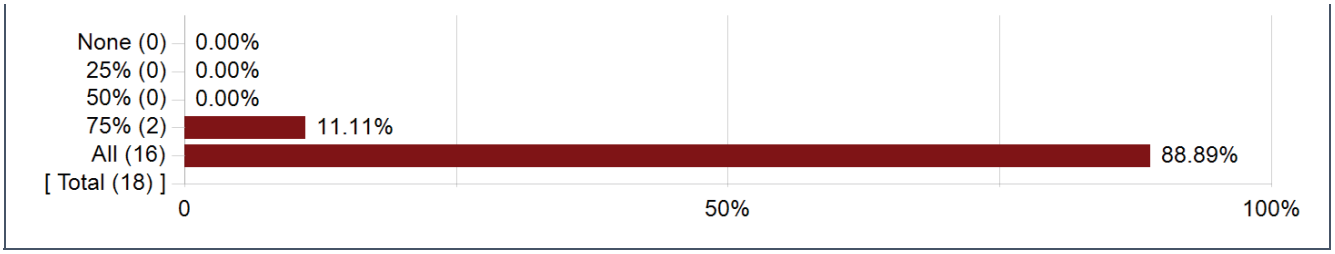
Why, primarily, did you take this course over others?



How many hours per week outside of attending required sessions did you spend on this course?



What proportion of classes did you attend?



Please comment on the level of difficulty of the course relative to your background and experience.

Comments
This course is very math-heavy, so steer away if you're not yet confident in your arithmetic and ability to take partials. Professor Pieters is tough but fair.
Took the honors sequence (200H, 201H). Liked the material in regular a lot better - no vector mathematics and theorems, but looking at how model can reflect data.
Dynare and Matlab were incredibly difficult as I had no coding experience, and it felt unfair that others were able to breeze through it
Having already taken ECON 20000 and ECON 20100 with this professor, I was exactly qualified to succeed in this course.

Please identify the name of the TA/CA/Intern you are commenting about.

Comments
Varun and Arturo
Varun and Arturo
Varun Ahluwalia
Varun
Varun/Arturo
Varun
Varun
Varun
Varun Ahluwalia

THE UNIVERSITY OF CHICAGO

ECON 20200 2 - The Elements of Economic Analysis III (Spring 2019) - Instructor(s): Gina Pieters

Number Enrolled: **50**
Number of Responses: **13**

Report Comments

Opinions expressed in these evaluations are those of students enrolled in the specific course and do not represent the University.

Creation Date: **Tuesday, June 23, 2020**

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The Course

What are the most important things that you learned in this course? Please reflect on the knowledge and skills you gained.

Comments
Multiple economic modeling methods
Different macroeconomic models through time (Solow, Neoclassical, asset pricing, overlapping generations model, etc) Also a bit of Matlab in preparation for future policy courses
economic models and intuitions
Optimization on a macroeconomic level; growth rates and trends, optimal savings and interest rates under a variety of different economic models.
Basics of Macroeconomics, lots of Models
As with 200 and 201 its kind of hard to say what is important before I have taken more classes in the major.
Macro
Built on knowledge of microeconomics from 200 and 201 to form a solid foundation in macroeconomic analysis. Became acquainted with several important macroeconomic topics and models
Basics of macro, there was a lot of Algebra

Describe how aspects of this course (lectures, discussions, labs, assignments, etc.) contributed to your learning.

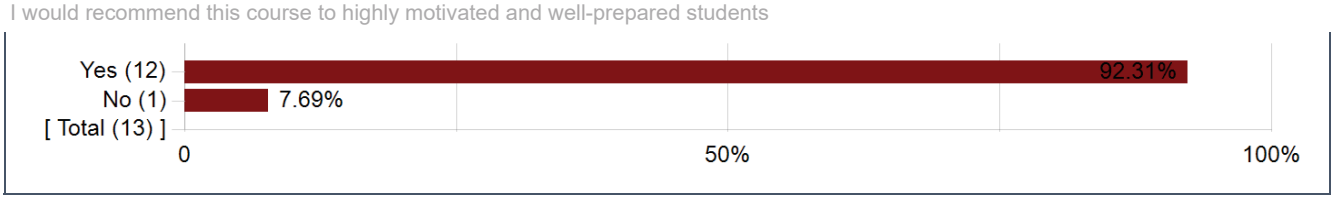
Comments
The lectures notes posted on Canvas are essential for studying. Working on all practice problems on my own also helped a ton.
Lectures were very organized and helped with understanding course material, discussion sections were not very helpful because much of it was just reviewing the material taught in class rather than helping us with how to apply them to our problem sets
very structured teaching and detailed notes
Practice problems and topic summaries were very useful in preparing for exams.
Lectures were very useful and Dr. Pieters taught the material very well
Lectures were very in depth. Assignments were very carefully crafted to reinforce the lectures.
Dr. Pieters's study materials and notes are always incredibly helpful and her lectures are clear and interesting
I thought that lectures weren't always the most helpful because she would skip a lot of steps in the math. It wasn't until I was doing the practice problems/going through the math on my own with every step that I understood some of the models

	Mean	Median	N/A	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
This course challenged me intellectually.	4.69	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	30.77%	69.23%
I understood the purpose of this course and what I was expected to gain from it.	4.38	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	15.38%	30.77%	53.85%
I understood the standards for success on assignments.	4.33	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	8.33%	8.33%	25.00%	58.33%
Class time enhanced my ability to succeed in graded assignments.	4.23	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	30.77%	15.38%	53.85%
I received feedback on my performance that helped me improve subsequent work.	4.15	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	7.69%	15.38%	30.77%	46.15%
My work was evaluated fairly.	4.46	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	7.69%	0.00%	30.77%	61.54%
I felt respected in this class.	4.62	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	7.69%	0.00%	15.38%	76.92%
Overall, this was an excellent course.	4.23	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	7.69%	23.08%	7.69%	61.54%

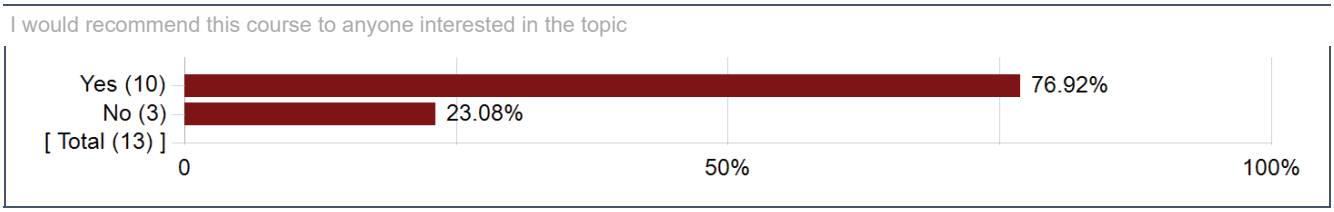
Additional Comments about this course:

Comments
I felt it was very difficult to prepare for the exams. Yes, we were given a lot of resource material such as homeworks, problem sets, and topic summaries to help prepare us. That being said, the exams were very difficult, and included questions that were a big step higher and more difficult than any of the material we were given beforehand. This made it hard to prepare for the exams and it was difficult to understand the level of understanding we were at.
Grading scheme way too harsh. Exams too difficult.

I would recommend this course to highly motivated and well-prepared students



I would recommend this course to anyone interested in the topic



The Instructor

Thinking about your time in class, what aspect of the instructor's teaching contributed most to your learning?

Comments
office hours
Professor Pieters had well organized lectures that connected to the previous day's material, so it felt like there was some sort of arc to the class. We covered a good amount of material, including the basics of MATLAB, which was appreciated.
Dr. Pieters is very knowledgeable, organizes lectures well, and provides plenty of resources for success in the class.
lectures, office hours
BEST FOR ECON 200 SEQUENCE! Nobody else provides the amount of additional support outside of classroom than she does!
Professor Pieters gave a lot of review materials to support the lectures, and the lectures provided more mathematic detail and context for the economic models.
Clear examples, doing the math out,
Prof Pieters is one of the hardest working profs I have had. She carefully crafts assignments so that you gain the full understanding of the material. She KNOWS exactly what you don't know and helps you approach confusing topics in a step by step manner in assignments.
Clearly explains topics in class
Dr. Pieters's class is very clear. She is a great lecturer.

What could she/he modify to help you learn more?

Comments
She could give us more questions time, in way that shows she really want to answer our questions
I wish she took the time to work through solving each model thoroughly in the relevant, lecture, though, because she would often leave the rest to us to solve on our own without walking us through the algebra tricks that would yield the correct results. She spent a bit too much time on reviewing the last lecture, so we were always half a day behind.
give us more time to complete homework
Give us more difficult practice problems to prepare for the exams!
Maybe a practice problem or two...
Proof read the topic summaries! There were so many times I was necessarily confused by the topic summaries because of small typos that implied contradictory information.
Better prepare us for exams, tell us what to study to succeed on exams, less harsh grading, better curving.
It felt like lectures were just Algebra on the board a lot of times. I think it would have been nice to have more context for why certain equations work in some instances and not in others, such as the different EEs. I'm not really sure that anything can fix the fact that class time just felt like math on the board because it seems like that's what this class is. Sometimes skipping steps in the math also made the class more confusing.

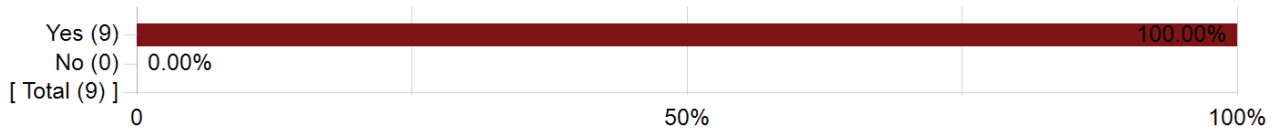
The Instructor

	Mean	Median	N/A	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
Organized the course clearly.	4.62	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	38.46%	61.54%
Presented lectures that enhanced your understanding.	4.38	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	15.38%	30.77%	53.85%
Facilitated discussions that were engaging and useful.	4.31	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	23.08%	23.08%	53.85%
Stimulated your interest in the core ideas of the course.	4.38	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	15.38%	30.77%	53.85%
Challenged you to learn.	4.62	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	38.46%	61.54%
Helped you gain significant learning from the course content.	4.31	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	15.38%	38.46%	46.15%
Was available and helpful outside of class.	4.54	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	46.15%	53.85%
Motivated you to think independently.	4.62	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	38.46%	61.54%
Worked to create an inclusive and welcoming environment.	4.62	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	38.46%	61.54%
Overall, this instructor made a significant contribution to your learning.	4.38	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	15.38%	30.77%	53.85%

The Teaching Assistant, Course Assistant, Intern

Did this class include instruction by a TA, CA or Intern?

Did this class include instruction by a TA, CA or Intern?



What aspects of the TA's teaching contributed most to your learning?

Comments
The section I went to was a recap of the week's materials, which could be helpful at times.
office hours
Very available and kind!
Discussion lectures were useful in reviewing models from previous class.
So helpful!

What could she/he modify to help you learn more?

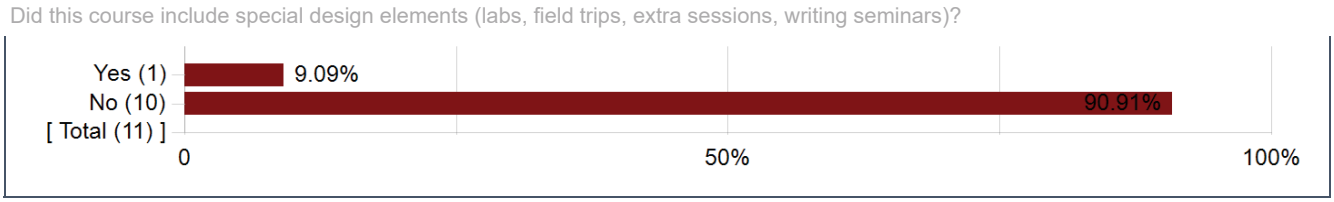
Comments
Working through more problems/solving more models
he was great!
Give more feedback on how to prepare for exams better, or give practice problems that allow us to apply models learned from class.

TA/CA or Intern

	Mean	Median	N/A	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
Facilitated discussions that supported your learning.	4.38	4.50	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	12.50%	37.50%	50.00%
Gave you useful feedback on your work.	4.25	4.50	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	25.00%	25.00%	50.00%
Stimulated your interest in the core ideas of the course.	4.25	4.50	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	25.00%	25.00%	50.00%
Challenged you to learn.	4.25	4.50	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	25.00%	25.00%	50.00%
Helped you succeed in the class.	4.13	4.50	0.00%	0.00%	12.50%	12.50%	25.00%	50.00%
Was available and helpful outside of class.	4.38	4.50	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	12.50%	37.50%	50.00%
Overall, the TA/CA made a significant contribution to your learning.	4.25	4.50	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	25.00%	25.00%	50.00%

Additional Course Elements

Did this course include special design elements (labs, field trips, extra sessions, writing seminars)?

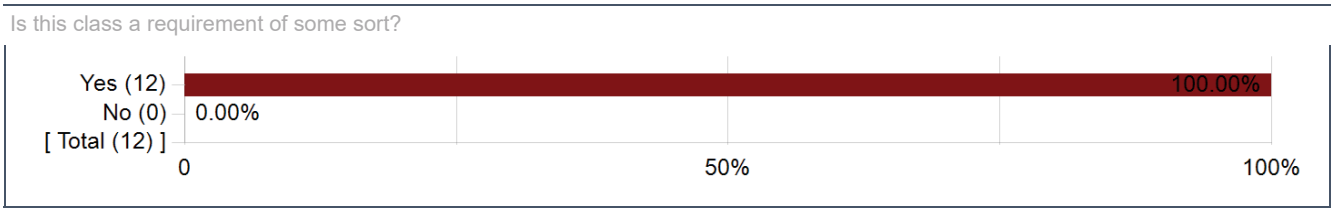


How much did the following elements of the course contribute to your learning gains?

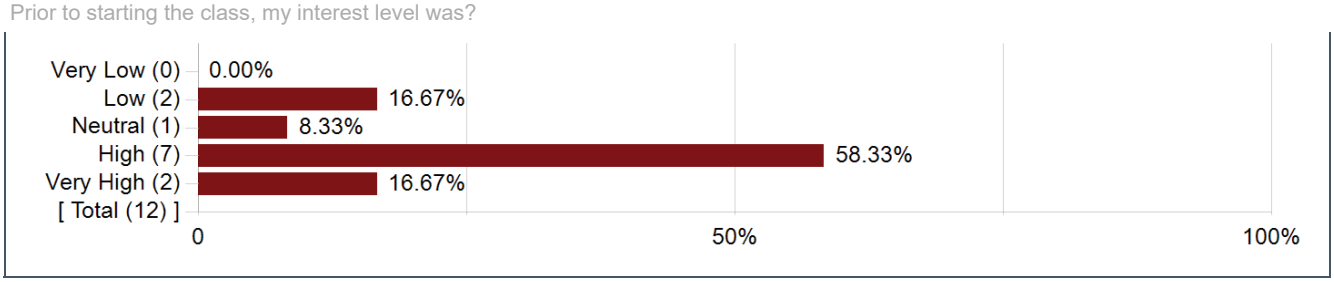
	Mean	Median	N/A	No Gain	A Little Gain	Moderate Gain	Good Gain	Great Gain
Laboratory Experience	N/A	N/A	100.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%
Field Trips	N/A	N/A	100.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%
Library Sessions	N/A	N/A	100.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%
Review sessions	5.00	5.00	60.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	40.00%
Writing Seminars	N/A	N/A	100.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%

Student Information

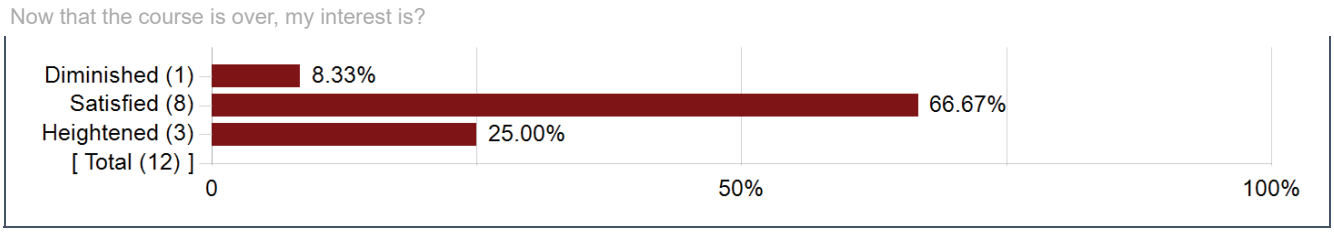
Is this class a requirement of some sort?



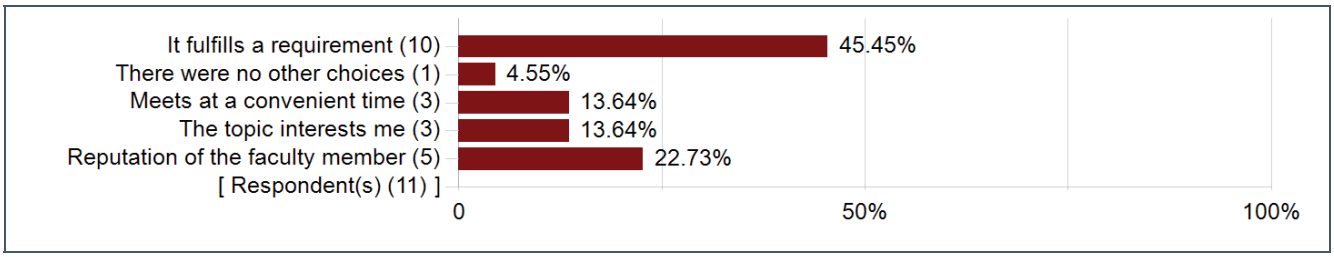
Prior to starting the class, my interest level was?



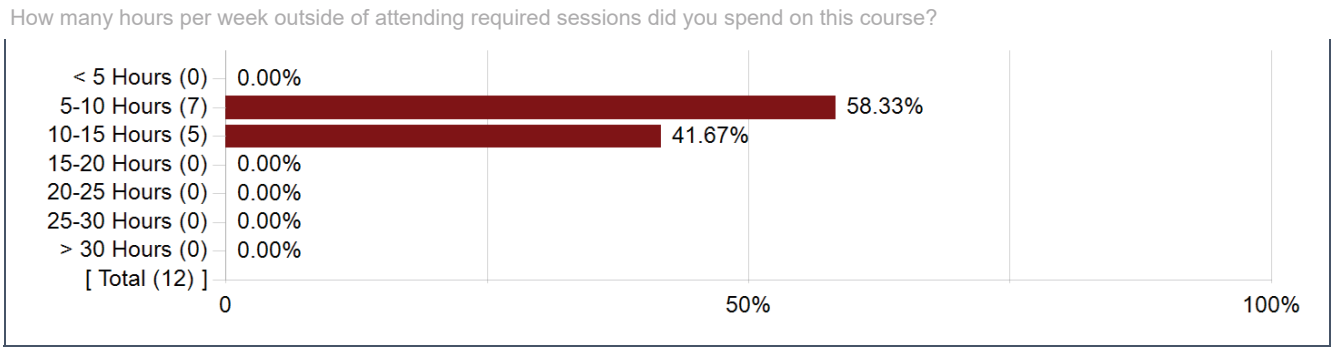
Now that the course is over, my interest is?



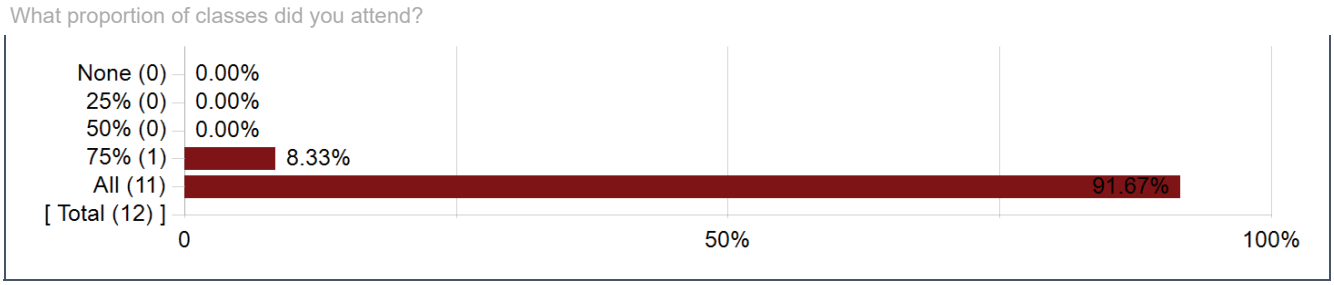
Why, primarily, did you take this course over others?



How many hours per week outside of attending required sessions did you spend on this course?



What proportion of classes did you attend?



Please comment on the level of difficulty of the course relative to your background and experience.

Comments
The beginning of this course was easy, as it highlighted macroeconomic phenomenon that could be learnt elsewhere. However, as the course progressed, more and more material was introduced -- specifically economic models from different time periods, proved to be a little overwhelming. But once I got the hang of models, plus working on homework assignments every week, the course became easy towards the final exam.
Exams are kind of brutal. Not that you can't get an A, because you can if you put in the effort, but they tend to melt your mind in the process. Even as someone who scored in the top 10% of the class I was consistently shocked by the difficulty of exams.

Please identify the name of the TA/CA/Intern you are commenting about.

Comments
Varun & Arturo
Arturo Joachin
Arturo
Arturo
Varun

THE UNIVERSITY OF CHICAGO

ECON 20100 91 - The Elements of Economic Analysis II (Summer 2019) - Instructor(s): Gina Pieters

Number Enrolled: **9**
Number of Responses: **6**

Report Comments

Opinions expressed in these evaluations are those of students enrolled in the specific course and do not represent the University.

Creation Date: **Tuesday, June 23, 2020**

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The Course

What are the most important things that you learned in this course? Please reflect on the knowledge and skills you gained.

Comments
The basic tool sets of economic analysis, how to solve partial, General and Social planner problems etc.
firms problem, game theory, profit max,
Econ 200s toolkit which teaches utility maximization in perfect competition, monopolies, duopolies, as well as game theory, price and quantity optimization, etc.
micro
The biggest things I got from this course was how to look at a firm's problem - whether it's profit-maximizing or cost-minimizing - and apply it to different scenarios (i.e. monopolies, oligopolies, and competitive markets). More broadly, I liked that the course built on the math skills and economic intuition that was established in ECON 200.
Lots of micro. General equilibrium, social planner stuff, other market types (monopolies, oligopolies, etc). Almost all of it didn't feel new coming from principles of micro and the first course of this sequence. Solving Lagrangians was still the primary technique of the class I'd say.

Describe how aspects of this course (lectures, discussions, labs, assignments, etc.) contributed to your learning.

Comments
They were all very geared towards helping me understand the material, I think the quizzes helped we be on top of things ad made sure I was caught up with the material.
the lectures are amazing, the example problem and homework is very helpful.
The summer class only had 9 students and it was in a small classroom, not a lecture hall. This was very helpful as it was easy to ask questions whenever I got confused. Additionally, Professor Pieters was readily available three times a week for office hours where we could ask questions about the homework or anything in general. She also was very responsive on discussion boards on canvas and via email. Overall, Dr. Pieters was an excellent instructor who was clear, fair, and easy to reach out to with any questions.
Lectures and assignments were good for learning materials. Loved the quizzes. All econ classes should have quizzes. That made it so easy to stay on top of the material.
Lectures were by far the most helpful; Prof. Pieters is an amazing lecturer and she (1) very easy to follow and (2) always willing to answer questions. Aside from class lectures, the notes and practice problems that Prof. Pieters posted on Canvas were very valuable because they helped clarify/walk through concepts that I may not have understood fully from class.
As someone who usually zones out during lectures and has to read copious amounts to catch up, Professor Pieters structured the course really well for me. Her lectures were clear and slow, and depsite my proclivity I sometimes got a lot out of them. Still, I'd say that the online topic summaries she uploads with practice problems in addition to office hours most days allowed me to easily fill any gaps in my knowledge even when I missed lectures.

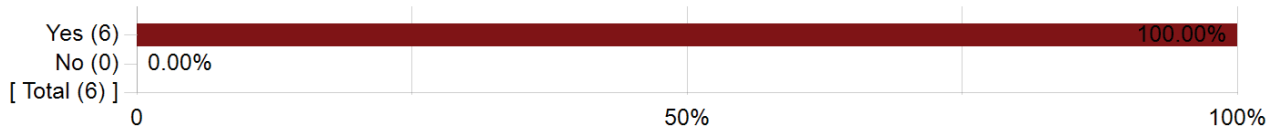
	Mean	Median	N/A	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
This course challenged me intellectually.	4.50	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	16.67%	16.67%	66.67%
I understood the purpose of this course and what I was expected to gain from it.	4.67	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	33.33%	66.67%
I understood the standards for success on assignments.	5.00	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	100.00%
Class time enhanced my ability to succeed in graded assignments.	4.83	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	16.67%	83.33%
I received feedback on my performance that helped me improve subsequent work.	4.83	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	16.67%	83.33%
My work was evaluated fairly.	4.83	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	16.67%	83.33%
I felt respected in this class.	4.83	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	16.67%	83.33%
Overall, this was an excellent course.	4.80	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	20.00%	80.00%

Additional Comments about this course:

Comments
I only wish the expectations for the quizzes were made a little more clear--I wasn't sure exactly what topics the quizzes would cover and whether they would cover content from the homework or the previous week, which made it a bit more difficult to study for.
idk 201 is 201, and this class covered quite a bit of material and I felt like I learned a lot. The three hour class length is ridiculous though--a two hour meeting three times a week would be a lot more reasonable.
I would just note that, as a non-econ major who doesn't intend to do anything in the field of economics (partially because of this sequence), even though the course was run well, I don't think the content is useful for me. I'll probably never use most of it again. Honestly, even for people interested in going into economics, it'd probably be more efficient to just learn how to solve a Lagrangian and then self-studying some of the other stuff if ever needed.

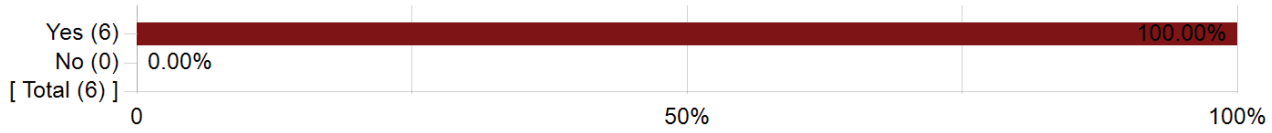
I would recommend this course to highly motivated and well-prepared students

I would recommend this course to highly motivated and well-prepared students



I would recommend this course to anyone interested in the topic

I would recommend this course to anyone interested in the topic



The Instructor

Thinking about your time in class, what aspect of the instructor's teaching contributed most to your learning?

Comments
Dr. Pieters is an excellent instructor. Being able to explain all concepts perfectly and immaculately planning the schedule of the classes. I think she is the most well prepared and fair professor I have ever had. She was also interesting which made a lot of the math
the lecture is very helpful, the example is best for quiz review and while doing the homework
Dr. Pieters explained the content thoroughly without going on confusing tangents, she was readily available outside of class, she answered questions during lecture whenever something was not confusing, and she provided significant out-of-class content to review and practice such as topic summaries and practice problems (separate from the homework). I have had several poor experiences with the 200s sequences throughout the course of the past school year, but Professor Pieters has hands down been the best economics professor I've had at this school so far, and has encouraged my passion for economics when other classes diminished it.
Great instructor honestly and explained concepts in a way that really made sense intuitively. I felt like this course was really helpful in solidifying my understanding of micro and even though the classes were three hours (way too long please shorten the length) I felt pretty engaged the whole time. She also had a ton of material available on campus (practice exams, practice problems, concept notes) which made it much easier to check concepts for problem sets as well as study for quizzes. I also felt like it wasn't too hard to figure out the kinds of questions she'd ask on quizzes which took a lot of anxiety out of studying for exams. The standards for success were clear and transparent as well and I felt like I always had a solid understanding of where I was in the class. Also, she incorporated a ton of real world examples on problem sets which made the problem sets more relatable. I've always felt like one of the biggest problems with the 200 sequence is that it can feel like a ton of repetitive calculus, but relating it to real issues really improved what I was getting out of the class. In general, this course was taught very well and I enjoyed taking it.
Prof. Pieters is a great lecturer. Her lectures are very organized and it's very easy to see how concepts taught earlier on in the class connect to those taught later. I especially appreciated how - as the class progressed - she made comparisons between the new material and the old material so that the similarities and differences between the things we were learning were clear.
Her office hours, topic summaries, and practice problems. (I would also note that I took this during the summer with few students so OH might've been far easier to get information out of than usual.) I also think her HW policy is REALLY good: you can literally turn in photos of someone else's work and it's fine. All that matters is whether you have the right answers. Really encourages collaboration and reduces stress for the HW, while still having it to contribute to learning.

What could she/he modify to help you learn more?

Comments
Nothing much.
nothing, everything is amazing.
I only wish the homework assignments had less typos and the questions were more clear so we didn't have to go back through our work and change our work before submitting. However, in the case that there was a typo or poor wording revealed after the homework was due, Dr. Pieters was always fair in returning any points that were missed because of this.
Honestly, not much. I would've appreciated spending a little more time on oligopolies because that was crammed into the last lecture; I relied mostly on practice problems and her notes on Canvas to learn that material.
Nothing off the topic of my head.

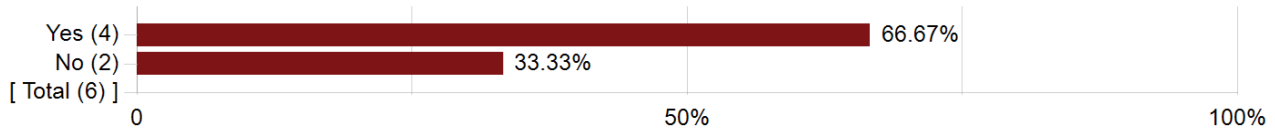
The Instructor

	Mean	Median	N/A	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
Organized the course clearly.	4.83	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	16.67%	83.33%
Presented lectures that enhanced your understanding.	4.83	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	16.67%	83.33%
Facilitated discussions that were engaging and useful.	4.67	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	33.33%	66.67%
Stimulated your interest in the core ideas of the course.	4.67	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	16.67%	0.00%	83.33%
Challenged you to learn.	4.83	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	16.67%	83.33%
Helped you gain significant learning from the course content.	4.83	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	16.67%	83.33%
Was available and helpful outside of class.	5.00	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	100.00%
Motivated you to think independently.	4.83	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	16.67%	83.33%
Worked to create an inclusive and welcoming environment.	5.00	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	100.00%
Overall, this instructor made a significant contribution to your learning.	4.83	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	16.67%	83.33%

The Teaching Assistant, Course Assistant, Intern

Did this class include instruction by a TA, CA or Intern?

Did this class include instruction by a TA, CA or Intern?



What aspects of the TA's teaching contributed most to your learning?

Comments
honestly i didn't interact with them much but they gave prompt feedback on homework
N/A - I never saw him.

What could she/he modify to help you learn more?

Comments
N/A - I never saw him.

TA/CA or Intern

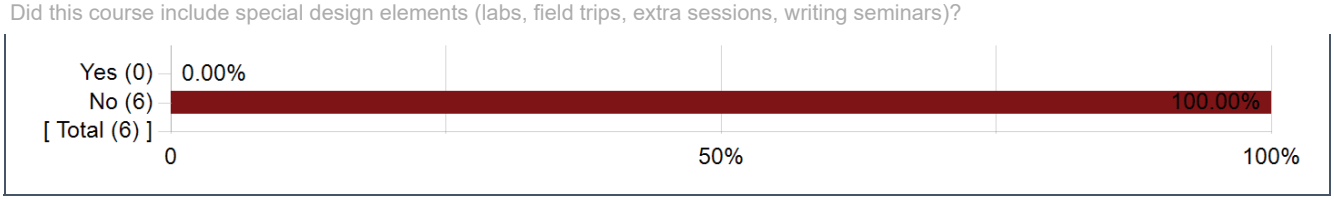
	Mean	Median	N/A	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
Facilitated discussions that supported your learning.	N/A	N/A	100.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%
Gave you useful feedback on your work.	4.00	4.00	50.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	50.00%	0.00%
Stimulated your interest in the core ideas of the course.	N/A	N/A	100.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%
Challenged you to learn.	N/A	N/A	100.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%
Helped you succeed in the class.	N/A	N/A	100.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%
Was available and helpful outside of class.	3.00	3.00	50.00%	0.00%	0.00%	50.00%	0.00%	0.00%
Overall, the TA/CA made a significant contribution to your learning.	N/A	N/A	100.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%

Additional feedback to the TA/CA/Intern:

Comments
Unfortunately, I did not have the time to meet with the TA.
N/A - I never saw him.

Additional Course Elements

Did this course include special design elements (labs, field trips, extra sessions, writing seminars)?

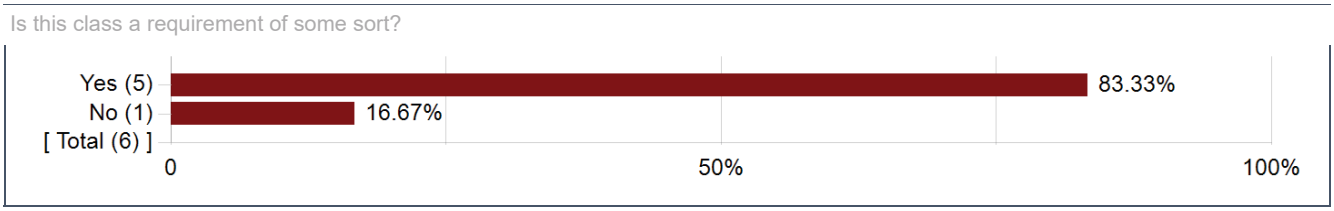


How much did the following elements of the course contribute to your learning gains?

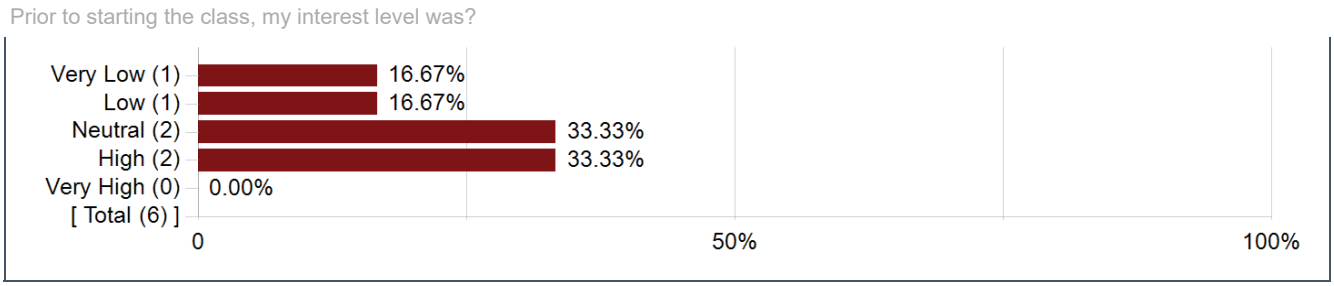
	Mean	Median	N/A	No Gain	A Little Gain	Moderate Gain	Good Gain	Great Gain
Laboratory Experience	N/A	N/A	100.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%
Field Trips	N/A	N/A	100.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%
Library Sessions	N/A	N/A	100.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%
Review sessions	N/A	N/A	100.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%
Writing Seminars	N/A	N/A	100.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%

Student Information

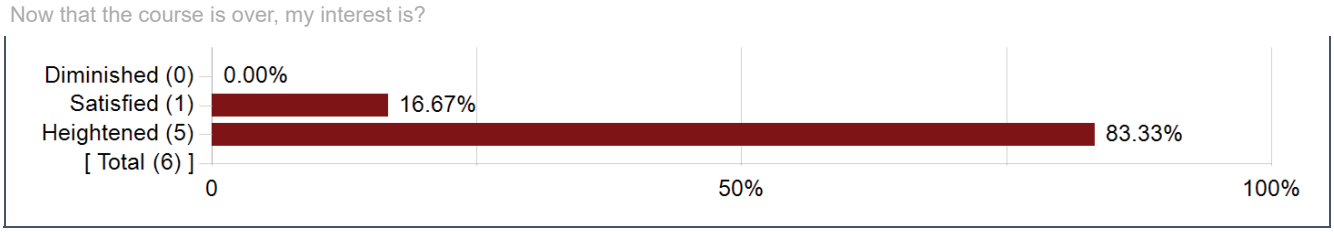
Is this class a requirement of some sort?



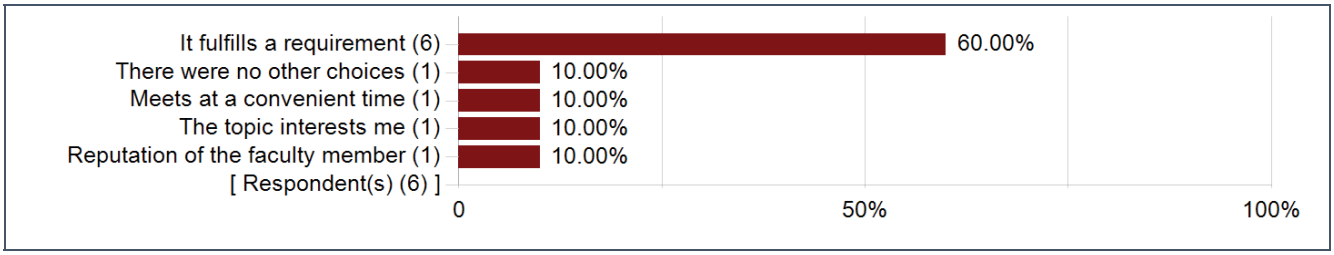
Prior to starting the class, my interest level was?



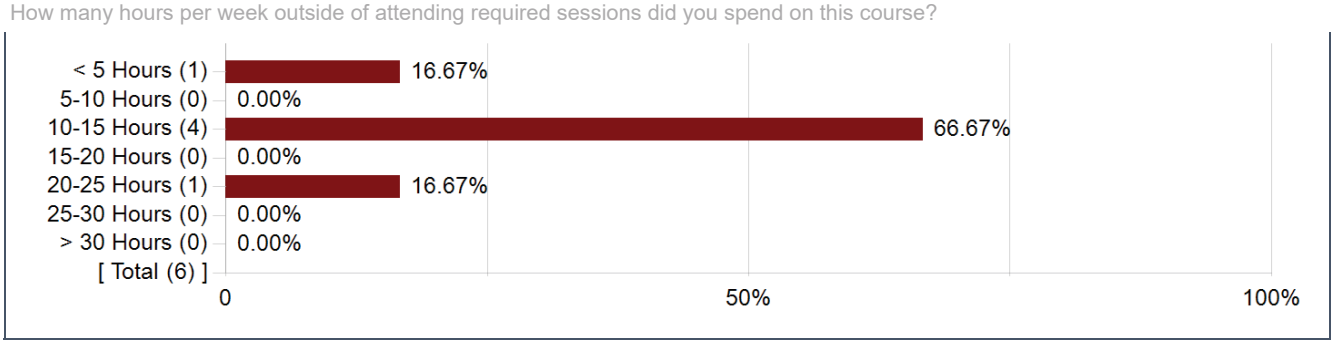
Now that the course is over, my interest is?



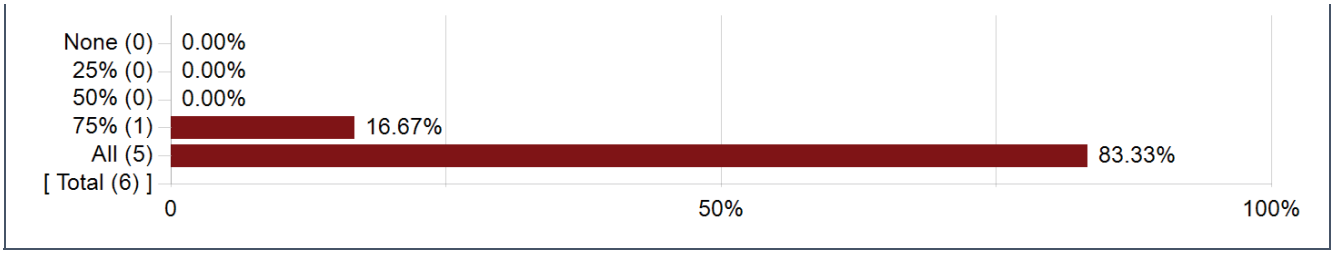
Why, primarily, did you take this course over others?



How many hours per week outside of attending required sessions did you spend on this course?



What proportion of classes did you attend?



Please comment on the level of difficulty of the course relative to your background and experience.

Comments
I took Econ 200 and none of the principles classes and it was not bad at all. I did take IB SL Economics, but that only really gave me the theoretical background. I took both Math 151-152-153 sequence and Math 195,196 which are required for the major and so the math was not bad at all.
Because it is a summer class, it squeezes 10 weeks worth of content into about 5 weeks, meaning that there is a significant amount of coursework. However, if you work at it, complete all the practice problems/homeworks, listen in class, and do your due diligence studying, Professor Pieters will reward you with a fair and appropriate grade.
Pretty easy course after the first in the sequence; everything just sort of builds off that/repeats it only adding variation slowly enough to follow easily. As someone who took math 163 I found the math not difficult at all. The only thing you really needed to know is how to solve a Lagrangian and how to do a basic maximization, which we learned last quarter anyway.

Please identify the name of the TA/CA/Intern you are commenting about.

Comments
Mohammad Moravvej farshi
Mohammad Moravvej

THE UNIVERSITY OF CHICAGO

ECON 10200 1 - Principles of Macroeconomics - Instructor(s): Gina Pieters

Project Title: **College Course Evaluation - Autumn 2019**

Number Enrolled: **137**
Number of Responses: **46**

Report Comments

Opinions expressed in these evaluations are those of students enrolled in the specific course and do not represent the University.

Creation Date: **Thursday, April 9, 2020**

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What are the most important things that you learned in this course? Please reflect on the knowledge and skills you gained.

Comments
Basics of macroeconomics, including graphs of aggregate economy, money supply, etc.
The core components of macroeconomics and how the economy functions on a large scale.
concepts in Macroeconomics, training in thinking as an economist
Introduction to the banking system High level overview of macro economic concepts
Basic concepts of how the economy works
Everything is connected
I learned the basics of macroeconomics. The most important thing I learned was the affect of fiscal and monetary policy on the economy.
Basics of Macroeconomics I wish I took this course before completing the economics sequence and major requirements
I learned about how various agents and markets work together in different ways.
General overview of Macro
New Macroeconomic concepts: loanable funds market, cfd, AD–AS etc
Basic principles of macroeconomics.
The principles of macroeconomics.
Circular flow, Aggregate demand, GDP and impact, Solow model, world trade, monetary policy, and more.
Ability to problem solve and think critically on tests
Concepts in general about this topic
How the theoretical economy works on a macroeconomic scale. A lot of graphs! Demand/Supply, Trade, etc.
solow model
Basic macroeconomic analysis and how they are reflected in the data that we see in our real world.
How different macro is from micro.
I got a really good overview of a lot of topics in macroeconomics, notably the Solow model, trade, governmental roles, and other factors of economics that I have not had experience with.
– How economy–wide phenomena both come from and influence the interaction of multiple agents in an economy – The application of macroeconomic concepts to daily life (taxes, unemployment, etc.)
The functions of the models necessary for understanding economic systems.
I learned the basics of macroeconomics and how components of the macroeconomy interact with one another.
– Solow Model – Monetary & Fiscal policy – interest rates – AD–AS curves
Basics of macroeconomics and how those concepts relate to real world events
Just macro basics needed for progressing in econ
Various macro models for equilibrium and growth including AD–AS and Solow models.
I can understand the news on macroeconomics better
The fundamentals behind what Learned in the 200 series
I gained a basic understanding about macroeconomics, including monetary and fiscal policy, trade barriers and other economic concepts.
The reasoning behind rises and falls in economies.
I understood the mechanisms underpinning the world's most salient economic problems today.
It was my first Econ class, I really enjoyed the course and learned a lot
I learned the basics about macroeconomics as well as how Econ courses are structured and evaluated.
I gained a foundational understanding of economics on a national and global scale. I can now think about topics like unemployment, trade, and monetary policy in the broader scope of the macroeconomy and how they are all closely linked to one another.

Describe how aspects of this course (lectures, discussions, labs, assignments, etc.) contributed to your learning.

Comments
Lectures were important to understand the basics of the material. Questions on the quiz and homework were frequently far beyond in–class discussion, though, so going to office hours (hosted every day) is really important.
Lectures were incredibly well organised and delivered – Prof. Pieters is a great lecturer, and her real life examples always made topics very interesting.
lectures are awesome, funny, engaging, enriching, 100/100
WK review
Go to class! very interesting lectures
Lectures provided me with understanding of the material.
– Lectures were most impactful, Dr. Pieters gave useful examples for topics and student participation was welcomed. – As a 4th year who's taking this as an elective, I wish I would've taken this before starting and completing the econ sequence. This course definitely would've been a great foundation for Econ 202–Econ 23950
Favorite assignments were the ones that had us do practical things, such as fill out tax forms or apply topics such as inflation to the tuition of UChicago / comparing salaries of different majors.
Lectures were conducted well and I learned a lot during them.
Quizzes helped me stay on task, homeworks delved into real life aspects of the things we were learning in class.
Disconnect between homeworks, quizzes and lectures weren't helpful
I learnt the principles in lectures, and how to do specific problems in discussions.
Lecture helped immensely.
Lecture was the first introduction to the material, topic summaries reinforced these ideas, practice problems, homework, and quizzes solidified them.
Lectures contributed the most
Lectures were really interesting. the weekly quizzes and homeworks were also really helpful in retaining what I've learned
Lectures I found to be helpful. Professor Pieters is good at explaining concepts in class. Discussions were also helpful. Not a lot of students go when there's no quiz, so it's really helpful to be in a smaller group with your TA and ask questions about the subject material. Prof Pieters also puts up topic summaries and practice problems: super useful!!
lecture was good
Lectures were very well organized. They were filled with discussions about various macroeconomic topics and examples were thoroughly shown on the board. The professor's own input or opinion about the different topics she teaches was very interesting to hear and she often connects them to real–world examples, which was very nice since some of the econ here can be very abstract. Assignments allowed us to practice the math needed for this course, but also allowed us to see actual data and analyze them. Quizzes, in my opinion, were very thoughtful and really challenged us to apply our knowledge to different economic situations. They were hard, but at the end, the most useful and fun.
The homeworks were helpful in keeping me on track and actually learning the material.
Lectures were very helpful in understanding the overall concepts, and then the practice problems, topic summaries, and homework helped to combine the math/problems and the concepts. Altogether, they were effective in prepping for quizzes and the final. There was no textbook which was a bit frustrating, but the class still flowed well.
– Lectures helped explain the material, HW assignments built on the concepts and applied them to new settings
Lecture time was quite crucial in understanding assessments, as well as the resources offered by the instructior.
Professor Pieters was an excellent lecturer. She explained topics clearly and provided real world examples to supplement.
– Lectures are important! She teaches topics quite well and, while the topic summary covers a lot of it, it is best to attend.
Lectures
TA office hours saved me for this class
Lectures were dry and it was challenging to pay attention. Homework and quizzes were very helpful.
Lectures and lecture summaries were essential
The lectures and very well–organized and clear. We are encouraged to ask questions and actively engage with the course material.
Lectures gave basically all I learned
Lectures are usually packed with materials but mostly very informative. Homework assignments and quizzes help build up knowledge of the materials.
The hw and quizzes were spaced out perfectly and were great tests of knowledge
Lectures were very helpful, as she often offered us real world examples that directly applied to what we were learning and she always explained all concepts thouroughly.
I found the lectures to be very helpful for introducing and explaining the topics. The topic summaries and the practice problems were some of the best tools for reviewing the lectures and doing the homework.

Please respond to the following:

	Mean	Median	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
This course challenged me intellectually.	4.29	4.00	2.22%	0.00%	11.11%	40.00%	46.67%
I understood the purpose of this course and what I was expected to gain from it.	4.38	5.00	0.00%	4.44%	8.89%	31.11%	55.56%
I understood the standards for success on assignments.	4.18	4.00	2.22%	4.44%	15.56%	28.89%	48.89%
Class time enhanced my ability to succeed in graded assignments.	4.16	5.00	4.44%	4.44%	13.33%	26.67%	51.11%
I received feedback on my performance that helped me improve my subsequent work.	4.02	4.00	2.27%	6.82%	15.91%	36.36%	38.64%
My work was evaluated fairly.	4.18	4.00	2.22%	4.44%	13.33%	33.33%	46.67%
I felt respected in this class.	4.49	5.00	2.22%	0.00%	6.67%	28.89%	62.22%
Overall, this was an excellent course.	4.38	5.00	2.22%	2.22%	6.67%	33.33%	55.56%

Additional comments about the course:

Comments
great course taught by an amazing instructor, who care about students, unlike most professor at this university, who just thinks about research
The instructor is very fair and very organized. although at times the lectures moved at a snails pace and could be boring.
Difficult, but I learned a lot!
The topic summaries and practice problems are really helpful — would definitely recommend doing them along with class
The canvas hw really sucked when we had to upload images. There were several occasions where I lost 3 or 4 pts just because the image I uploaded didn't work.
I appreciate the blind grading that was done in this course—it's not something that happens very often. For someone who has never taken an economics course, I still really enjoyed the class and did not feel disadvantaged because of this. I believe this is because I attended almost all of the lectures. The most challenging part of the course was the homework.

I would recommend this course to:

	No	Yes
Highly-motivated and well-prepared students	6.82%	93.18%
Anyone interested in the topic	6.82%	93.18%

Thinking about your time in the class, what aspect of the instructor's teaching contributed most to your learning?

Comments
The instructor's friendliness and frequent availability in office hours was critical to my learning.
Incredible lectures. The best notes I've ever been able to compile for a class.
attitude, creating friendly classroom atmosphere, clear lecturing aimed at helping students learn and not just regurgitating content
Openess
N/A
Answering questions
Lecturing.
Pieters is incredibly well organized, structured, and really cares about here students learning.
Well prepared Professor
Explanations of definitions.
Professor Pieters works through concepts thoroughly and comprehensively on the board, which makes them very accessible.
Lecture, especially relating to current world economic news, as well as tangents that actually bettered my understanding of the material.
Math done in class
It was very interesting, the way she gave lectures, and I never felt bored about the topic.
Prof pieters is really determined to make sure that we understand the concepts. She was funny and engaging during lecture. She's helpful if you're willing to put in the effort.
lectures
Professor Pieters clearly knows what she's talking about. She is able to easily answer student questions, sometimes even connecting them to other real–world situations. The fast pace in which she teaches and answers impromptu questions shows that she is very knowledgeable, which makes it very easy for us to trust her teaching and words. She also has a canny sense of humor and is clearly enthusiastic and passionate about economics. The lectures were very well organized and math examples were shown on the board. Diagrams were clear and she walked us through a lot of the analysis in class. She also covers more controversial topics, telling us that they can be controversial for various reasons, which really got me interested in economics more.
– Lectures were clear, office hours were quite helpful – Topic summaries were really helpful!
Lectures, she kept on task and explained everything cohesively
Lectures and data presentations
Creating fictional scenarios in the real–world that demonstrated a relevant model or concept.
Lectures are great
She encouraged questions
Professor Pieters is always very helpful with explaining complicated concepts through simple examples.
Multifaceted examples.
Dr. Pieters' humor
Best prof. I've had yet at UChicago
The real world examples in class
Dr. Pieters was engaging by asking questions to the class about a topic she was ready to introduce. This was helpful for making us think and figure out the meaning of unemployment or the implications of trade instead of her just telling us what they meant. Dr. Pieters also spoke very clearly and stopped to ask for any questions before continuing onto a new subject. I appreciate how she also briefly reviewed the material from the previous class at the start of each lecture.

What could the instructor modify to help you learn more?

Comments
Homeworks posted on Friday would be useful
n/a, Pieters is the best, top shelf
Less math
N/A
Stop writing in the shadow of the board.
Moving the lectures along more quickly would help me to not fall asleep during lectures. Sometimes concepts were covered for such a long time that I could barely pay attention anymore.
The homework's and quizzes weren't related to class.
Make sure Canvas works properly for quizzes
Fewer real life data, more homework or exam relevant maerial
More practice problems.
Professor Pieters could work through more math examples during class.
More math in class
Maybe making more practice problems that are more similar to homeworks/quizzes?
go a little slower maybe
Nothing. In my opinion, she is the best economics professor I've had so far.
Nothing!
A more concise topic summary which adheres more closely to the way in which she articulates it in class. Additionally, I feel as though often times the most important things (such as formulas we were intended to use) were afforded a disproportionate amount of time to, say, observations of FRED curves or presentations of foreign currency.
na
Change the homework file less often and fewer modifications to the answer key
Spend less time on definitions and more time on computation.
Nothing
N/A
More examples tying in more topics.
Canvas homework's, make them written
As far as the time she has in class, I think she does a very good job
An occasional example on how to do calculations similar to the homework problems would be helpful.

The Instructor . . .

	Mean	Median	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree	N/A
Organized the course clearly.	4.58	5.00	2.22%	0.00%	4.44%	24.44%	68.89%	0.00%
Presented lectures that enhanced your understanding.	4.50	5.00	0.00%	2.27%	9.09%	25.00%	63.64%	0.00%
Facilitated discussions that were engaging and useful.	4.31	5.00	0.00%	6.98%	11.63%	23.26%	55.81%	2.33%
Stimulated your interest in the core ideas of the course.	4.45	5.00	2.27%	0.00%	9.09%	27.27%	61.36%	0.00%
Challenged you to learn.	4.59	5.00	0.00%	2.27%	2.27%	29.55%	65.91%	0.00%
Helped you gain significant learning from the course content.	4.43	5.00	2.27%	0.00%	11.36%	25.00%	61.36%	0.00%
Was available and helpful outside of class.	4.47	5.00	0.00%	2.22%	13.33%	17.78%	62.22%	4.44%
Motivated you to think independently.	4.40	5.00	2.22%	0.00%	13.33%	24.44%	60.00%	0.00%
Worked to create an inclusive and welcoming learning environment.	4.43	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	13.64%	27.27%	54.55%	4.55%
Overall, this instructor made a significant contribution to your learning.	4.44	5.00	2.27%	0.00%	9.09%	27.27%	59.09%	2.27%

What aspects of the TA's teaching contributed most to your learning?

Comments
All aspects. Extremely useful.
Availability outside of class and patience when trying to help us understand challenging concepts
office hours, discussion sections
Questions
meredith was really energized and knowledgable about economics, always helpful after quizzes and during discussion
Help in discussions.
Josefina was always very helpful whenever needed.
always available
Problem solutions
Discussion.
Going over practice problems.
Help with problem sets
quizzes
Meredith was super nice and helpful! She tried to explain super confusing topics in an easier & clearer manner. She studied this stuff & was a uchicago undergrad student too, so she really understands what we're going through and really wants to help.
Meredith is a very good teacher, made stuff a lot clearer and was nice
Allie was very helpful during discussion sections. She was able to answer student questions and provided good feedback on our quizzes.
N/A
NA
Meredith was amazing. She was super helpful with every question, and acted as the connecting person in delivering messages to the professor as well
Office hours
Office hours
Examples
She was awesome
Explained generally hard concepts that many people struggled with
Meredith was incredibly helpful during our discussion sections. Her teaching style was great because she walked through the concepts we covered slowly and with lots of detail.

What could the TA modify to help you learn more?

Comments
Meredith could've spent more time going over the things Peiters discussed in class as well as what would be on the homework and quizzes instead of spending the entire time on one topic she thinks is important/personal rants even though outside of discussion and office hours they would've been enjoyable
Discussions sections were not engaging nor helpful
Nothing
N/A
More engagement
Nothing, she was great!
nothing
nothing meredith was great!
None
Nothing. Keep up the good work.
N/A
Nothing
More preparation and time.
n/a, TAs were awesome
Nothing
N/A
nothing, most of our time with her we were taking quizzes
Organizing discussion sections based on what the few people who were there actually wanted to cover rather than a review of everything again
collaboration
NA
N/A
Nothing! She was terrific.

The TA/CA or Intern. . .

	Mean	Median	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree	N/A
Facilitated discussions that supported your learning.	3.94	4.00	0.00%	8.82%	20.59%	29.41%	32.35%	8.82%
Gave you useful feedback on your work.	4.23	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	21.21%	27.27%	42.42%	9.09%
Stimulated your interest in the core ideas of the class.	3.93	4.00	0.00%	6.06%	24.24%	27.27%	30.30%	12.12%
Challenged you to learn.	4.10	4.00	0.00%	3.03%	18.18%	36.36%	33.33%	9.09%
Helped you succeed in the class.	4.07	4.00	0.00%	9.09%	6.06%	45.45%	30.30%	9.09%
Was available and helpful outside of class.	4.32	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	8.82%	44.12%	38.24%	8.82%
Overall, this individual made a significant contribution to your learning.	3.97	4.00	0.00%	3.03%	27.27%	30.30%	30.30%	9.09%

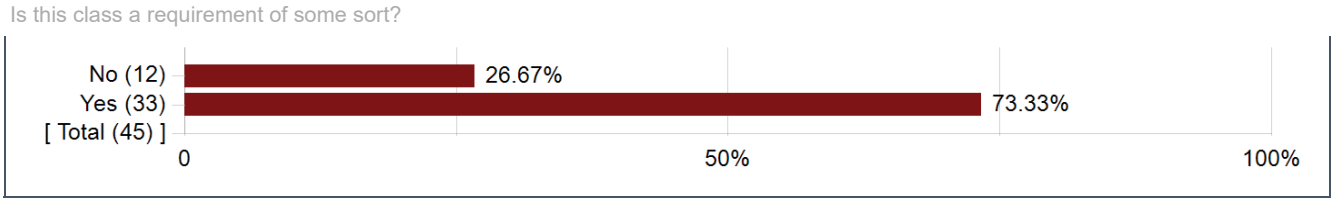
Additional feedback to the TA/CA/Intern:

Comments
Meredith was an amazing TA.
Josefina
TA name: Josefina
Thank you for clearing up the Solow Model!
Meredith was so helpful and approachable, it made her one of the best Tasting I've ever had.

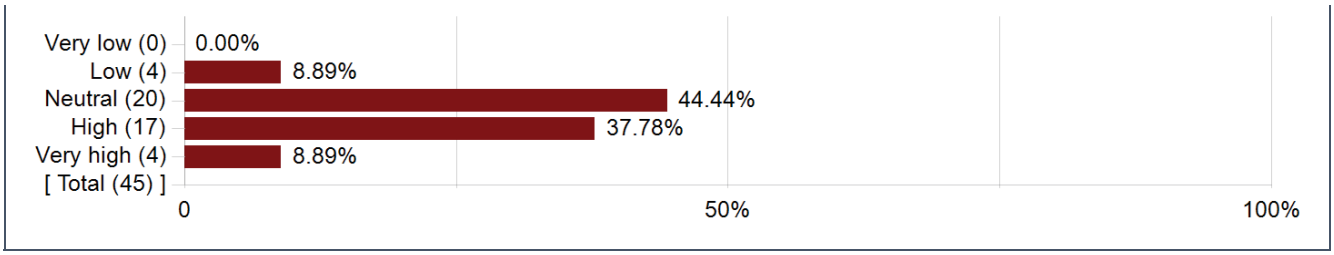
How much did the following elements of the course contribute to your learning gains?

	Mean	Median	No Gain	A Little Gain	Moderate Gain	Good Gain	Great Gain	N/A
Laboratory Experience	N/A	N/A	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	100.00%
Field Trips	N/A	N/A	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	100.00%
Library Sessions	N/A	N/A	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	100.00%
Review Sessions	4.00	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	100.00%	0.00%	0.00%
Writing Seminars	N/A	N/A	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	100.00%

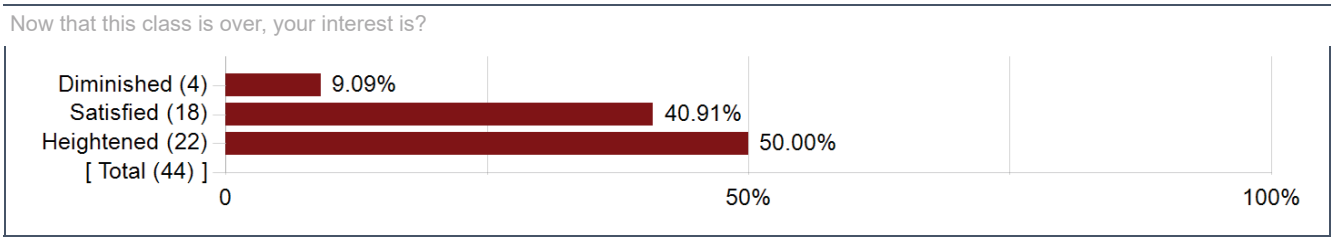
Is this class a requirement of some sort?



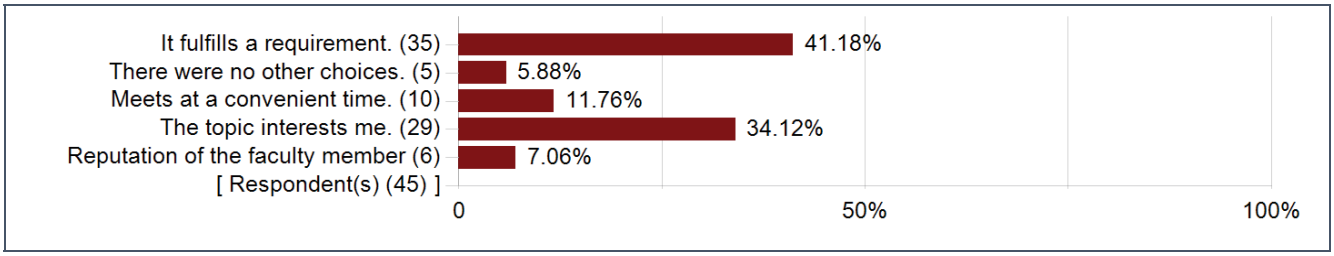
Prior to starting this class, your interest level was?



Now that this class is over, your interest is?

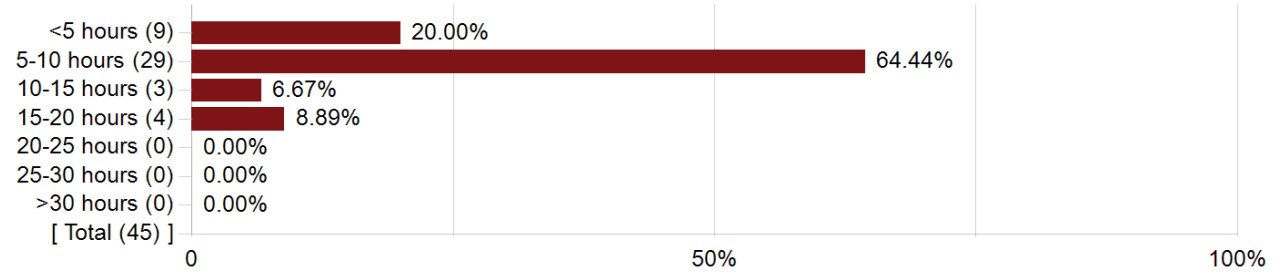


Why did you choose to take this course? (Select all that apply)



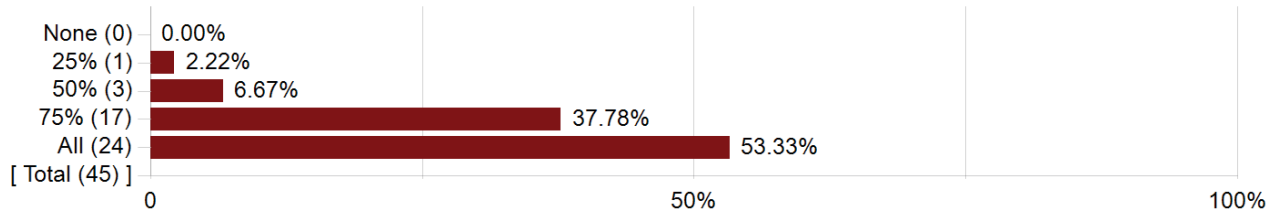
How many hours per week outside of attending required sessions did you spend on this course?

How many hours per week outside of attending required sessions did you spend on this course?



What proportion of classes did you attend?

What proportion of classes did you attend?



Please comment on the level of difficulty of the course relative to your background and experience.

Comments
You need to go to office hours and have a good study group to succeed in this course.
Just right, with no assumed prior knowledge. Homeworks were definitely much more challenging that practice questions/quizes, which was unsettling, but the rest was very manageable
well calibrated, for beginners, again Prof Pieters is simply the best teacher in the ECON department I have yet encountered, none can compare, no other cares about students like she does, she is simply the best
It was of moderate difficulty.
Medium difficult
Relatively easy
Moderate
It was difficult, but doable if you put in the effort! Definitely was helpful to have exposure to Econ before (I took micro).
It was pretty much what I expected.
For someone just starting the business econ major, this course was appropriately challenging and informative
Moderate difficulty. I came in with a decent background in macroeconomics after completing a high school class, so I already understood some of the basic concepts. However, there were certainly some more complex concepts which were more difficult to grasp.
You truly have to learn the material. It is not possible to skim and cram for quizzes.
Homeworks are too hard
Manageable given my experience with micro and 200.
On par
Not too hard given I had no econ background
Trivial
with no background, it is fairly difficult
I have never taken an Econ class before, and I did not feel disadvantaged by this. If you go to class, use the office hours, and do the homework, this class is a level of difficulty that is still challenging and enjoyable, but not too overwhelming.

If you could provide advice to future students in this course with this instructor what would it be?

Comments
Go to office hours. Work iwth your peers.
listen in class to everything she says, gold all the time
Office hours
N/A
Sit in the front and ask questions.
N/A; the course was very well structured and straightforward.
Trying to pay attention in lecture is helpful but not strictly necessary to do well. This course is overall not very difficult, especially with any background and understanding of economic principles.
na
Look at topic summaries and practice problems.
Go to class
This is a really nice class with a great professor
Go to lectures, go over the topic summaries, and do the practice problems! You'll be okay. Also don't be afraid to ask questions and go to OH.
go to office hours
Go to the lectures. If possible, all of them. Ask lots of questions because the professor is very capable of answering them all. Start homework early so you can have more questions to ask in office hours or through the canvas forum. Exams can be hard, but it won't be if you truly understand the material. And if you don't, then again, ask.
Take advantage of the topic summaries, practice problems, and other resources on canvas
Practice problems are really helpful to go over the concepts, so definitely review those and the topic summaries prior to the quizzes and final.
Be proactive in working with your peers, it may prove the only way to survive this class. Also, attendance in class can prove crucial, especially when it comes to fully using the review resources provided.
Go to class, take notes, review the notes and you will do well.
– Go to lectures and make sure you truly understand the homework and practice problems.
Have patience then you will be rewarded
Begin the homework as early as possible so that you can better learn the concept for the quizzes.
Go to the lectures
Always make sure that you understand the fundamental idea behind the models. Simple memorization will not help you with this course.
Go to office hours. Professor and TAs are always willing to help.
Be on top of HW.
Avoid this instructor by all means. If you are unlucky enough to have her, find other people to do the work with to help pass the time.
Keep up with every topic and get help if you don't understand something
Go to class and use Dr. Pieter's office hours. Dr. Pieter's office hours especially were very helpful for understanding any concepts that few difficult to grasp.

Based on feedback received thus far, what grade do you expect to get in this course? How does that compare to the grade you expected to get when you initially enrolled in the course?

Comments
A, A to A–
A– to A. I was definitely expecting a lower grade, but Prof. Pieters and the TAs are very fair when evaluating work, and the class notes were very good. Porf. Pieters also made the course very interesting, which helped me focus more in lectures and hence perform better in assignments.
idk this is uchicago, famous for killing fun and where only the gpa goes down on you, maybe a B+ if I am lucky right?
B–, lower
N/A
A. I am currently receiving the grade that I expected, if not a little lower.
I expect to get a B+/A, I initially expected to get an easy A
I expect an A– or higher.
I expect to get an A– or an A, which is what I expected going into this course initially.
Hopefully at least a B
na
A– (what I expected)
I hope I get an A. I expected to drop the class before taking it.
expect to get a higher grade than I originally thought bc I got used to it
As long as I don't get sick during my final exam, I believe I can manage an A– or an A if I tried really hard. When I enrolled in this course, I expected a B, knowing that I did poorly on Econ 202 before.
My expectations have remained similar to what I began the course with.
I am hoping to at least get a C which is in line with what I anticipated at the beginning. However, I was unaware of how hard fought for this grade would have been.
A/A–. This was about what I expected
Probably a little lower. This course is challenging and keeps you on task throughout the entire quarter. If you fall off for a bit, it's hard to catch up.
Grade so far was what I expected from this large of a class
I think I'll get an A–. I expected to get an A.
B+or an A
A/A–; about the same, but perhaps lower because there are a lot of students in this class who have already taken the 200s sequence.
A/A–
I see myself getting a B+ in this course. I initially believed I would get a lower grade because I did not have an background in economics.

THE UNIVERSITY OF CHICAGO

ECON 20200 1 - The Elements of Economic Analysis III - Instructor(s) Gina Pieters

Project Title: **College Course Evaluation - Winter 2020**

Number Enrolled: **10**
Number of Responses: **5**

Report Comments

Opinions expressed in these evaluations are those of students enrolled in the specific course and do not represent the University.

Creation Date: **Friday, April 17, 2020**

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What are the most important things that you learned in this course? Please reflect on the knowledge and skills you gained.

Comments
I learned how to build and solve various macroeconomic models. I also learned basic MATLAB skills and developed stronger macroeconomic intuition. Finally, I learned how to read and create various relevant graphs.
Very comprehensive understanding of ECON 202 Material, Representative Agent Model, differences between various models
macroeconomic models of the economy (some are literally such oversimplifications), flow of capital, understanding the money market understanding existing models, comparing them to real data, and understanding why the discrepancies are present

Describe how aspects of this course (lectures, discussions, labs, assignments, etc.) contributed to your learning.

Comments
The lectures were very clear and well–organized. However, the practice problems, topic summaries, and slides posted on Canvas were the most helpful resource for me in reviewing and reinforcing class material.
Presentations, Practice Problems, Topic Reviews, Problem Sets – made the material more understandable, Dr. Pieters is very organized
The quizzes really did felt like a midterm–level assessment just distributed over many weeks, which was helpful in that I really had to study that week's material in depth to succeed, but it was stressful.

Please respond to the following:

	Mean	Median	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
This course challenged me intellectually.	5.00	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	100.00%
I understood the purpose of this course and what I was expected to gain from it.	4.60	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	40.00%	60.00%
I understood the standards for success on assignments.	4.40	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	60.00%	40.00%
Class time enhanced my ability to succeed in graded assignments.	4.40	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	60.00%	40.00%
I received feedback on my performance that helped me improve my subsequent work.	4.20	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	20.00%	40.00%	40.00%
My work was evaluated fairly.	4.80	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	20.00%	80.00%
I felt respected in this class.	5.00	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	100.00%
Overall, this was an excellent course.	4.60	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	40.00%	60.00%

I would recommend this course to:

	No	Yes
Highly-motivated and well-prepared students	0.00%	100.00%
Anyone interested in the topic	66.67%	33.33%

Thinking about your time in the class, what aspect of the instructor's teaching contributed most to your learning?

Comments
The instructor was extremely knowledgeable in her discipline and ensured that the nuances of the models presented were always highlighted. Her well–organized slides and presentations were also essential.
When she wrote on the board, made the class go a bit slower and it was easier to absorb the information from the powerpoints
Professor Pieters is very responsive and resourceful both in and outside of class. She was very clear in stating a lot of the limitations of economic models and made sure everyone in the class (both sections) were on the same page with the progress of the class.

What could the instructor modify to help you learn more?

Comments
I understand the burden of producing so many materials for class. However, nearly 200 typos of varying sizes are hard to deal with. The Bug Bounty system is a good improvement but ultimately I would take no topic summaries and less typos than what we actually had for the quarter. Also, the amount of brute algebra necessary for some of the homework assignments was excessive. Some of the questions did a better job of balancing concepts and manageable algebra which allowed us to see the implications of the math we were doing.
I would opt for a midterm instead of the 6 quizzes – easier to find the time to prepare for (harder to study a lot on 6 different weeks, we get busy with other stuff)
Please make sure the lecture slides, homework assignments, and topic summaries are free from typos. The bug bounties are great to make up for lost points on the homework/quizzes but I really rather lose points on assignments than having to wait for updated course materials to be published throughout the quarter when studying for quizzes or doing homework. It gets really frustrating after a couple of days when my understanding of the course materials is hindered by mere typos and notation mistakes.

The Instructor . . .

	Mean	Median	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree	N/A
Organized the course clearly.	5.00	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	100.00%	0.00%
Presented lectures that enhanced your understanding.	4.60	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	40.00%	60.00%	0.00%
Facilitated discussions that were engaging and useful.	4.80	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	20.00%	80.00%	0.00%
Stimulated your interest in the core ideas of the course.	5.00	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	100.00%	0.00%
Challenged you to learn.	5.00	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	100.00%	0.00%
Helped you gain significant learning from the course content.	5.00	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	100.00%	0.00%
Was available and helpful outside of class.	5.00	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	100.00%	0.00%
Motivated you to think independently.	4.80	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	20.00%	80.00%	0.00%
Worked to create an inclusive and welcoming learning environment.	5.00	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	100.00%	0.00%
Overall, this instructor made a significant contribution to your learning.	5.00	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	100.00%	0.00%

What aspects of the TA's teaching contributed most to your learning?

Comments
The TA worked through homework problems with us to help us arrive at the correct solutions.
Michael encouraged us to collaborate during Friday OH, and guided us as well
his availability Friday morning when the homework was due each week

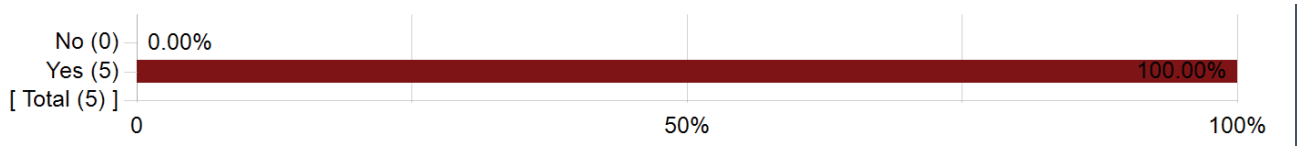
What could the TA modify to help you learn more?

Comments
Nothing!

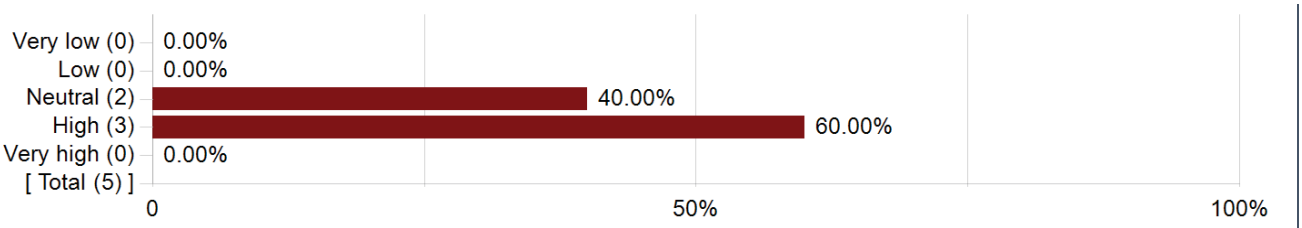
The TA/CA or Intern. . .

	Mean	Median	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree	N/A
Facilitated discussions that supported your learning.	4.00	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	25.00%	50.00%	25.00%	0.00%
Gave you useful feedback on your work.	4.25	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	75.00%	25.00%	0.00%
Stimulated your interest in the core ideas of the class.	4.00	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	25.00%	50.00%	25.00%	0.00%
Challenged you to learn.	4.25	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	75.00%	25.00%	0.00%
Helped you succeed in the class.	4.00	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	25.00%	50.00%	25.00%	0.00%
Was available and helpful outside of class.	4.33	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	50.00%	25.00%	25.00%
Overall, this individual made a significant contribution to your learning.	4.00	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	25.00%	50.00%	25.00%	0.00%

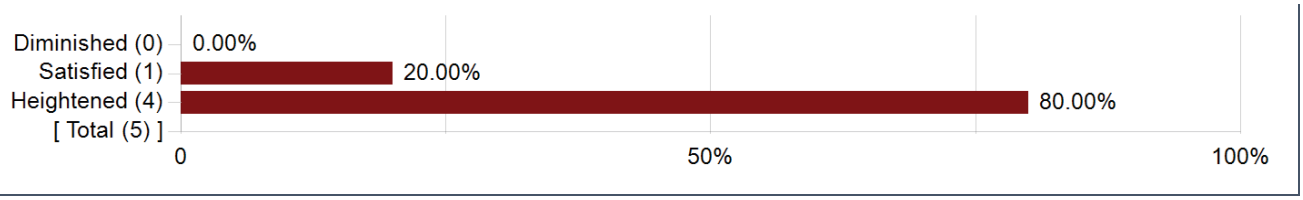
Is this class a requirement of some sort?

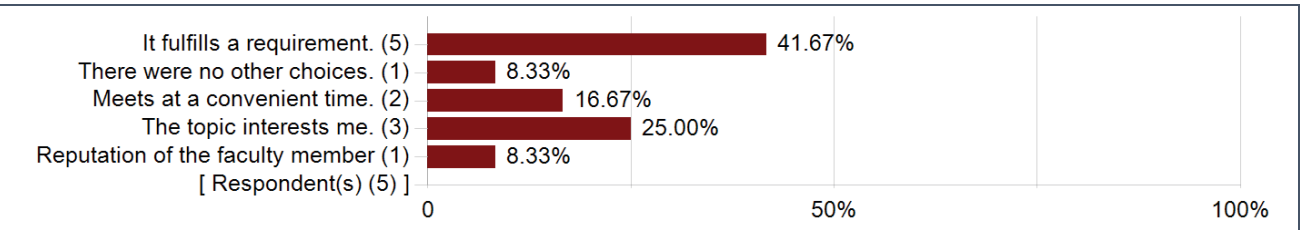


Prior to starting this class, your interest level was?

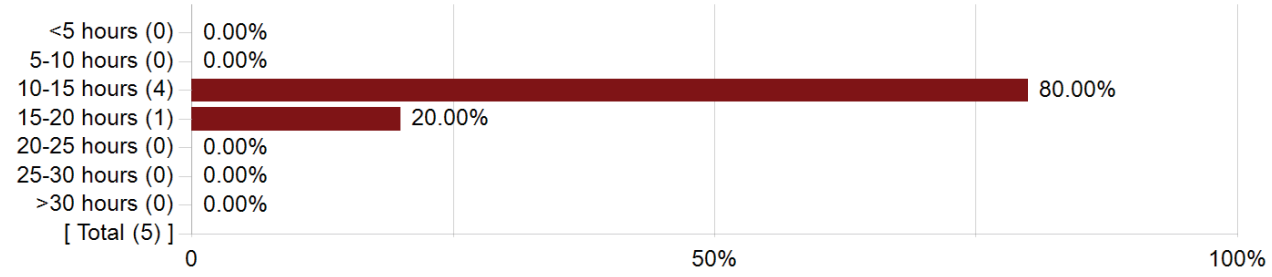


Now that this class is over, your interest is?

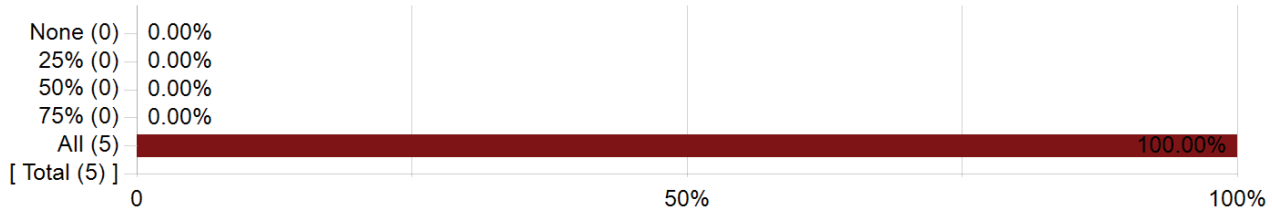




How many hours per week outside of attending required sessions did you spend on this course?



What proportion of classes did you attend?



Please comment on the level of difficulty of the course relative to your background and experience.

Comments

This course was difficult but manageable if you did all of the practice assignments and paid attention in class.

If you could provide advice to future students in this specific course with this specific instructor what would it be?

Comments

It's important to not feel discouraged by the initial difficulty level, just work through the problems and do your best and you should be alright.

Review Econ 201!

Based on feedback received thus far, what grade do you expect to get in this course? How does that compare to the grade you expected to get when you initially enrolled in the course?

Comments

I expect a B+, which is the grade I expected when I enrolled.

A. I am getting an A, meeting my expectation upon enrollment.

THE UNIVERSITY OF CHICAGO

ECON 20200 2 - The Elements of Economic Analysis III - Instructor(s) Gina Pieters

Project Title: **College Course Evaluation - Winter 2020**

Number Enrolled: **30**
Number of Responses: **9**

Report Comments

Opinions expressed in these evaluations are those of students enrolled in the specific course and do not represent the University.

Creation Date: **Friday, April 17, 2020**

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What are the most important things that you learned in this course? Please reflect on the knowledge and skills you gained.

Comments
Working with various models, math methods, and coding in Matlab
Basic macroeconomic models, writing our own models, dynare and coding, etc.
Better understanding of economic modeling
How to solve various different macroeconomic models, as well as some context around them (advantages, flaws, accuracy, etc)
Matlab skills; solving dynamic models

Describe how aspects of this course (lectures, discussions, labs, assignments, etc.) contributed to your learning.

Comments
Lectures were great. Homeworks could be a little intense, but ultimately aided learning.
The lectures were excellent. Everything was explained in such a clear manner. The math was shown on the board and available in slides. Real–life examples were applied to the questions to make it easier for us to understand. Assignments were quite hard but not impossible to complete. Tests and homework were spread throughout the quarter, making it easier for students to optimize their own time. The discussion sections were well organized and corresponded to the week's materials.
The lectures were very helpful – professor Pieters spent a lot of time making sure we understood the material
Lectures were good, and the slides were really important especially for complex concepts that required a second or third glance at home. The psets were important preparation for the quizzes, although there was a significant jump in complexity between lectures, psets, and quizzes
Lectures were useful. However, we spent a lot of time discussing logistics of the class. Dr. Pieters posting the slides online was amazing.

Please respond to the following:

	Mean	Median	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
This course challenged me intellectually.	4.44	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	11.11%	33.33%	55.56%
I understood the purpose of this course and what I was expected to gain from it.	4.11	4.00	0.00%	11.11%	11.11%	33.33%	44.44%
I understood the standards for success on assignments.	3.78	4.00	11.11%	0.00%	22.22%	33.33%	33.33%
Class time enhanced my ability to succeed in graded assignments.	4.00	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	33.33%	33.33%	33.33%
I received feedback on my performance that helped me improve my subsequent work.	4.00	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	22.22%	55.56%	22.22%
My work was evaluated fairly.	4.00	4.00	0.00%	11.11%	22.22%	22.22%	44.44%
I felt respected in this class.	4.22	5.00	0.00%	11.11%	11.11%	22.22%	55.56%
Overall, this was an excellent course.	4.00	4.50	0.00%	25.00%	0.00%	25.00%	50.00%

Additional comments about the course:

Comments
As someone who took Econ 20200 before and did poorly with a different instructor, I have to say that Professor Pieters is amazing and very patient with her students. If you don't know which professor to sign up for, this is it.
Professor Pieters cancelled the final exam as a result of the coronavirus situation, which demonstrated great care for her students. Much respect!

I would recommend this course to:

	No	Yes
Highly-motivated and well-prepared students	22.22%	77.78%
Anyone interested in the topic	33.33%	66.67%

Thinking about your time in the class, what aspect of the instructor's teaching contributed most to your learning?

Comments
Dr. Pieters has a way of explaining new concepts that makes them interesting and accessable.
Everything was excellent. Professor Pieters is an amazing lecturer – probably the best I've had so far in my whole three years of college. She is able to explain difficult concepts in a way that is easy for us to understand by using real–world examples. When the math gets confusing, she walks us through step–by–step. Any question that a student asks her, Professor Pieters is able to answer it immediately and unlike some other professors, actually answers the question being asked. Professor Pieters is also available for help outside of class through discussion boards and office hours.
She spent a lot of time making sure we understood the topic and began each lecture with a recap that was very helpful
was extremely prompt about responding to emails and helpful during office hours
Gina is really really organized (ten page syllabus for example). So she provides tons of resources and avenues for success. There are slides, topic summaries, and practice problems for every lecture. It's a lot to keep track of, but if fully taken advantage of, is incredibly helpful for learning the material. She can come across as strict and intimidating at first, but she's actually nice and funny in her own sort of way. Her teaching style will definitely grow on you as you get used to it.
She was good at giving examples

What could the instructor modify to help you learn more?

Comments
N/a
The high workload does not bring me more gains.
Nothing. Please keep up with the great work because I think you're a much–needed lecturer in the Econ 200 series.
More practice problems
this course was not very difficult but the practice problems and lectures notes had a number of typos & notation inconsistencies that made them unnecessarily time consuming to understand. the slides were useful for class but instead of creating 50+ page slides, one page of clearly written notes or 5–6 clear slides would have worked. If it isn't possible to make fewer typos then using a textbook would have been better.
There are a lot of typos, like, a lot. She offered extra credit for students who found typos, and while this helped somewhat, it was not a perfect system. Made certain psets and concepts a little more confusing at times, but I suppose that is a natural consequence of having so many resource documents. The class is also a lot of work, which can make it hard to keep up with at times. I would really recommend not having quizzes and psets in the same week. Even if it means fewer quizzes...
Dr. Pieters was a great lecturer, but I feel that her attempts to foster participation weren't useful. Often when she asked a question, no one would answer. I think this is because the class is a lecture so students don't really want to participate.

The Instructor . . .

	Mean	Median	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree	N/A
Organized the course clearly.	4.33	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	66.67%	33.33%	0.00%
Presented lectures that enhanced your understanding.	4.33	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	66.67%	33.33%	0.00%
Facilitated discussions that were engaging and useful.	4.22	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	11.11%	55.56%	33.33%	0.00%
Stimulated your interest in the core ideas of the course.	3.78	4.00	0.00%	11.11%	33.33%	22.22%	33.33%	0.00%
Challenged you to learn.	4.22	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	11.11%	55.56%	33.33%	0.00%
Helped you gain significant learning from the course content.	4.11	4.00	0.00%	11.11%	0.00%	55.56%	33.33%	0.00%
Was available and helpful outside of class.	4.56	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	44.44%	55.56%	0.00%
Motivated you to think independently.	4.33	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	66.67%	33.33%	0.00%
Worked to create an inclusive and welcoming learning environment.	4.00	4.00	11.11%	0.00%	11.11%	33.33%	44.44%	0.00%
Overall, this instructor made a significant contribution to your learning.	3.89	4.00	0.00%	11.11%	22.22%	33.33%	33.33%	0.00%

What aspects of the TA's teaching contributed most to your learning?

Comments
Friendly and ran great office hours and problem sessions.
Jo was a great TA who truly cares about us as students. She spends time reviewing material and helps us walk through homework questions before the due date that might be confusing. She is able to answer student questions and is available for help most of the time. She coordinates well with the instructor so we know exactly what to expect out of her discussion.
Never asked TA for help
Michael's office hours on Fridays were honestly incredible
Michael was really funny and relatable. He didn't always have perfect mastery of the material, which is NOT a criticism. The material was really hard sometimes, and he did a good job of making us feel like were we not alone.

What could the TA modify to help you learn more?

Comments
Nothing
Nothing. Keep up the great work.
Be more prepared for questions on lecture materials and homework
Idk

The TA/CA or Intern. . .

	Mean	Median	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree	N/A
Facilitated discussions that supported your learning.	4.00	4.50	0.00%	12.50%	25.00%	12.50%	50.00%	0.00%
Gave you useful feedback on your work.	4.25	4.50	0.00%	0.00%	25.00%	25.00%	50.00%	0.00%
Stimulated your interest in the core ideas of the class.	4.25	4.50	0.00%	0.00%	25.00%	25.00%	50.00%	0.00%
Challenged you to learn.	4.25	4.50	0.00%	0.00%	25.00%	25.00%	50.00%	0.00%
Helped you succeed in the class.	4.13	5.00	0.00%	12.50%	25.00%	0.00%	62.50%	0.00%
Was available and helpful outside of class.	4.38	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	25.00%	12.50%	62.50%	0.00%
Overall, this individual made a significant contribution to your learning.	4.13	5.00	0.00%	12.50%	25.00%	0.00%	62.50%	0.00%

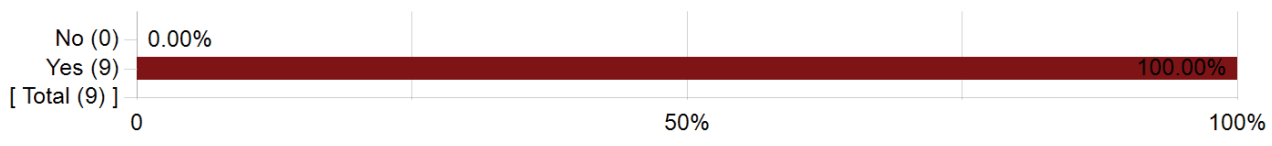
Additional feedback to the TA/CA/Intern:

Comments
Thanks Michael!

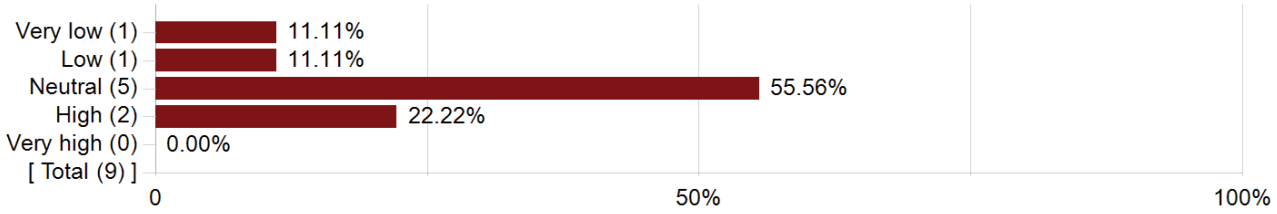
How much did the following elements of the course contribute to your learning gains?

	Mean	Median	No Gain	A Little Gain	Moderate Gain	Good Gain	Great Gain	N/A
Laboratory Experience	N/A	N/A	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	100.00%
Field Trips	N/A	N/A	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	100.00%
Library Sessions	N/A	N/A	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	100.00%
Review Sessions	3.00	3.00	0.00%	0.00%	100.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%
Writing Seminars	N/A	N/A	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	100.00%

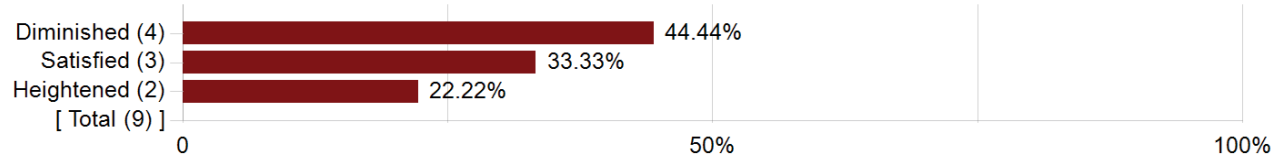
Is this class a requirement of some sort?

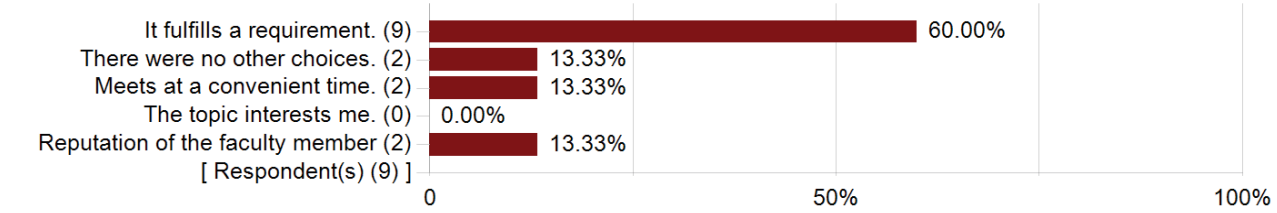


Prior to starting this class, your interest level was?

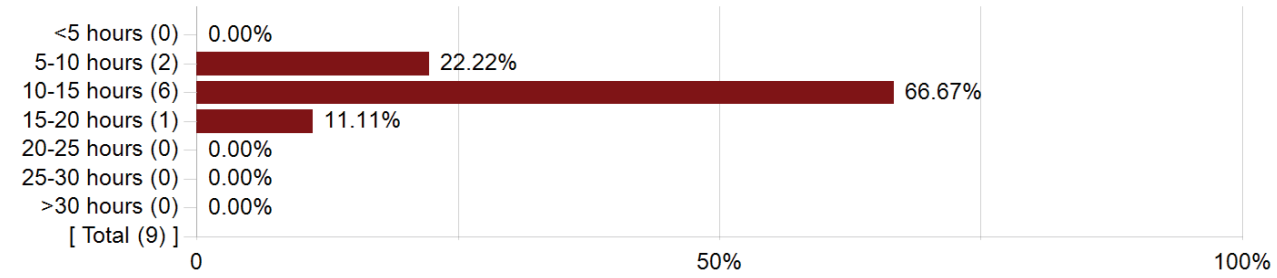


Now that this class is over, your interest is?

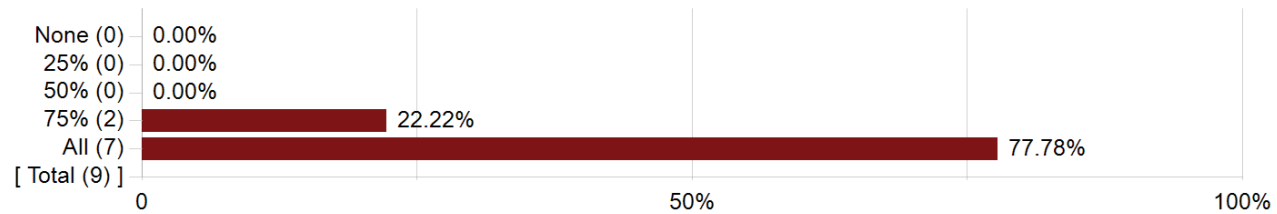




How many hours per week outside of attending required sessions did you spend on this course?



What proportion of classes did you attend?



Please comment on the level of difficulty of the course relative to your background and experience.

Comments
Fairly challenging, but Dr. Pieters is an engaging lecturer. Nothing felt unfair.
Although the material is quite hard, because the professor and TA were so great, it was not impossibly difficult.
It's a lot of work, at least compared to 200 and 201. The programming requirement was challenging without previous programming experience (although the tutorials were helpful). There's also a pretty steady flow of assessments, with a quiz almost every week. Grading isn't too bad compared to some econ courses here
I took half of 20210 before dropping it and this class was much easier, though the grading was much harsher

If you could provide advice to future students in this specific course with this specific instructor what would it be?

Comments
Maybe brush up on 201 concepts if you didn't take it the quarter before—I struggled at first because I took 201 a year before. It is still possible to work harder and catch up, but brushing up before will make life easier.
The workload is huge and the extra time and effort spent does not bring you proportionally additional gains on the materials
Review topic notes, do practice problems, keep up with the material, and most importantly, if you have any questions, ask away. You will definitely get great help.
Don't give up after the first couple weeks. It will get better. A lot of people dropped third week and I considered doing so, but I'm so glad I didn't.
Really review the hw answers and practice problems

Based on feedback received thus far, what grade do you expect to get in this course? How does that compare to the grade you expected to get when you initially enrolled in the course?

Comments
I expect to get a B– or B, which is about what I set out for in the beginning.
I expect a grade somewhere in the B range. I had very low expectations with grades since I had failed this course before but was pleasantly surprised by the excellent teaching that helped me understand all that I did not the first time I took this course.
An A. Expected A– or A. Weird situation this quarter, since no final exam.
I expect a B+, which is about the same as the grade I expected.

THE UNIVERSITY OF CHICAGO

ECON 23950 1 - Economic Policy Analysis - Instructor(s) Gina Pieters

Project Title: **College Course Evaluation - Spring 2020**

Number Enrolled: **44**
Number of Responses: **18**

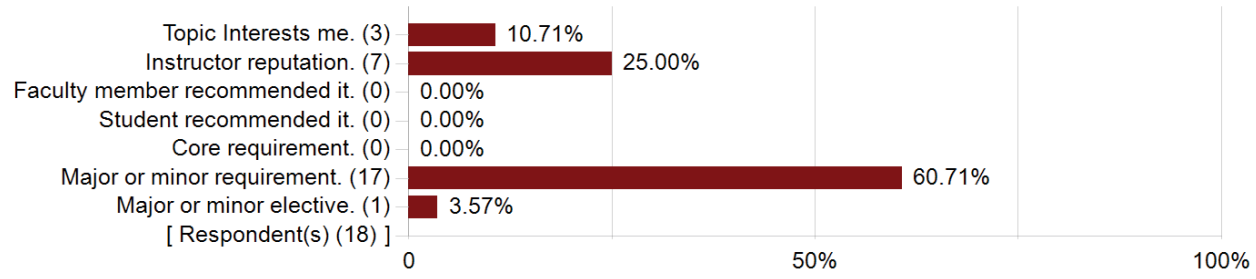
Report Comments

Opinions expressed in these evaluations are those of students enrolled in the specif course and do not represent the University.

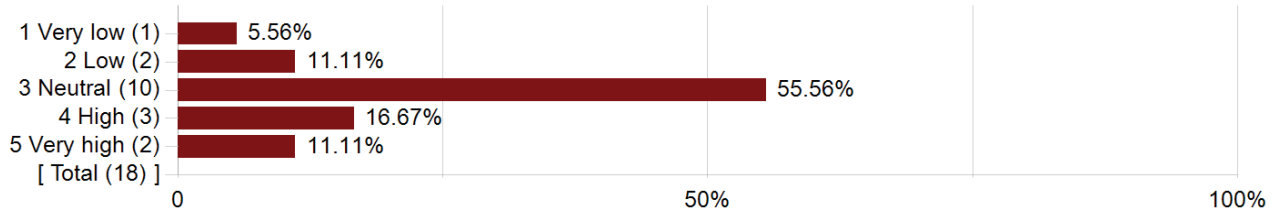
Creation Date: **Thursday, August 13, 2020**

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Why did you choose to take this course? (Select all that apply)

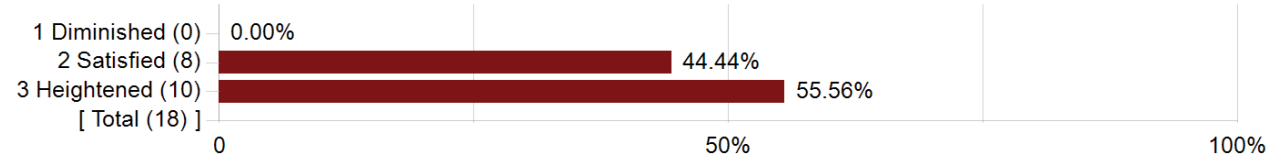


Prior to starting this class, your interest level was?



Statistics	Value
Response Count	18
Mean	3.17
Standard Deviation	0.99

Now that this class is over, your interest is?



Statistics	Value
Response Count	18
Mean	2.56
Mode	3
Standard Deviation	0.51

What are the most important things that you learned in this course? Please reflect on the knowledge and skills you gained.

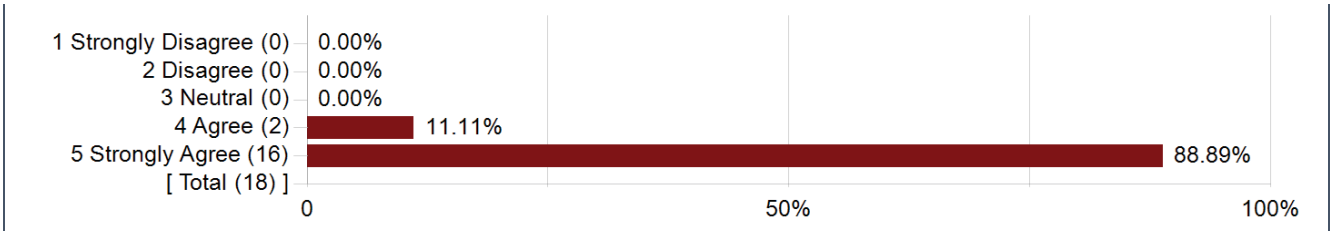
Comments
monetary and fiscal policy
The variety of models that can be used to model economic systems. How to use them, their history, their pros/cons.
How to write a paper on current policies
how macroeconomics works and modeling real life problems in economic teerms
I gained the ability to apply what I learned in class to real world situations. I think the most rewarding element of this class was writing the papers on fiscal and monetary policy. Being able to use models that I learned in class and then apply them to a real world issues was amazing. I do not believe this class usually uses paper as the main grading portion, but I believe my writing skills in economic policy analysis have ameliorated significantly.
Thinking about fiscal and monetary policy.
How to effectively apply theory to policy analysis
Various theories concerning fiscal policy and monetary policy
monetary policy and fiscal policy
How to model basic fiscal and monetary policies
I learned about variety of models that can be used to investigate economic policy decisions and their potential impacts. I learned how to set these models up, how to solve them, and how to contextualize them.
Analysis of models for fiscal and monetary policy.
Fiscal and monetary policy models.

Describe how aspects of this course (lectures, discussions, labs, assignments, etc.) contributed to your learning.

Comments
i find the way in which Gina structured the lectures were ideal to the circumstances of this quarter; pre–recorded lectures for the first 40 minutes of class followed by a zoom call lecture clarifying the material was extremely helpful for international students who were not able to attend the live lecture.
Lectures were recorded and were a great resource both for initially learning and for reviewing during assignments. Discussions helped with the nuances of the material. Assignments drove home points and developed understanding better.
2 lectures per week–each asynch and synch
lectures and homeworks were most helpful
It was online lectures, with zoom classes where we could ask questions. Papers were the main assignments, as well as well as homework. She included a QRE which were short answers in response to lectures, that only helped your grade (you did not need to get the right answers to get points).
Prof. Pieters did a good job of conveying information despite the pandemic. Although she conveyed intuitive understandings of models well, sometimes I still felt that I didn't understand the real world correlations to what we were studying.
Dr. Pieters is an amazing professor! Her structure and planning if the syllabus made for an easy transition to remote learning. This class was a great experience.
The combination of pre–recorded lectures and live lectures is a great form
lectures and homework are helpful.
The lecture videos were the primary way for me to learn the class content. They were quite dense so I needed to slow down while watching them, but overall they were fine. The synchronous portion of the class involved going over some of the concepts and answering questions, which was generally helpful, although I had rarely digested the material enough to ask meaningful questions during these sessions. Discussion sessions were useful for asking questions once I had digested the material more. The problem sets were difficult and at times caused me to get bogged down in math and miss the broader point of the model I was solving (which tends to happen to me with economics classes), but overall they were helpful. The papers were very good opportunities for me to understand how the models from class are used (both in terms of equations and simulations) and contextualized.
The lectures were supremely well done, the QREs were engaging, and the writing assignments were incredibly fulfilling. Professor Pieters is my absolute favorite at the university because she so clearly puts everything she can into her classes. It is beyond clear that every little element of the course is crafted with a future part in mind. This is such a crucial part of what makes her classes such phenomenal experiences — not only because of the level of effort this takes to pull off from her end — but because one knows that they are truly learning. Not just being told things to remember, but being given the tools to truly think through the materials. For this, Professor Pieters cannot be thanked enough and, as such, all aspects of this course were outstanding and greatly contributed to my learning.
Prerecorded lectures went over slides in depth and lecture time was used for discussion and questions.
HWs and papers expanded on class material.

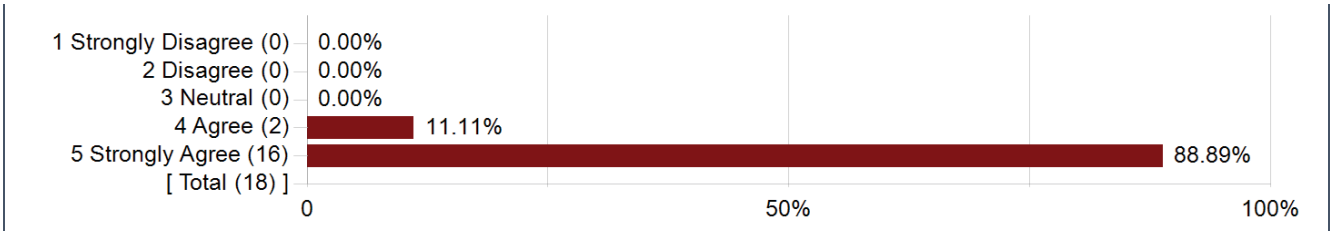
The Instructor(s) . . .

1. Provided a syllabus that allowed you to plan your learning and study time effectively.



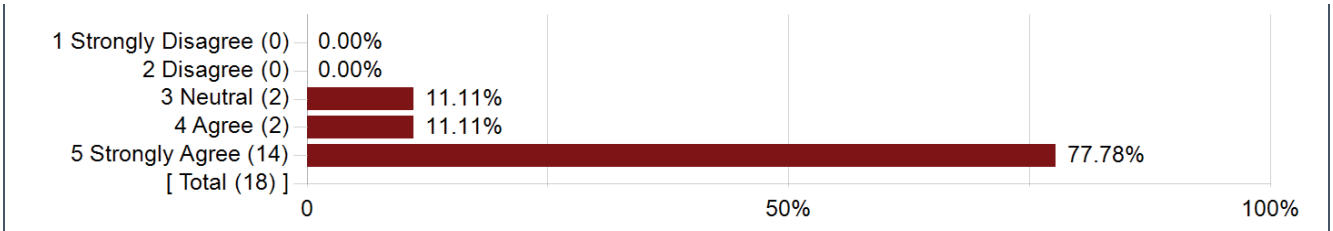
Statistics	Value
Response Count	18
Mean	4.89
Median	5.00
Standard Deviation	0.32

2. Explained clearly the course objectives and expectations.



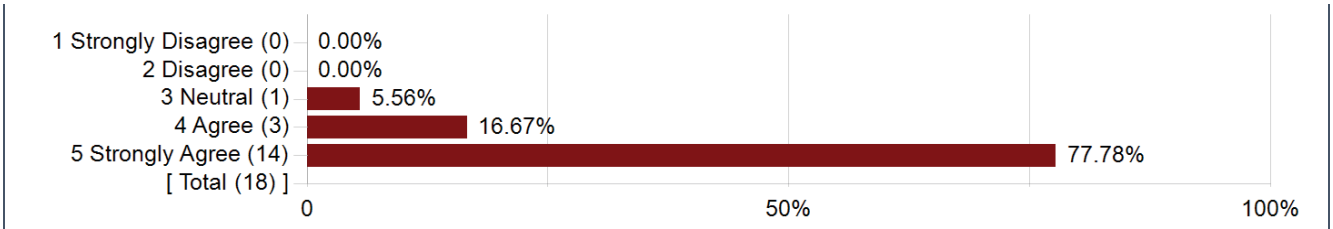
Statistics	Value
Response Count	18
Mean	4.89
Median	5.00
Standard Deviation	0.32

3. Stimulated your interest in the core ideas of the course.



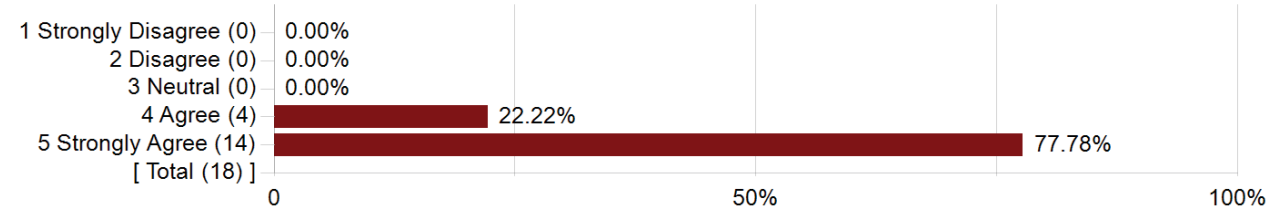
Statistics	Value
Response Count	18
Mean	4.67
Median	5.00
Standard Deviation	0.69

4. Was available and helpful outside of class.



Statistics	Value
Response Count	18
Mean	4.72
Median	5.00
Standard Deviation	0.57

5. Overall, the instructor made a significant contribution to your learning.



Statistics	Value
Response Count	18
Mean	4.78
Median	5.00
Standard Deviation	0.43

What aspect of the instructor's teaching contributed most to your learning?

Comments
she was very clear on the structure of the class, the parameters of the assignments, and her extremely clear lectures.
She clearly tried really hard to make online class work well and it showed. It wasn't seamless, but I think her system worked well. This was my most work–intensive class this quarter and I think I learned a lot as a result.
Her explanations in Office Hours and in recorded lectures
Pieters was very disorganized and had a lot of trouble explaining the economic intuition behind concepts. Mostly rote memorization. First half of course was extremely difficult and poorly organized but second–half became more manageable and questions were explained pretty clearly on slides.
Professor Pieters was ready to help and provided multiple resources for her students. She also structured the class in which we are able to improve upon our previous submissions
She was extremely responsive and made it easy for students to ask questions. Although it was all online, she still made herself accessible through different platforms that made it very easy for students to reach her. The recorded lectures and then 40 minute class time was extremely effective.
Her availability and effective use of digital tools.
Discussion in class
Explain everything clearly. Lecture slides are extremely helpful.
The videos (and slides that went with them) were the most helpful.
Her meticulousness and unwavering dedication to her students' learning. Professor Pieters truly goes above and beyond in every capacity. I truly cannot stress how wonderful she is as a teacher and how much this helps one's learning. From how she prepares her materials, to how open she is to student feedback, to the effort she puts in to deeply answering any students' questions or unpacking their understanding of the material, Professor Pieters' instruction is beyond compare.
Extremely robust and thorough supply of online materials for lectures, homework, papers, etc.
Very clear and methodical teaching.

What could the instructor modify to help you learn more?

Comments
the lectures on panotopa video had a bit of an issue; the volume was quite low; however, beyond this, there was absolutely nothing that Gina could/should work on.
N/A. Given that this was her first time teaching the course and further that it was online, I think that Prof. Pieters did a great job.
discuss the economic intuition rather than plug and chug derivatives
Nothing
Nothing. Dr. Pieters is one of the best Econ instructors at U of C.
It would have been helpful to maybe spend a little more time summarizing the models at the beginning of the synchronous class sections. Sometimes we would jump into specifics and I would get a bit lost.
Explain how more updated models change our basic ones.

Please include the name of the TA/CA/Intern you are evaluating.

Comments
Michael Ma
Michael Ma, Misbah Tanvir
Michael Ma
Michael Ma
Multiple TA's

What aspects of the TA's teaching contributed most to your learning?

Comments
Michael was very helpful in explaining aspects of the problem sets and answering my questions about the models. I had no problems with Misbah but generally did not interact with her as much.
Availability in his office hours and helpful advice in solving problems

What could the TA modify to help you learn more?

Comments
They couldn't answer questions very well.

Additional feedback to the TA/CA/Intern:

Comments
He was wonderful and helped me in discussion section. Always was willing to answer questions.

THE UNIVERSITY OF CHICAGO

ECON 23950 2 - Economic Policy Analysis - Instructor(s) Gina Pieters

Project Title: **College Course Evaluation - Spring 2020**

Number Enrolled: **31**
Number of Responses: **18**

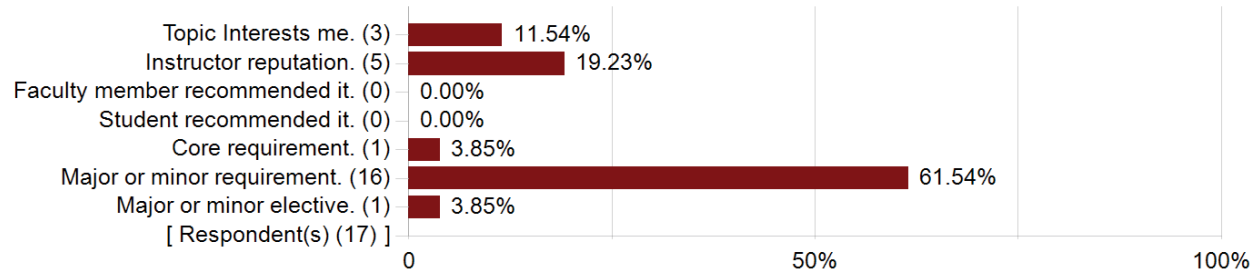
Report Comments

Opinions expressed in these evaluations are those of students enrolled in the specif course and do not represent the University.

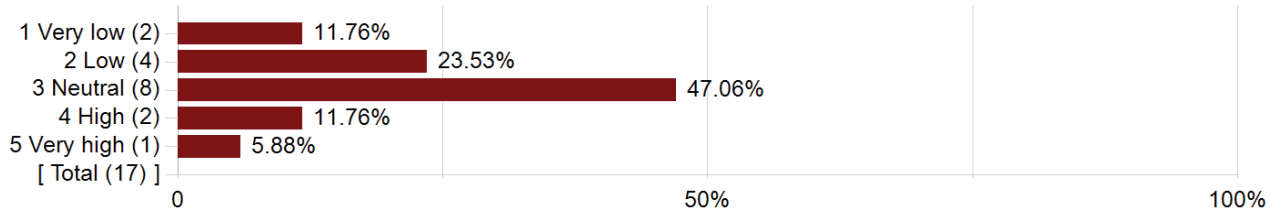
Creation Date: **Thursday, August 13, 2020**

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Why did you choose to take this course? (Select all that apply)

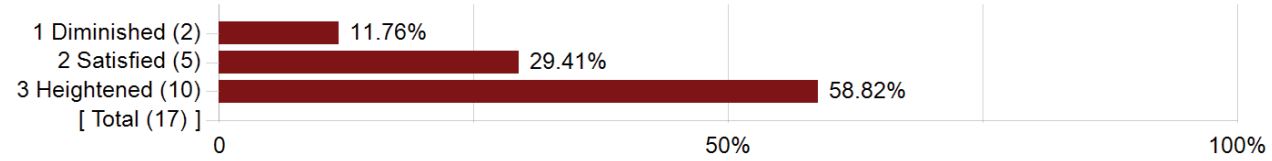


Prior to starting this class, your interest level was?



Statistics	Value
Response Count	17
Mean	2.76
Standard Deviation	1.03

Now that this class is over, your interest is?



Statistics	Value
Response Count	17
Mean	2.47
Mode	3
Standard Deviation	0.72

What are the most important things that you learned in this course? Please reflect on the knowledge and skills you gained.

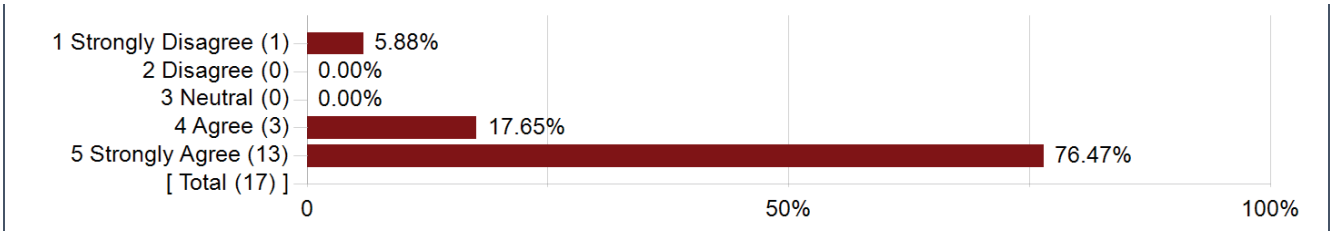
Comments
Key models and applications for said models in fiscal and monetary policy. Also, exposure to MATLAB.
Basic monetary/fiscal policy and how economic frameworks/concepts translate to (simplified) real life scenarios.
Basics of Fiscal and Monetary Policy
That this professor will do everything to make this class as hard as possible for the students.
How to create and understand economic models, and to explore policies through them.
Experience designing and applying simple economic models to real economics problems; experience with a wide variety of different policy models; exposure to intro/intermediate level thinking about fiscal and monetary policy
The model paradigms to map the tensions present in specific economic policy.
Little bit of Matlab and a lot of fiscal and monetary policy theory
Different models of fiscal and monetary policies. How to write an economics paper.
continuation of the 200s sequence, applications of economic models to monetary and fiscal policy
This class expands upon the skills attained in the 200s sequence.
I learned how to set up simple forms of model from contemporary issues.
Various macroeconomic models
Composition of various economic policy models; how to test models in Dynare
How to use macroeconomic theories to analyze fiscal and monetary policies. Learned a lot on how to model economies and simulate them using MATLAB and Dynare.

Describe how aspects of this course (lectures, discussions, labs, assignments, etc.) contributed to your learning.

Comments
Pre–recorded lectures and live discussion sections. Weekly problem sets or fiscal/monetary papers.
Prerecorded lectures with live class Q+A, mini quiz questions on the lectures, weekly homework, two fiscal papers and two monetary papers
Lectures were good, never attended discussions. PSETS were long and sometimes unclear, but they were overall fairly alright
Assignments ridiculously hard. Essays as part of uchicago Econ were unnecessary and something that we have never done before.
The mini–lectures were organized clearly, and, while I don't like mini–quizzes, the timed QREs for each lecture were helpful to keep you up to date on the material, which is especially important when we're doing distanced learning
Despite COVID, lectures were adapted as well as they could be and were the basis for learning. Instructor was very available for questions, support, and feedback
Lectures and assignments were the most important part. Professor Pieters is an incredibly clear lecturer and her assignments are very carefully crafted to make you "learn" the material in your own right if you did not pick up on the nuances in lecture.
Amazing slides, and very well–planned course.
Writing papers on fiscal and monetary policy was a particularly effective method for synthesizing lecture content and skills covered in the homework assignments. These papers were a great introduction to the skills one might use to conduct economic research, and they were the most rewarding assignments I've completed in my Economics major coursework so far.
The flipped classes were helpful, and I really liked how you could go at your own pace on the slides/lectures. Office hours are also super helpful, please go to them!
Lectures were very well prepared. You learn the technical stuff in psets. And the papers were cool to learn a bit of modeling
The lectures (they were online) were helpful and the monetary/fiscal policy papers were instrumental in thinking through the various macroeconomic theories and models.

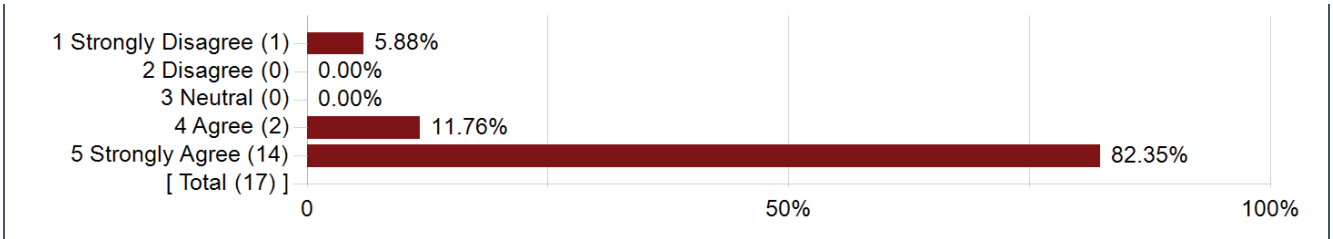
The Instructor(s) . . .

1. Provided a syllabus that allowed you to plan your learning and study time effectively.



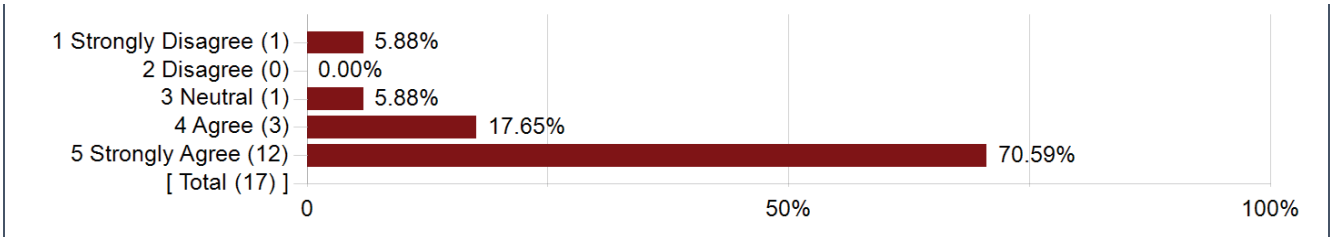
Statistics	Value
Response Count	17
Mean	4.59
Median	5.00
Standard Deviation	1.00

2. Explained clearly the course objectives and expectations.



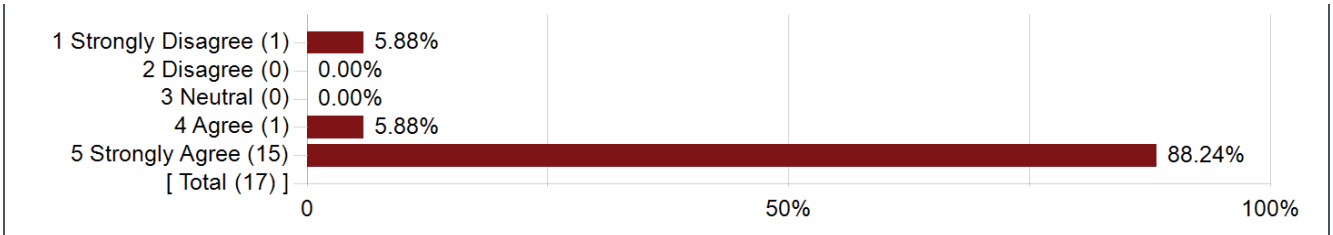
Statistics	Value
Response Count	17
Mean	4.65
Median	5.00
Standard Deviation	1.00

3. Stimulated your interest in the core ideas of the course.



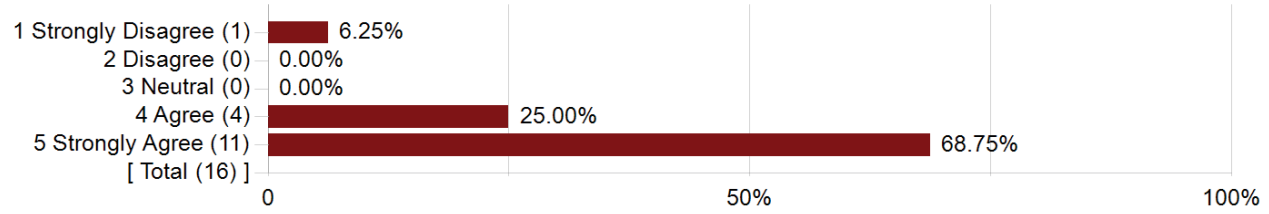
Statistics	Value
Response Count	17
Mean	4.47
Median	5.00
Standard Deviation	1.07

4. Was available and helpful outside of class.



Statistics	Value
Response Count	17
Mean	4.71
Median	5.00
Standard Deviation	0.99

5. Overall, the instructor made a significant contribution to your learning.



Statistics	Value
Response Count	16
Mean	4.50
Median	5.00
Standard Deviation	1.03

What aspect of the instructor's teaching contributed most to your learning?

Comments
Office hours were very helpful and I would highly recommend attending! The pre–recorded lecture and live discussion style of teaching was also helpful.
Professor Pieters is one of the most organized instructors I've had at UChicago. She lays out the expectations clearly and the benchmarks needed to achieve each letter grade. She is reasonable in her assignment load and clear in communication. She designs her course so thoughtfully.
I think Professor Pieter's lectures were generally pretty clear (despite having typos once in a while) and I found the discussion board to be pretty useful. While the papers were definitely stressful, they were quite interesting/informative. Professor Pieter was also quite accommodating and flexible about the assignments this quarter
Very structured and expectations were unbelievably clear.
Nothing. Bad instructor.
Being available to students throughout the week, and explaining concepts clearly and concisely. Mini–lectures were structured well such that you can go back and review specific concepts part by part
Professor Pieters is a great instructor and I recommend on the strongest possible terms waiting to take Econ 29350 with her. Dr. Pieters is very effective at designing a clear, structured course that holds you to high expectations with the content but allows you flexibility (especially during this Spring 2020 COVID quarter.) Dr. Pieters was very effective at structuring learning through a mix of problem sets, homework, lectures, and class discussion. If you want an instructor who will set expectations very clearly, have fair and neutral grading, and have a challenging but not overwhelming workload, this is the class for you.
Professor Pieter's assignments have to be some of the best I have completed at UChicago in the sense that she spends a lot of time making sure that the questions lead us to meaningful conclusions and practice the skills that we are taught.
If Gina is anything she is thorough and invested in your comprehension of the material
Very well planned materials and fair grading scheme
–clear lectures, presented well –she was extremely flexible given the circumstances of the quarter and had a syllabus that provided us multiple opportunities to earn the best possible grade
Professor Pieters provides many resources for students to learn the material, which means that students with various learning styles can all be successful. All expectations/grade cutoffs/assignment details are clearly laid out at the beginning of the course—the organization of the class was impeccable.
The office hours are a great opportunity to work through problems with the Professor. Professor Pieters is a great teacher, her assignments force you to critically analyze content discussed in class. Sometimes the class can be overwhelming, but she's always fair and you learn a lot in her class.
Gina is definitely a character but she's super smart and cares about her students if you get past her strict appearance. She's surprisingly funny. She was great dealing with the online quarter. The papers were much more fun than quizzes and I would consider keeping them even when the course is taught in person.
Lectures were well–planned and detailed
Dr. Pieters was very clear and organized about how the course was to run, what to expect about the grades and assignments, and how to interact with her and the TA's about the course material. She was readily available outside of class, and she was always willing to reflect student opinions on how the course is run, especially given the unprecedented online nature of this course.

What could the instructor modify to help you learn more?

Comments
I feel like the course started very intensely and I was struggling to keep up in the beginning but slowed down heavily towards the end of the quarter. This may have just been me, but maybe spreading out the level of difficulty (especially in regards to psets/MATLAB) may be helpful.
Reduce the number of typos on lectures/hw and make it more clear when they do occur.
More engaging style. This economics class needs some pizzaz
More clarity on PSETS and please fewer typos
Instead of cramming everything into prerecorded non–interactive powerpoints, actually teach the class.
Gina was a great instructor, especially in these times! I feel like only you can help you learn more at this point.
As the course goes through future iterations, it would be helpful to get the topic guides and practice problems like in past classes.
Make sure all written material presented is free of bugs.
Nothing! Amazing class, amazing professor
Nothing. This class was perfect.
N/A
Sometimes the requirements of the paper were a little unclear. Oftentimes, the paper was easier than it seemed and I often felt more stressed than I ultimately should have been.
Often, there are some errors (especially in homework) that could prevent you from finishing the assignment quickly. However, Dr. Pieters is available to answer questions and the bug bounty policy was actually helpful in motivating me to look at the material presented more closely, which ultimately helped me understand the material better.

Please include the name of the TA/CA/Intern you are evaluating.

Comments
Misbah
Michael Ma
Mishab
Michael Yuhuang

What aspects of the TA's teaching contributed most to your learning?

Comments
Misbah was very patient and good explaining concepts. She was also willing to help debug MATLAB code, which was helpful.
Explained concepts clearly
Overall great TA, wouldn't give away answers but would provide helpful hints.
Michael is the goat. He's super funny and helpful. Give him a job please and I wish he could be my TA forever.

What could the TA modify to help you learn more?

Comments
Please TA econ classes next year Michael, I would appreciate it
N/A

Additional feedback to the TA/CA/Intern:

Comments
Pretty good and straightforward TA. Understood the concepts well, and adjusted responses accordingly for students
great job!
He's the best

THE UNIVERSITY OF CHICAGO

ECON 17110 1 - International Monetary Systems - Instructor(s) Gina Pieters

Project Title: **College Course Evaluation - Autumn 2020**

Number Enrolled: **45**
Number of Responses: **19**

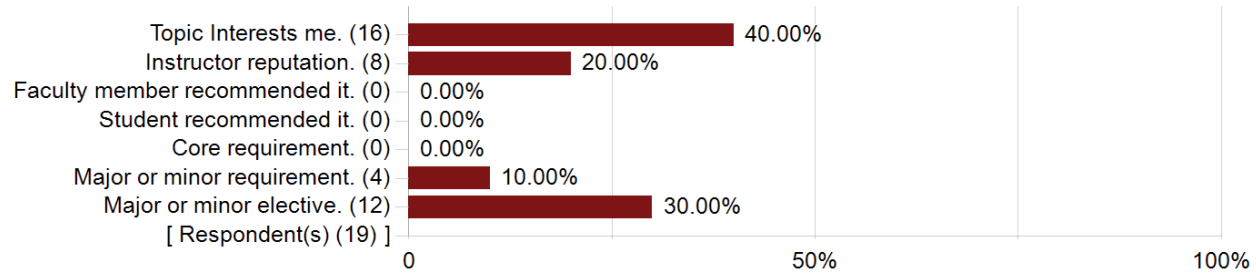
Report Comments

Opinions expressed in these evaluations are those of students enrolled in the specif course and do not represent the University.

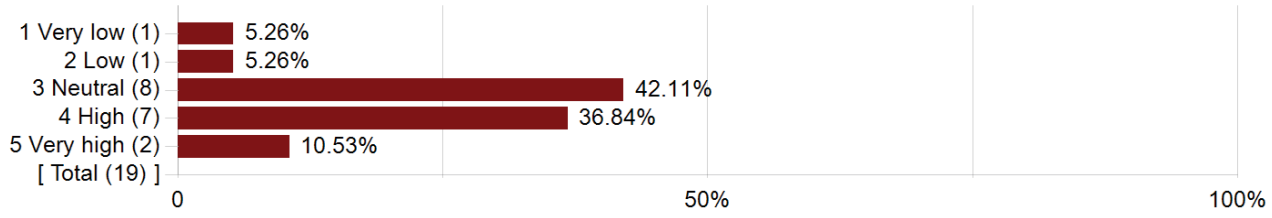
Creation Date: **Tuesday, February 16, 2021**

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Why did you choose to take this course? (Select all that apply)

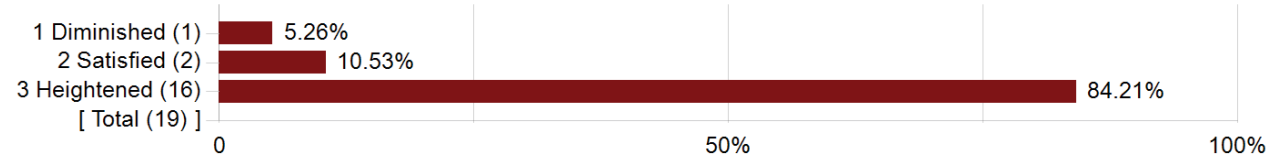


Prior to starting this class, your interest level was?



Statistics	Value
Response Count	19
Mean	3.42
Standard Deviation	0.96

Now that this class is over, your interest is?



Statistics	Value
Response Count	19
Mean	2.79
Standard Deviation	0.54

What are the most important things that you learned in this course? Please reflect on the knowledge and skills you gained.

Comments
How the foreign exchange markets work, and how changes in the exchange markers effect the rest of the economy.
IS–LM–FX model
How exchange rates relate to interest rates, GDP, inflation etc.
I learned about how exchange rates work and how to manipulate models
I learnt the interaction between interest rates and exchange rates, and how that relates to overall macro economic conditions.
Mundell–flemming model, global financial systems
How monetary transactions and systems in general mark the world go round.
How changes in monetary policy impacts exchange rates. Whether it is viable to invest in one country or the other depending on interest rates and risk.
How money flows around the world, IS–LM–FX model
International economics
Understanding of exchange rates and money, as well as applications of monetary policy and concepts from Econ 2395 etc.
How exchange rates move and affect economic factors.
Introductory theory on exchange rates and international monetary opolicy
The role of different monetary systems and their effect on the country, currency and GDP.
Importance of monetary systems in the facilitation of global trade; the mechanisms by which currency exchange rates fluctuate; modern and historical monetary policies
What money actually means (form of exchange, store of value, etc) and how it is exchanged across markets in the form of currency. How various events or crises affect interest rates, money supply, and aggregate demand for money.
For this course, there were 2 quizzes for the quarter, 1 big paper, 3 homework assignments, and 2 short answers to do before every class. We learned about exchange rates, trade, Mundell Fleming Model, currency boards, etc.

Describe how aspects of this course (lectures, discussions, labs, assignments, etc.) contributed to your learning.

Comments
QREs, asynchronous lectures, and office hours
The pre–recorded lectures explain things very clearly, and the QREs help us understand the material.
Everything was helpful. I liked the split between watching lectures and discussing in class
Course was great
Pre recorded lectures were very clear and well laid out.
lectures were really helpful, so are the homeworks
The asynchronous portion of the lecture combined with in–class discussion was fantastic and helped me manage the considerable difficulty of having ADHD in a quarantine.
The asynchronous lectures were great. It was nice to be able to engage with the material at my own pace and the slides were very comprehensive. Being able to work on questions in a breakout room group was also helpful for finding study partners.
na
Lectures were useful, in person section also very helpful.
Enjoyed classes
The discussions and QREs were helpful in fully understanding the lectures.
The lectures (both synchronous and asynchronous) by Dr. Pierers were very helpful for learning and understanding the class material. Dr. Pieters' office hours were incredibly useful as well. Discussion sections helped me learn some of the basic foundations of the course.
Asynchronous lectures, practice problems, topic summary sheets, office hours, TA discussion sections, term paper. Asynchronous lectures (and accompanying slides) and discussion section (and accompanying slides) were particularly amazing.
Course had 2 lectures weekly (with asynchronous content to review before class), and also 1 discussion section weekly. It was super helpful that everything was recorded. Professor and TA were both very helpful and clear. Definitely attend discussion sessions, too.

The Instructor(s) . . .

	Mean	Median	N/A	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree	Total Responses
Provided a syllabus that allowed you to plan your learning and study time effectively.	4.32	5.00	0.00%	10.53%	0.00%	5.26%	15.79%	68.42%	19
Explained clearly the course objectives and expectations.	4.26	5.00	0.00%	10.53%	5.26%	0.00%	15.79%	68.42%	19
Stimulated your interest in the core ideas of the course.	4.26	5.00	0.00%	10.53%	0.00%	5.26%	21.05%	63.16%	19
Was available and helpful outside of class.	4.28	5.00	5.26%	10.53%	0.00%	5.26%	15.79%	63.16%	19
Overall, the instructor made a significant contribution to your learning.	4.32	5.00	0.00%	10.53%	0.00%	5.26%	15.79%	68.42%	19

What aspect of the instructor's teaching contributed most to your learning?

Comments
Her explanations for complicated topics
The QREs are very helpful. And discussing those QREs in smaller groups help heighten the remote learning experience.
Prof Pieters is a fantastic lecturer
very clear pre recorded lectures. QRE questions were also useful to stimulate understanding of material.
She really knows what she's doing
Professor Peters blew this class out of the water for me. I was hesitant at first because the language in the syllabus seemed harsh but she was nothing if not helpful at all times and incredibly understanding. I had no issues with keeping up in any capacity despite the added challenge of ADHD. She brought a class I was mildly interested into one of my favorite classes I have ever taken.
One of the best structured and organized courses I have taken at the university. Professor Pieters was able to convey the material in a well manner. The structure and organization was on point. I never felt I was lost or not on track with course material. Topic summary and practice problems were definitely a bonus when it came to knowing the material better.
Prof. Pieters was fantastic! She was comprehensive and thorough in her explanations, available often, and an engaging lecturer, even over zoom.
Prerecorded videos
She provides significant amounts of resources for learning, is extremely available to discuss the course or related topics, and is an excellent teacher overall. She is clearly an expert in her subject and is passionate about it—but she also truly cares about our learning. Professor Pieters is the best teacher I've had at this university.
Her passion for the topic.
Dr. Pieters did a fantastic job of answering my questions, and whenever I was inevitably confused with course material she was more than happy to take the time to more thoroughly explain concepts.
Gina Pieters is the best econ prof I've had at this school. She is incredibly dedicated to students and making sure that she is doing absolutely everything she can to help them succeed. She will by no means do the work for you (rightly so), but she gives you all the tools you need to do well (office hours, ridiculously fast email/canvas response time, practice problems, topic summaries, term paper support and feedback, etc) and genuinely wants people to do well and enjoy the material. But it doesn't stop at the course material...she wants you to enjoy economics. She is willing to talk about other interests or questions and is quick to provide support on connecting class material to other uchicago courses and current events. She is a rare breed among econ profs...econ dept needs to give her a raise and tenure soon because she's the real deal.
Professor Pieters was wonderful: tough but fair grader. Made expectations, how things were graded, and when things were due extremely clear. We can tell she's passionate about the subject. The lectures were helpful, and she's also extremely available for office hours.

What could the instructor modify to help you learn more?

Comments
nothing
NA
Provide clearer answer keys and a little more guidance for the final paper and some more practice problems (she mentioned when writing quiz 2 that it currently (in draft form) was too long as she had come up with more problem – it would be great if she released those as practice as she didn't use them as exam questions (as the quiz did end up being reasonable in length)
Spending a little more time going over the material before going into the QREs could be helpful. The quizzes were also very time constrained.
She can come off as a little bit intimidating
The only issue I ever had with the class was that on rare occasions I did not quite know what a question was asking but she was very helpful if this did come up.
Nothing at all :) Prof. Pieters is one of the best professors I've had in a long time.
More clear descriptions of what we need to do for assignments, particularly the homeworks and modules
Online classes make video lectures rather tough to get through—but, of course, Pieters has no control over that.
I still was confused by the possible grade distribution.
N/A
Nothing. She is doing everything she can to help students learn and is *very* receptive if anyone brings concerns or suggestions to her attention. She always welcomes feedback. The only things that come to mind relate to remote learning more broadly and not Prof Pieters. She navigated this environment with incredible thought and care.
NA

Remote Course Questions

How effective were the different modes of remote teaching in this course?

	Mean	Median	N/A	Very Ineffective	Ineffective	Neutral	Effective	Very Effective	Total Responses
Synchronous Lectures	4.38	5.00	5.88%	11.76%	0.00%	0.00%	11.76%	70.59%	17
Asynchronous (prerecorded) Lectures	4.72	5.00	0.00%	5.56%	0.00%	0.00%	5.56%	88.89%	18
Large Discussions (everyone in the class)	4.25	5.00	11.11%	5.56%	0.00%	11.11%	22.22%	50.00%	18
Small Discussions (zoom breakout rooms)	4.47	5.00	5.56%	5.56%	0.00%	0.00%	27.78%	61.11%	18
Short Quizzes	3.70	4.00	44.44%	5.56%	0.00%	11.11%	27.78%	11.11%	18
Laboratories	1.00	1.00	94.12%	5.88%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	17
Timed Exams	3.75	4.00	11.11%	5.56%	5.56%	16.67%	38.89%	22.22%	18
Written Work (take home exams, papers, problem sets, etc.)	4.56	5.00	0.00%	5.56%	0.00%	0.00%	22.22%	72.22%	18
Scheduled Faculty Office Hours	4.57	5.00	22.22%	5.56%	0.00%	0.00%	11.11%	61.11%	18
Scheduled TA Office Hours	4.46	5.00	27.78%	5.56%	0.00%	0.00%	16.67%	50.00%	18

Please elaborate on the above.

Comments
I think the course was well designed. Pieters made her self available, recorded material, and answered questions. i would appreciate if she gave some more guidance on the paper, and provided clearer instructions on the homework. I particularly liked the QRES
Grade scope feedback could be improved.
Professor Peters is a Top–Tier professor and did an incredible job in this class. I know that every point I get I earned and that she could not have possibly taught the class better than she did.
Asynchronous content was 40mins or less and we watched that before class starts. Synchronous lecture is used to facilitate class discussion. As soon as class starts Professor Pieters recaps the material and we go into breakout rooms and discuss QREs. QRE's are questions we knew beforehand and discuss them during breakout rooms.
NA
I felt that the problem sets, in–class QRE's, and the final paper were very effective in a remote teaching environment.
All of these "modes" were helpful. Asynchronous lectures and TA office hours were crucial. Synchronous lectures were also helpful but less so if people in your small group didn't come prepared. Sometimes can be hard to ask questions in the large synchronous class setting, so maybe there's a way to submit anonymous questions before each class on canvas or Piazza and then Prof Pieters can know what questions to address directly in synchronous lecture.
Office hours were great— all questions were answered clearly.

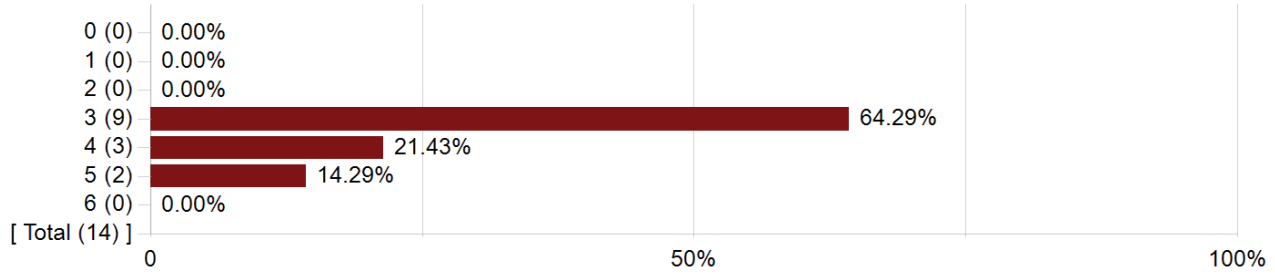
Did the instructor make adjustments to the course mid-quarter? If so, please comment on the effectiveness of those adjustments.

Comments
Yes.
Yes, she started being available during the "assyncronous" part of class time to answer questions, added more office hours, and starting using the clicker to help present the lecture recordings. I thought all of the changes were really good.
NA
She modified the structure of in–person lectures halfway through the course in response to feedback, focusing on QREs and breakout groups. I thought it was generally a good use of time.
She did and they were productive in terms of more engaging asynchronous lectures.
Yes, but it wasn't just mid–quarter. She was always open to feedback. Six of one half dozen of the other on whether it mattered to see Prof Pieters's face in the asynchronous videos. The yellow pointer dot thing, however, was very helpful!
Yes! Professor Pieters took our comments into consideration.

Please describe any element of this course, including specific actions by the instructor, that improved your remote learning experience.

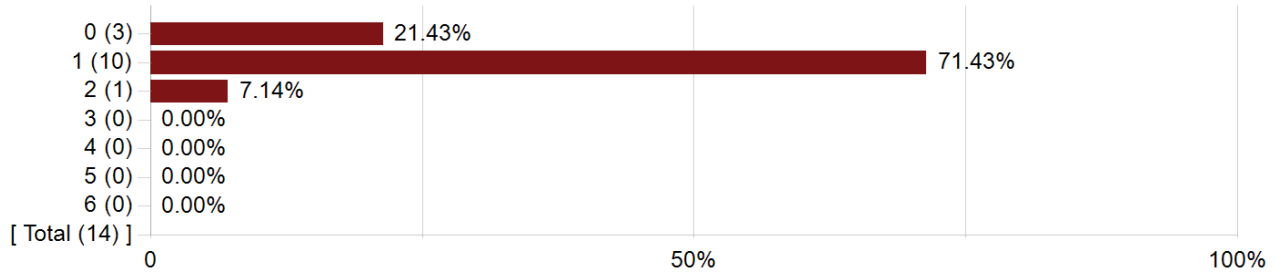
Comments
She held copious amounts of office hours and was responsive to student emails
Pre recorded lectures were great. The ability to pause and rewind makes a big contribution to learning.
The split lectures really helped because it allowed me to watch them at my own pace and digest materials in a way that was best suited to me while allowing me to really understand the material before discussing in the synchronous portions.
Additional office hours so that student across different time zones could attend. Practice problems and topic summaries helped a lot.
NA
A very clear and organized syllabus; it can be hard to track assignments when everything is online, so having a set and super detailed syllabus at the very beginning of the quarter is huge.
Flexibility with regard to problem sets, timed exams, and QRE's was very helpful, as it helped to alleviate the stress of technology problems potentially hurting my academic performance.
TA discussion section and slides were SO helpful. Sometimes just having more examples of questions and appropriate responses was the thing that helped me really grasp the material. This also applies to the practice problems and QREs. Both were great as well.
Just making sure the videos were recorded was helpful.

How many hours per week did you spend in lectures for this course (synchronous or asynchronous)?



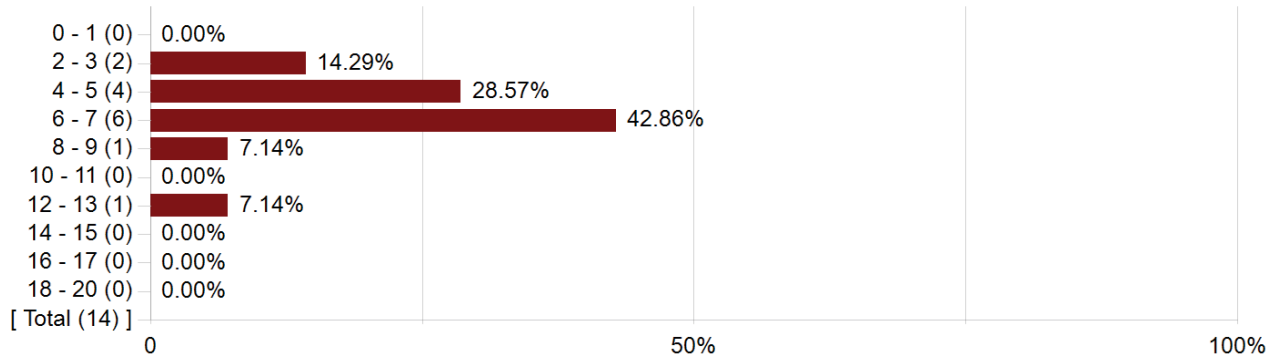
Statistics	Value
Response Count	14
Mean	3.50
Standard Deviation	0.76

How many hours per week did you spend in other scheduled activities for this course (labs, discussions, etc.)?



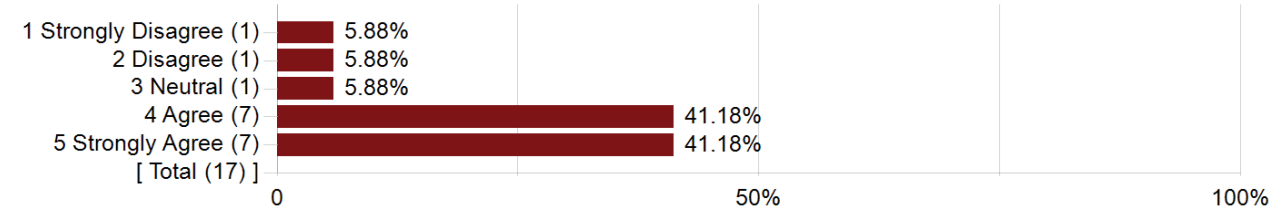
Statistics	Value
Response Count	14
Mean	0.86
Standard Deviation	0.53

How many additional hours per week did you spend on this course (reading, problem sets, writing, etc.)?



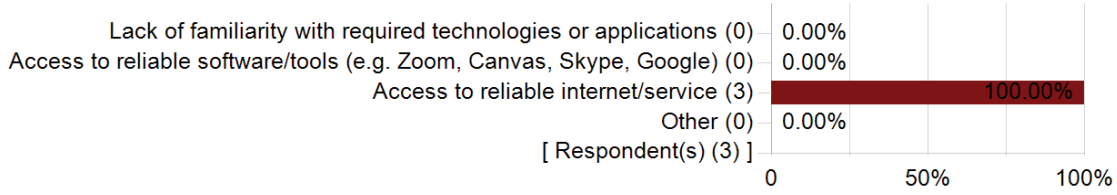
Statistics	Value
Response Count	14
Mean	6.00
Standard Deviation	2.42

The overall workload of the course was appropriate.

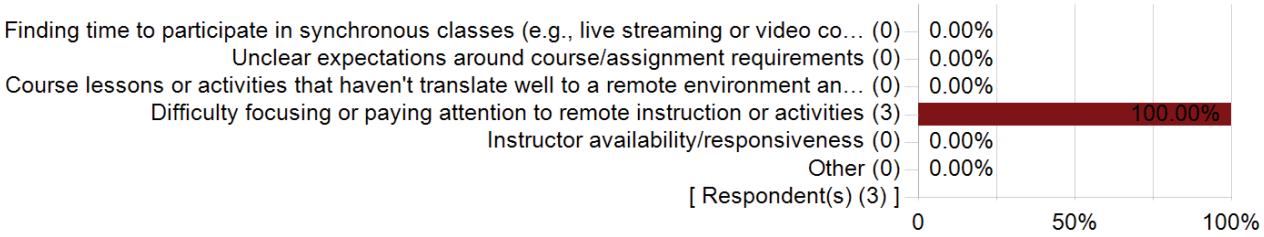


Statistics	Value
Response Count	17
Mean	4.06
Standard Deviation	1.14

Which of the following technological issues continue to be a challenge for you? (check all that apply)



Which of the following learning/educational issues continue to be a challenge for you? (check all that apply)



TA/CA/Intern Questions

Please include the name of the TA/CA/Intern you are evaluating.

Comments
Carly Schippits
Carly Schippits
Carly
Carly Schippits
Carly
Carly Schippits
Carly Schippits
Carly Schippits
Carly

What aspects of the TA's teaching contributed most to your learning?

Comments
Her discussion sessions are helpful understanding the material.
Discussion sections
she ran discussions were not great and did a lot of the grading
Carly explains things so well, and she's also so nice
Carly is helpful when it came down to explaining a concept in more detail. She gave good insights about how to approach a homework question.
slides for discussion sections were helpful
N/A
Discussion section and slides. Availability to meet outside of class. Email responsiveness. Carly was wonderful. Professional, kind, patient, responsive.
She's so helpful! The Discussion sessions were very useful, especially when ahead of a homework assignment due to quiz to take. She was also very available for office hours.

What could the TA modify to help you learn more?

Comments
N/A
Nothing
I want to say another discussion section each week (one for reviewing class material the second for approaching problems and problem sets/open questions), but I know that not everyone attended the one. Carly prepared for these really well and it showed.
she could provide more detailed feedback on homework and more practice problems
NA

Additional feedback to the TA/CA/Intern:

Comments
Change nothing.
Great!

Assignments and Participation

	Mean	Median	N/A	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree	Total Responses
The assignments in the course were reasonable.	4.19	4.50	0.00%	6.25%	6.25%	0.00%	37.50%	50.00%	16
The assignments and classroom activities served the course objectives.	4.44	5.00	0.00%	6.25%	0.00%	0.00%	31.25%	62.50%	16
Instructor’s feedback/comments on your assignments were clear, specific, and helpful.	4.06	5.00	0.00%	6.25%	6.25%	18.75%	12.50%	56.25%	16
Assignments were returned to you in a timely manner.	4.50	5.00	0.00%	6.25%	0.00%	0.00%	25.00%	68.75%	16
The class met regularly, on time, and for the entire period.	4.63	5.00	0.00%	6.25%	0.00%	0.00%	12.50%	81.25%	16
If the class did not meet at the regularly scheduled time, were the changes and reasons behind them explained clearly.	4.38	5.00	50.00%	6.25%	0.00%	0.00%	6.25%	37.50%	16
You were prepared for classes and attended regularly.	4.56	5.00	0.00%	6.25%	0.00%	0.00%	18.75%	75.00%	16

ECON 20000 5 - The Elements of Economic Analysis I - Instructor(s) Gina Pieters

Project Title: **College Course Evaluation - Autumn 2020**

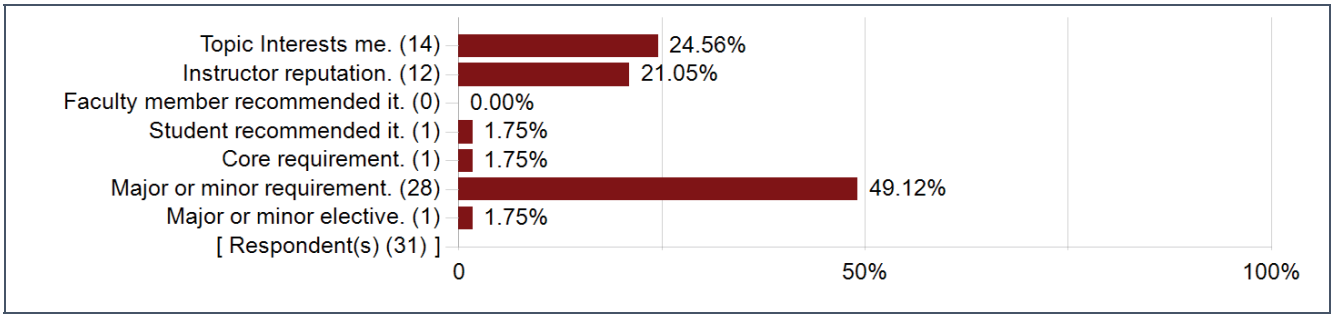
Number Enrolled: **54**
Number of Responses: **32**

Report Comments

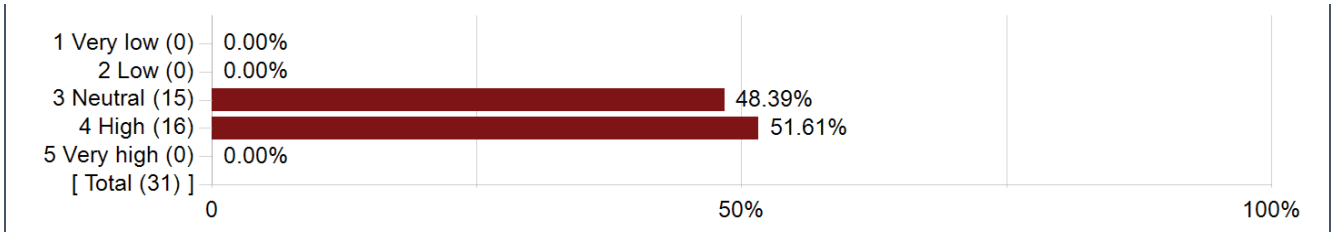
Opinions expressed in these evaluations are those of students enrolled in the specif course and do not represent the University.

Creation Date: **Tuesday, February 16, 2021**

Why did you choose to take this course? (Select all that apply)

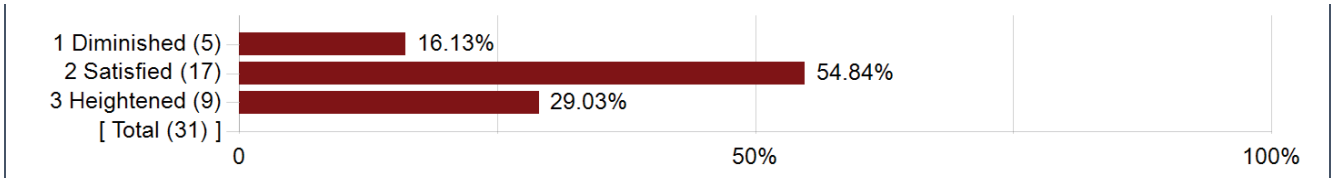


Prior to starting this class, your interest level was?



Statistics	Value
Response Count	31
Mean	3.52
Standard Deviation	0.51

Now that this class is over, your interest is?



Statistics	Value
Response Count	31
Mean	2.13
Standard Deviation	0.67

What are the most important things that you learned in this course? Please reflect on the knowledge and skills you gained.

Comments
Crafting consumer demand. Combining math and economic concepts.
Utility maximization, expenditure minimization, how to apply calculus to economics
Lagrangian, UMP, EMP, Duality, CS, EV, CV, Canonical and Descriptive Models
Econ stuff
Basic tools and concepts that are necessary to understand in the field of Economics
Basic economic concepts (budget constraints, utility/preferences, demand, applied concepts as well)
I learned how to use math to analyze microeconomic topics
Introductory material for the Econ major. Lagrangians.
Computing and determining partial and general equilibriums. The computations extend from the intuitions of microeconomic equilibriums in ECON 10000.
Economical analysis
lots of basic econ skills
utility, preferences, goods endowment economies, and home–goods
How consumers behave given a maximizing function and constraint(s)
Fundamental microeconomic principles
Langrangian multipliers, optimization, and other important micro topics.
Economic analysis
I learned a lot of the 'toolkits' of the fundamentel economics.
microeconomic skills that build the base for the next couple classes of this sequence
How to solve UMP and EMP problems when applied to a wide variety of scenarios, how to solve problems of consumer preferences, and understanding microeconomic theory
Lagrangians, utility maximizations, how consumers make choices, how price changes affect consumer decisons/behaviors
Using calculus concepts to understand economics.

Describe how aspects of this course (lectures, discussions, labs, assignments, etc.) contributed to your learning.

Comments
Pre–recorded lectures were a little fast and often required multiple viewing but well encapsulated the information. QREs/practice problems helped prepare for quizzes and homeworks.
Lectures were hard to understand at first watch. Definitely needed class time/discussion sections to understand. Quizzes are conceptual, HW mathematical and TEDIOUS.
PSETS are the best indicator of your understanding QREs are also helpful
Synchronous QRE / asynchronous lecture blend of class was really nice
Lectures were the meat of the course, and discussions were more like office hours. Assignments made sure you knew what was expected to know for the tests
There are more than enough resources provided to succeed in this class. Professor Pieters and the TAs are rockstars. Professor Pieters takes so much time to create the slides, record the videos, be present in class, answer questions on the discussion board (which are many) so diligently, answer questions on the bug bounty board (also so many) and she updates every file right away, hold MULTIPLE office hours, and process all regrade requests! This is probably only half of the stuff she does for this class, and she has three classes and does her own research as well. Students who complain just don't appreciate the effort she puts into this class – she wants everyone to succeed but also holds everyone accountable for their learning.
The prerecorded lectures were helpful as was the homework before it changed to become more quizlike
Prerecorded lectures were a helpful resource. In–class discussion was more of a flipped classroom style. Wish Prof Pieters would have taught the problems instead of putting us in breakout rooms to try to decipher ourselves.
The mix of pre–recorded and synchronous lectures is extremely effective. Watching the pre–recorded lectures helps me gain an initial understanding of what the materials are, and class time enables clarifications and further discussions.
Lectures and discussion
prerecorded lectures were the most useful in learning the content, as well as psets and quizzes.
Extremely structured lectures
prerecorded lectures were uploaded the night before class, and then we would have discussions about the weeks content
Everything worked well together. I specifically liked the alternating PSETS and quiz set up, I think that worked well to give us practice and then be tested.
Pre–recorded lectures help a lot
the prerecorded lectures and slide were wonderful and greatly contributed to the learning. the Lima textbook provided was difficult to follow at times, and felt unrelated to the lectures at some times— overall, it seemed like we only had the lectures as resources for the homework and quizzes.
the recorded lectures were really helpful and detailed. i also thought that the QREs were a good way to test my knowledge and increase understanding.
Pre–recorded lectures were great, it was nice to be able to re–watch them before the exams. QREs were good for checking understanding and getting to know people in the class. Biweekly problem sets and quizzes was a very good structure, it was nice to know how I was keeping up with the material since there was so much content
The recorded lectures were helpful especially after Professor Pieters included video and the mouse functionality. The in person classes were good for clarifying the topics but it was not as good once people stopped coming to class. The discussion session with Catalina was also really helpful because her notes always made topics easier to understand.
Pre–recorded lectures were the most helpful in understanding the material.

The Instructor(s) . . .

	Mean	Median	N/A	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree	Total Responses
Provided a syllabus that allowed you to plan your learning and study time effectively.	4.63	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	3.33%	0.00%	26.67%	70.00%	30
Explained clearly the course objectives and expectations.	4.67	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	3.33%	26.67%	70.00%	30
Stimulated your interest in the core ideas of the course.	4.20	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	10.00%	6.67%	36.67%	46.67%	30
Was available and helpful outside of class.	4.41	5.00	3.33%	0.00%	3.33%	6.67%	33.33%	53.33%	30
Overall, the instructor made a significant contribution to your learning.	4.20	4.00	0.00%	3.33%	3.33%	10.00%	36.67%	46.67%	30

What aspect of the instructor's teaching contributed most to your learning?

Comments
The lectures.
Lecture videos and discussion sections.
Lectures, psets
Her voice in the lectures was super soothing, even thought the material made me cry heh
Pieters is an excellent and understanding teacher. While she has high expectations, she works very hard to help you achieve them.
The little summaries provided in class before we went into breakout rooms were the most helpful, but mostly the assignments (i.e. QREs and problem sets) were quite useful as well.
She was very kind and open to helping students succeed. I could tell she cares a lot about her students.
Prerecorded lectures and topic summaries and practice problems provided under canvas were very helpful in understanding course material.
The structure is really great. No midterms or finals.
Where pre–recorded lectures focused on the concepts, we were given the opportunity to answer questions to see how well we were able to apply the concepts learnt.
Thorough expalainantion
her level of organization
Pre–recorded lectures and answering questions on discussion board.
I've never seen more structured lectures than Pieters'. I love the way she compartmentalizes every topic. It makes it so much clearer and easier to connect concepts with one another and look at the grander scheme of things.
Professor Pieters does a great job of explaining concepts and breaking down ideas in a way that makes you excited to learn more!
Once she made the adjustments half way through the quarter my learning improved. The asynchronous lectures really stepped up after that and helped me digest the content.
Lectures and in–class Q&As
The pre–recorded lectures by far.
the lectures, powerpoints, and topic summaries were extremely helpful
Professor Pieters was really good at explaining concepts that seemed very technical and abstract into more simple terms that still captured the intricacies of the concepts we were learning. She was also very willing to explain the material many different ways and learning the history of some of the concepts we learned was also pretty cool.
Recorded lectures and office hours
Pre–recorded lectures were super helpful and clear!
She is a very good lecturer and her pre–recorded lectures are always available on Panopto to review again.

What could the instructor modify to help you learn more?

Comments
Perhaps spend more time on the big–picture ideas behind the concepts. We often delve into the nitty–gritty and lose track of what we are trying to do with the concepts we learned.
More review of concepts.
Posting lectures earlier (usually about 12 hours before class, I would prefer 24 or so)
Perhaps giving some type of practice quizzes would be very helpful since they are very theoretical and there's otherwise no practice
Whenever a question was asked, I felt as though Professor Pieters did not fully answer it ever.
Work through full problems during class time. Clearer standards for quizzes to understand both grading and what we were to be tested on.
None!
Too much homework and is too difficult.
the quizzes were not similar to the homework/what we had talked about in class at all, so having consistency across content would help
Make actual class time more productive.
Quiz questions are always a hit or miss, and I never know whether I did well or not after taking it. I could feel the same way towards 2 quizzes and have one turn out to be an A and another one a C. I don't feel like the questions are entirely/holistically representative of the things I learn in class, so I wish Pieters can find a way to address this concern.
I know it is a lot to ask, especially given how available she makes herself outside of class, but I would really appreciate lectures being uploaded earlier, because it always made me kind of rush through the material.
I think the live structure of class was a bit clunky at times. Maybe standardize it a bit more to where we have an exact amount of time for each so that way we can talk about both QREs in class.
Explain QRE questions and probably some quiz questions more clearly
She is very intimidating, which is both inspiring as a female economics student but also can lead to her perceived less available. She stays by the syllabus and is strict on that, so often students are afraid to ask for adjustments in her eyes the class is very fair. The synchronous class time is not useful at all, once most people reasonably got the 20 points for the QREs attendance for the class fell. I believe there are much better uses for class time– the breakout rooms were usually not productive if you did not attempt the QREs as they are graded after and the class discussion was very dry on the topic. I am not sure how class time can be more helpful, but perhaps discussing how 'practically' in the 'real world' the concepts are — for example bringing up an article that she only puts screenshots of on the slides and discussion the economic concept at play can put greater context into the understanding of the QRE. Most people have a pset group and if they wish to check the answers on the QREs they can check with each other, or discuss they QREs for a much much shorter time to leave room for a broader discussion. A variety of types of activities would help: p–sets were often laborious, i don't how she can diversify they activities but p–sets quizzes and lectures got monotonous. Taking the quiz was the most fun.
i found that doing the QREs in the group document. i did not mind doing the QREs in random breakout rooms, but i also liked the assigned groups. I found the group doc was more helpful because it motivated each group to put an answer in the document.
Nothing; every professor in the Economics department should strive to be like Professor Pieters
Go over more difficult questions and how to think through them using intuition in class or in the lectures. The QREs are good examples of those types of questions but solving them myself or even with others does not help me develop the economic intuition or see how I could/should be thinking about solving a problem.
More time during the class time allocated to reviewing the material, not going over QREs.

Remote Course Questions

How effective were the different modes of remote teaching in this course?

	Mean	Median	N/A	Very Ineffective	Ineffective	Neutral	Effective	Very Effective	Total Responses
Synchronous Lectures	3.59	4.00	3.33%	3.33%	10.00%	26.67%	40.00%	16.67%	30
Asynchronous (prerecorded) Lectures	4.47	5.00	0.00%	3.33%	3.33%	3.33%	23.33%	66.67%	30
Large Discussions (everyone in the class)	3.42	3.50	17.24%	3.45%	13.79%	24.14%	27.59%	13.79%	29
Small Discussions (zoom breakout rooms)	3.48	4.00	0.00%	3.45%	17.24%	24.14%	37.93%	17.24%	29
Short Quizzes	3.81	4.00	10.34%	0.00%	10.34%	17.24%	41.38%	20.69%	29
Laboratories	4.00	4.00	96.55%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	3.45%	0.00%	29
Timed Exams	3.67	4.00	40.00%	0.00%	10.00%	10.00%	30.00%	10.00%	30
Written Work (take home exams, papers, problem sets, etc.)	4.14	4.00	6.67%	0.00%	3.33%	10.00%	50.00%	30.00%	30
Scheduled Faculty Office Hours	4.09	4.00	24.14%	3.45%	3.45%	10.34%	24.14%	34.48%	29
Scheduled TA Office Hours	3.43	4.00	20.69%	6.90%	13.79%	17.24%	20.69%	20.69%	29

Please elaborate on the above.

Comments
Nothing comes to mind.
Problem sets were absurdly long and math was not taught in lectures.
TA office hours were useless. Quizzes were extremely hard, psets were hard but more time made them manageable
Asynchronous lectures were helpful even though they were complicated, liked the synchronous summaries in lectures before QREs, zooom breakout rooms to discuss QREs were usually good, quizzes and HW were very very complicated but somewhat manageable thanks to office hours/discussion sections
I really liked the 5 quiz system as opposed to a midterm/final exam format. Allowed me to stay up to date with course material and have a good understanding of if I was understanding course material.
The lectures and the psets were by far more effective than the quizzes, as the quizzes focused on extremely focused content and didn't really accurately gage our understanding of the class as a whole, despite what Professor Pieters says in the syllabus
The timed exams would be three questions on material very different from the early homeworks, so even if you studied a lot, if one question confused you it would complete tank your grade for that quiz. Professor Pieters provided a makeup exam which I greatly appreciated, but I still feel like quizzes with so little questions made it hard to adequately reflect the many hours of studying I did to prepare.
The structure of the course was really good. Professor Pieters and the TAs were also very helpful during office hours
The recorded lectures are where I did most of my learning. Class time was good to get clarity on the concepts. Then, doing the homework really solidified the concepts for me. Office hours with Professor Pieters were helpful for getting help on homework or extra help before quizzes. Professor Pieters is really nice and always willing to explain or re–explain topics in and out of class.
Problem sets and quizzes (alternated by week) were pretty difficult and stressful. Allowed to collaborate through Canvas discussion boards.

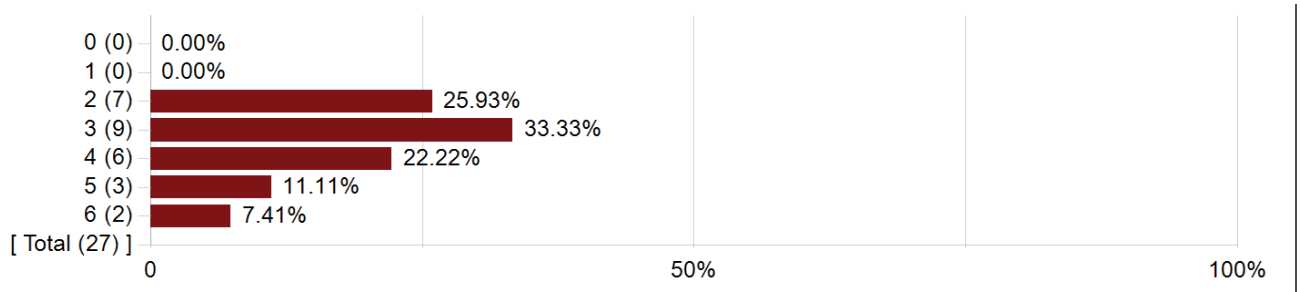
Did the instructor make adjustments to the course mid-quarter? If so, please comment on the effectiveness of those adjustments.

Comments
No
Not really.
Yes. They were discussed in class and were good.
The problem sets were changed from a more math–y style to a style more like we'd see on the tests, and I'm not sure how I feel overall about it. On one hand, it's helpful to have more conceptual questions to practice with, but on the other hand, the math–y questions were how I tested my base knowledge from the lectures and learned certain techniques.
Yes – added more office hours, changed format of HW. These changes were appreciated!
Yes, she really listened to her comments!! I appreciated the effort, though I felt the change in making homework more similar to quizzes was detrimental to my learning. It made homework incredibly difficult, and I felt as though I was unable to learn the basic concepts fully.
Yes, Prof Pieters reviewed our comments mid–quarter and made effective adjustments.
Professor responded to every single comment in the mid–quarter survey. Very responsive.
Yes, namely having the pre–recorded lectures made available to us earlier on the previous day so that we have more time to watch them.
She made the homework questions more like the quizzes, which was very helpful in terms of knowing what to expect and how to apply mathematical concepts to conceptual ideas.
Yes, very effective!
The biggest tangible adjustment was prerecorded lectures being posted earlier, which personally was not a big deal to me either way. I understand the work it takes to make those lectures, and wouldn't mind them being posted later to keep the quality up (they never went down though) because they were extremely helpful.
yes, the instructor made adjustments in the middle of the course based on comments and they were helpful. i liked that professor pieters went over the feedback and changes she was making in a video
Yes, changed the HW to more closely mirror the quizzes. I think it was good adjustment, established a lot more clarity in the course and the concepts
Yes, halfway through the course Professor Pieters made adjustments to the homework to make it more theoretical based after people said that the quizzes were too difficult. I personally did not like this change because homework before the change helped me solidify the concepts through practice and then I could study and apply them on the quiz to more difficult, application–based questions. With the harder Pset it was like I had to skip over a step to get from my understanding from lecture to the homework. So I had to do the practice problems in order to do the homework whereas before I could do them concurrently.

Please describe any element of this course, including specific actions by the instructor, that improved your remote learning experience.

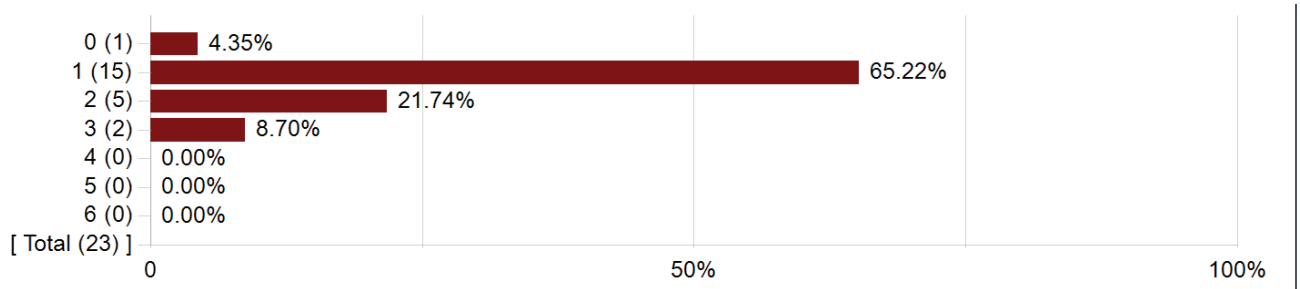
Comments
Nothing comes to mind.
Adjusted homework questions to more resemble the test. Homework got harder, but felt more prepared for test
Asynchronous lectures were very nice to have since we could go at our own pace through them and not feel too rushed since they are pretty dense.
Overall the course was very well–organized which was very appreciated!
The prerecorded lectures with preview slides on the bottom were wonderful. Professor's voice was also very calming to listen to.
The quiz formats! It was very helpful and something Prof Pieters should continue as online learning continues. I loved having short timed bi–weekly quizzes. Really aided me in studying and understanding class concepts.
The pre–recorded lectures and bi–weekly quizzes were helpful, and I preferred this structure to having one or two high stakes exams.
the prerecorded lectures were incredibly well done, and she made an abundance of resources readily available
Two dropped assignments and one dropped homework alleviated a lot of stress.
The amount of office hour availability was really helpful
Making the change in the lectures to include video and easier to understand visuals was helpful. Also, the course was EXTREMELY organized. Professor Pieters always posted topic summaries and practice problems for each topic as well as a pdf slideshow of the lecture for reference. The grading expectations were clear from the beginning and everything was outlined in great detail in the syllabus. I liked the course structure of leaving the first 40 min for the lectures and then the last 50 min is for zoom class time because then it didn't feel like I had to do class twice (on zoom and pre–recorded)
Multiple discussion sections and multiple quiz–taking slots.

How many hours per week did you spend in lectures for this course (synchronous or asynchronous)?



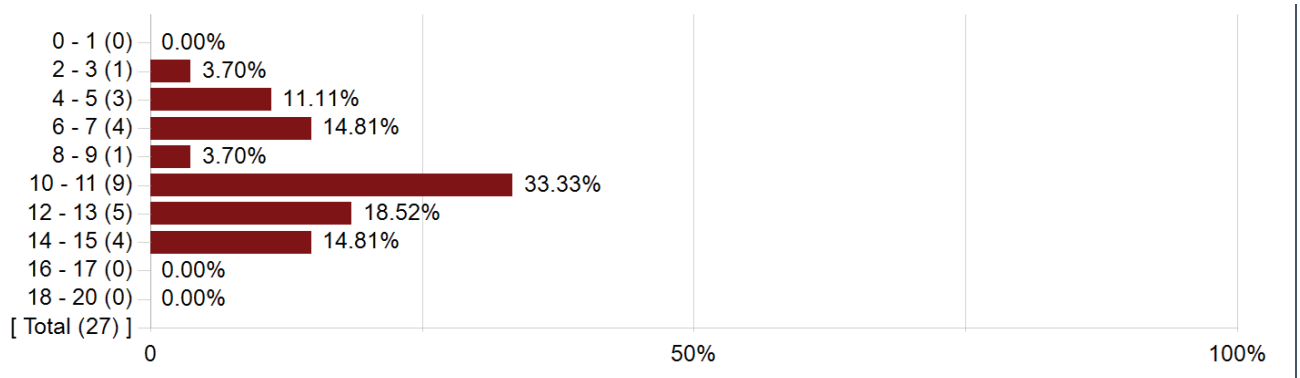
Statistics	Value
Response Count	27
Mean	3.41
Standard Deviation	1.22

How many hours per week did you spend in other scheduled activities for this course (labs, discussions, etc.)?



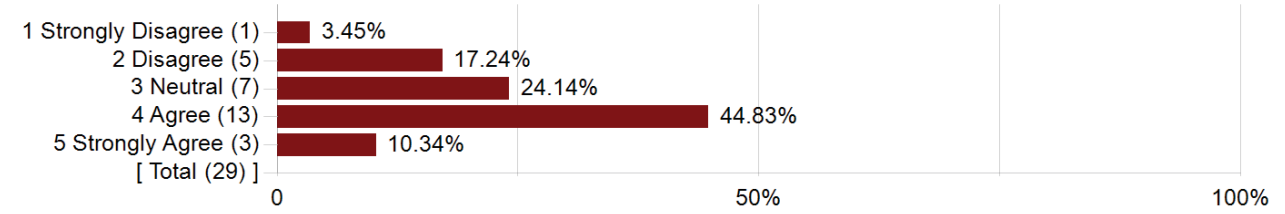
Statistics	Value
Response Count	23
Mean	1.35
Standard Deviation	0.71

How many additional hours per week did you spend on this course (reading, problem sets, writing, etc.)?



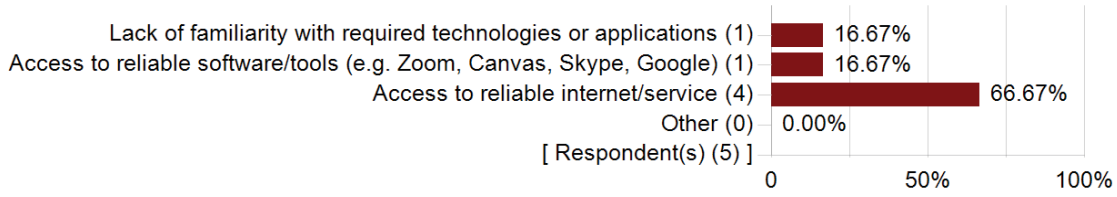
Statistics	Value
Response Count	27
Mean	9.59
Standard Deviation	3.54

The overall workload of the course was appropriate.

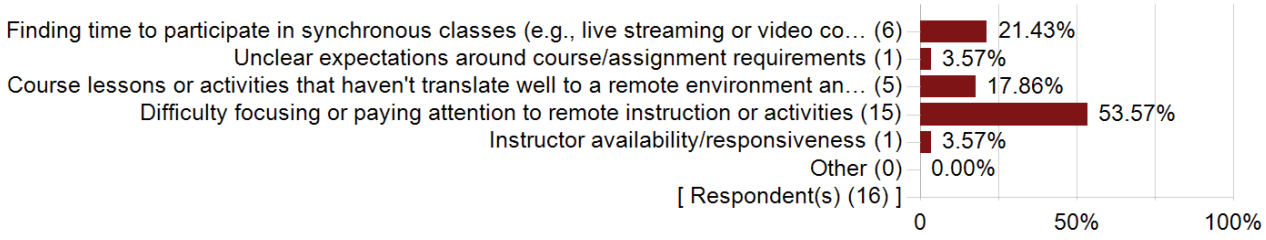


Statistics	Value
Response Count	29
Mean	3.41
Standard Deviation	1.02

Which of the following technological issues continue to be a challenge for you? (check all that apply)



Which of the following learning/educational issues continue to be a challenge for you? (check all that apply)



TA/CA/Intern Questions

Please include the name of the TA/CA/Intern you are evaluating.

Comments
Han Bin Kim
HanBin Kim
Han Bin Kim
Catalina
Han Bin Kim
Catalina
Kim
Catalina and Kim
Kim
Han Bin Kim
Catalina
Kim
HanBin Kim

What aspects of the TA's teaching contributed most to your learning?

Comments
Answering homework questions during the discussion sections.
Helpful office hours
None..
HER NOTES!!!! Those were works of art! I love that she worked out examples!
none
When she led discussions
detailed explaination of example questions
They were both great! Catalina often came to discussion with prepared things for the group to go over, which were then uploaded on canvas which I really appreciated.
discussion section
Catalina had excellent hand written notes that were really good at demystifying concepts and explaining them and the math in an easy way
Nothing
Helped us understand class concepts during lecture when we broke out into small discussion rooms, and helpful office hours.

What could the TA modify to help you learn more?

Comments
Give more direct answers when asked questions about HW
She could be better with actually teaching concepts/answering students' questions.
go over topics more pertinent to the hw or quiz material
Review specific homework questions in the psets to make it more relevant
nothing!
Allow student feedback. Ask students what they want to review.
No need at all
Maybe be a bit more explicit when answering homework related questions. I understand not wanting to just give us the answer. However, she would often not provide any aid whatsoever in terms of concepts when asked questions related to the homework, which did not make the discussion sections very helpful.
nothing

Additional feedback to the TA/CA/Intern:

Comments
Nothing comes to mind.
Getting a tablet would help make writing more legible
Catalina is an amazing person – she takes 10 min to explain something that would take me three hours to get on my own!
Thank you both!
Catalina was really nice and was also really helpful in Office hours. She also made sure to post her notes on Canvas right after discussion which was super helpful.
Discussion sections didn’t help at all

Assignments and Participation

	Mean	Median	N/A	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree	Total Responses
The assignments in the course were reasonable.	3.45	3.00	0.00%	3.45%	13.79%	34.48%	31.03%	17.24%	29
The assignments and classroom activities served the course objectives.	4.14	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	6.90%	0.00%	65.52%	27.59%	29
Instructor’s feedback/comments on your assignments were clear, specific, and helpful.	3.90	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	3.45%	24.14%	51.72%	20.69%	29
Assignments were returned to you in a timely manner.	4.18	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	3.57%	7.14%	57.14%	32.14%	28
The class met regularly, on time, and for the entire period.	4.46	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	53.57%	46.43%	28
If the class did not meet at the regularly scheduled time, were the changes and reasons behind them explained clearly.	4.24	4.00	39.29%	0.00%	0.00%	7.14%	32.14%	21.43%	28
You were prepared for classes and attended regularly.	4.37	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	7.41%	7.41%	25.93%	59.26%	27

THE UNIVERSITY OF CHICAGO

ECON 20000 6 - The Elements of Economic Analysis I - Instructor(s) Gina Pieters

Project Title: **College Course Evaluation - Autumn 2020**

Number Enrolled: **54**
Number of Responses: **32**

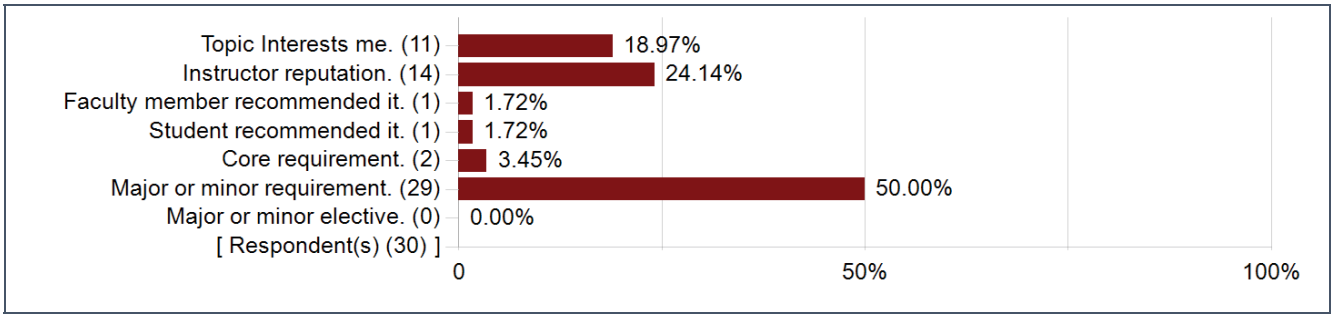
Report Comments

Opinions expressed in these evaluations are those of students enrolled in the specif course and do not represent the University.

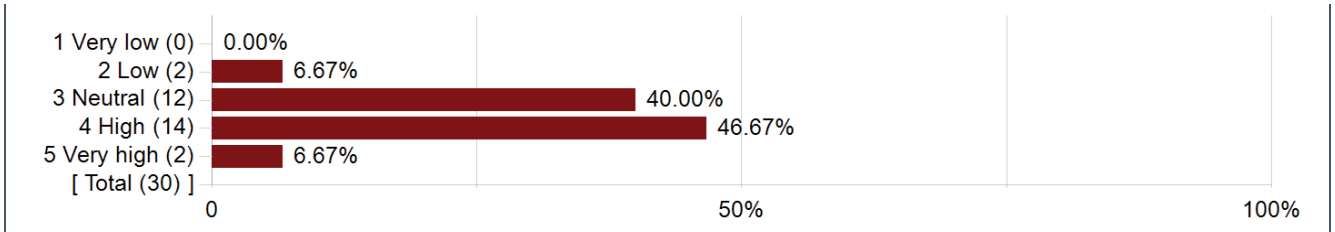
Creation Date: **Tuesday, February 16, 2021**

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Why did you choose to take this course? (Select all that apply)

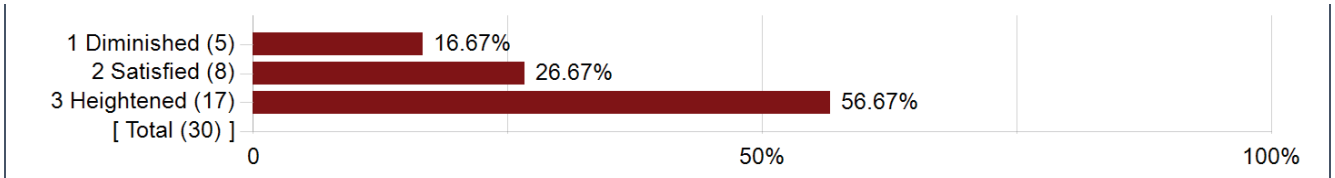


Prior to starting this class, your interest level was?



Statistics	Value
Response Count	30
Mean	3.53
Standard Deviation	0.73

Now that this class is over, your interest is?



Statistics	Value
Response Count	30
Mean	2.40
Standard Deviation	0.77

What are the most important things that you learned in this course? Please reflect on the knowledge and skills you gained.

Comments
Metric spaces, continuity, open/closed sets, convergence, and proofs/def/theorems for these topics
Consumer choices and preferences, and the way to create different microeconomic models.
Utility maximization, expenditure minimization, Lagrangians, preferences
Consumer price theory. To be honest, every topic in this course is utterly trivial for math majors and/or quantitatively sophisticated students. For those with mathematical maturity, take honors if you have a keen interest in economics; take regular if you just want to get by without spending much time.
The most important thing I learned was the effect of price changes on demand and consumerism.
The actual underlaying principles behind the models and formulas that where presented. This class was not just pure math (if that is what you have heard before) but instead we also talked a lot about what made/makes that math possible.
Marshallian & Hicksian, Lagrangians, and duality were probably the most important topics which were taught early in the course. Storage, shadow prices, risk, and perfect credit markets were cool to learn about since it could be applied to your life
Preferences, major themes of microeconomics but with more math involved
Consumer behavior
Partial equilibrium analysis
How consumers make choices
I learned about many of the aspects behind microeconomic shifts, along with methods to identify and interpret them. I also gained a good conceptual understanding of a wide variety of microeconomic topics.
Budget constraints, utility maximization problems, income and substitution effect, goods economies, decision making with uncertainty.
Finding optimal bundles/money spent given some constraints
Economic intuition
Hicksian and Marshallian demand, How to apply/solve lagrangian multiplier problems, substitution/income/endowment effect
Economic intuition
The techniques to break down an agent's consumption in various states.
How agents choose ideal bundles, and how different changes can affect that selection
Consumer choie
I learned how to relate Economic equations and intuition.
learning the tools for econ and how to apply them
Making implications about human behavior from mathematical expressions and graphical representations.
Utility maximization under constraint(s)

Describe how aspects of this course (lectures, discussions, labs, assignments, etc.) contributed to your learning.

Comments
I found the recorded lectures to be the most useful. Office hours as well. The handout seemed more in depth, than what was quizzed on/what seemed to be the main gists of the topics, although useful as well
The discussion sections with the TAs were very helpful.
Pre–recorded lectures were very thorough and helpful. We had 40 minutes of class time to go through QRE's in breakout groups, which helped me understand the material.
Did not attend any lectures, only learned through reading lecture notes
Asynchronous lectures were helpful. Homeworks were a helpful learning tool but very time–consuming.
The asynchronous lecturers where by far the biggest contributor but the synchronous lectures where helpful because we went over QRE's and also end–of–class questions.
Discussion sections were very helpful
Pre–recorded lectures were helpful in presenting the material, in class discussion sessions were used to answer questions about the topics and to go over the QREs assigned for each class
Pre–recorded lectures and powerpoints gave comprehensive explanation of topics. It was very helpful to have them available to print and use as notes. In–class groupwork in breakout rooms and then reviewing the answer with whole class very effective in showing how the material can be looked at from another perspective. The breakout room discussion with classmates always helped to look at the material from another perspective. The questions for the breakout rooms also helped prepare us for the quizzes. Discussion sessions and TA–provided notes were also helpful because they showed the material in another way and were an effective way to summarize the material from the passed two weeks.
Prerecorded lectures were very thorough; homework was time–consuming but very helpful for learning the material.
The pre–recorded lectures gave clear pictures of each topic and the synchronous lectures went over some examples to solidify the materials
Lectures (prerecorded) — were excellent Lectures (live, talking about the prerecorded lectures and then sending people into 4–person breakout rooms) — also excellent Homeworks — 1 per 2 weeks, very helpful Quizzes — 1 per 2 weeks, a lot of people agreed that they were unfair and unrelated to the homeworks; I thought they were a stretch in application but doable
Lectures were alright but didn't go in depth on much material. Assignments were where the bulk of the learning happened.
Lectures were very well–organized
The lectures were helpful in understanding the material and the homework and quizzes were helpful in using the material I learned and lecture and applying it.
2/3 of lecture time was prerecorded. The last third was live and I think the most beneficial because we were able to work with others in our class in breakout rooms to solve comprehension questions about the topic for that day. The prerecorded lectures were also helpful because they gave you time to absorb the material. The problem sets/assignments reinforced what we learned in class but sometimes were a lot harder than what we did during lectures.
The recorded lectures did a good job not only explaining specific concept we studied, but connecting a concepts to the other concepts we learned and to the real world. Class time was devoted to solving more conceptual problems collaboratively. These problems were good review for the semi weekly quizzes. The homework also asked about real–world applications of the material we might have not necessarily considered on our own, but required more computation (i.e. Lagrangians). The optional practice problems were the most computational aspect of the course and were also good practice.
Prerecorded lectures were where you learn most of it. Synchronous classes are pretty much useless unfortunately. As for questions you might have regarding the material, office hours was good (although often times felt kind of hurried, like Prof. Pieters wanted to answer your question and get you out as quick as possible) and the discussion board was ok too. Unfortunately, with online class it is harder to access the Professor in an extended manner. Practice problems fulfill their role as practice. HW was good too.
Lectures were quite helpful as were live classes
The lectures are well–organized and helpful. I had to rewatch them a few times typically because they were packed with content. The homework also helped with the math/problem–solving aspects of the course.
The lectures were helpful and very informative.

Comments
Class time is meant for clarifying lectures and getting some guidance for the quick response exercises, all info is contained in the lectures. Quizzes contain questions that won't have seen before, you have to think on your feet. Assignments are less conceptual and more doing the work itself.
Recorded lectures were very helpful because they could be revisited. It was hard to internalize all the material given that lectures were posted the evening before.

The Instructor(s) . . .

	Mean	Median	N/A	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree	Total Responses
Provided a syllabus that allowed you to plan your learning and study time effectively.	4.57	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	6.67%	30.00%	63.33%	30
Explained clearly the course objectives and expectations.	4.67	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	3.33%	0.00%	23.33%	73.33%	30
Stimulated your interest in the core ideas of the course.	4.27	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	13.33%	0.00%	33.33%	53.33%	30
Was available and helpful outside of class.	4.47	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	10.00%	33.33%	56.67%	30
Overall, the instructor made a significant contribution to your learning.	4.50	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	13.33%	23.33%	63.33%	30

What aspect of the instructor's teaching contributed most to your learning?

Comments
The lectures contributed the most. I found he explained the concepts and basic definitions very well in lectures.
She provided us with good summaries for topics.
The professor used live class time to go through QRE questions that helped reinforce the material we were learning
Lecture notes
Her pre–recorded lectures were well laid out and were the most helpful part of the course.
The very clear explanations about what we where covering in class. The material was all new to me (my high school offered no ECON classes but Professor Pieters had wonderful explanations.
Pieters was able to explain the concepts and understand where they are coming from and what they tell us.
Gina Pieters was extremely open to feedback and overall was an excellent lecturer
Course structure couldn't have been planned better. All aspects of the course were clear in the syllabus. Professor always responded to questions on class discussion boards on Canvas quickly and comprehensively.
Prerecorded lectures, class time, office hours
The pre–recorded lecture
Pieters designed the course very elegantly
Her explanations of things in class were helpful to understand topics which were unclear from the videos.
Clearly knew what she was talking about and had a lot of passion for teaching the material. Professor Pieters was always helpful in terms of clarifying any content.
Very organized
Lectures and homework.
During the live portion of the class as well as during office hours, Dr. Pieters was very very helpful and was always very kind. She explains concepts very well in these settings.
She was always available to answer questions. Her teaching style is also very organized.
Professor Pieters is an incredible teacher. When it comes to tying topics together and connecting them to real world applications, Professor Pieters in unmatched. She really did a fantastic job explaining how everything built off of each other. She also really does care about providing a good educational experience. She had us fill out a mid quarter evaluation and recorded an hour long video of her responding to each topic.
Prerecorded lectures were great. Responding to discussion board posts was good too. Office hours was good, but could be improved (more time for students genuinely interested in going beyond the exam material and getting a deeper understanding).
Her lectures/psets
Dr. Pieters was very good at re–explaining concepts during office hours and being responsive on Canvas discussion boards.
Office hours and her ability to answer questions that we had was great.
Office hours were the most helpful.

What could the instructor modify to help you learn more?

Comments
However, applying what I learned in lectures and office hours to the handouts was significantly harder. I would've liked some more guidance on some of the proofs there. As well as some more explanation on what he wanted with proofs. The grading (especially on quizzes) seemed a little harsh.
More examples
She could've spent more time on difficult topics rather than dedicate the same amount of time to each topic.
Eliminate Zoom breakout rooms and provide a more traditional lecture style as if we were in pre–covid times
The synchronous parts of the class were sometimes helpful but not always. We would discuss an assignment with other classmates but if no one got it right she would not reveal the correct answer. This made it so that at times you were unsure whether or not you understood a concept. Material on homework was not the best preparation for quizzes as the two included very different kinds of questions. Homework was quite time–consuming mostly because of a lot of algebra which did not demonstrate or improve knowledge of the underlying economic concept.
To be honest I think she has hit the nail on the head. After the mid–quarter change of having recorded videos with a mouse and later on also a video of her, the concepts made more sense and I could better underestand the material more. Personally I think remote learning has an advantage as I don't just hear something one time and immediately understand it. Professor Pieters videos made rewatching the videos very rewarding as the more you understood a concept the more you could piece together important bits she was talking about.
Give more examples on how to solve mathematical equations (Hicksian, CV & EV).
Professor Pieters was extremely organized and made expectations very clear throughout the class. However, I did not feel properly prepared for the quizzes, as the material they tested was often unrelated to the material in lectures and homework.
It would be better if there are more office hours time slots throughout the week
Nothing
The lectures didn't really translate well into the virtual environment... it felt like we were just being force–fed material and then expected to bring the concepts and calculations together on our own through the p–sets and studying for the quiz.
Nothing
Nothing. She was a great professor.
Nothing.
Nothing
This isn't something she should modify, just a note to future students reading this. The expectations of this course match the style/quality the course is taught at. That is, on the quizzes and homeworks corresponding to a certain set of lectures, you may be asked to questions about how the materials corresponds to previous material. There are probably easier Econ teachers. It isn't easy to reach this level of understanding, and I really struggled with the class at first. However, after time, if you put it the work, you can get it. The class is great, but at least for me, it did require significant effort to do well. The only thing I'd modify is adding a QRE style question to the practice problems, as the QREs were more similar to the quizzes than the practice problems. Also, I don't think that technical regrades should be limited to two.
Drop interesting economic implications here and there. Provide real life examples of what we're learning. More office hours for discussion about things beyond the exams.
Focus on non–math explanations. When you have a bunch of weird notation, it becomes easy to get lost quickly. Generally, did a good job explaining concepts but not always
Dr. Pieters was busy this quarter and couldn't hold too many additional office hours, but the ones she did hold were incredibly helpful. More office hours would be great!
The homeworks were sometimes just filled with unecessarily long questions where algebra was the majority of the assignment and that may have distracted from learning the econ concepts and applying them at points. Otherwise everything was great.
Add more weekly open door office hours.

Remote Course Questions

How effective were the different modes of remote teaching in this course?

	Mean	Median	N/A	Very Ineffective	Ineffective	Neutral	Effective	Very Effective	Total Responses
Synchronous Lectures	3.75	4.00	17.24%	3.45%	0.00%	27.59%	34.48%	17.24%	29
Asynchronous (prerecorded) Lectures	4.50	5.00	3.45%	0.00%	0.00%	10.34%	27.59%	58.62%	29
Large Discussions (everyone in the class)	3.27	3.00	26.67%	6.67%	10.00%	30.00%	10.00%	16.67%	30
Small Discussions (zoom breakout rooms)	3.59	4.00	10.00%	10.00%	3.33%	20.00%	36.67%	20.00%	30
Short Quizzes	4.35	4.00	20.69%	0.00%	3.45%	3.45%	34.48%	37.93%	29
Laboratories	3.50	3.50	93.10%	0.00%	0.00%	3.45%	3.45%	0.00%	29
Timed Exams	3.65	4.00	13.33%	3.33%	6.67%	20.00%	43.33%	13.33%	30
Written Work (take home exams, papers, problem sets, etc.)	4.43	4.50	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	7.14%	42.86%	50.00%	28
Scheduled Faculty Office Hours	4.27	4.00	24.14%	0.00%	0.00%	13.79%	27.59%	34.48%	29
Scheduled TA Office Hours	4.00	4.00	31.03%	0.00%	0.00%	24.14%	20.69%	24.14%	29

Please elaborate on the above.

Comments
The synchronous part of the class wasn't extremely helpful, however the discussion sections with the TAs were very helpful.
Only attended one or two synchronous lectures, but personally felt that Zoom breakout rooms are useless; did not watch prerecorded lectures because lecture notes are self–explanatory
Asynchronous lectures were the most helpful part of the course. The quizzes and homework were helpful for learning but were very different in presentation so homework was not adequate preparation for quizzes.
As I mentioned previously, I think Professor Pieters has hit online–teaching on the head. The only reason I put Ineffective on zoom breakout rooms is because I personally don't like these discussions. I much more prefer hearing the instructor teach but this is just a personal preference of mine and not to say other people can find it effective. The QRE's themselves (the topic of these discussions) where extremely helpful though.
Pieters did a mix of synchronous and asynchronous.
Professor's office hours were always helpful. In–class breakout rooms helpful because we were answering a question that looked at the material for that day more conceptually.
I did not think it was fair to have 60% of my performance determined by the quizzes. The material on the quizzes often felt unrelated to what was taught/assigned, and grading was often very harsh
Econ NEEDS to be in person.
The asynchronous videos were sometimes very bland and hard to pay attention to, especially when they were information packed slides without any visual input. The class periods helped to gain a better understanding of the topics discussed, but often the videos themselves explain things too quickly or in a confusing manner.
The breakout rooms were such a wonderful addition. Especially in an online setting it provided a great way to meet people in the class and learn about the material with other people rather than just by yourself.
Good that synchronous class is optional because it's kinda useless. It was mainly prerecorded lectures, QREs, practice problems, and then homeworks that were how you learn and apply.
.
I found Dr. Pieters office hours the most helpful, as she would typically offer additional examples and describe things in a very intuitive way. The timed quizzes were sometimes stressful, but the format of the class allows you to drop your lowest score. This policy reduced a lot of stress, as I could make some mistakes during the quarter. The QREs and homeworks also allowed me to practice and boost my grade. The homework was often pretty challenging. We were told not to spend more than 20 hours on this course, but I probably spent more time than that— and that's fine by me.
The homework was more math oriented and since quizes were more conceptual oriented, I think some assignment problems with alot of math were distracting from learning the econ concepts.

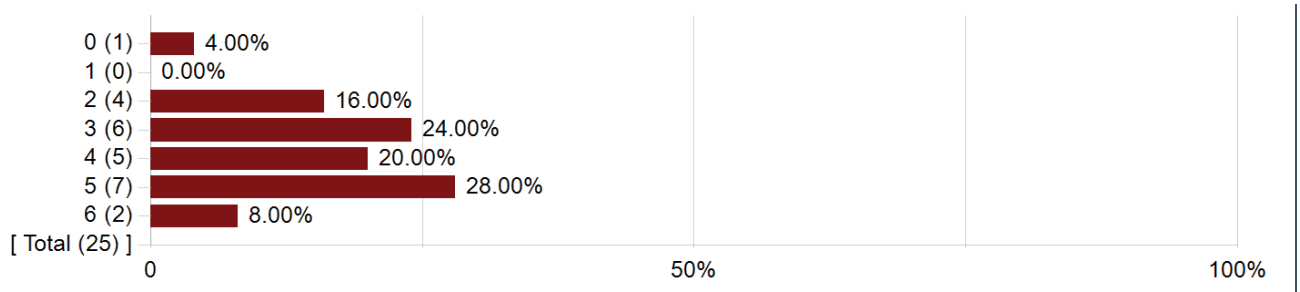
Did the instructor make adjustments to the course mid-quarter? If so, please comment on the effectiveness of those adjustments.

Comments
No, but the quizzes got easier after a big portion of the class did not do well on a quiz (I do not know if this was done intentionally or coincidentally).
The instructor changed the style of the homework mid–quarter to the style of the quizzes, which didn't really help since the quizzes were less helpful than the homework assignments to begin with.
Prof. Pieters sent out a fairly detailed mid–qaurter survey and reflected on the responses meticulously in both written and verbal forms
Small adjustments were made mostly to TA office hours. This did not greatly affect the class.
Yes! She took the mid–quarter evaluation very seriously (even made a video to address the evaluations) and changed how the class was handled. Three changes stood out that where very effective: usage of mouse on recorded videos (she could point at material she was talking about), video of her inside those recorded videos, and also made homework closer to what quizzes where like (more theory/thought heavy than just number crunching).
Yes, she included her mouse in pre–recorded videos which made it easier to follow along.
Yes
Yes. Professor sent out a poll to everyone and based on responses, adjusted course. More open–door office hours helpful because scheduling an appointment can be intimidating.
Changed the assignments to be more conceptual, good to develop intuition
The instructor adjusted to hold office hours before each synchronous lecture after mid–quarter, which was very helpful.
Adjustments were made to the recorded lecture videos mid–quarter, which helped to make them more attention holding.
Yes, Prof. Pieters started posting the pre–recorded lectures sooner before class time halfway through the semester after this was a suggestion on a mid–quarter survey she sent us
Yes. The adjustments were effective.
Yes, she changed the problem sets to be more conceptual and more like the quizzes. I thought that was helpful because it made whatever was on the quiz easier to anticipate, but it also made the homework require a lot more effort than previous weeks.
Yes. Effective.
Dr. Pieters collected feedback from students and made some adjustments, but couldn't add extra office hours or post the lectures earlier, which was understandable given her workload.
Listened to feedback on lecture clarity and made adjustments.

Please describe any element of this course, including specific actions by the instructor, that improved your remote learning experience.

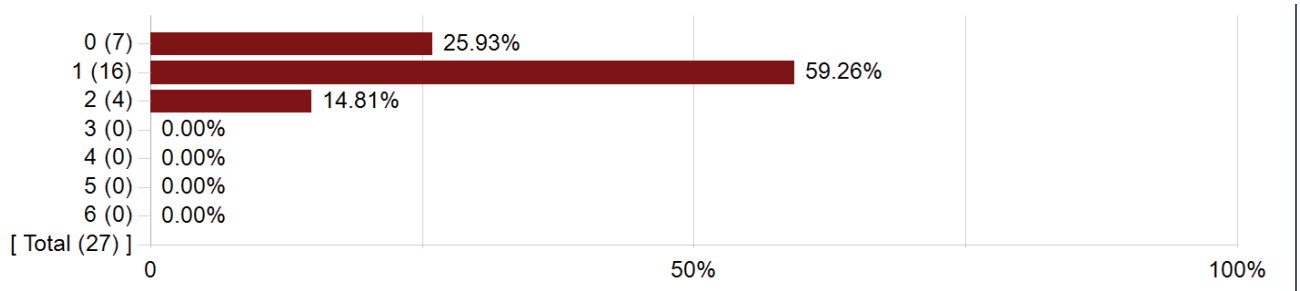
Comments
The quizzes were at a set time, and if you weren't in a timezone similar to Chicago time then you were at a severe disadvantage, which didn't help in the remote setting.
The grading scheme is simply perfect; the rotation of biweekly homeworks and biweekly quizzes creates a balance between pressure and pace throughout the duration of the entire quarter
The asynchronous lectures were helpful and they included a bookmarked PowerPoint layout with labeled timestamps to go back to places you had trouble.
To be brief, as I have already elaborated on this before, the pre–recorded lectures where amazing.
I like that the asynchronous videos were separated and had time stamps on them. It was easier to listen to the videos than listen in class (not her fault, just a zoom problem) so it was very helpful that all of the material was taught in the videos and not in zoom.
Very available for office hours
The instructor tried to accommodate people from different time zones, which helped me a lot
I liked the small breakout rooms
She was very helpful in class and office hours and I liked that we were in small breakout rooms in class so we could get to know other students in the class.
The breakout rooms! And the alternating quizzes and homework weeks were really nice.
Pre–recorded lectures improved the remote learning experience as we could go back and watch them as many times as we want.
The prerecorded lectures are good.
She structured it well
Dr. Pieters genuinely tried to offer us more office hours during finals week/create a course that was engaging remotely.

How many hours per week did you spend in lectures for this course (synchronous or asynchronous)?



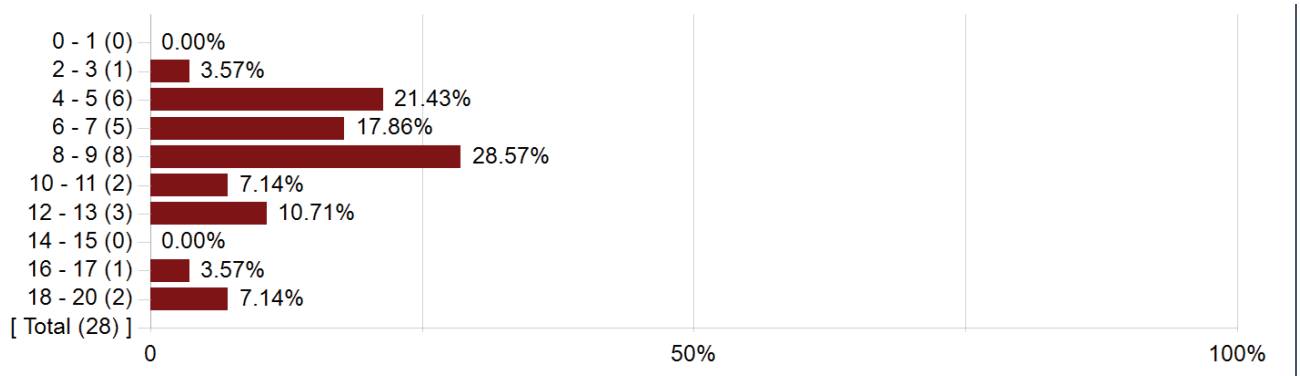
Statistics	Value
Response Count	25
Mean	3.72
Standard Deviation	1.46

How many hours per week did you spend in other scheduled activities for this course (labs, discussions, etc.)?



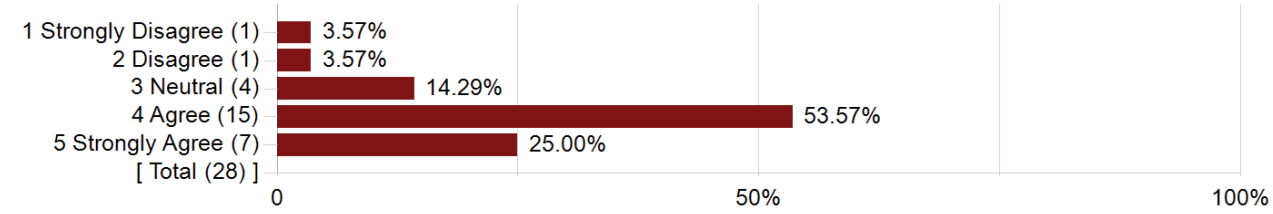
Statistics	Value
Response Count	27
Mean	0.89
Standard Deviation	0.64

How many additional hours per week did you spend on this course (reading, problem sets, writing, etc.)?



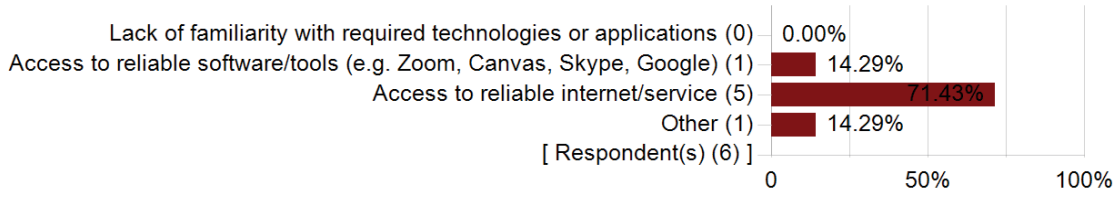
Statistics	Value
Response Count	28
Mean	8.50
Standard Deviation	4.17

The overall workload of the course was appropriate.

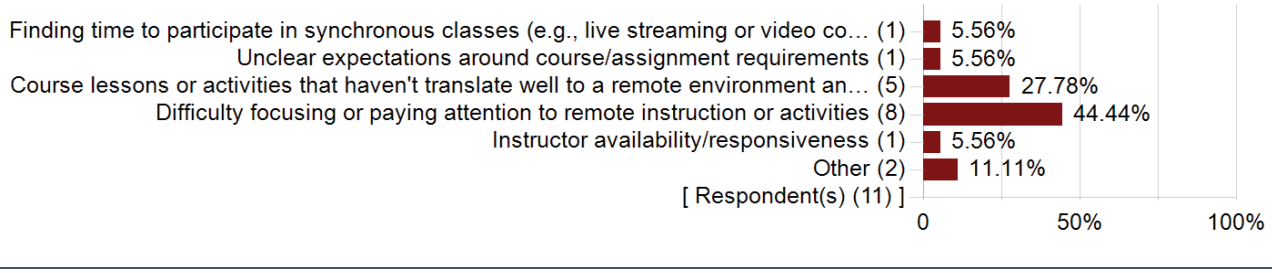


Statistics	Value
Response Count	28
Mean	3.93
Standard Deviation	0.94

Which of the following technological issues continue to be a challenge for you? (check all that apply)



Which of the following learning/educational issues continue to be a challenge for you? (check all that apply)



TA/CA/Intern Questions

Please include the name of the TA/CA/Intern you are evaluating.

Comments
Catalina
Catalina
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Catalina Mican
Caterina Mican
Catalina
Catalina Mican
Catalina
Hanbin Kim
Catalina Mican
Catalina Mican
Catalina Mican Rivera
Catalina
Catalina Mican

What aspects of the TA's teaching contributed most to your learning?

Comments
She explained difficult topics very well during the discussion questions.
Discussion section and notes
Her office hours
Her notes being uploaded to canvas was helpful in making sure I had understood the material (I could compare what I was thinking with the notes and see how I stood).
She included diagrams on the confusing topics and explained it more clearly for the students to grasp. She knew that these topics were hard and comforted me if I didn't understand. Catalina was so helpful and an amazing TA.
Her discussion sections were really helpful in explaining more foundational topics that we didn't have time to go over during lecture
Discussion notes summarising the material from previous two weeks.
Discussion Sections
The discussion session with the TA every week was helpful
Going over specific examples of how to do Lagrangians the first week — it was on the homework and there was no example of the algebra anywhere in the lecture. Lives were saved.
Catalina's discussion notes were absolutely beautiful and helped to clarify topics that the class was confused about.
The notes were great! Really helpful and well organized, and a great source of study material. Office hours were also really great in clarifying material and helping with problem sets.
I didn't really go ever
Her discussion session notes were really helpful. It was easy to see what parts of lecture were important for the homework.
Her notes were very nice.
Explanations
Her grading I guess
She was quite organized and was quite clear in her explanations
Catalina was very well prepared for office hours sessions—she always looked over the lectures and prepared a "how to" guide on a specific concept.
Her discussion sections and office hours were great! She was able to provide a different perspectice on the material that made it easier to understand and answered our questions really well.

What could the TA modify to help you learn more?

Comments
She chose what she would talk about in her discussion section instead of having it be led by student questions.
Nothing.
Not much, very helpful
Nothing, I think Catalina did a great job as a TA and discussion sections served to supplement the material.
Plan time in discussion sessions better to get through material quicker. Include more abstract aspects of content.
Nothing! Catalina is a queen!!
Catalina could prepare a few more examples to help make concepts intuitive, but other than that she was very helpful!
Nothing really. Very helpful. Great TA
Not much.

Additional feedback to the TA/CA/Intern:

Comments
Nothing.
Her notes were well laid out and comprehensible but having her discussion section be led by student questions would have been more helpful.
This is for the other TA, Kim, she went very fast and kinda came off as condescending in her discussions. I only went to one of her discussions and did not find it helpful at all.
I really liked your notes!
I asked Catalina questions a few times and I trust that she knows more about economics than me, but often times it felt like she was only capable of the most basic level explanation. If the question was deeper at all (or sometimes even just a variation of the basic concepts), Catalina didn't really know.
Thanks for all your notes and discussion sections. Very helpful

Assignments and Participation

	Mean	Median	N/A	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree	Total Responses
The assignments in the course were reasonable.	3.93	4.00	3.57%	0.00%	10.71%	10.71%	50.00%	25.00%	28
The assignments and classroom activities served the course objectives.	4.27	4.00	3.70%	0.00%	0.00%	11.11%	48.15%	37.04%	27
Instructor’s feedback/comments on your assignments were clear, specific, and helpful.	3.85	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	11.11%	29.63%	22.22%	37.04%	27
Assignments were returned to you in a timely manner.	4.23	4.00	3.70%	0.00%	0.00%	18.52%	37.04%	40.74%	27
The class met regularly, on time, and for the entire period.	4.74	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	25.93%	74.07%	27
If the class did not meet at the regularly scheduled time, were the changes and reasons behind them explained clearly.	4.65	5.00	37.04%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	22.22%	40.74%	27
You were prepared for classes and attended regularly.	4.37	5.00	0.00%	7.41%	0.00%	3.70%	25.93%	62.96%	27

ECON 20100 5 - The Elements of Economic Analysis II - Instructor(s) Gina Pieters

Project Title: **College Course Evaluation - Winter 2021**

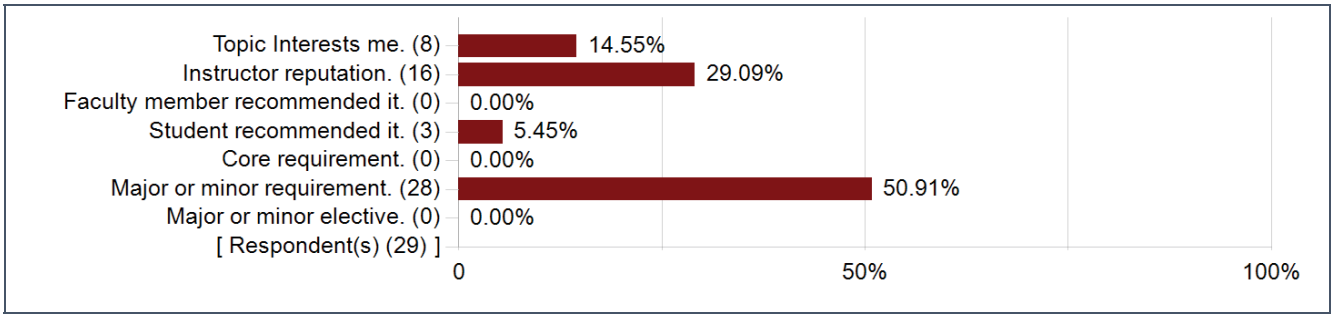
Number Enrolled: **51**
Number of Responses: **29**

Report Comments

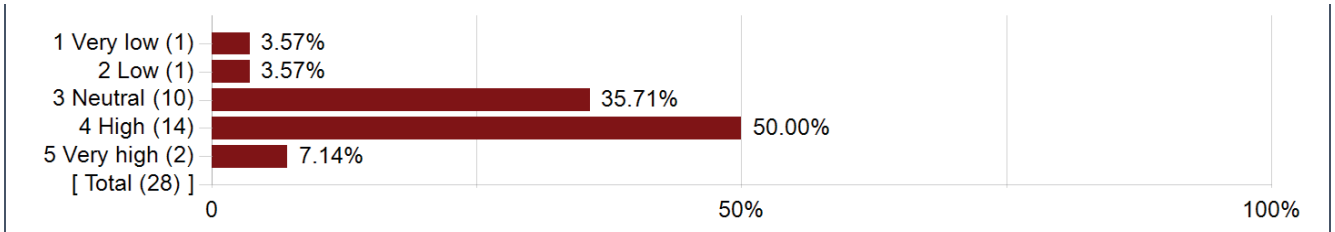
Opinions expressed in these evaluations are those of students enrolled in the specif course and do not represent the University.

Creation Date: **Saturday, July 3, 2021**

Why did you choose to take this course? (Select all that apply)

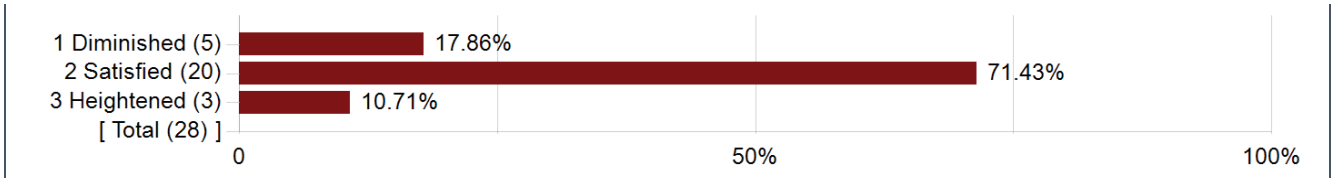


Prior to starting this class, your interest level was?



Statistics	Value
Response Count	28
Mean	3.54
Standard Deviation	0.84

Now that this class is over, your interest is?



Statistics	Value
Response Count	28
Mean	1.93
Standard Deviation	0.54

What are the most important things that you learned in this course? Please reflect on the knowledge and skills you gained.

Comments
Business cycle and firm theory.
Setting up consumer and firm problems, Lagrangians
n/a
Firm's problem and as an extension of ECON 200, the interaction between the consumer and firm (as seen in general equilibriums). The most interesting aspect of all this is the fact that the technique to solving these equilibria are the same, but there are so many ways to set up the problems to reflect the question at hand. The versatility of the technique in solving real–life problems is quite an eye–opener!
I learned more about real life economic situations as well as how to solve them in equation form
how to build and solve econ models and some real world applications
Intermediate microeconomics – continuation of tools developed in Econ 200
economic principles and how they apply in a larger context
Production and cost functions, game theory, monopolies SPP, public goods
Monopoly, competitive market, etc.
That game theory interactive class was fun
Pretty much a review of first quarter econ sequence, with some game theory towards the end.
That the econ department at UChicago is just applying langrangians in different contexts
More elements of economic analysis, including partial and generally equilibria as well as various market shocks.
Fermat's little theorem, graph theory, set theory, etc.
Applying many different economic concepts that was mentioned in earlier economic courses and learning the math behind them.
A consolidated knowledge of constructing mathematical models on qualitative questions.
profit maximization, firm–focused problems in the long run and short run, social planners problem, cost curves, game theory,
Understanding how the firm makes profit–maximizing decisions and how these decisions change in different economic settings.

Describe how aspects of this course (lectures, discussions, labs, assignments, etc.) contributed to your learning.

Comments
Assignments help you grasp the concepts and do practice problems.
Lectures, posted slides, practice problems, and assignments all contributed to my learning
Prerecorded lectures and practice problems were most helpful
I love the mix of pre–recorded lectures (that takes half of regular class time) and the synchronous classes. They compliment each other so well!
The pre–recorded lectures were very helpful. I found the QRE's helped you understand what was the important core ideas from each topic.
pre–recorded lectures are very helpful.
prerecorded lectures were incredibly helpful, and I really appreciated how promptly professor Pieters was able to upload work
The highly organized and structured topics
Pre–Lecture videos were incredibly helpful. Homeworks were a really good way to apply what we learned.
Prerecorded lectures are the most helpful
Lecture videos were nice and clear, and sometimes the discussion sections were helpful, if we had enough time to get our questions answered.
The pre–recorded lectures and office hours were the most helpful in doing homework and quizzes
Lectures are great
Asynchronous Lectures were very efficient and easy to follow. Assignments helped reinforce applying the concepts.
The prerecorded lectures are very helpful to learn the content of the class, the live class is also great to clarify questions or confusions in the prerecorded lectures. The TA discussions also work really well to clarify confusions.
Recorded lectures were the most beneficial for my learning, as well as working through the problem sets
Dr. Pieters recorded asynchronous content and had synchronous lectures twice a week. The entire course was extremely well–designed. We had two Quick Response Exercises a week (17 in the quarter, only needed to complete 10), bi–weekly quizzes, and bi–weekly problem sets. The class was paced very well, couldn't ask much else from a remote experience.

The Instructor(s) . . .

	Mean	Median	N/A	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree	Total Responses
Provided a syllabus that allowed you to plan your learning and study time effectively.	4.73	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	3.85%	19.23%	76.92%	26
Explained clearly the course objectives and expectations.	4.81	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	18.52%	81.48%	27
Stimulated your interest in the core ideas of the course.	4.50	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	11.54%	26.92%	61.54%	26
Was available and helpful outside of class.	4.88	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	11.54%	88.46%	26
Overall, the instructor made a significant contribution to your learning.	4.56	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	11.11%	22.22%	66.67%	27

What aspect of the instructor's teaching contributed most to your learning?

Comments
I felt like I didn't learn much from this class. There was a lot of content covered quickly and professor did good job.
Clear organization of the course and open to helping always.
Her lectures, the practice problems, and the problem sets were the most helpful.
She was very clear in her pre recorded lectures and explained topics well.
The explanation of concepts was done in great depth, yet there are always real–life examples and intuition to solidify our understanding!
Pieters had a good amount of office hours and was very helpful in these office hours. In addition, her lectures were very clear and very easy to learn from.
everything
Overall, Prof Pieters is a great instructor. She very much knows what she is doing and has a unique ability to meet students wherever they are. I really appreciated how much time she put into the course – between creating assignments/quizzes, holding classes/office hours, responding to so many discussions/bug bounties, and responding to emails as well. It did not go unnoticed, especially when she said that this was the first time she used slides in class– we really appreciate it! I really liked the way she did office hours, where she creates a list based on when people entered and goes through that list – it is very fair!
Professor Pieters is a great instructor and would explain both math and concepts really well.
Professor Pieters was one of the best instructors I had at UChicago! She explains really well and always links the material we learned at class to real–world situations, which made it very engaging for me (coming from no economics background in high school). Professor Pieters genuinely cares about her students and really listens to what we have to say. I hope I get to take her classes again in the future!
Lecture videos were great! office hours were helpful
Pieters is a very good lecturer. Her class is very organized and her expectations are clear.
Prerecorded Lectures
I really liked how clear the recorded lectures were, and the provided practice problems with solutions always pointed me in the right direction if I felt lost on the homework.
Dr. Pieters is very good about listening to feedback and making adjustments which helps if something is off about the course.
The pre–recorded lectures and office hours were the most helpful. Problem sets and homework were also important in reviewing materials
Office hours and recorded lectures
She was very good at asking questions and working with the students.
The office hours and the slides of the class content.
Professor Pieters is a great professor. She is very organized with the course material and she also is good about taking feedback from students. The aspect that helped me learn most was through the recorded lectures and asking questions in office hours. I also liked how we talked about some modern day applications of concepts we were learning about in news articles
Dr. Pieters is a fantastic lecturer. She really explains things clearly and provides relevant examples. Her lectures are very organized and edited for clarity. Really great learning experience!

What could the instructor modify to help you learn more?

Comments
I really like Pieters however I am burned out of covid and I felt like her class was a lot of work and we covered too much too fast. I would advise maybe slow it down online as many students have little motivation until things go back to in person.
There were quite a few errors in lecture slides and practice problems, which made it difficult to study and understand sometimes.
I believe the problems arise from the structure of the course rather than Professor Pieters' teaching
None!
Perhaps when introducing new equations/formulas you could color–code or say in the lecture how important the equation is/how often we'll be using it. Sometimes, I can't distinguish what is just a one off equation that we might use once and what we'll be using all the time
NA, she's great
Listen to student feedback– a lot of people took time to fill out the mid quarter evaluation, and though she made a video going over them, it almost felt like she was shaming us for being honest and told us to deal with it. I understand that this was not her intention but it came across as one big defense. I also did not appreciate how the feedback form closed even though she said it would be kept open.
providing more support for students who were struggling. The structure of office hours made it a somewhat intimidating environment, and it was often hard to learn what you could do to improve your performance on future assignments. She is a very blunt person and while her honesty was sometimes helpful, her responses to feedback could be kind of demoralizing.
The only thing I can think about is her grading system. It makes it very difficult to get an A. But because of this, I feel that I put in a lot more effort in this class than I have in any other class at UChicago and that really helped me learn a lot (even if I didn't get an A).
Create more transparency around the quiz questions: tell us how many questions there will be, and what type of questions we should expect (math, graphs, conceptual, etc.). For the first three quizzes, I had no idea whether Pieters was going to ask a graph–related question, math, etc. and so it was difficult for me to decide how I was going to divide my time studying for each of the concepts. I thank Pieters for doing this for the last three quizzes, but this would have saved a tremendous amount of time studying if this was a policy from day 1.
I feel like it would be helpful to have examples in the videos that worked with numbers rather than just variables to better understand the processes.
The grading has to change! I was with Dr. Pieters for two quarters but I don't know why exams were weighted a lot higher this quarter than the last. Homeworks counts only 10% towards the final grade and tbh I don't have the incentive to do them.
Upload the lectures earlier. I often found myself staying up until 1 a.m. waiting for the next morning's recorded lectures to be uploaded. I often think there wasn't enough time to both finish watching the lectures and get a decent amount of sleep before the in–person class, leading to me being sleep deprived during the day. I understand that Pieters was very busy this quarter. Maybe as a compromise, students could be sent emails when the lectures are finished uploading so that they can start as soon as the lectures are uploaded (rather than having to repeatedly check back).
The lecture videos seemed to get progressively more dense and faster towards the end of the quarter. I found myself needing to pause and rewind a lot more. It would be nice if content was distributed a little more evenly so it doesn't feel like we're rushing through material at the end. Also, I really didn't feel comfortable answering the last question about human slavery on our final. It just felt strange to refer to the slaves as "resources" that could be allocated... I would ask if such questions could not be included in future assessments for the course.
More correlation between the psets and quizzes/assessments
Nothing that I can think of. The class was challenging but also fair expectations.
n/a
Instead of giving an overwhelming amount of practice problems to prepare for the quiz, maybe cut it down so that we are able to focus on more important concepts before the quizzes. Also, I think it would be helpful to show math in the lectures or pre–recorded lectures by writing it out physically instead of just having text show up. I think it would make the problem–solving process a lot clearer.
N/A

Remote Course Questions

How effective were the different modes of remote teaching in this course?

	Mean	Median	N/A	Very Ineffective	Ineffective	Neutral	Effective	Very Effective	Total Responses
Synchronous Lectures	3.83	4.00	7.69%	0.00%	3.85%	26.92%	42.31%	19.23%	26
Asynchronous (prerecorded) Lectures	4.67	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	3.70%	25.93%	70.37%	27
Large Discussions (everyone in the class)	4.00	4.00	32.00%	0.00%	0.00%	20.00%	28.00%	20.00%	25
Small Discussions (zoom breakout rooms)	4.00	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	4.00%	24.00%	40.00%	32.00%	25
Short Quizzes	3.45	4.00	25.93%	11.11%	7.41%	11.11%	25.93%	18.52%	27
Laboratories	5.00	5.00	95.83%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	4.17%	24
Timed Exams	3.81	4.00	36.00%	0.00%	4.00%	20.00%	24.00%	16.00%	25
Written Work (take home exams, papers, problem sets, etc.)	4.30	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	11.11%	48.15%	40.74%	27
Scheduled Faculty Office Hours	4.48	5.00	16.00%	0.00%	0.00%	4.00%	36.00%	44.00%	25
Scheduled TA Office Hours	4.18	4.00	26.09%	0.00%	4.35%	8.70%	30.43%	30.43%	23

Please elaborate on the above.

Comments
Class is couple of bi weekly quizzes and psets. I felt like she could've weighted psets more. Also I did not like the bugs bounties because it unfairly gave advantage to students who work ahead and I felt she could've done extra credit for all.
The quizzes were incredibly hard, and once again, about 15 questions in total counted for 80% of our grade.
I really don't like the timed quizzes. It is very stressful. I really prefer longer midterm/finals.
The synchronous lectures were great, but not as great as the asynchronous lectures which were masterfully written. I loved during synchronous lectures when she would bring in articles from the real world. Discussions were great, but not as good as they were last quarter. The short quizzes were horrendously ineffective, the averages are insanely high (unfairly so). Homeworks were okay, though I honestly don't prefer working together. I liked homework last quarter better, as I feel less motivated to learn the material. This just in turn made the quizzes worth more, which was not good at all. I know this is standard for most Econ courses, but the exams for other courses are curved. Office hours were great. I REALLY enjoyed the game theory activity– that should be implemented in every class where game theory is taught.
the format of quizzes was incredibly stressful, and the fact that they were worth 80% of your grade seemed excessive. Because there were so few cumulative points on each quiz, an absentminded error (which she made clear were still legitimate errors) could tank your grade. I would study hard for quizzes and understand concepts well, and I felt like it very rarely, if ever, paid off.
The asynchronous lectures sometimes repeat what included in the synchronous lectures. Also, I dislike the short quiz format, which in my perspective does not reflect student's true understanding level of the material.
It's as if Professor Pieters constructed questions to intentionally have us make mistakes and lose points, rather than to actually test our knowledge on the material. The quizzes were never really related to content from the homework, or they would involve such long computational problems that there would be no way for a student to successfully complete the entire quiz without working with others.
The overall organization of the course was reasonable. Lectures and homework followed by quizzes every week. The expectation from the professor was clear.
Having small breakout rooms for QREs was nice because I was able to talk to people in the class and actually form a study group
This course was very complete – there were faculty office hours, TA office hours, discussion sections, etc. There were ample resources to have any question answered in a timely manner.

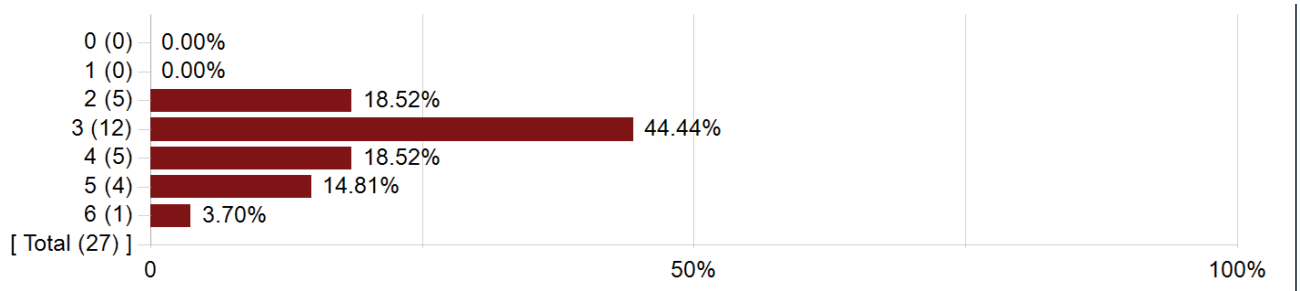
Did the instructor make adjustments to the course mid-quarter? If so, please comment on the effectiveness of those adjustments.

Comments
N/A
Yes. Adjusted office hours times.
She didn't make adjustments until 8th week, at which point it was too late. A lot of the time, I felt as though Professor Pieters harped about how she really reads and listens to our comments, but when she went over them, I felt as though she just made excuses for herself or her students' problems
Yes, I like how she really took into consideration what the students wanted. Many students thought the quizzes were too short, so she added more questions.
No– and frustratingly so. There was plenty of valid feedback on the evaluations, but little was taken into consideration. From what I can recall, there were two changes made: the 3/4 questions on quizzes (thanks for letting us vote!) and the new cheating policy. Honestly, I felt like the cheating policy was meant to just teach us the prisoners dilemma? It felt very unfair to students who had not cheated.
She changed the quizzes from having 3 questions to 4, which was definitely helpful.
Yes. I hoped that
n/a
Changing the quiz format from 3 to 4 questions was especially important to me.
Making 3 quiz questions into 4 quiz questions. I didn't really mind the change.
Yes, we changed the number of questions on the quizzes but this change was only helpful for the people who voted for that

Please describe any element of this course, including specific actions by the instructor, that improved your remote learning experience.

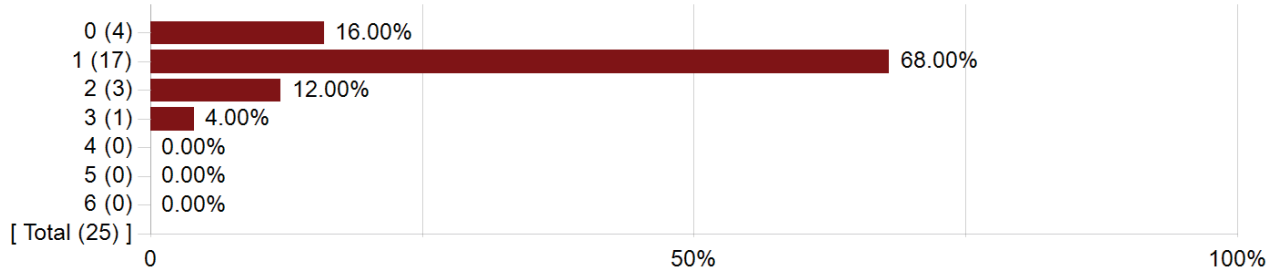
Comments
Pieters is a nice person but I did not like the strangely formulated quizzes she gave out. She has a unique style which I think is probably fun and definitely pushes you to understand but again being burned out of covid sucks any motivation to really learn this quarter.
She seems to really care about her students which is always nice
I would have appreciated it if expectations regarding cameras on/off were clarified at the beginning of the quarter. I know this seems trivial, but it is important to students who are going through Zoom fatigue.
Professor Pieters would upload tons of good review material quickly
Breakout rooms were great!
n/a
It was helpful having the additional few more hours to submit homework due to time differences.
recorded lectures, posted notes, and practice exams are really hepful.
I really appreciated the office hours, it was super helpful to clarify any concerns.
Dr. Pieters's grading scheme allowed us to drop one quiz and one Pset which was super helpful. It was fair and accommodated for different circumstances. Also really loved the bi–weekly quiz and Pset system.

How many hours per week did you spend in lectures for this course (synchronous or asynchronous)?



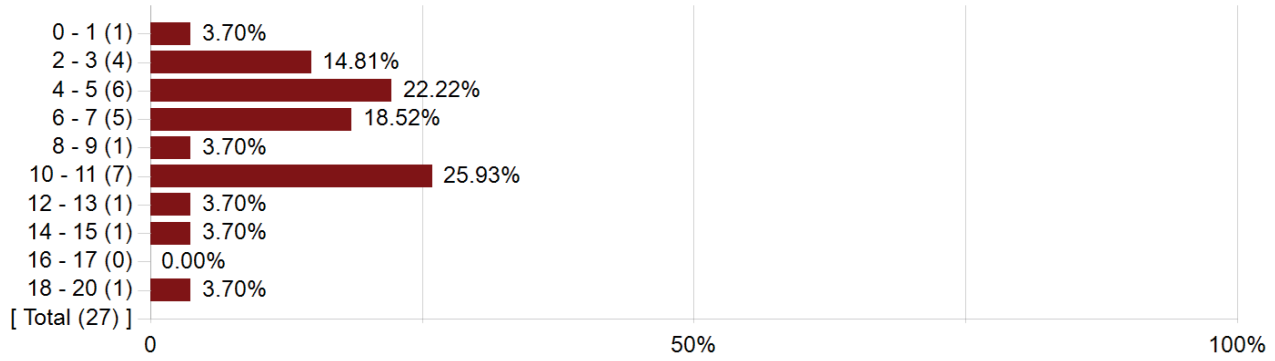
Statistics	Value
Response Count	27
Mean	3.41
Standard Deviation	1.08

How many hours per week did you spend in other scheduled activities for this course (labs, discussions, etc.)?



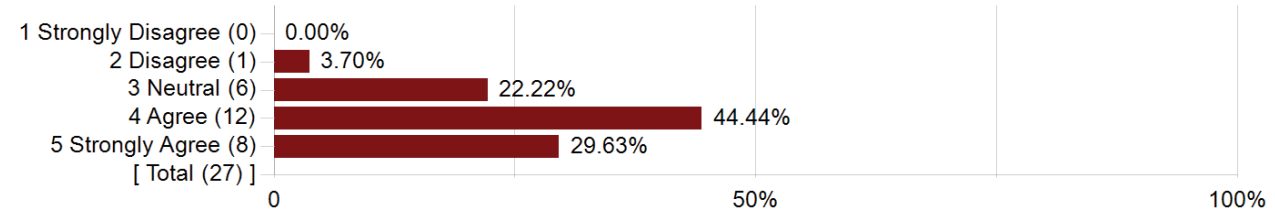
Statistics	Value
Response Count	25
Mean	1.04
Standard Deviation	0.68

How many additional hours per week did you spend on this course (reading, problem sets, writing, etc.)?



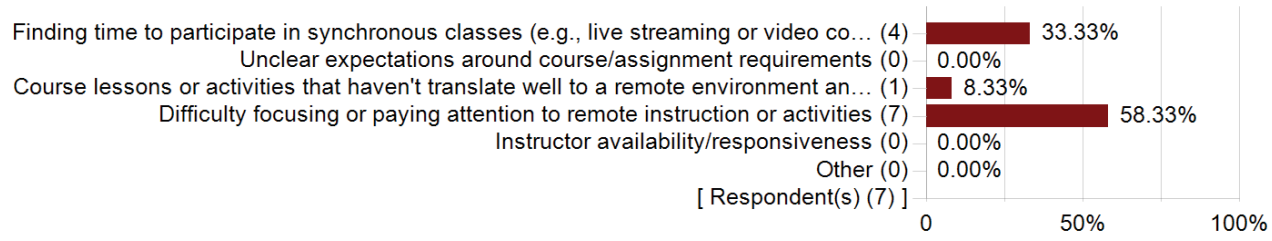
Statistics	Value
Response Count	27
Mean	7.33
Standard Deviation	4.24

The overall workload of the course was appropriate.



Statistics	Value
Response Count	27
Mean	4.00
Standard Deviation	0.83

Which of the following learning/educational issues continue to be a challenge for you? (check all that apply)



TA/CA/Intern Questions

Please include the name of the TA/CA/Intern you are evaluating. What aspects of the TA's teaching contributed most to your learning? What could the TA modify to help you learn more? Please include any additional feedback for the TA/CA/Intern.

Comments
Ha Bihn.
Han Bin Kim.
Elle Kim. She held discussion sessions, which were helpful but sometimes it seemed like she didn't feel like answering our questions
Elle I think. She was fine, much improved from last quarter.
Elle Kim. She was great in fortnightly discussion sections, helping to clarify the concepts that most people had questions with, as well as reviewing particular problem set and quiz questions that proved to be more challenging!
Han bin kim. really great TA!
Elle Kim
Elle. NA
HanBin (Elle) Kim was a good TA.
Hanbin (Elle) Kim. Elle was very helpful and responded to emails promptly. Although near the end of quarter, she became less responsive, it was understandable because she was the only TA for this class and she had her own exams to worry about.
Elle had great powerpoints and i liked her memes
Han Bin Kim. She is always available outside class and responds to emails timely. Her explanation is clear and the discussion sections held by her are really useful.
Kim is very responsible and good at explaining.
Elle HanBin Kim She's great, improved a lot since last quarter
TA: Elle. The slides were very helpful. Elle went through how to solve problems and was very available.
TA was Elle. She was helpful when she would be able to respond to our questions. Otherwise, material from discussion was not generally helpful to adding to our knowledge of the material. It just took time away from us being able to ask homework questions.
Elle Kim. She was very good about getting things back in time and elaborating on why she scored questions the way she did.
Elle's discussion section and office hour every week was very helpful. She was friendly and willing to solve problems.
Akshima hosted night office hours which was really helpful for students in different time zones.
HanBin Kim (Elle) The discussion session that Elle led was super helpful and she was very great and patient in explaining some concepts of of the class works.
Elle – she is really helpful during office hours and explains concepts well. I liked the discussion sessions this quarter because she had nice powerpoints and good examples. Also she always tried to make it fun with memes! She also was really responsive over email for hw help
Han Bin Kim. She was a great TA! Put lots of time and care into discussion sections and was always available for feedback.

Assignments and Participation

	Mean	Median	N/A	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree	Total Responses
The assignments in the course were reasonable.	4.04	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	3.70%	18.52%	48.15%	29.63%	27
The assignments and classroom activities served the course objectives.	4.28	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	8.00%	56.00%	36.00%	25
Instructor’s feedback/comments on your assignments were clear, specific, and helpful.	4.23	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	3.85%	7.69%	50.00%	38.46%	26
Assignments were returned to you in a timely manner.	4.58	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	3.85%	34.62%	61.54%	26
The class met regularly, on time, and for the entire period.	4.77	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	23.08%	76.92%	26
If the class did not meet at the regularly scheduled time, were the changes and reasons behind them explained clearly.	4.79	5.00	26.92%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	15.38%	57.69%	26
You were prepared for classes and attended regularly.	4.35	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	3.85%	3.85%	46.15%	46.15%	26

THE UNIVERSITY OF CHICAGO

ECON 10200 1 - Principles of Macroeconomics - Instructor(s) Gina Pieters

Project Title: **College Course Feedback - Spring 2021**

Number Enrolled: **133**
Number of Responses: **61**

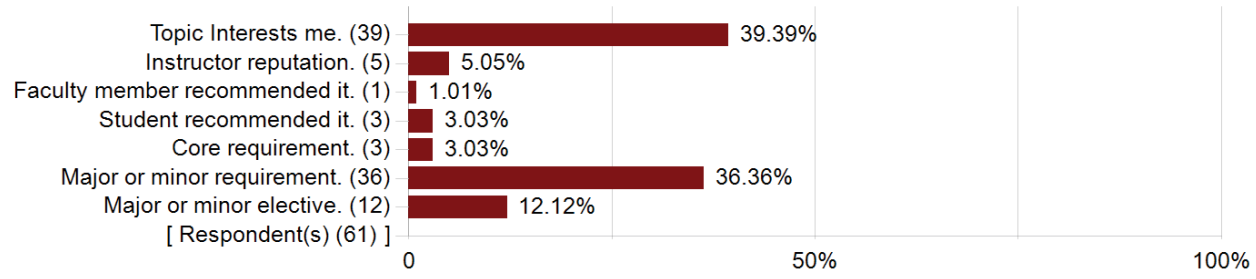
Report Comments

Opinions expressed in these evaluations are those of students enrolled in the specific course and do not represent the University.

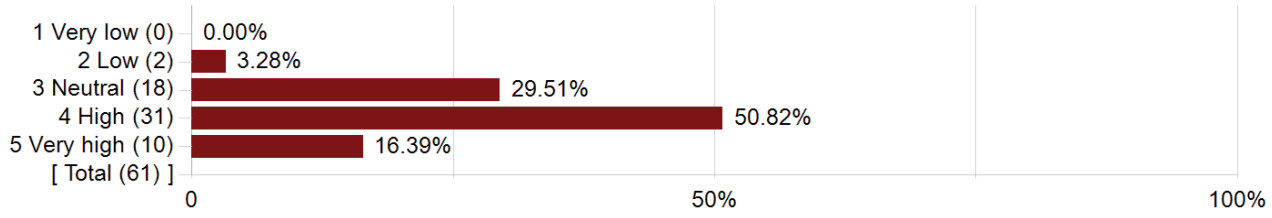
Creation Date: **Monday, June 28, 2021**

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Why did you choose to take this course? (Select all that apply)

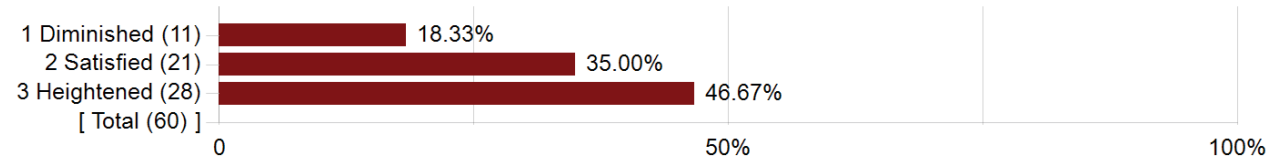


Prior to starting this class, your interest level was?



Statistics	Value
Response Count	61
Mean	3.80
Standard Deviation	0.75

Now that this class is over, your interest is?



Statistics	Value
Response Count	60
Mean	2.28
Standard Deviation	0.76

What are the most important things that you learned in this course? Please reflect on the knowledge and skills you gained.

Comments
Problem solving
Helped me to look at macroeconomics in more of an abstract way and introduced me to more Chicago School thoughts.
Production Functions, AD/AS graphs, GDP, etc.
CFD, ADAS Equilibrium.
Basic Macroeconomic principles.
Basic ideas behind macroeconomics (fiscal policy, monetary policy, SRAS/LRAS/AD, CFD, inflation, etc.)
Macroeconomics topics for international scale and US specifically. We learned the Circular Flow Diagram, how to understand and apply GDP, (inter)national trade, economic growth, income/output/inflation/interest rates, the ADAS curve and the Loanable Funds Martket, the Federal Reserve System and fiscal and monetary policy
Learned about macroeconomic topics and how the data fits into the concepts we are learning.
Basics of macroeconomics: GDP, inflation, unemployment, monetary and fiscal policy
I think I just gained a more general understanding of what macroeconomics is and the application to the real world.
Recap of macro.
Implications of macroeconomic policies.
GDP, inflation, money and markets.
Learning about how the economy in the US predominantly works, eg. interest rates.
Study skills, how to analyze graphs and read economic models, a basic understanding of the global economy
fiscal and monetary policy CFD and how
The most important thing I learned about was common misconceptions about the US and world economy. I also learned how to view my macroeconomics knowledge through a historical lense.
This is the first economics class I have ever taken, and as an econ major I really appreciated the constructive and comprehensive exposure to macroeconomics. I feel much greater comfort with representing the relationships depicted in ADAS, Loanable Funds, and Money Market diagrams.
learning about the macroeconomic ideas and how they apply to the world around us
We learned basics to macroecon, great introduction to this topic.
The basics of macroeconomic concepts
More about the economy at large
The basic mechanisms behind and applications of macroeconomics. I gained a broad understanding of a lot of different topics.
basics of macroeconomics, gdp, circular flow diagram, etc
Macro tools that the government can use to achieve economic objectives. ALthough I had learned most of these topics in high school (A–Level Econ), this class went more in depth into certain topics and covered some new ones.
Thorough foundation in macroeconomics.
Basic macroeconomic theories and how it applies in the US and globally
GDP, Inflation, Money supply, Trade, Monetary Policy, Fiscal policy
Inflation, the Money Market, Circular Flow Diagram
Basic mechanics of Macroeconomics
I learned about GDP, money, and how the patterns generally work.
Interactions in government, money inflation, RGDP/NGDP

Describe how aspects of this course (lectures, discussions, labs, assignments, etc.) contributed to your learning.

Comments
topic summaries
There were plenty of assignments available to complete to give you more practice with the concepts being quizzed.
We had a combination of synchronous classes, prerecorded lectures, and assignments.
The class is set up great. Asynchronous videos are a great way to prepare for live lecture.
Pre–lecture videos were the bulk of learning. Live class added information or real–life application. The QRE made us apply the materials we learned, and the homework reinforced both mechanical and conceptual material.
This class employed a flipped classroom structure, so we watched 30 minutes of recorded lecture and attended 50 minutes of live lecture where Dr. Pieters answered questions and introduced more content.
Lectures are very helpful, homework assignments alternate with quizzes every week and both sets of assignments are effective, discussion sections are helpful
I appreciated the prerecorded lectures.
The instructor spend a lot of time answering questions and had a very strong grasp of the content.
Recorded lectures were excellent and well structured.
very engaging lectures
Discussions were nice but a little overcomplicated sometimes.
Pre–recorded lectures and live lessons, homeworks and quizes
Asynchronous lectures, office hours, and practice problems greatly contributed to my learning in this course
lectures were informative as they were recorded, the structure of the class was not as great. QREs were helpful in reinforcing the material but the weekly quizzes were worth 85% of our total grade which was essentially a midterm every other week
The quick response exercises during synchronous class helped me learn the most. Attending both the live and asynchronous lectures also helped me a good deal. I also learned a lot studying for quizzes. Completing homework assignments helped me learn the least but were still good.
The course was very well structured to suit my tastes for a remote course. Dr. Pieters would pre–record lecture for us to watch preceding live lecture which would itself have a component of discussion if you opted in to join a breakout room, which is actually how I met one of my best friends now.
Lecture's taught the material, while the assignments and discussion really helped reinforce any topics from classes.
Lectures were incredible. Dr. Pieters' ability to take complex economic topics and distill them to be digestible for a principles class while still retaining the nuance was the foundation of my learning for this class.
Lectures were great, Quick Response questions were interesting and discussing them in zoom breakout rooms/live was helpful. The quizzes every other week were truly excellent, they really tested your understanding of the concepts and the grading rubric was comprehensive and fair. Homework and practice problems were very helpful to prepare for quizzes.
There were homework assignments that helped us solidfy topics discussed during lectures. There were also biweekly quizzes.
Lectures were okay I liked how she went through the QREs each time as that really encouraged students to go to her lectures.
pre–recorded classes and lectures for questions were really helpful
practice problems and p sets were helpful
The practice problems and homework were always extremely helpful to me in reviewing for quizzes. I also really appreciated having the pre–recorded lectures to watch as much as I wanted and review before quizzes.
pre–recorded videos allowed me to comprehend lecture material at my own pace, while daily response exercises allowed me to apply that knowledge in a low–risk and collaborative setting
There was a recorded lecture for the first ~30minutes of class followed by live class in which you discuss the exercise given in the prerecorded class.
Lectures and review sessions were extremely instructive.
The combination of re–recorded and live classes worked well
Recorded lectures were very helpful—especially the ability to rewind and rewatch.
Mostly lectures, lectures (both synchronous and asynchronous) were very well organized
Lectures helped, and the slides used on the lectures were particularly helpful. Assignments were sometimes useful for judging
There were practice problems for each topic and we had biweekly homework and quizzes, which were really helpful.

The Instructor(s) . . .

	Mean	Median	N/A	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree	Total Responses
Provided a syllabus that allowed you to plan your learning and study time effectively.	4.46	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	3.39%	10.17%	23.73%	62.71%	59
Explained clearly the course objectives and expectations.	4.48	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	3.45%	8.62%	24.14%	63.79%	58
Stimulated your interest in the core ideas of the course.	4.26	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	6.90%	8.62%	36.21%	48.28%	58
Was available and helpful outside of class.	4.40	5.00	3.39%	1.69%	1.69%	6.78%	32.20%	54.24%	59
Overall, the instructor made a significant contribution to your learning.	4.35	5.00	0.00%	1.75%	3.51%	7.02%	33.33%	54.39%	57

What aspect of the instructor's teaching contributed most to your learning?

Comments
problems she provided
Plethora of resources available.
The prerecorded lectures.
The structure of the professors class is perfect. Really enjoyed and benefitted from the structure.
The QRE reinforced my learning a lot and I loved how we would go over it in class too just to make sure we all understand the material. Furthermore, the breakout rooms really kept me engaged in applying the material, and was one thing that kept me coming to live class.
I liked how she answered questions students had about the recorded lecture – it really helped to clarify tricky concepts and expose misconceptions.
Lectures, office hours (one on one and for the whole class), assignments including Homework and Practice Problems to prepare for the Quizzes
She provided a lot of feedback on assignments and really went into detail about everything
I appreciated how knowledgable Prof Pieters is in the subject.
The QREs were good at making sure you always understood the core concept.
Recorded lectures
The pre recorded lectures were very helpful to take notes at your own pace
Prerecorded lecture was very good.
Pre–recorded lecture
Willingness to meet outside of class, patience during office hours, over organization/ class organization
recorded lectures were well explained
Pieters' use of polleverywhere as a question forum contributed the most to my learning. Her answers to everyone's questions were really comprehensive and always helped me better understand the concept. I also appreciated her organization skills. She clearly conveyed her expectations so I knew what I needed to accomplish to succeed in the class. All of her materials were consistently provided on time and were updated frequently to remove errors. Surprisingly it is rare to have a professor as organized as Pieters is.
I absolutely adored having Dr. Pieters. Her syllabus initially scared the everliving daylights out of me but in retrospect the exacting and methodical, no–nonsense thing that she sets out from the beginning really allows the class to get fun after expectations are properly laid out. Also, she herself is witty and remarkably effective at getting information across. Also very soothing voice, would listen to lectures again. And her cat was a much appreciated bonus.
I feel like the professor did a great job of making the material engaging and easy to learn
Lectures
Life class was always engaging
She's just an excellent lecturer and has planned her course so well that it's seamless to learn a lot.
Prof. Pieters was always clear with her grading expectations and updated students about how they were doing in the class. She is extremely knowledgeable and was excellent at explaining concepts.
She is incredibly organized and clear with her expectations. I always knew what I needed to learn
The practice problems
The pre–recorded lectures were extremely helpful, as I was able to watch them as many times as I wanted to review for quizzes.
pre–recorded videos and responsiveness to student feedback
Live class and poll–ev was good, because we could ask questions and also discuss with our group members.
Lectures with a firm plan and clear objectives.
Explaining things thoroughly and providing strong examples
Pre–recorded videos included most information, as well as resources like practice problems, quick response exercises, and the topic summaries.
Prof. Pieters was always available to think thorugh concepts with her students, and her explanations for the content were quite clear, helpful and understandable. Prof. Pieters also provided a great deal of content on the canvas page that allowed students to practice the concepts if they felt unclear on them, which made studying for the quizzes straightforward.
Very well structured and organized syllabus
Lectures (slides) and QREs sometimes. I think the flexibility of deciding which parts of the course that would allow us to engage best with the material is definitely very helpful.
She allowed us to submit questions that we had for the topic of the day and answered them during class.
Lectures were very useful, and Prof. Pieter's adaptability and flexibility made the class experience consistently changing in a positive direction.

What could the instructor modify to help you learn more?

Comments
do her grading and posting of materials at a faster pace she was always behind
Maybe be more clear in expectations. Also, I felt the Mankiw's book was not very helpful.
There are way too many files and platforms to keep track of, and the bug bounties, while helpful for some people, make everything more confusing once all the files are updated. Pieters has a very different teaching style than Sanderson, so just be prepared.
Nothing. It's great.
The syllabus was a bit long and overwhelming because so much information was on there. I am not sure how it can be improved because you have to convey all the information for the class upfront, but also it makes the class seem very overwhelming at first, when it is very manageable.
Nothing! Professor Pieters is amazing!
The quizzes are often way too conceptual. I didn't feel like doing the homework problems and the practice problems translated well to the quizzes.
Even after meeting with her one on one to discuss how I could improve, I was not given any concrete answers.
Advise people to buy the textbook instead of making it optional. The summary sheets are good but it would just be best if we all got the textbook. Sometimes the quiz rubric was bit arbitrary and you would lose marks for failing to conform to the rubric instead of lacking understanding – this was frustrating.
n/a
None
Instructor does not need to make any modifications
have the collaborative portion be worth more!! each quiz carried so much weight
I think it would be beneficial for future students to clarify that this course tests people on both macroeconomic theory, but also history and current events. I found that a lot of the topic summaries, which I used to study, only covered the mathematics and theory relevant to the topic, not the historical or current event material which was only in the recorded lecture, but was still on the quizzes.
I know she said she herself is likely to do this when using gradescope in the future, but clarifying ahead of time how to format regrade requests would be helpful.
Curve was unreasonably hard, this course can tank your GPA
N/A
a short running list of topics learned so far could be helpful to keep everything together in one's head.
Make the course easier
It is a very difficult course and the quizzes feel a bit disconnected fom the practice problems we did in class
Make practice questions more in line with how the quizzes are
n/a
Professor Pieters tried VERY hard to make this a smooth quarter, but I think her effort achieved the opposite. a 12–page syllabus as well as multiple announcements, various documents which needed to be checked every week for updates, and other aspects of the logistics of the course made it very difficult to know what was going on. I think she made it over–complicated for herself and for her students.
While I found that the mechanical aspects of the course (what we need to attend and what is optional, what assignments are ones we should probably do and which we don't need to) made a lot of sense in terms of structure and content, the way in which they were explained, both in the syllabus and in lecture, felt very complicated and daunting. A more clear timeline/guideline of what a student should do week–to–week in the course in order to succeed would be very helpful. Additionally, the questions on the short answer questions were sometimes vague such that a student may not be entirely sure which concept the question was assessing, and which of the possible angles to answering the question they should tackle.
Make discussion sections a little more tied in to the Monday/Wednesday lectures
spending less time on administrative stuff and being more organized instead of using multiple platforms. Have consistent class start times and actually have transparent answer keys to all homeworks and quiz mark schemes. The mark scheme on grade scope is hardly sufficient for me to understand the correct answer.
I think the QREs could be modified sometimes and sometimes concepts could be explained a bit better.
n/a

Remote Course Questions

How effective were the different modes of remote teaching in this course?

	Mean	Median	N/A	Very Ineffective	Ineffective	Neutral	Effective	Very Effective	Total Responses
Synchronous Lectures	4.07	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	6.90%	18.97%	34.48%	39.66%	58
Asynchronous (prerecorded) Lectures	4.70	5.00	1.75%	0.00%	0.00%	3.51%	22.81%	71.93%	57
Large Discussions (everyone in the class)	3.83	4.00	23.64%	0.00%	1.82%	25.45%	32.73%	16.36%	55
Small Discussions (zoom breakout rooms)	4.12	4.00	8.93%	1.79%	7.14%	8.93%	33.93%	39.29%	56
Short Quizzes	4.02	4.00	12.96%	1.85%	7.41%	12.96%	29.63%	35.19%	54
Laboratories	4.00	4.00	90.57%	0.00%	0.00%	3.77%	1.89%	3.77%	53
Timed Exams	3.93	4.00	27.27%	1.82%	5.45%	12.73%	29.09%	23.64%	55
Written Work (take home exams, papers, problem sets, etc.)	4.43	5.00	5.77%	0.00%	1.92%	5.77%	36.54%	50.00%	52
Scheduled Faculty Office Hours	4.30	5.00	25.93%	0.00%	3.70%	9.26%	22.22%	38.89%	54
Scheduled TA Office Hours	4.28	4.00	26.42%	0.00%	1.89%	9.43%	28.30%	33.96%	53

Please elaborate on the above.

Comments
I felt the grading rubric for quizzes was very abstract. I understood the answers once I read them, but they seemed extremely specific. For example, there were a couple questions asking how certain professors at Chicago would interpret data, and it seemed subjective.
My only problem stems from the quizzes, specifically the T/F/A questions. It took me a while to figure out that you have to put EVERY assumption on there.
I do not have anything to complain about.
Synchronous and asynchronous lecture conveyed a ton of information. Exams and QRE made sure we actually understand the material and can apply it in new situations.
The course was clear and had many resources which allowed for success
We were primarily graded on quizzes; the material was interesting, but the application on the quizzes was tough to get results based off of my understanding.
Practice problems were extremely helpful, but quizzes could be over complex.
Pre–recorded lcture were really helpful because it allowed for us to go at our own pace.
Asynchronous lectures, office hours, and practice problems greatly contributed to my learning
Every part of the course was clearly designed with the goal of performing well on the quizzes and ultimately gaining a A–grade level of understanding of the material.
All very helpful.
Everything was great, and there were plenty of office hours provided. However, I was unfortunately unable to attend any of them this quarter, so I can't speak to their effectiveness.
I think prof Pieters did a good job providing students with many opportunities to succeed in her class (dropping low quizzes and homeworks), but I also think her grade weighting system is a little harsh compared to other classes I've taken. Of course, all classes and profs are different, but it is a little difficult as a student when one prof is much harder than others.
TA office hours helped a lot
The key components to my success on quizzes were TA discussions the week before, pre–recorded lectures, and practice problems. I was able to go back and re–watch/re–do each of these in preparation for quizzes.
homeworks and quizzes were very well–designed applications of course material
Tests were difficult and needed specific ideas to gain full credit
Quizzes were extremely difficult and comprised 85% of the grade. Pre–recorded lectures were where most information was located and synchronous lectures acted as additional information/context.
TA discussion sections felt pretty disjointed from the rest of the class at times
I think the practice problems were the most helpful part.
We had QREs, short question to test our understanding on the topic, in every class and we were able to discuss it in small breakout rooms which was helpful.

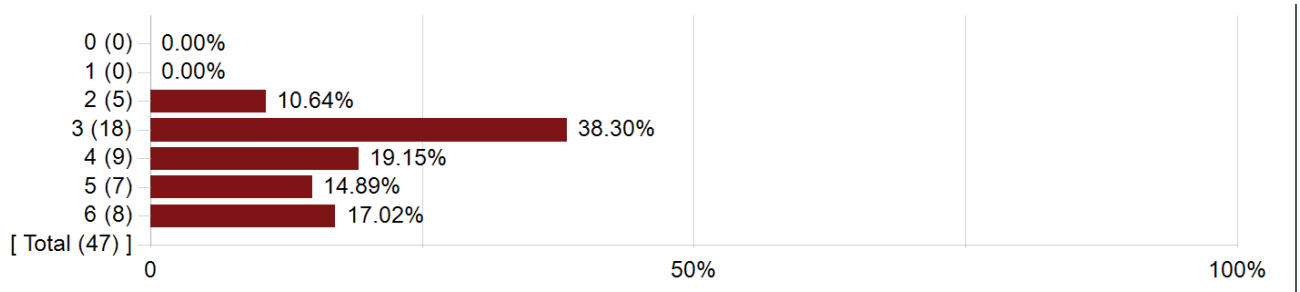
Did the instructor make adjustments to the course mid-quarter? If so, please comment on the effectiveness of those adjustments.

Comments
some assignments became optional
Yes. They were fine.
Yes, the professor made minor changes. They benefitted the people that asked for them and were minor enough to have no effect on me.
Not sure.
Yes – the professor responded to the comments on the mid quarter evaluations that we completed and it was very helpful
n/a
No
n/a
I am not sure. She reviewed the mid–quarter survey with the class and went through all the responses to show what she could and could not change. She ultimately did not have to change much, if any at all because it was already so good.
Nope.
N/A
N/A
There was a mid–quarter survey, I did not make note of the changes myself
never took in any feedback
N/A
yes, Professor Pieters added questions in our homework so we can pick and choose which ones to answer (didn't have to answer all questions to get full mark)

Please describe any element of this course, including specific actions by the instructor, that improved your remote learning experience.

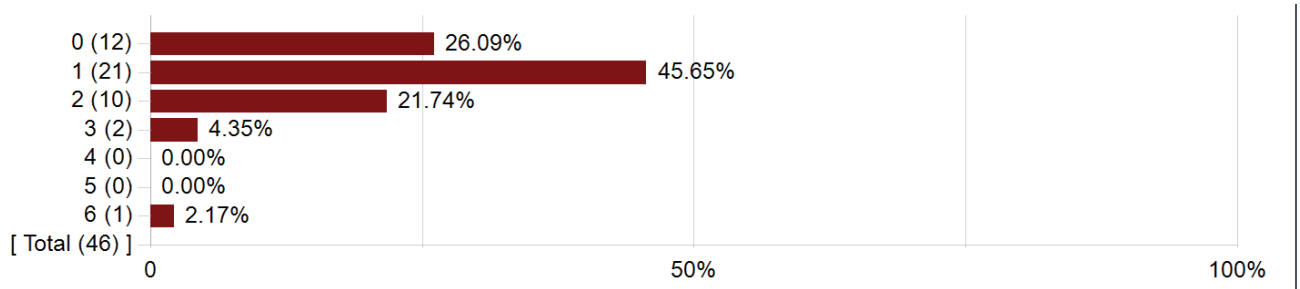
Comments
collaborative work with classmates
N/A
Her openness to questions.
Zoom One–on–One office hours were great!
n/a
QREs – they were a good barometer of understanding when you aren't physically in class. I don't know if these are new to this year though.
The pre–recorded lectures
n/a
Alternating homework and quizzes weekly alleviated the stress from having your whole grade rely on two huge exams and having to turn in homework every week.
Sending out emails describing your exact positioning in the class was both stressful but very hepful simultaneously.
The creation of small groups to discuss things helped a significant amount.
The asynchronous lectures were very well organized. the small discussions were nice since we could have a group which we chose or work on our own.
The lectures being recorded helped me go back and rewatch them
The pre–recorded lectures were so helpful. I'm very happy I took this class online so I was able to have these lecture videos to rewatch while studying.
daily breakout rooms !
Prerecorded lectures enabled easy review and learning at the student's pace (could be sped up, et cet)
The resources that Prof. Pieters on the canvas page (lectures, practice questions, slides, and homework answers) made it easy to access and interact with the content in a virtual environment.
Clear course structure
N/A

How many hours per week did you spend in lectures for this course (synchronous or asynchronous)?



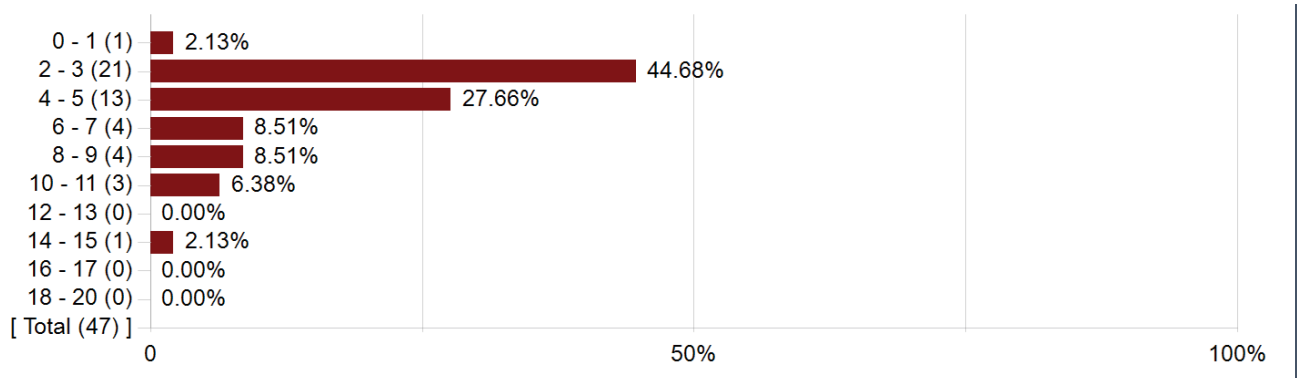
Statistics	Value
Response Count	47
Mean	3.89
Standard Deviation	1.29

How many hours per week did you spend in other scheduled activities for this course (labs, discussions, etc.)?



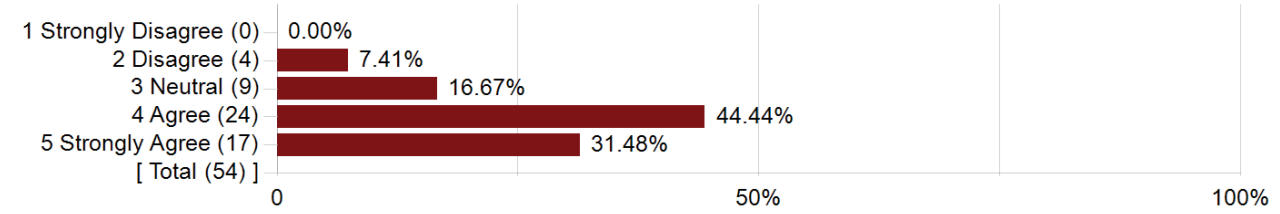
Statistics	Value
Response Count	46
Mean	1.15
Standard Deviation	1.09

How many additional hours per week did you spend on this course (reading, problem sets, writing, etc.)?



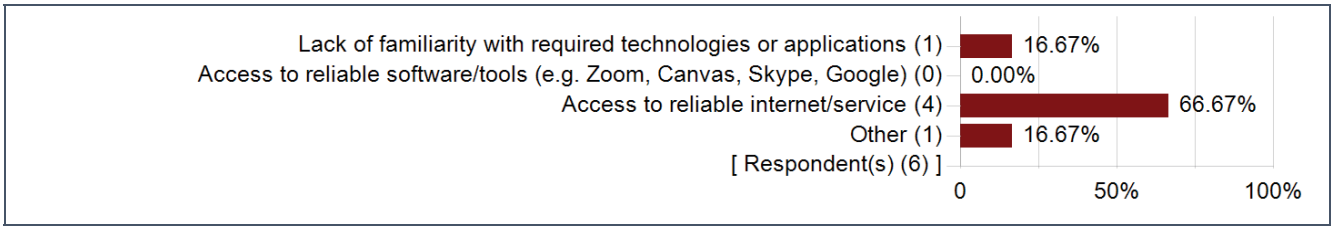
Statistics	Value
Response Count	47
Mean	4.60
Standard Deviation	2.71

The overall workload of the course was appropriate.

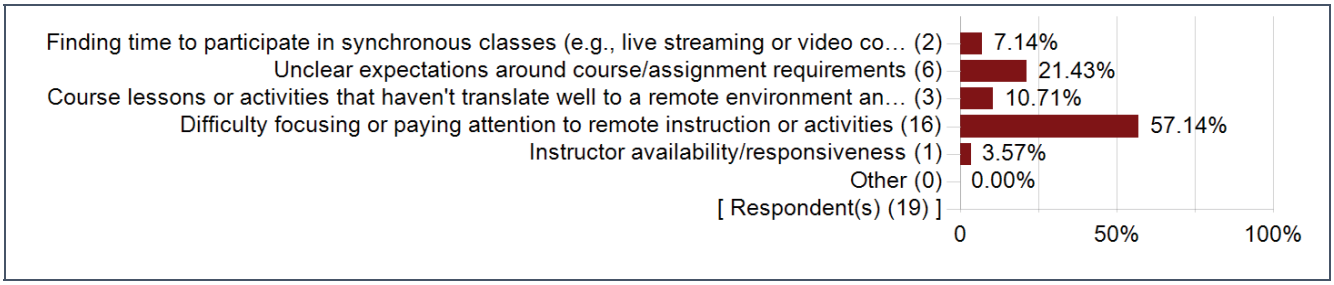


Statistics	Value
Response Count	54
Mean	4.00
Standard Deviation	0.89

Which of the following technological issues continue to be a challenge for you? (check all that apply)



Which of the following learning/educational issues continue to be a challenge for you? (check all that apply)



TA/CA/Intern Questions

Please include the name of the TA/CA/Intern you are evaluating. What aspects of the TA's teaching contributed most to your learning? What could the TA modify to help you learn more? Please include any additional feedback for the TA/CA/Intern.

Comments
Paul
Rex Zhang. He was knowledgeable and helpful.
Rex. set up fantastic presentations to help us grasp the ideas presented by the professor.
Rex, very knowledgeable.
Dharrnesha Inbah Rajah
Rex Zhang, Dharrnesha Inbah Rajah, Paul Zaporzan
Dharrnesha Inbah Rajah. Paul Zaporzan. Jiayi (Rex)Zhang. These TA's led separate discussion groups every other friday. These review sessions were sometimes helpful.
Rex was really helpful in explaining any concepts that I found tricky.
Paul Zaporzan, great TA! Very helpful during office hours and great at explaining concepts!
Rex
Rex– very prompt and helpful, also had a great cat
Rex. Rex was very nice and approachable and had a good teaching style.
Jiayi (Rex) Zhang. Once again, I think he did a great job in the discussion sessions, and I don't really have any complaints. The course is designed in such a way that I generally wasn't confused a lot, but any time I was, Rex was easily able to explain the topics.
Paul Zaporzan. He was very attentive and helpful during TA Discussion sections and office hours. If he couldn't answer a question during the live time, he would always make sure to follow up about it after.
Paul Zapporan Was very prepared for discussion sections, answered questions quite clearly most of the time
N/A
The TA discussions/lectures on Fridays really helped in summarizing the important parts of the material and making all four topics for the upcoming quiz fit together.
Darnesha had super clear slides and was great at reinforcing understanding of various topics from class
Paul Zaporzan. I think Paul was good, but the discussion sections were mainly geared towards homework discussion, and I did not attend often as I had no issues with the homework and had other commitments.
Rex Zhang was informative and easily accesible through email.
Rex Zhang is a great TA. Super patient, helpful and responsive.
Paul Zaporzan – explained concepts that we were confused on during discussion session clearly. I can't think of anything else that should be done.
All 3 TAs were very helpful in office hours, giving good advice on quizzes and being very accessible for questions.

Assignments and Participation

	Mean	Median	N/A	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree	Total Responses
The assignments in the course were reasonable.	4.30	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	1.89%	9.43%	45.28%	43.40%	53
The assignments and classroom activities served the course objectives.	4.44	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	3.85%	1.92%	40.38%	53.85%	52
Instructor's feedback/comments on your assignments were clear, specific, and helpful.	4.20	4.00	1.92%	1.92%	3.85%	15.38%	28.85%	48.08%	52
Assignments were returned to you in a timely manner.	4.38	5.00	0.00%	1.92%	1.92%	5.77%	36.54%	53.85%	52
The class met regularly, on time, and for the entire period.	4.54	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	3.85%	1.92%	30.77%	63.46%	52
If the class did not meet at the regularly scheduled time, were the changes and reasons behind them explained clearly.	4.59	5.00	11.54%	0.00%	1.92%	3.85%	23.08%	59.62%	52
You were prepared for classes and attended regularly.	4.42	5.00	1.96%	0.00%	1.96%	5.88%	39.22%	50.98%	51

ECON 23950 2 - Economic Policy Analysis - Instructor(s): Gina Pieters

Project Title: **College Course Feedback - Autumn 2021**

Number Enrolled: **54**
Number of Responses: **24**

Report Comments

Opinions expressed in these evaluations are those of students enrolled in the specific course and do not represent the University.

Creation Date: **Tuesday, April 19, 2022**

What are the most important things that you learned in this course? Please reflect on the knowledge and skills you gained.

Comments
how to model and evaluate fiscal and monetary policies.
Fiscal and monetary policies, how to link theoretical economic models in context of real–world policy.
How to understand real economic policy using the tools we learned in the 200s sequence
fiscal/monetary policy
Nothing, Professor Pieters taught us nothing useful or helpful regarding the basis of Economic Policy.
Various models and insight into how to relate models to the real world
How to apply neoclassical concepts to topics like optimal taxation policy, etc. This class is very much practical applications of the base concepts learned in the econ core and seems like a good bridge for those who want to go into econ policy work.
Applications of economic models on policy topics
A bunch of different models and how to use them to evaluate actual policies
I learned how to model fiscal and monetary policies. More importantly, we learned how to apply the models we learned by modeling a real–life phenomenon.
The course was challenging intellectually and time wise.
An incredible amount on fiscal and monetary policy and modelling. Gina is a wonderful professor, you just need to be prepared to take on the courseload.
Basically everything I should have learned from ECON 200–202. I feel that I didn't learn much from COVID but this class has helped me make up a significant amount of it. How to solve EEs, steady state, etc
This course taught me how to think about and model economic policies with the analytical toolkit provided by the 200s sequence—especially ECON 202. I also gained a good amount of coding knowledge and experience.
How to apply general economic models from ECON200–202 to real world policy problems
How to evaluate monetary policy
models associated with fiscal and monetary policy.
This class tied what I learned in the 200–202 sequence together. Much of the material I felt was abstract in the past made much more sense. I learned how to build a variety of fiscal and monetary models and how to write an economics paper.
Applying models to real–world policies
I learned about how to model various different policy decisions as well as the difference between fiscal and monetary policies.

Describe how aspects of this course (lectures, discussions, labs, assignments, etc.) contributed to your learning.

Comments
lectures were helpful, but pests were most helpful in terms of applying lecture material to the term papers.
Lectures are very helpful as Prof. Pieters is a good lecturer.
probably learned the most from writing papers
Lectures were great!
The lectures were excellent—very clear and conveyed material well. Assignments were good for getting a practical understanding of topics.
Lectures and homeworks were most helpful for me
The problem sets were really helpful and I like that we have a max of 50 pts with 65 possible. Also, the lectures were amazing!! Super engaging and felt very comfortable asking questions in class.
Lectures were great, but psets/papers were very time consuming, grading policy reasonable but tough
The papers were difficult but genuinely helped me learn the material. If you go to OH, Gina is there to help you do the papers.
Literally all of it! Surprisingly, just sitting in lecture without taking notes, I absorbed so much. Definitely go to office hours if you are ever confused. the EdThread is also great.
The lectures and the papers contributed most to my learning in this class. Rather than an exam, the paper gave you time to explain and use the material in class. This class also allowed for collaboration on the homework assignments which also helped with practicing the material in the lectures. The QREs also helped check for understanding mid–lecture which was helpful for reinforcing some kind of takeaway from the lecture that day.
Lectures were important in introducing new models and discussing how conventional models that we had previously learned can be adjusted to replicate the real world, such as with taxation. Problem sets were largely a supplement to class discussions. The assignments were the crucial source of learning and challenge, however, as they forced us to individually map the models to specific examples of policy.
I did not find the course structure to be conducive to learning
Lecture were helpful in completing the homework and paper assignments.
Lectures were extremely clear, and Prof Pieters did a good job answering questions. The homeworks had us derive some of the answers given in class slides and put a twist on them. The papers were the bulk of work for the class, and I enjoyed them—though I would note that Dynare is an absolute mess. I understand that this is something they use at the Fed, but the language is so terribly written, and I felt that TAs/core tutors were unable to help with this aspect of the course. If the purpose of the course was to learn how to code in Dynare, we should have devoted time to it in class. If not, I would suggest adopting the Python packages that have the same functionality, as Python is a much more straightforward language in general—and something that people tend to have experience with.
Policy papers were interesting
Lectures were the most important aspect. Professor Pieters would go through various aspects of monetary/fiscal policy and go through different models that pertained to the two.

Please respond to the following:

	Mean	Median	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
This course challenged me intellectually.	4.83	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	4.17%	8.33%	87.50%
I understood the purpose of this course and what I was expected to gain from it.	4.29	5.00	4.17%	0.00%	12.50%	29.17%	54.17%
I understood the standards for success on assignments.	4.17	5.00	0.00%	12.50%	12.50%	20.83%	54.17%
Class time enhanced my ability to succeed in graded assignments.	4.00	4.00	8.33%	4.17%	12.50%	29.17%	45.83%
I received feedback on my performance that helped me improve my subsequent work.	4.21	5.00	0.00%	12.50%	8.33%	25.00%	54.17%
My work was evaluated fairly.	4.46	5.00	0.00%	4.17%	8.33%	25.00%	62.50%
I felt respected in this class.	4.61	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	8.70%	21.74%	69.57%
Overall, this was an excellent course.	4.22	5.00	4.35%	13.04%	0.00%	21.74%	60.87%

Additional comments about the course:

Comments
Incredibly difficult course that challenged me intellectually and fulfilled my interest in the subject. Pieters' grading policy for term papers was strange and ultimately didn't work, since she was weeks behind on grading papers.
This course was surprisingly writing–heavy, unlike other economics classes. The bulk of the grade is made up of papers that function like a midterm. I preferred this format, but I understand some other students might prefer having more traditional exams.
Too difficult and too much workload
This course was unnecessarily hard. Originally we were supposed to write 3 10 page minimum policy papers where we had to create and code a model. We were never taught how to create a model. If you can take this class with another teacher, do yourself a favor and take them.
This was one of the best courses I've taken in the econ major. It's definitely challenging, but I understood exactly what I was learning during the course. The projects were really challenging, but super rewarding once I figured them out. Professor Pieters was an amazing teacher!
I really enjoyed the way Professor Pieters teaches—she is really good at conveying information and helping you learn. I didn't love the paper assignments. I found they took a long time and were stressful. However, they probably are a more useful way of learning and applying material than testing.
The standards for the policy papers were not clearly explained. I feel that there was unnecessary stress in writing the papers as I thought I would be held to the standards of papers for other writing courses. It would be nice if the sample papers given had their actual grade included rather than just knowing they got above a B (names could be blurred if this is a concern).
Gina is absolutely wonderful, you just need to go to OH. Gina wants you to work smart instead of hard and I think that's something that takes people a lot of time to realize.
I will say, be prepared for a lot of work, but you will learn a lot from it all. Professor Pieter's decision to make us write papers was. a good choice because it forced us out of our comfort zone to do something new and useful. In the process, I learned a lot while writing the papers.
It's clear how thoughtful Prof. Pieters was with designing this course. The grading system (timed/untimed points) and the paper writing process (peer feedback, FoF) felt intentionally constructed to help us succeed and not get overwhelmed. The paper deadlines in this course were also flexible which was much appreciated when the quarter became chaotic.
I would say that, after a certain point, lectures did not enhance my ability to succeed in graded assignments as we essentially had the ability to write our final paper as early as week 6. This was also likely the most time–consuming course I have taken in the Economics major. Much of this was due to the intellectual challenge of the course. The common critique that students discuss about the Economics major, standard track, is that it is not useful but rather too theoretical. The entirety of this course was applying theoretical models to real world policy, and I feel like I produced papers with real (though not necessarily surprising) insights about policy. I also feel confident in my ability to assess policy proposals which, though still not necessarily the most useful skill, is rewarding nonetheless and a good near–conclusion to the major. I feel like writing the papers was both more rewarding and more challenging than taking another Economics course where the medians on exams are 50s. It is worth noting that the unlimited time on, and difficulty of, the papers very much brought out the perfectionist in me and seemingly others, at times to a near–maddening degree, and thus raised the standards for success on assignments. I would say that there were other, non–intellectually–challenging portions of the course that were also very time consuming. I spent a handful, if not over a dozen, of hours trying to get Dynare to work on my computer and/or VLab (both on my computer and on Reg desktop computers). I couldn't get it to work on the latter, and also could not get it to work on the former based on materials provided in class, which was very frustrating. Eventually, after spending a lot of time on Google and YouTube, I figured out that iCloud was likely causing problems on my computer insofar as it automatically uploaded all files upon saving. I got it to work, but only when my Wifi was turned off (thus preventing any iCloud upload). I would also say that uncertainty over deadlines, and whether or not there would be sufficient time for our papers to be graded, added stress beyond the core coursework. If these technical/logistical issues had not occurred, I think that I would have had an especially good experience in this course.
I thought the course structure was not ideal
Really a great class, and something I recommend to anyone who has completed the prerequisites. I would recommend it to people in the Data Science track, even though it's not a requirement.

I would recommend this course to:

	No	Yes
Highly-motivated and well-prepared students	4.17%	95.83%
Anyone interested in the topic	25.00%	75.00%

Thinking about your time in the class, what aspect of the instructor's teaching contributed most to your learning?

Comments
Her explanation of the intuition of the models being used in class and papers, especially Kiyotaki–Wright
Lectures were very helpful, as were one–on–one appointments.
Lecture slides
Professor Pieters is extremely compassionate and understanding.
Prof Pieters is an excellent lecturer. In general, the lectures were very organized and cut to the heart of topics well. She is also very approachable and made it easy for students to ask questions if they didn't understand topics or wanted to dig deeper. She also has a great personality and made lectures genuinely enjoyable to attend.
Lectures were really interesting and engaging
Prof Pieters is a very good lecturer. And very good at answering questions
I think the papers were way more helpful than the problem sets. However, the problem sets were super important to my understanding of the course content as well. The only thing that I would change is getting more guidance on papers. Prof Pieters was willing to give us more feedback with our second papers, but this would have really helped for the first as well.
Good lectures, well prepared class system
Availability in OH
Literally all of it, though if you have questions and are shy, go to her office hours! Ed is great too. Just ask the questions, you literally aren't the first to ask and cannot look more silly than I did lol
Prof. Pieters is one of the best lecturers in the department. Going to class was extremely useful for understanding the material; she's engaging and demonstrates a strong knowledge of the material. I also appreciated her patience and help in office hours. It's definitely useful to go to office hours if you're confused. Additionally, Prof. Pieters published review materials from the 200s sequence which helped tremendously with remembering the math concepts from those courses. I feel so grateful to have had her as a professor.
Lectures, uploading slides and lecture audio, papers, Ed discussion.
Office hours. I did not feel the lectures were particularly useful for my learning
Mid quarter feedback. Office hours incredibly helpful. Clear slides that are uploaded with the recording lets you go back to classes when you need to clear up a topic.
Posting the slides with the annotated comments from class was super helpful when completing assignments.
She was very clear in lectures, and did a good job answering questions. I felt treated with respect in this course.
Appreciate how available class notes and resources were. Grading was appropriate
Office hours were very very helpful. I think that the material from class can be a little intimidating, but Professor Pieters is so kind in office hours and helps a lot to guide you without making you feel silly about your questions. The lectures were great, but sometimes it was hard to pay attention for the whole 1 hour and 20 minutes.

What could the instructor modify to help you learn more?

Comments
Grading policy! She allowed students to turn in papers late without any sort of penalty but this ultimately lead to her not grading papers by the deadline she created and panic in terms of students not knowing whether they need to complete the optional final paper or not.
The peer feedback system for the papers was a little weird because some students simply ended up not bothering to give in actual good feedback and instead followed the rubric to the T (to get the good feedback grade). Perhaps there should be a section where the feedback grade is based on how helpful the feedback is as a whole.
Go through the models more, make QREs a flowover for all categories so people are incentivized to come to lecture.
Prof Pieters has a very detailed grading system that can be a lot to follow. I think simplifying it would help. I also am not a big fan of feedback on feedbacks.
Her slides were very dense in content, often skipped many math steps so were sometimes hard to follow.
Nothing!
I really enjoyed the real–world applications of models when they were in there. I know they took time, but they were more fun than a bunch of math
I think I could have extracted more from the paper writing process if I could check my model/get guidance on my model at least with the TAs. I feel like there was more concern from the TAs about not telling us the answer rather than actually helping us.
A little more guidance to coding and soft aspects
Maybe more samples of what the paper would look like? Also a little more guidance on psets and the paper models?
N/A
Bug bounties were a bit annoying, especially in keeping track of what on slides was or was not correct as I was writing my final paper. Also less uncertainty over grading time/due dates/technical software like Dynare, as discussed in my previous response. I also felt like the paper prompts were not always of equal difficulty – I am aware that we get to choose which to write about, so maybe this is not an issue, but it is something to possibly consider from a grading equity perspective.
I would not do the paper structure. I felt there was not an incentive to learn the broader material or to listen in class. Also going more into the math would help rather than just putting equations on the slides
The feedback on feedback process felt clunky. Also, I think the fiscal paper/prompts should have been talked about in class earlier. We only mentioned the first paper the week the draft was due (I hadn't started yet), and I had a bit of a panicked week trying to get my Dynare to work. She was accommodating with the paper deadlines, but I think given how important they are to the course, it would have been good to emphasize them in the early weeks.
Nothing.

The Instructor . . .

	Mean	Median	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree	N/A
Organized the course clearly.	4.65	5.00	0.00%	4.35%	4.35%	13.04%	78.26%	0.00%
Presented lectures that enhanced your understanding.	4.52	5.00	0.00%	8.70%	0.00%	21.74%	69.57%	0.00%
Facilitated discussions that were engaging and useful.	4.45	5.00	0.00%	8.70%	4.35%	13.04%	60.87%	13.04%
Stimulated your interest in the core ideas of the course.	4.32	5.00	0.00%	9.09%	4.55%	31.82%	54.55%	0.00%
Challenged you to learn.	4.70	5.00	0.00%	4.35%	0.00%	17.39%	78.26%	0.00%
Helped you gain significant learning from the course content.	4.55	5.00	9.09%	0.00%	0.00%	9.09%	81.82%	0.00%
Was available and helpful outside of class.	4.82	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	18.18%	81.82%	0.00%
Motivated you to think independently.	4.61	5.00	0.00%	4.35%	4.35%	17.39%	73.91%	0.00%
Worked to create an inclusive and welcoming learning environment.	4.68	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	4.55%	22.73%	72.73%	0.00%
Overall, this instructor made a significant contribution to your learning.	4.64	5.00	4.55%	0.00%	4.55%	9.09%	81.82%	0.00%

What aspects of the TA's teaching contributed most to your learning?

Comments
Eliot and Manuel were really happy to stay after class and help us out if we needed help.
Manuel taught the discussion section each week where he would go through the lecture concepts and homework problems. He also went through some coding tutorials which helped immensely with writing our papers. I appreciate how kind and approachable he is.
Discussion sessions were informal yet informative
Office Hours
office hours
Discussion sections

What could the TA modify to help you learn more?

Comments
Eliot seemed to go on a tangent a lot which would not really answer my question, though he's super smart and taught me a lot i would like for his answers to be a bit more concise. Manuel was not very responsive to emails throughout the quarter, but he helped a lot when he responded. I think the TAs could also be a bit more familiar with the paper prompts so they can give us more focused help.
N/A
Nothing
Maybe set a more concrete idea of what the discussion section should look like; go over the homework rather than the slides.

The TA/CA or Intern. . .

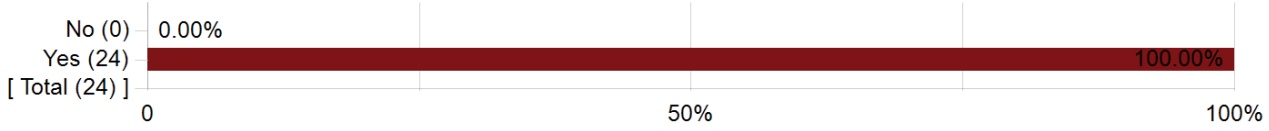
	Mean	Median	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree	N/A
Facilitated discussions that supported your learning.	3.33	3.00	10.00%	10.00%	30.00%	20.00%	20.00%	10.00%
Gave you useful feedback on your work.	4.00	4.00	0.00%	10.00%	20.00%	20.00%	40.00%	10.00%
Stimulated your interest in the core ideas of the class.	3.78	4.00	10.00%	0.00%	30.00%	10.00%	40.00%	10.00%
Challenged you to learn.	3.67	4.00	10.00%	0.00%	30.00%	20.00%	30.00%	10.00%
Helped you succeed in the class.	3.44	3.00	10.00%	10.00%	30.00%	10.00%	30.00%	10.00%
Was available and helpful outside of class.	4.33	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	10.00%	40.00%	40.00%	10.00%
Overall, this individual made a significant contribution to your learning.	3.44	4.00	10.00%	10.00%	20.00%	30.00%	20.00%	10.00%

Additional feedback to the TA/CA/Intern:

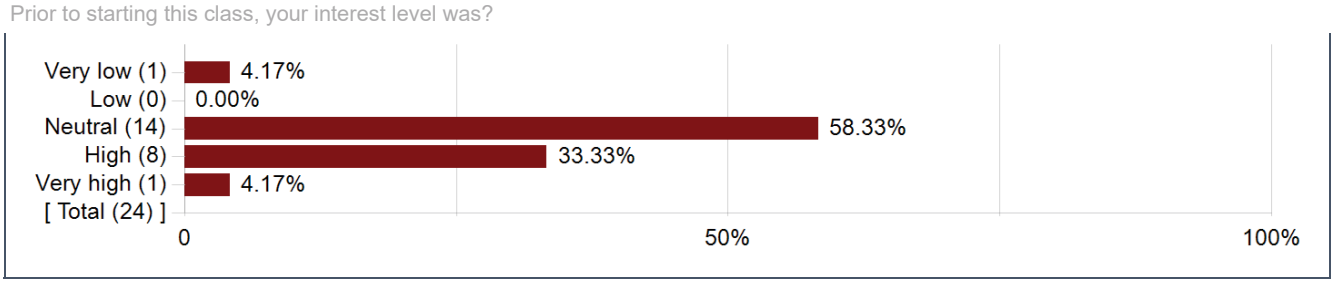
Comments
the TAs were not helpful or well prepared at all
I wish that we could get more direct hints on the PSETs from the TAs as something since they were worried about revealing too much, it made me only more confused.
More clarity over what they can and cannot do would probably be useful, especially with respect to questions relating to technical issues

Is this class a requirement of some sort?

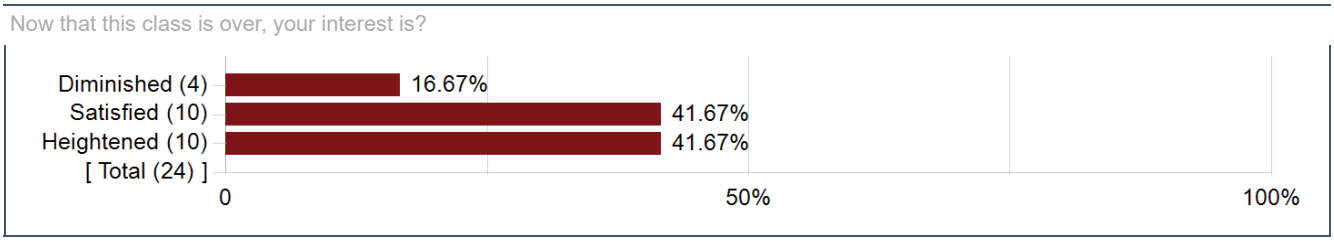
Is this class a requirement of some sort?



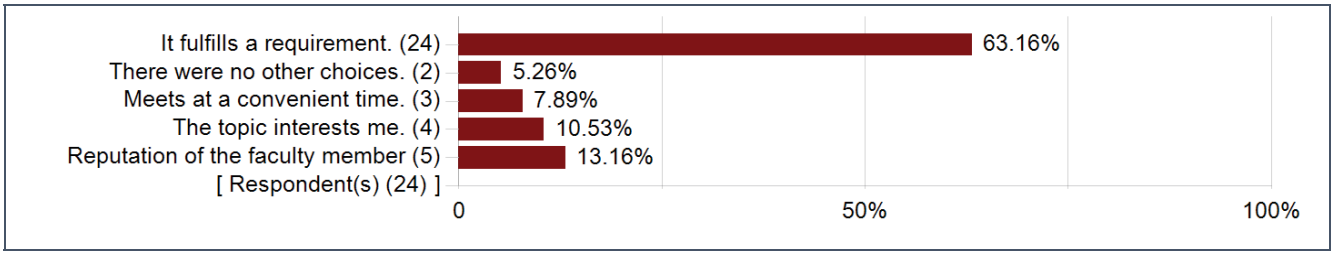
Prior to starting this class, your interest level was?



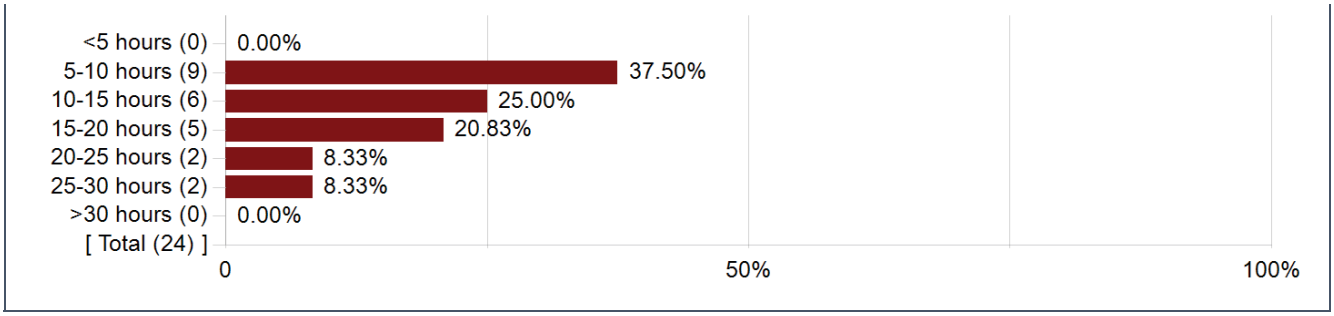
Now that this class is over, your interest is?



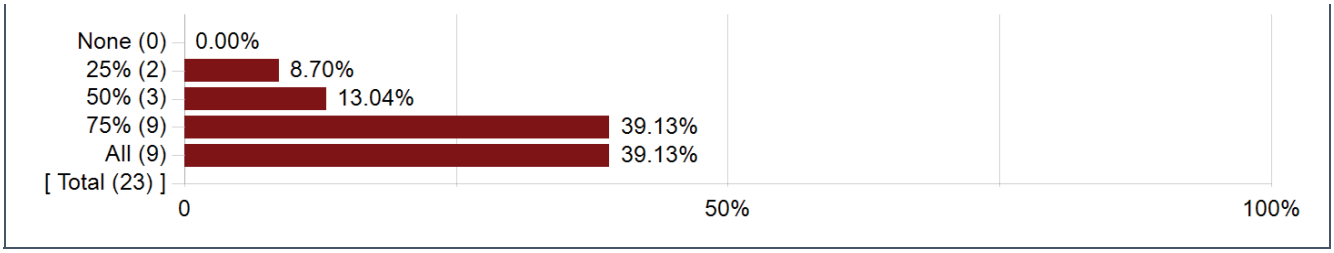
Why did you choose to take this course? (Select all that apply)



How many hours per week outside of attending required sessions did you spend on this course?



What proportion of classes did you attend?



Please comment on the level of difficulty of the course relative to your background and experience.

Comments
This was an upper–level economics class and expects knowledge of econ 200–202. I took econ 200–202 quite recently but was already slightly rusty, so at the beginning a bulk of the time was spent relearning the past material.
Very difficult
The papers were very very difficult
It is challenging but doable
The content of the course was not difficult, but writing correct papers was fairly difficult.
Very difficult, but worth it
It was comparable to other econ courses like 202 or metrics. Homeworks took a while but nothing crazy. Papers were time consuming however
Difficult
I did all of the ECON 200–202 during covid, and I felt I didn't learn much. As a result, this class was very hard, but I sosmehow made it through
This course was challenging for incorporating the concepts learned in the 200s alongside new models of economic policies. Despite its difficulty, this class offered a strong support system to help you succeed if you put in the work. The effort you put in feels rewarding at the end.
Very difficult but rewarding. There is a lot of independence and standards are high.
The material could be tricky, but I felt the assignments were reasonable given the pset groups. The material in 200–202 is important for this course, and I wish I could go and retake those courses before this one. All the 200–202 material makes much more sense after this course.

THE UNIVERSITY OF CHICAGO

ECON 23950 3 - Economic Policy Analysis - Instructor(s): Gina Pieters

Project Title: **College Course Feedback - Autumn 2021**

Number Enrolled: **49**
Number of Responses: **26**

Report Comments

Opinions expressed in these evaluations are those of students enrolled in the specific course and do not represent the University.

Creation Date: **Tuesday, April 19, 2022**

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What are the most important things that you learned in this course? Please reflect on the knowledge and skills you gained.

Comments
how to analyze monetary and fiscal policies using economic models
Fiscal and Monetary Policy
How to model different types of fiscal and monetary policy.
General economic policies. Which confused me. A lot.
Fiscal and monetary policy. Using microfounded models to address aspects of these policies.
Policy evaluation in economics
Learning to model with Matlab and Dynare and reviewing models from the Econ 200s
I learned how real economist go about writing papers.
How to write papers, fiscal policy (proportional taxation), monetary policy (money–search model)
applying economic models we have learned in the econ 200 sequence to the real world
How data and theory play a critical role in informing economic policies
How to look at a policy in the news and learn how to analyze it with legitimate data and models.
Tools of fiscal and monetary policy, how the government uses these, how to reconcile both data and theory in economic research, monetary history of the US, how perception dictates policy approaches, etc
How to form models from economic descriptions
The most important things I learned had to dealt with building up models that could be applied to monetary and fiscal topics. However, the skill I learned was to take a real life policy, map it onto a model we had discussed, and see how we could interpret the data in a real life example. Prior to this economics class I had not done this before, and with a lot of grade being Policy Papers I definitely learned this skill.
Economic models to understand fiscal and monetary policy.
Taxation, theory behind monetary policy,
How to simulate fiscal and monetary policies using economic models.
Analyzing fiscal and monetary policies, writing legit papers on them.
Fiscal and monetary policy.
how to analyze policy and apply economic methods learnt so far to them
models in fiscal and monetary policy

Describe how aspects of this course (lectures, discussions, labs, assignments, etc.) contributed to your learning.

Comments
lectures and the paper assignmments
Lectures were great, though very tough! Needed lots of macro! However, Gina Pieters is AMAZING!
Lectures went over the models and empirical results, homeworks and papers gave applications in other areas.
Just lectures. Did not think homeworks helped too much.
Lectures were highly engaging and interesting, and discussions helped clarify some key concepts learnt over the week as well as Matlab simulation codes.
Psets and policy papers
Lecture slides and Panopto recordings were very helpful to study
Havign to write a paper really expanded my learning of the subject
Lectures went very quickly through math, and the slides were sometimes difficult to understand – I understand that a lot of this was due to the course's structure. Homework assignments, if you did them, were extremely helpful for grasping the ideas from lecture.
2 papers, psets, and QREs
The paper assignments taught me how to apply models to what I see in the world.
Lectures were absolutely amazing! Professor Pieters always presented real world data relevant to the issues we were studying. Quick response exercises in lectures helped us be more alert and think about what we were studying. A very well structured class overall. Ed Discussion boards helped a LOT in getting questions answered quickly.
The lecture and slides help a lot
The lectures are great, the homeworks can only aid in your work, and the posting of both pre–class notes and after–class notes (which handwritten notes of what professor wanted to emphasize) was amazing.
Lectures were very informative, homeworks were really helpful in applying the concepts. Papers were hard, but very satisfying to complete.
Lectures were great and psets helped teach the material. The format of the class involved writing long economic papers on a created model. I enjoyed being exposed to economic writing.
Lectures were hard to follow at times but generally okay. Problem sets were really helpful for digesting the material.
Very organized slides, but lectures are mostly reading through them.
Learned how to implement taxes effectively as a government. How to use economic models in class and apply them to different scenarios. Econ is all about applied math – this class takes you into learning the math and then the HW makes you think critically and apply it.
lectures were super helpful
lectures were good

Please respond to the following:

	Mean	Median	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
This course challenged me intellectually.	4.92	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	8.33%	91.67%
I understood the purpose of this course and what I was expected to gain from it.	4.71	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	4.17%	20.83%	75.00%
I understood the standards for success on assignments.	4.79	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	20.83%	79.17%
Class time enhanced my ability to succeed in graded assignments.	4.54	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	16.67%	12.50%	70.83%
I received feedback on my performance that helped me improve my subsequent work.	4.63	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	12.50%	12.50%	75.00%
My work was evaluated fairly.	4.79	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	4.17%	12.50%	83.33%
I felt respected in this class.	4.96	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	4.17%	95.83%
Overall, this was an excellent course.	4.39	5.00	4.35%	0.00%	8.70%	26.09%	60.87%

Additional comments about the course:

Comments
(1/2) Where to start. I sincerely do not believe this course should be part of the econ sequence. I think if it were just 90% less equation and model solving this class would have benefitted much more towards everyone's enrichment. I ask people who graduate and go into their careers, and no one has ever told me that this class has benefitted them, specifically the math part. I already hold a strong disdain for any class that has this much math and would rather do research on current topics or even just explain the history of every real–life policy ever. I don't understand how doing complicated model solving and lagrangians or euler equations really will help me in life in any economic field (unless I become a pure economist). It really just felt like a test to see if I was able to do straight math for a quarter.
Very difficult class. It has been by far the most challenging course I have taken yet at UChicago, but I felt like I learned a lot.
I heard it was a very difficult course going into it, however, it was very fair and carefully constructed to teach well.
Amazing course!
N/A
Homeworks were collaborative, which was nice. Most of the grade points come from the two/three papers, and the professor was very lenient about the deadline.
Phenomenal. Pieters is awesome. Maybe one of the best lecturers Ive had at this university. She took a class that should boring (fiscal and monetary policy) and made it SUPER interesting. Lots of real life examples. Great conversation in class. Phenomenal and understandable lecture notes. Uchicago is making a huge mistake if we dont get her tenure because for once this is a professor who knows how to EDUCATE and not just research. very rare at this school.

I would recommend this course to:

	No	Yes
Highly-motivated and well-prepared students	4.35%	95.65%
Anyone interested in the topic	21.74%	78.26%

Thinking about your time in the class, what aspect of the instructor's teaching contributed most to your learning?

Comments
The course was organized very nicely, and Prof Pieters tried her best to help us understand the materials. She is always really helpful in her office hours.
She is just an incredible proffessor. She is really motivated to make you understand economics and why it is important.
Just lectures and posting lectures online, which was nice.
Professor Pieters always makes lectures interesting.
Professor Pieters always goes beyond in explaining the concept but also the intuition and potential applications.
Good lecturer
The QREs
the lecture slides were really detailed
Pieters' class policies were outlined extremely clearly and allowed me to plan my workload. Posting the slides beforehand.
I have had this instructor a few times, and she is able to teach very dense material through real world applications in a way I haven't seen many times.
Professor Pieters is probably the BEST Econ instructor I have had so far. She strives to ensure students get not only theoretical knowledge but know how to apply it in all walks of Econ. I really appreciate her having papers as the main mode of assessment instead of exams because I got invaluable experience researching and writing in economics. The course overall was just so organised that I never felt lost and knew exactly what was going on at all times.
explain slides materials
The fact that this course had an incredible focus, one could maybe argue at times excessively, on the assumptions that a certain model was making and when we could drop these assumptions. While some students might view this as boring, I loved this. I felt that my knowledge of the model was richer and so when it came to mapping a policy to the model, I had a good idea of the "story" I had to create to see certain types of results and the extent that I could interpret those results.
Lectures were very informative and well organized
Lectures were great. Gina is very helpful and a fun professor to have.
interesting responses, well informed on current events and how they apply to class material, in depth answers, cared about her students. Actually wanted the information we learned about to influence our lives and future job prospects. Every document she gave us for work was VERY thorough and gave multiple opportunities throughout the quarter to provide more information. TAKE HER COURSE
very thorough
Great at responding to questions and strong lectures

What could the instructor modify to help you learn more?

Comments
Nothing.
(2/2) the entirety of the class structure. When I started the course, I thought it was neat that there would be only essays and homeworks (and other related grading components). And even better is that you're allowed to group with as many people as you want for homeworks. Also essays had no late penalty! But. 1. The homeworks+in class components deincentivize you to work to the end of the quarter. If you gather enough points, you don't need to do the last two homeworks... which is great grade wise but basically no one works on the last two homeworks or cares about the material. 2. You are at a extreme disadvantage without a group. Since there is no cap for homework group sizes, there are groups of 10+ students who just do half a question each for the homework, while others are stuck going solo. 3. Having no essay deadlines (and then say that you must turn it in by a certain date for specific essays or else they aren't 'guaranteed' to be graded) 4. Having this very complicated grading system that was intended to benefit students but as far as me and classmates can tell should just be broken into traditional percentage categories NOTE: Pieters is a great person and lecturer. But as a professor of a course I would definitely not recommend people to take her for policy just because of the class structure. And it can be argued that a lot of the things that are 'wrong' are simply up to the students' discretion (go to class, do your homeworks due diligence, turn in papers as soon as possible...) but if you were a student of this class you would also likely feel frustrated from how unconventional it's structured.
More engaging material during lectures — just reading off gets repetitive.
help on setting up papers
Perhaps the lecture slides themselves could be made a bit clearer, with consistent headlines and connecting body text. This would've been helpful since I found that while the slides were followable in lecture, it was quite difficult to see how equations related to one another when reviewing them in post.
Nothing
probably move a bit slower
Nothing, course was structured amazingly.
I think it would have been helpful to go over examples about modifying models for a specific policy in class so that we could go through the process together. Also want to say I so appreciate how respectful Professor Pieters was of students' mental health and personal situations by being flexible on assignment deadlines!
Nothing comes to mind.
Keep being awesome.
n/a

The Instructor . . .

	Mean	Median	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree	N/A
Organized the course clearly.	4.76	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	4.00%	16.00%	80.00%	0.00%
Presented lectures that enhanced your understanding.	4.68	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	12.00%	8.00%	80.00%	0.00%
Facilitated discussions that were engaging and useful.	4.48	5.00	0.00%	4.00%	12.00%	16.00%	68.00%	0.00%
Stimulated your interest in the core ideas of the course.	4.36	5.00	4.00%	4.00%	8.00%	20.00%	64.00%	0.00%
Challenged you to learn.	4.68	5.00	0.00%	4.00%	0.00%	20.00%	76.00%	0.00%
Helped you gain significant learning from the course content.	4.52	5.00	4.00%	4.00%	0.00%	20.00%	72.00%	0.00%
Was available and helpful outside of class.	4.76	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	4.00%	16.00%	80.00%	0.00%
Motivated you to think independently.	4.64	5.00	0.00%	4.00%	0.00%	24.00%	72.00%	0.00%
Worked to create an inclusive and welcoming learning environment.	4.72	5.00	0.00%	4.00%	4.00%	8.00%	84.00%	0.00%
Overall, this instructor made a significant contribution to your learning.	4.56	5.00	0.00%	4.00%	4.00%	24.00%	68.00%	0.00%

What aspects of the TA's teaching contributed most to your learning?

Comments
Helpful for questions
none
N/A

What could the TA modify to help you learn more?

Comments
Na
the TA was very unhelpful. He was never willing to go over homework or papers in depth since he was afraid of giving away answers. he was also not very straightforward during discussions and often rambled.
Discussion sections tended to become very talkative when the information that was actually presented wasn't actually that important. To be blunt, it could seem like a ramble at points. Perhaps I overprepared for the discussion sections, but I didn't feel we reviewed the content in a way that was efficient. My suggesntion would be to have a clear and concise structure of what we will cover, rather than depending/expecting a lot of participation.
Every time talking to a TA is like guessing riddles. They answered whatever question you had in an absurdly vague way. You have to memorize their words, write them down, read and re–read, to finally get a sense of what they were trying to tell you. Please, if you think the question is too direct, just tell me and let me rephrase it, and don't torture us both.

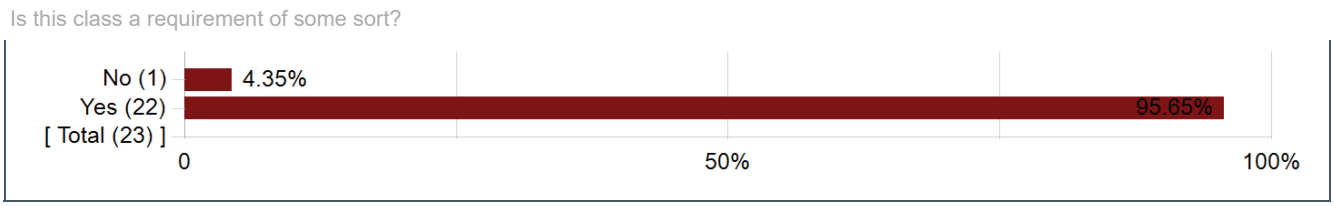
The TA/CA or Intern. . .

	Mean	Median	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree	N/A
Facilitated discussions that supported your learning.	3.33	4.00	7.69%	23.08%	7.69%	38.46%	15.38%	7.69%
Gave you useful feedback on your work.	3.58	4.00	7.69%	7.69%	15.38%	46.15%	15.38%	7.69%
Stimulated your interest in the core ideas of the class.	3.58	4.00	7.69%	7.69%	15.38%	46.15%	15.38%	7.69%
Challenged you to learn.	3.50	4.00	7.69%	7.69%	23.08%	38.46%	15.38%	7.69%
Helped you succeed in the class.	3.67	4.00	7.69%	7.69%	15.38%	38.46%	23.08%	7.69%
Was available and helpful outside of class.	3.92	4.00	0.00%	7.69%	15.38%	46.15%	23.08%	7.69%
Overall, this individual made a significant contribution to your learning.	3.50	4.00	7.69%	15.38%	7.69%	46.15%	15.38%	7.69%

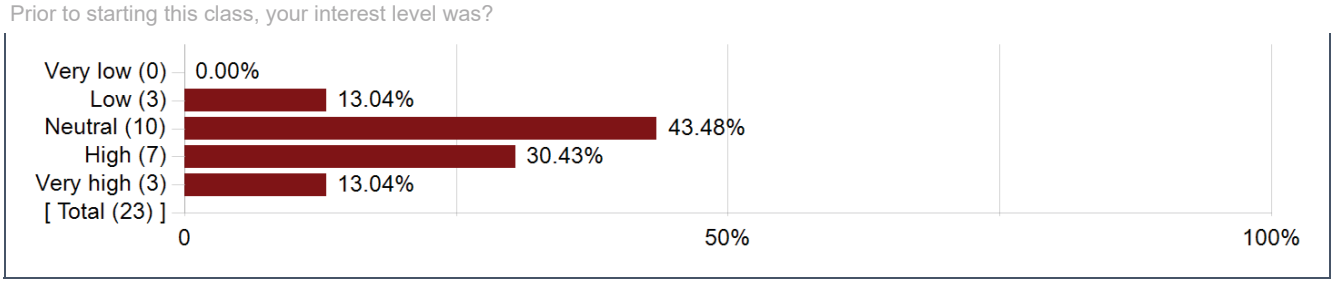
Additional feedback to the TA/CA/Intern:

Comments
N/A

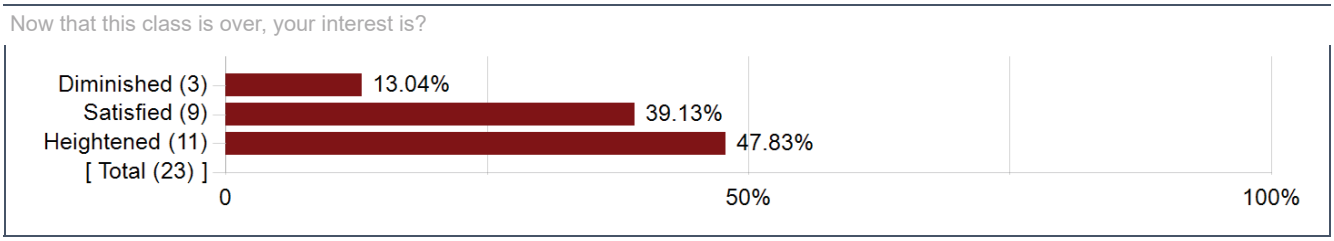
Is this class a requirement of some sort?



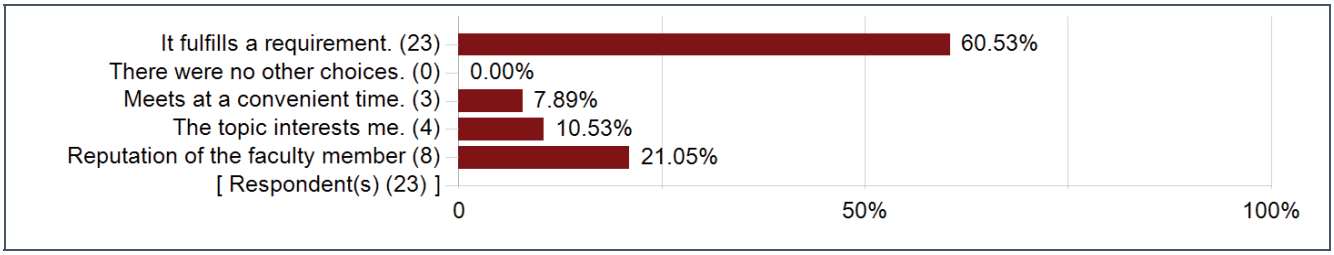
Prior to starting this class, your interest level was?



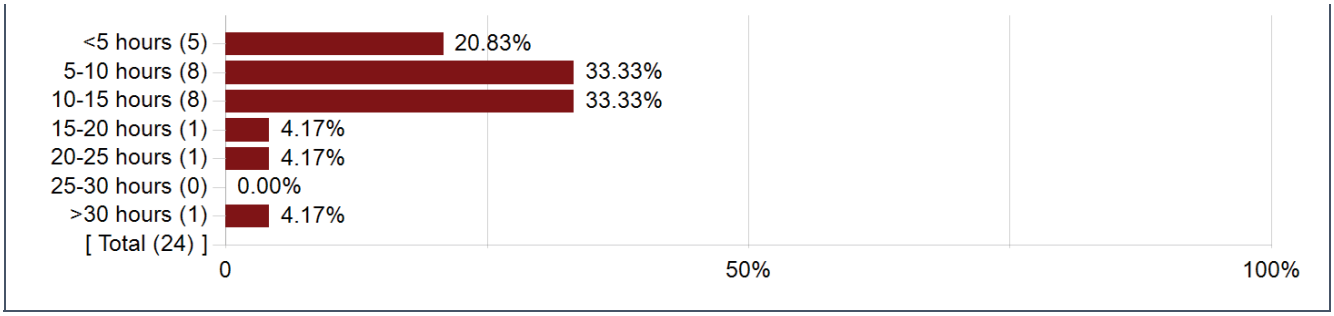
Now that this class is over, your interest is?



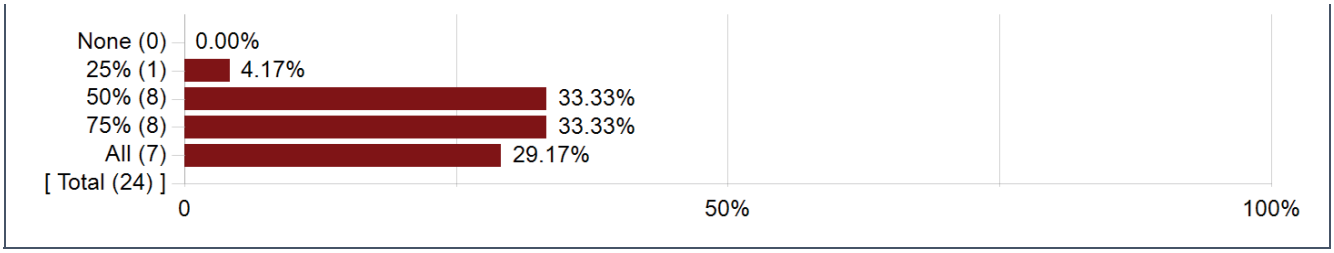
Why did you choose to take this course? (Select all that apply)



How many hours per week outside of attending required sessions did you spend on this course?



What proportion of classes did you attend?



Please comment on the level of difficulty of the course relative to your background and experience.

Comments
it was very unique with papers but difficulty was expected
Very difficult; not sure how I would've gotten through it if we were tested on the material (there were papers and homeworks only)
Very difficult for me since I have limited experience with Matlab
Fair
My background is just the 200 series (non–honors) and principle level classes. The difficulty was very manageable, just focus a lot on your paper which means also focusing on learning the intuition behind a model, and you can succeed in the class (note: this class had no exams, you aren't expected to memorize every detail. Take advantage of this!).
This class was difficult, but expectations were reasonable
Problem sets were totally fine compared to the 200s. Writing papers was long and pretty difficult, but Gina was very accomadating.
Course material itself was not too difficult compared to ECON 20200 but the class moved very quickly
The first part of the course is basically ECON 202 stuffs. The second part – the monetary part – however, gets really weird because the models are too off from the reality and it was a real pain to try to analyze policies with these models.
Difficult. But expectations were reasonable. Pieters makes the course very fair.
pretty hard, but also because i was unable to attend class. should be much better if u attend class

THE UNIVERSITY OF CHICAGO

ECON 17110 1 - International Monetary Systems - Instructor(s): Gina Pieters

Project Title: **College Course Feedback - Winter 2022**

Number Enrolled: **46**
Number of Responses: **14**

Report Comments

Opinions expressed in these evaluations are those of students enrolled in the specific course and do not represent the University.

Creation Date: **Monday, April 4, 2022**

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What are the most important things that you learned in this course? Please reflect on the knowledge and skills you gained.

Comments
How exchange rates are determined, impact of monetary policy on macroeconomy
n/a
International trade, exchange rates, monetary policy.
I learned how monetary policy and exogenous shocks can affect global economics.
Exchange rates, monetary policies, inflations, and currencies.
How international monetary systems affect one another and theories for how to interpret macroeconomic events.
Effects of monetary policy, modeling recessions, how exchange rates are interdependent, etc.
How international markets work with each other, exchange rates, capital flight, pegs, interest rates
It's just an excellent summary of the topic.

Describe how aspects of this course (lectures, discussions, labs, assignments, etc.) contributed to your learning.

Comments
QREs were very helpful
n/a
Lectures move fast but the daily QREs, lecture summaries, slides, and practice problems are really helpful to reinforce information.
Lectures were great; the QREs kept students engaged in a low–stakes way.
The lectures were really organized and I especially like Professor Pieters' slides.
Lectures and lecture slides were very helpful in following the content. QRE's (one question we discuss in each class) and homework assignments were very helpful in concretizing knowledge from lecture.
The lectures were very organized and clear, making the concepts very digestible.
Lectures were helpful, assignments were useful.
There's no real textbook so the material is introduced in lectures, clarified in the practice problems, and tested in the homework assignments.

Please respond to the following:

	Mean	Median	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
This course challenged me intellectually.	4.57	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	42.86%	57.14%
I understood the purpose of this course and what I was expected to gain from it.	4.50	4.50	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	50.00%	50.00%
I understood the standards for success on assignments.	4.64	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	35.71%	64.29%
Class time enhanced my ability to succeed in graded assignments.	4.50	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	7.14%	35.71%	57.14%
I received feedback on my performance that helped me improve my subsequent work.	4.57	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	42.86%	57.14%
My work was evaluated fairly.	4.64	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	35.71%	64.29%
I felt respected in this class.	4.64	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	35.71%	64.29%
Overall, this was an excellent course.	4.29	4.50	0.00%	7.14%	7.14%	35.71%	50.00%

Additional comments about the course:

Comments
just really boring and not useful for most
It was very well–organized, and I learned a lot.
Probably the best course I've taken at UChicago.
I think it's an excellent course, I love Gina and appreciate how seriously she takes the task of having us truly understand the material

I would recommend this course to:

	No	Yes
Highly-motivated and well-prepared students	7.14%	92.86%
Anyone interested in the topic	0.00%	100.00%

Thinking about your time in the class, what aspect of the instructor's teaching contributed most to your learning?

Comments
QREs
slides
Prof. Pieters is very open to feedback, gave lots of resources, and was always willing to answer questions and explain things in different ways. Her expectations for assignments were always very clear.
Prof Pieters gave very thorough lectures and had extremely detailed presentations and was really flexible with remote learning as well.
She clearly explained concepts in lecture, and her assignments (like the QREs) helped to reinforce our understanding of class concepts.
The slides, examples, use of QRE
Professor Pieters is fantastic! She is clearly knowledgeable about the topic and I really appreciated when she took the time to discuss the war in Ukraine and connect it to topic we had just been talking about in class. She's a great lecturer and happy to answer questions to help clarify any concepts.
Gina is one of the most organized professors I've had. This made it very easy to review the material, especially in preparation for the final.
She was very clear from the beginning.
All of it, Gina is a great instructor. The in–class Quick Response Exercises facilitated discussion among the students.

What could the instructor modify to help you learn more?

Comments
More detailed explanations in homework answers
n/a
Recorded lectures were great since it's hard to catch everything the first time and I'd go back over them– please continue to record lectures even with a return to in–person classes.
Sometimes Professor Pieters goes over the content very fast, so I hope she could slow down a little because there are a lot of materials in this course.
n/a
Pieters cares a lot about her students, but she is very focused in her rules, so don't expect any freebies. Sometimes she explained concepts a little more confusing than they needed to be
Nothing, Prof Pieters is amazing! Her syllabus is so in depth and her expectations are very clear.

The Instructor . . .

	Mean	Median	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree	N/A
Organized the course clearly.	4.57	5.00	0.00%	7.14%	0.00%	21.43%	71.43%	0.00%
Presented lectures that enhanced your understanding.	4.64	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	35.71%	64.29%	0.00%
Facilitated discussions that were engaging and useful.	4.57	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	42.86%	57.14%	0.00%
Stimulated your interest in the core ideas of the course.	4.38	5.00	0.00%	7.69%	0.00%	38.46%	53.85%	0.00%
Challenged you to learn.	4.79	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	21.43%	78.57%	0.00%
Helped you gain significant learning from the course content.	4.50	5.00	0.00%	7.14%	0.00%	28.57%	64.29%	0.00%
Was available and helpful outside of class.	4.50	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	7.14%	35.71%	57.14%	0.00%
Motivated you to think independently.	4.57	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	42.86%	57.14%	0.00%
Worked to create an inclusive and welcoming learning environment.	4.57	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	7.14%	28.57%	64.29%	0.00%
Overall, this instructor made a significant contribution to your learning.	4.50	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	7.14%	35.71%	57.14%	0.00%

Please include the name of the TA/CA/Intern you are evaluating. What aspects of the TA's teaching contributed most to your learning? What could the TA modify to help you learn more? Please include any additional feedback for the TA/CA/Intern.

Comments
He was great! Very helpful during discussion section
Yuchen was extremely helpful and took his time to really explain concept to us.
Yuchen Du was amazing, and he is super patient when explaining concepts.
Yuchen is AMAZING! He was so so helpful in breaking down complicated concepts during discussion section and helped me understand homework questions without giving away the answer. One of my favorite TA's at UChicago!
Yuchen. I never went to discussion but he seemed like a nice person.
Yuchen
Yuchen was a good TA, his office hours were generally quite helpful.

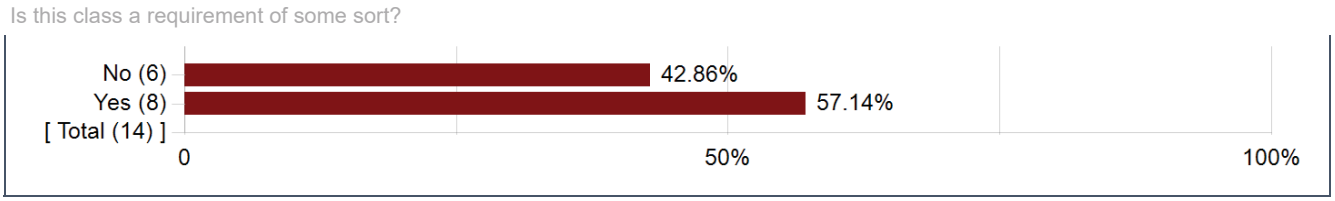
The TA/CA or Intern. . .

	Mean	Median	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree	N/A
Facilitated discussions that supported your learning.	4.22	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	20.00%	30.00%	40.00%	10.00%
Gave you useful feedback on your work.	4.33	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	20.00%	20.00%	50.00%	10.00%
Stimulated your interest in the core ideas of the class.	4.11	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	30.00%	20.00%	40.00%	10.00%
Challenged you to learn.	4.14	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	20.00%	20.00%	30.00%	30.00%
Helped you succeed in the class.	4.22	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	20.00%	30.00%	40.00%	10.00%
Was available and helpful outside of class.	4.38	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	20.00%	10.00%	50.00%	20.00%
Overall, this individual made a significant contribution to your learning.	4.11	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	30.00%	20.00%	40.00%	10.00%

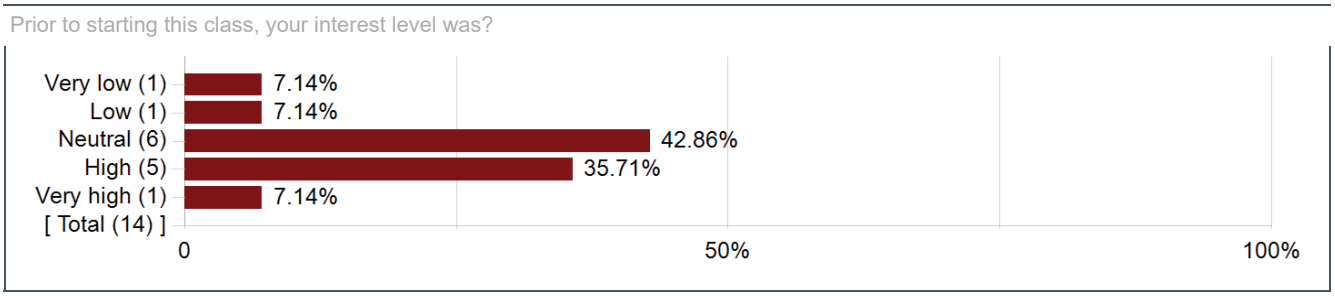
How much did the following elements of the course contribute to your learning gains?

	Mean	Median	No Gain	A Little Gain	Moderate Gain	Good Gain	Great Gain	N/A
Laboratory Experience	N/A	N/A	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	100.00%
Field Trips	N/A	N/A	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	100.00%
Library Sessions	N/A	N/A	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	100.00%
Review Sessions	1.00	1.00	100.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%
Writing Seminars	N/A	N/A	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	100.00%

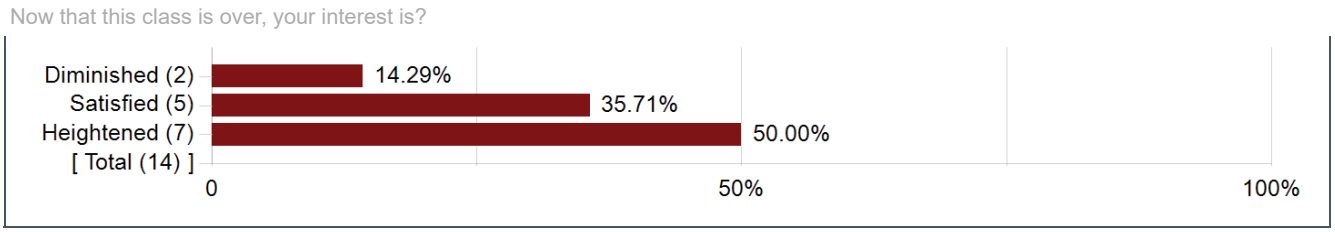
Is this class a requirement of some sort?



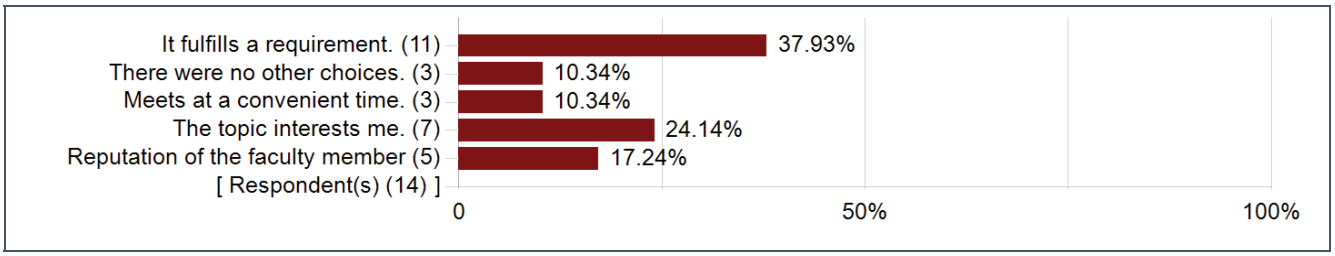
Prior to starting this class, your interest level was?



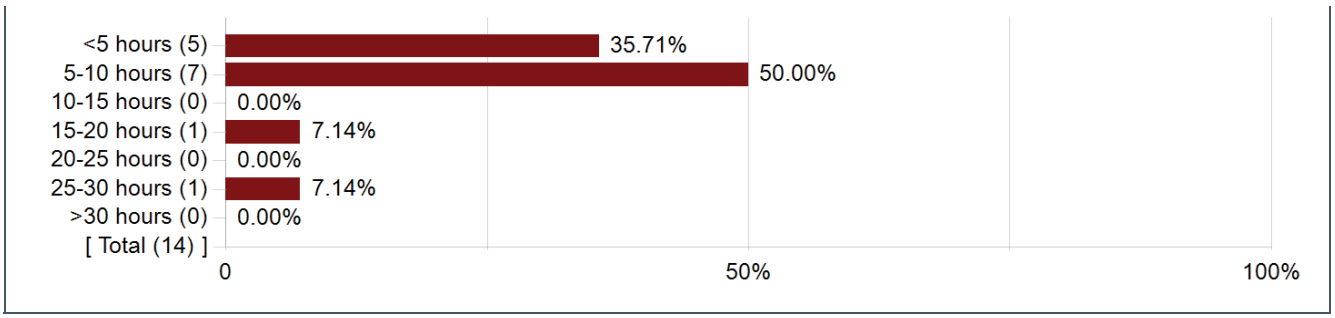
Now that this class is over, your interest is?



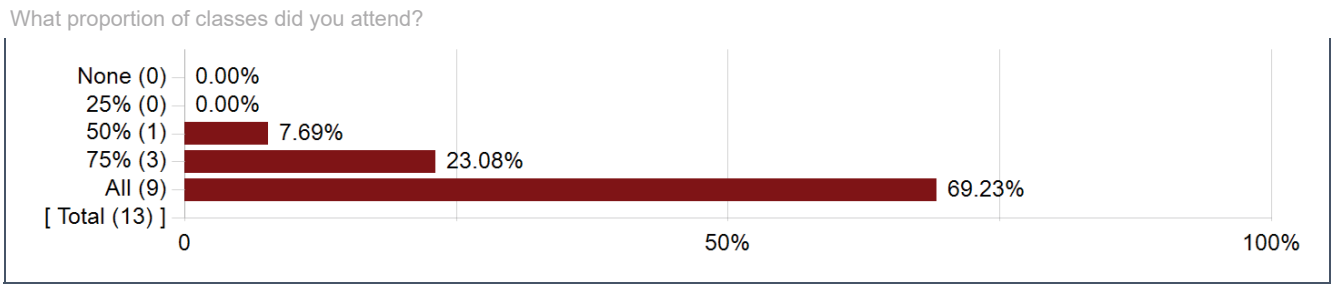
Why did you choose to take this course? (Select all that apply)



How many hours per week outside of attending required sessions did you spend on this course?



What proportion of classes did you attend?



Please comment on the level of difficulty of the course relative to your background and experience.

Comments
Fast–paced at times
Pretty challenging, unlike other economics classes I've taken and requires some background knowledge of macro.
A little confusing initially, but ultimately not too difficult
The class was not very difficult. I think the prof did a good job making it accessible to business econ majors.
Pretty hard, not an easy elective
Pretty doable.

THE UNIVERSITY OF CHICAGO

ECON 20200 1 - The Elements of Economic Analysis III - Instructor(s): Gina Pieters

Project Title: **College Course Feedback - Winter 2022**

Number Enrolled: **42**
Number of Responses: **20**

Report Comments

Opinions expressed in these evaluations are those of students enrolled in the specific course and do not represent the University.

Creation Date: **Monday, April 4, 2022**

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What are the most important things that you learned in this course? Please reflect on the knowledge and skills you gained.

Comments
macroeconomics concepts and applications
A lot
review of econ 201 gen eq, macroeconomic models (economic growth and business cycles), bond/equity market, money, theory vs data
Different economic models and how to solve them
Basic macroeconomic analysis.
The fundamental tools needed to analyze macroeconomic behavior. Topics included solow growth model, endogenous growth model, neoclassical growth model, lifetime budget constraint and permanent income hypothesis, business cycle modeling, asset pricing, bond markets, cash–in–advance model to analyze inflation impacts on consumption, and baumil–tobin model.
How to micro–found macro models using concepts we learned in Econ 200 and 201, e.g. decentralized competitive market, production functions, utility functions, Lagrangians. We then moved on to macro models like Business Cycle Model, Neoclassical growth, cash in advance, Baumol Tobin. A lot of stuff packed into 9 weeks
Lagrangians
I learned the foundations of macroeconomic theory by constructing macroeconomic models from microeconomic concepts, and how to use MATLAB to work with macroeconomic data.
Econ Models, Macroeconomic idea.
Model manipulation, general concepts surrounding bonds, inflation, business cycles, etc.
how to represent a real–world situation in an economic model, evolution of economic models over time
Economic models and macro thinking
Manipulating economic models
Setting up langrangians.

Describe how aspects of this course (lectures, discussions, labs, assignments, etc.) contributed to your learning.

Comments
lecture is excellent
Lectures, QREs, everything!
lectures, homeworks, practice problems
The QRE's were really helpful in encouraging me to go to class and reinforcing my understanding of concepts as we were learning them
While there were lots of materials, I felt like the way it was taught was either too compressed or glossed over concepts that were harder than expected.
I thought lectures were fantastic. Many of my friends didn't like how she refrained from going through every step of an algebraic derivation — I actually found this to be a perk of the course, since it saved her more time to focus on explaining intuition rather than doing algebra. The pset structure was AWESOME! I really enjoyed having a max cap of 40 points and having the flexibility to pick which problems to do. This eased a ton of pressure off during particularly stressful weeks. I also really enjoyed the quiz format for assessments vs a midterm. Studying only 2 weeks worth of material at a time was very doable. In fact, by the time the final came, I felt like I didn't have to reteach myself old concepts. I thought the quizzes were well designed also — they tested mastery of concepts instead of replication of what was done in class. You had to truly understand what you were doing to score well on the quizzes. If you just knew how to do the homework, that wouldn't be good enough, and I really enjoyed this aspect of the course. I feel like I learned so much from this course. Lastly, Pieters clearly cares immensely about providing abundant resources for us to succeed. There were plentiful practice problems for us to practice. THE TOPIC SUMMARIES ARE GREAT! Also, ed discussion was a fantastic way to ask questions.
Lectures were the main source of learning but Homework helped give us practice with Lagrangians
Lots of resources on canvas to use
Instruction was done mostly through lectures, which were helpful and informative. The biweekly problem sets and quizzes allowed me to ensure my understanding of the material.
Assignments helped me solidify the mathematics touched upon during lectures.
Homework, practice problems, and weekly quizzes were all helpful.
The lectures and assignments were helpful for understanding
Discussions helped with homework sometimes, practice problems were the most helpful, homework was harder than the quizzes.
Lectures and all the material she uploaded.

Please respond to the following:

	Mean	Median	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
This course challenged me intellectually.	4.74	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	5.26%	15.79%	78.95%
I understood the purpose of this course and what I was expected to gain from it.	4.47	5.00	5.26%	0.00%	0.00%	31.58%	63.16%
I understood the standards for success on assignments.	4.10	4.50	5.00%	10.00%	5.00%	30.00%	50.00%
Class time enhanced my ability to succeed in graded assignments.	4.35	5.00	5.00%	0.00%	10.00%	25.00%	60.00%
I received feedback on my performance that helped me improve my subsequent work.	4.40	5.00	5.00%	0.00%	5.00%	30.00%	60.00%
My work was evaluated fairly.	4.10	4.50	5.00%	10.00%	5.00%	30.00%	50.00%
I felt respected in this class.	4.47	5.00	5.26%	5.26%	0.00%	15.79%	73.68%
Overall, this was an excellent course.	4.32	5.00	5.26%	0.00%	15.79%	15.79%	63.16%

Additional comments about the course:

Comments
Incredibly hard grading. Would recommend the professor, however, take this class in sequence when your classmates aren't either dropping the class or spending far too much time on it.
I warn any student taking a course with pieters that it is very hard to score well. Her quizzes are very, very difficult, and most likely, only about 10–15% of students will end up with an A– or above. That said, she is a fantastic instructor, and you will learn a ton. I absolutely loved this course, and will probably end with a B/B+ myself. Absolutely worth it.
The course is very well structured + standards are super clear (grade boundaries/curve are updated and published every two weeks). It is pretty intense and information–heavy, so try to take a lighter courseload when taking it.
N/a
I wish it was made more interesting but information was presented in a dry manner and did not feel particularly engaging when the subject seemed like it would be a more interesting topic (macroeconomics).
Holy moly this class was difficult because it covers a lot of ground really quickly — reviewing material before and after class pays off and makes lecture more meaningful. this is not a backseat kind of class.
MatLab section was super rushed so that affected outlook on the rest of the course.

I would recommend this course to:

	No	Yes
Highly-motivated and well-prepared students	0.00%	100.00%
Anyone interested in the topic	33.33%	66.67%

Thinking about your time in the class, what aspect of the instructor's teaching contributed most to your learning?

Comments
lecture and QRE
The interaction with students and ability to clearly answer any question
great lectures, slides. always happy to take questions and answered them very well
clear explanations of theoretical concepts and demonstration of how they map out in data/realworld
The professor was very helpful during QRE's
Explanations and original videos prior to lectures were incredibly helpful.
Lectures, psets, practice problems, TOPIC SUMMARIES,
Prof Pieters is extremely organized; she's on top of everything from discussion boards, to grading, to teaching slides (aside from the odd error or technology malfunction). She's also always willing to dive deeper into the course material if you are curious.
The instructor was clear at explaining concepts and demonstrating how to solve the types of problems that would appear on problem sets and quizzes.
QRE's helped me understand and engage with other students in a low stakes but still pressured environment which i think was supremely helpful for everybody's learning. Going through problems in class then giving the answer and talking though everyone's ideas and illustrating the correct way to go about things was enlightening and the most informative period of the class.
The number of example problems (even though they were often hard to follow due to errors in problems/answer keys and the overwhelming array of variables used) included in homework, class slides, practice problems, and topic summaries were nice
qres. professor provides a lot of outside resources for you to succeed which are extremely helpful
In class lecture, rewatching lectures
Although the professor goes over most of the material in class, you have to study them yourselves a lot.

What could the instructor modify to help you learn more?

Comments
more lenient grading on final letter grade
Not much... maybe have topics explored in class that week and quizzes topics for that same week be the same
slow down on explaining slides sometimes (i.e. information density)
I think potentially more QRE's could be helpful
Do practice problems on the board. Make in class assignments where we knew what we were doing on the homework.
For the quizzes, give us more space for the more mathematically intense questions. Also, for free response and TFU questions, could you please state in the question all the areas of focus we should touch on? An example should be the following "How does an increase does an increase in productivity affect affect hours worked in an economy? For full credit, you must discuss general equilibrium impacts, consumer behavior impacts, and the effects on prices. If there are no effects on any of these topics, you must say that explicitly and explain." Or something of that sort.
Make the course a little more skewed towards doing the HW? Right now you basically can do half of the HW problems and still get full marks on that portion, but there isn't a lot of room for error on the quizzes (aka exams).
The instructor could have gone a bit more slowly with introducing new material.
Please try to make the slides more engaging and easier to follow as I feel like the slides were not particularly beneficial to my learning and even when I did go to class I had trouble understanding them after the fact reviewing them.
Not focus so much on 200/201 concepts for the beginning of the course and use that time to go over 201 concepts in more depth.
modeling practice problems during class/discussion
Providing a more solid grounding for those who hadn't taken 201/200 with her, slowing down MatLab

The Instructor . . .

	Mean	Median	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree	N/A
Organized the course clearly.	4.47	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	10.53%	31.58%	57.89%	0.00%
Presented lectures that enhanced your understanding.	4.53	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	5.26%	36.84%	57.89%	0.00%
Facilitated discussions that were engaging and useful.	4.68	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	31.58%	68.42%	0.00%
Stimulated your interest in the core ideas of the course.	4.42	5.00	0.00%	5.26%	10.53%	21.05%	63.16%	0.00%
Challenged you to learn.	4.68	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	5.26%	21.05%	73.68%	0.00%
Helped you gain significant learning from the course content.	4.53	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	10.53%	26.32%	63.16%	0.00%
Was available and helpful outside of class.	4.53	5.00	5.26%	0.00%	0.00%	26.32%	68.42%	0.00%
Motivated you to think independently.	4.63	5.00	0.00%	5.26%	0.00%	21.05%	73.68%	0.00%
Worked to create an inclusive and welcoming learning environment.	4.39	5.00	5.56%	0.00%	11.11%	16.67%	66.67%	0.00%
Overall, this instructor made a significant contribution to your learning.	4.47	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	10.53%	31.58%	57.89%	0.00%

Please include the name of the TA/CA/Intern you are evaluating. What aspects of the TA's teaching contributed most to your learning? What could the TA modify to help you learn more? Please include any additional feedback for the TA/CA/Intern.

Comments
Stefano
Stefano
Stefano was awesome, no complaints.
Stefano
Stefano; His discussion sections were always useful as he went through mathematical examples. He also graded stuff pretty quickly.
The TA held discussion sections and office hours to help with our understanding of the class concepts.
stefano bruzzo
Stefano Bruzzo–Gallardo
Was very helpful and engaged.

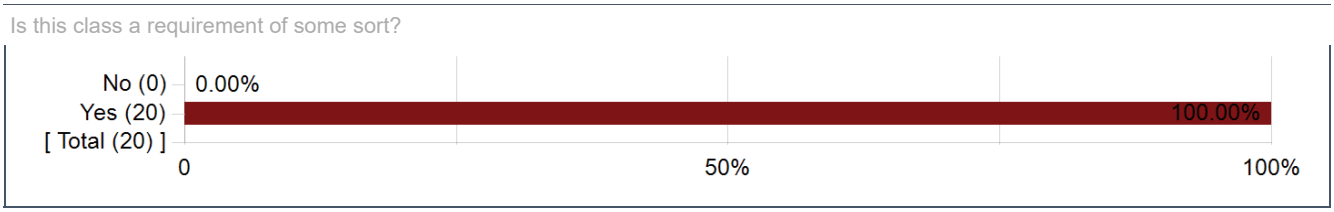
The TA/CA or Intern. . .

	Mean	Median	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree	N/A
Facilitated discussions that supported your learning.	4.25	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	16.67%	41.67%	41.67%	0.00%
Gave you useful feedback on your work.	4.33	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	8.33%	50.00%	41.67%	0.00%
Stimulated your interest in the core ideas of the class.	4.17	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	25.00%	33.33%	41.67%	0.00%
Challenged you to learn.	4.17	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	16.67%	50.00%	33.33%	0.00%
Helped you succeed in the class.	4.17	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	25.00%	33.33%	41.67%	0.00%
Was available and helpful outside of class.	4.42	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	16.67%	25.00%	58.33%	0.00%
Overall, this individual made a significant contribution to your learning.	4.09	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	27.27%	36.36%	36.36%	0.00%

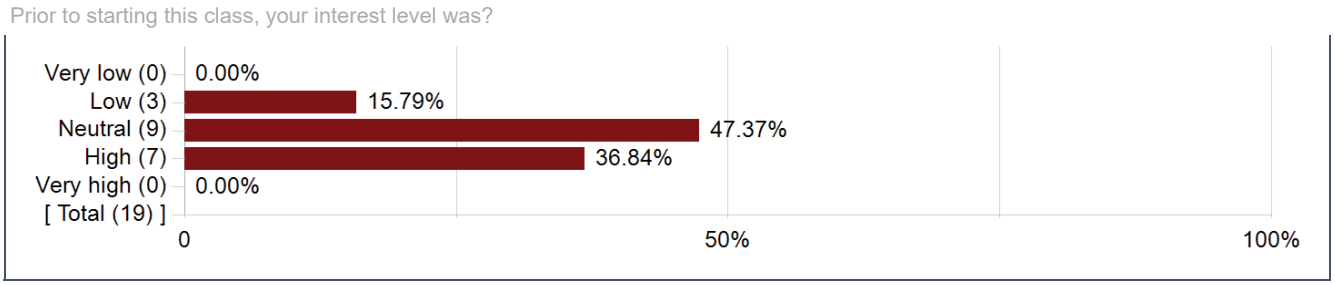
How much did the following elements of the course contribute to your learning gains?

	Mean	Median	No Gain	A Little Gain	Moderate Gain	Good Gain	Great Gain	N/A
Laboratory Experience	N/A	N/A	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	100.00%
Field Trips	N/A	N/A	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	100.00%
Library Sessions	N/A	N/A	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	100.00%
Review Sessions	5.00	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	100.00%	0.00%
Writing Seminars	N/A	N/A	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	100.00%

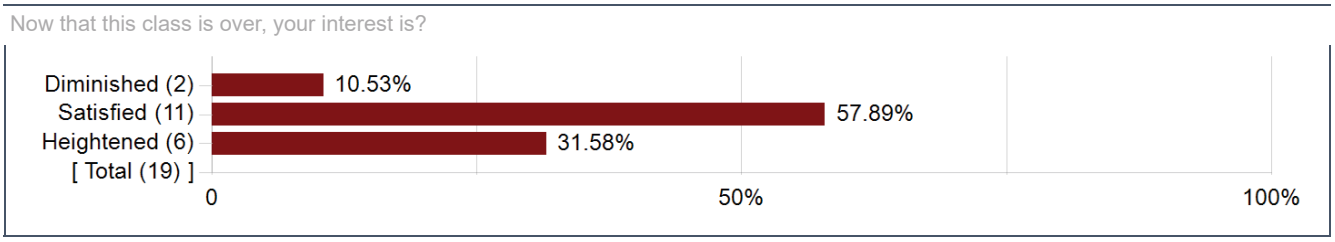
Is this class a requirement of some sort?



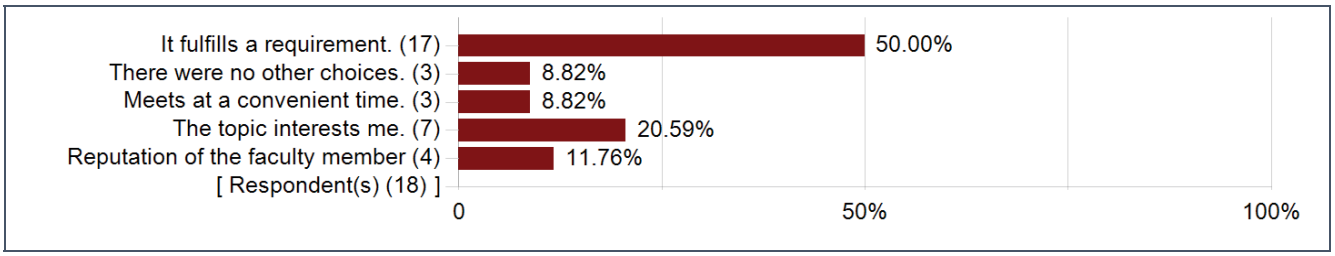
Prior to starting this class, your interest level was?



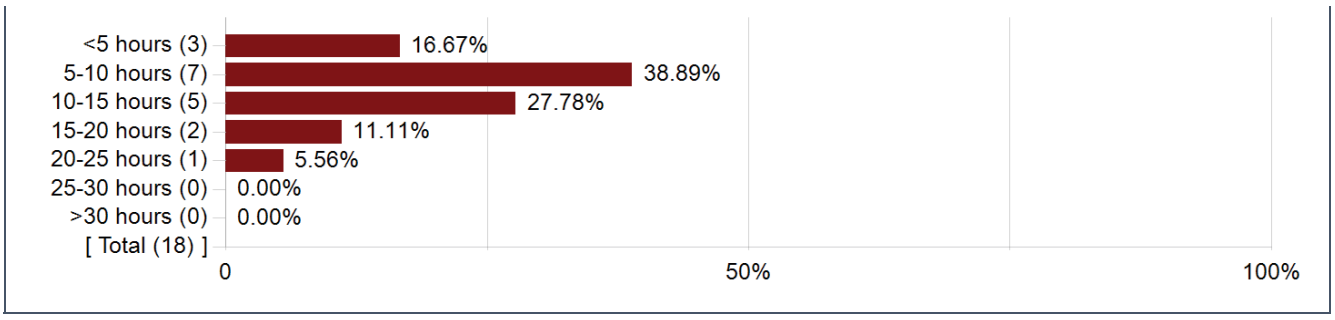
Now that this class is over, your interest is?



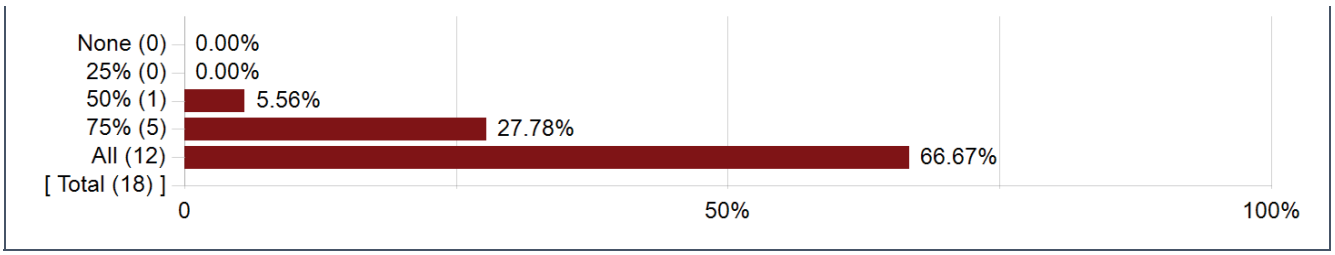
Why did you choose to take this course? (Select all that apply)



How many hours per week outside of attending required sessions did you spend on this course?



What proportion of classes did you attend?



Please comment on the level of difficulty of the course relative to your background and experience.

Comments
hard but manageable
hard course but not crazy
on par
HARD
Took econ 200–201 last year and took math 20300–20500 and abstract lin alg. This class was hard, but manageable.
The material itself isn't too difficult, but it's just a lot + if you haven't taken 200 and 201 in a while you will need to catch up quickly in the first week. Also revise Lagrangians
Difficult
The course was not especially difficult as someone with a reasonably high level of background in the subject.
This class was extremely difficult compared to the other classes in the Econ core and I had an incredibly difficult time as an Econ major engaging with and understanding the material presented.
The first quarter of the course was very difficult because the instructor assumed you retained enough of the information taught in 200/201 for her to breeze by an incredible amount of information and ultimately was very overwhelming. However, for the portion of the course that was material exclusively taught by the professor, it was much easier to grasp and learn the material,
Difficult

ECON 10200 1 - Principles of Macroeconomics - Instructor(s): Gina Pieters

Project Title: **College Course Feedback - Spring 2022**

Number Enrolled: **162**
Number of Responses: **56**

Report Comments

Opinions expressed in these evaluations are those of students enrolled in the specific course and do not represent the University.

Creation Date: **Thursday, August 18, 2022**

What are the most important things that you learned in this course? Please reflect on the knowledge and skills you gained.

Comments
General stuff about Macro. But what I've learned the most is guessing correctly what Prof. Pieters wants for her quizzes. Just guess correctly what she thinks.That's the only way you can succeed. "Open" to different answers is only a white lie. Also, I'm more experienced at subtraction, such as getting 2.75 out of 3. I thanks this class very much for improving my math skills.
General and strong conception of macro economics, large trends, and the US government.
Basic macroeconomic overview with some intersectionality between microeconomics and other concepts.
calculating GDP, supply/demand, monetary/fiscal policy, etc.
I learned about concepts such as GDP and CFD, which are fundamental in macroeconomics. The course also taught me how to apply the knowledge in class to real world situations, inspecting different countries' GDPs and inflation.
This course really tries to make you think like an economist might, by throwing you into the deep–end and hoping you swim. Through this experience I have learned that I am much more capable than I thought, but also still not where I may hope to be. Otherwise, material–wise, this course is a great introduction to Macroeconomics, in a fairly easy to understand manner, just with some difficulty to truly master the material.
lectures
Developing the economics eye, using information given to infer about past or future. AD–AS Diagrams helped a lot.
GDP and government policy
Learned to cram for a test. Learned about basic macroeconomic topics and graphs, as well as models like the money multiplier
I think one of the most important skills I learned from this class is to actually grasp and understand what I am learning rather than just remembering it for a test.
Applications of macro ideas
everything regarding macroeconomics
Most of the basic topics one expects to find in a intro to Macroeconomics course: inflation, unemployment, fiscal policy, GDP... The course also introduced us to some differences between economic schools of thought.
GDP and the impact of policy
There was so much information that I don't even know where to start. I would say I got a decent understanding of how the economy functions overall from a macro standpoint.
How the economy works.
I learned how to interpret economic data to come to a reasonable conclusion.
A comprehensive understanding of how the economy works on a macro–scale.
macroeconomic basics, GDP, inflation, interest rates, unemployment, etc.
General macroeconomics ideas/concepts
Macroeconomics
How to think through economic problems and apply economic concepts, particularly how to analyze graphs and apply scenarios to AD–AS diagrams.
Introductory and intermediary concepts of macroeconomics, Key differences between macroeconomic schools of thought, the variability of the economy that goes beyond classroom knowledge, distinctions between macroeconomic and microeconomic concepts.
monetary policy and fiscal policy
Every concept builds on each other
The Principles of Macroeconomics sums it up. If you have ever wondered how thee big picture works, this is the class for you.
how the economy exists on a macro–level, and the different factors that influence it
Interpreting macroeconomic data & concepts
How to think like an economist
Learned a lot about macroeconomics.
Understanding the financial markets and economies at a macroeconomic level
I learned about macro but it was hard to learn under the immense stress the class provided.
How economics work in the world as a big picture.

Describe how aspects of this course (lectures, discussions, labs, assignments, etc.) contributed to your learning.

Comments
Practice Problems, lectures
Lectures are extremely well presented and the TAs are very helpful in their discussion sections.
Mainly lecture based with homework and daily questions to further facilitate understanding.
lectures were very helpful and filled with valuable information
The lectures were most helpful, as they contributed to the bulk of my learning. The discussion sections reviewed the class material and quizzes.
Lectures along with the practice problems are the two most important factors for learning the material in this course. Discussion sections, while somewhat helpful, felt like the time would be better spent working on something else. Homework assignments were a little better, but also included a lot that didn't matter when it came to quizzes.
lectures and canvas
Practice problems and Topic summaries helped a lot
lectures were good but long
Lectures were somewhat useful for learning the material. Homework was not useful at all
This is mainly lecture–focused with discussion sections adding additional studying of content and weekly quizzes. The majority of learning was in class, emphasizing doing homework ahead of time and coming to discussions or during office hours with questions.
Homeworks, while so difficult I couldn't even finish them half the time, were a good tool of application.
lectures helped a little bit, but what mainly helped was homework and practice problems
Lectures were extremely informative and comprehensive, and did a great job in presenting the topics. TA sessions and practice problems helped us prepare for quizzes and go deeper into each topic.
Lectures were not particularly helpful, and the homeworks did not particularly correlate to quizzes
Lectures were necessary to attend to be successful.
All aspects helped me learn.
The class had 3 parts: lecture, homework, and quiz/review session. The lecture was important and somewhat necessary, I had to attend the quiz/review session.
Lectures were well–organized and clear. I really appreciated the topic summaries and class recordings so that I could review anything I missed in lecture, and I though practice problems were extremely helpful in making sure I understood the topic.
The lectures and discussion sections were informative and covered a large amount of material without being too much. Also the recordings of class lectures were immensely helpful in that they allowed for me to review the material multiple times before quizzes.
lectures and practice problems (hw, etc)
The lectures were helpful in explaining the content, the homework and practice problems were helpful in practicing the content, but the discussion sections (the ones when we did have tests on those days) were not very helpful.
Lectures were clear and followable and provided all the necessary information, while discussions reviewed difficult problems and offered an opportunity to check understanding. Homework and practice problems were relevant and helped develop both analytical skills and conceptual knowledge. QREs checked base understanding and required the development of quick logical thinking skills, which prepared me for the quizzes.
I found that office hours and the homework assignments were most helpful to me in grasping the material.
lectures and homework
My peers and the practice problems helped the most
lectures and slides were VERY helpful and clear. Pieters explained everything thoroughly and slides were great to refer back to for exams. The practice problems posted were also immensely helpful in preparing for quizzes
Lectures were the most helpful. Structured clearly.
The lectures provided the content we needed to understand without having to read anything else
Discussions were not very useful. Likewise, homework assignments were over odd subjects. Lectures were most useful for understanding.
Classes were helpful + QREs forced me to apply the knowledge I acquired in class
The lectures were less useful than if you just read through the slides and did the homework/practice problems.
I liked the lectures and how they were recorded for me to view later.

Please respond to the following:

	Mean	Median	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
This course challenged me intellectually.	4.56	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	5.45%	32.73%	61.82%
I understood the purpose of this course and what I was expected to gain from it.	4.07	4.00	0.00%	14.55%	5.45%	38.18%	41.82%
I understood the standards for success on assignments.	3.72	4.00	3.70%	12.96%	20.37%	33.33%	29.63%
Class time enhanced my ability to succeed in graded assignments.	3.89	4.00	1.89%	13.21%	16.98%	30.19%	37.74%
I received feedback on my performance that helped me improve my subsequent work.	3.72	4.00	3.70%	11.11%	22.22%	35.19%	27.78%
My work was evaluated fairly.	3.70	4.00	5.56%	11.11%	18.52%	37.04%	27.78%
I felt respected in this class.	4.09	4.00	1.85%	11.11%	7.41%	35.19%	44.44%
Overall, this was an excellent course.	3.76	4.00	3.70%	7.41%	27.78%	31.48%	29.63%

Additional comments about the course:

Comments
It's okay but is totally unnecessary for those who choose the standard track, especially with an unnecessarily harsh and unfair answer keys for quizzes.
It can be challenging if students arrive unprepared.
Teacher and TA's are terrible
Given the fact that this is an introductory course, I wish we moved a little bit slower and the quizzes were a little less expansive and a little more closely related to what I expected based on material from homework and practice problems.
An excellent course, with great professor and TAs.
One of the worst classes I have taken
Great teacher but hard course.
not like sanderson economics, very different grading style and a lot harsher
I'm not sure whether there will be another section to address this, but the grading system gives you no incentive to do homework/in–class work halfway through the class. Because of this, it almost felt insulting when we were repeatedly offered extra credit opportunities on HW and In–class assignments which would make almost no difference to our grade.
this course may seen like a low time commitment given that it's just quizzes and not exams — don't be fooled, the quizzes do require a lot of studying and a solid understanding of the material in order to succeed, so be careful and don't write this off as an "easy" course just because it's principls
do not take
The biggest problem I saw was that the professor sent out a survey for the students to anonymously provide their thoughts/opinions and then chose to read out peoples answers in front of the whole class (~200 people). She would then tear apart the students' responses and other students in the audience would laugh at the responses. I did not fill out the survey and I'm glad I did not because I would not have wanted to be ridiculed in front of my class. I feel sorry for the kids whose honest responses were publicly torn apart. Additionally, the way the quizzes are graded/structured changed from each quiz. Specifically the final felt very unstructured as it was cumulative but macro economics itself builds on itself so the final had a lot of vague questions that could have applied to multiple macro topics instead of being a clear topic (example: expansionary fiscal policy versus expansionary monetary policy). Furthermore, a large section of the practice problems were math based when in reality the quizzes had maybe one math problem. I felt that this did not help prepare me for the reality of the questions on the quizzes.

I would recommend this course to:

	No	Yes
Highly-motivated and well-prepared students	7.69%	92.31%
Anyone interested in the topic	25.00%	75.00%

Thinking about your time in the class, what aspect of the instructor's teaching contributed most to your learning?

Comments
Her confidence about herself teaches me how important self–esteem is for a person. Her demanding standards on her students teaches me about the reality of the world. She helps me mature: you cannot expect everyone you meet to be as kind and understanding as you've met when you're a kid. Tick, tick, tick, tedium is worst pain.
Clearly and concisely explains concepts and will further explain if confused
Engagement with questions and students.
posting topic sheets for review before quizzes
Professor Pieters recorded lectures, which was nice to look back to when reviewing for quizzes. She also tried to keep the class engaging by incorporating QREs (class problems) into class time.
The instructor taking time out of her lecturing to answer questions about the material was very helpful.
lectures with suplemental graphs
Lectures are kind of boring and make me want to fall asleep. Just look at the slides and topics on your own time.
QRE
Nothing, tries to show off her intelligence to a base level class, just overall couldn't explain things in a clear manner, excess information with a LOT of spelling and grammar errors that makes it hard to understand and learn.
Not really much. Her lectures are pretty dry, not the worst though.
I think that the homework and problem sets helped the most.
Professor Pieters is a very good teacher and what I noticed she does that not many other professors do is never rush a certain topic. Some days we would barely get through the lecture, but she made it a point to thoroughly go through the ins and outs of understanding a certain aspect of macroeconomics instead of just telling us what it is and expecting us to know it all.
The fact that the quizzes were impossible to succeed in contributed well to failing the class.
QREs
Her clarity, allied to the detailed and comprehensive power point presentations.
N/A
She was good at answering specific questions and presenting helpful information.
Office hours
I think she did a great job providing notes(Topic Summary & Slides Notes), and practice problems. During class, she did a great job of answering questions and demonstrating her knowledge of the material.
Thorough and well thought out/digestible explanation of complicated and unfamiliar material.
lectures and practice problems
Having the lecture slide available online
Slides
The organization of the class was excellent. Lectures were not too complex or demanding, and the quizzes focused on important topics and skills, not just raw memorization ability.
I found Professor Pieters' office hours sessions to be very helpful, at times more helpful than the TA discussion sections.
lectures
Organization
The slides and lectures were very thorough and clear
H
Her teaching did not contribute to my learning. Only the slides and practice problems that were posted online.
The lectures were easy to follow and understandable.
lectures, practice problems

What could the instructor modify to help you learn more?

Comments
How can a professor with such confidence have flaws? It is unbearable to say she has anything bad.
Not include material that is too accelerated for this course.
Clarity of what is expected through assignments. Can be difficult to parse at times.
slow down and make powerpoints less dense! the slides are filled way to0 much with information and are hard to follow when filled with lots of text.
I found myself overwhelmed by the number of quizzes in the class. While I understand she drops the lowest two quiz grades, it was still a lot tostudy for. Also, I wish the homework and QRE grade components were bigger.
To help me learn more, the professor could manage time a little better, and thus not speed through the last portion of what seems like every lecture.
more real life applications of the theory
Teach more linearly. Her thought process is often scattered, almost as if she wants to say too many things at once.
nothing
Just teach in a concise manner, principles of macroeconomics does not need to be extremely complicated, stop trying to flaunt your intellect on a bunch of underclassmen.
Have powerpoints that actually explain the connection between topics and explain things more relevantly. It's a fairly self–taught course
The quizzes are quite difficult, if there was a quiz study sheet to look at before and brush up knowledge on ideas from past week would be very helpful.
Make the quizzes more reflective of the content they teach us.
Simplifying where possible. A lot was not explained well so I would have to go back and teach it to myself
I can't think of anything – I just wish classes were a bit longer so that the topics could be presented more slowly and more time could be give for us to absorb everything.
Nothing
Talk about more specific topics/ideas that will be present on quizzes. A lot of the time I feel like I studied topics that were irrelevant because there was so much information.
More practice free response questions.
I don't think so.
I liked that the quiz policy is designed to be generous, but it was also very fast paced and it felt like I didn't always have the time to fully grasp the material, especially in the last three weeks of the quarter when we had quizzes every week.
provide more thorough responses on practice problem answer keys and have more productive discussion sections that prepare you for the quiz. she also could have been nicer about extra credit, grading, and overall student respect.
Nothing
Nothing! I really enjoyed the structure of the class.
The homework assignments and quizzes were incredibly difficult, and tested us on far more than what was covered in lectures.
in person office hours
Show exactly what you expect on the TFA's. It took me 5 quizzes to understand it. Way too late which really hurt my grade
The recorded lectures often had significant stretches where the microphone did not pick up the audio. It could seriously harm the effectiveness of the very convenient recordings. (Thank you for having them!)
some of the practice problems felt like they didn't accurately reflect what was on the quizzes, so maybe a few more practice problems
If tests are exclusively going to be on extreme examples of macroeconomic concepts, teach more of those in class.
The quizzes were most of our grade (80%) and, sometimes, strong knowledge of the concepts and application of the concepts wouldn't translate to a good grade. It was very easy to lose points on quizzes despite having the correct answer by not phrasing a sentence correctly. I think that the quizzes could be helped by making the grading criteria slightly more lenient, or giving students the opportunity to lower the weighting of their quiz scores by doing extra work (e.g. an extra HW assignment).
As I've written before, the practice problems had a large amount of math on them yet the quizzes had maybe one math problem. I'd say having more practice problems that actually are related to questions on the quiz, not unnecessary math, would help.
None

The Instructor . . .

	Mean	Median	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree	N/A
Organized the course clearly.	4.47	5.00	0.00%	3.77%	3.77%	33.96%	58.49%	0.00%
Presented lectures that enhanced your understanding.	4.17	4.00	1.89%	9.43%	7.55%	32.08%	49.06%	0.00%
Facilitated discussions that were engaging and useful.	3.84	4.00	5.66%	7.55%	13.21%	39.62%	30.19%	3.77%
Stimulated your interest in the core ideas of the course.	4.12	4.00	1.92%	7.69%	13.46%	30.77%	46.15%	0.00%
Challenged you to learn.	4.38	5.00	1.89%	3.77%	5.66%	32.08%	56.60%	0.00%
Helped you gain significant learning from the course content.	4.27	4.50	1.92%	3.85%	9.62%	34.62%	50.00%	0.00%
Was available and helpful outside of class.	4.10	4.00	0.00%	5.66%	15.09%	39.62%	35.85%	3.77%
Motivated you to think independently.	4.13	4.00	3.77%	3.77%	9.43%	41.51%	41.51%	0.00%
Worked to create an inclusive and welcoming learning environment.	4.06	4.00	3.77%	5.66%	13.21%	35.85%	41.51%	0.00%
Overall, this instructor made a significant contribution to your learning.	4.06	4.00	3.85%	5.77%	17.31%	26.92%	46.15%	0.00%

Please include the name of the TA/CA/Intern you are evaluating. What aspects of the TA's teaching contributed most to your learning? What could the TA modify to help you learn more? Please include any additional feedback for the TA/CA/Intern.

Comments
Manuel Veras is the TA. He is great and does not need to modify his teaching.
Manuel
Yuchen Du; he was my discussion leader. He always came prepared to discussions with material to go over.
Stefano Bruzzo–Gallardo was an alright TA, during his discussion sections he was able to clearly present the material, however occasionally if you asked him a question about an assignment he would provide an answer that didn't really make any sense, or was even straight up incorrect.
manuel
Their full names are not listed, however I've interacted with Manuel and Yuchen.
Stefano. His feedback on quizzes were the most useful part. Discussion sections were basically a waste of time
Stefano.
Yuchen Du
My TA was Stefano Bruzzo–Gallardo. He was always nice, clear, and prepared good discussion sections. He was also helpful during office hours.
Can't remember, but discussion class was a waste of time
Stefano Bruzzo–Gallardo
It was good.
Manuel Veras did a great job answering questions both during the lecture and quiz.
Stefano Bruzzo–Gallardo
Yuchen Du
Stefano Bruzzo–Gallardo. Stefano was available outside of class and organised helpful discussion sections and was really helpful in office hours before quizzes.
more useful discussion section topics. These would be held the week before the quiz and went over whatever the TA wanted, no time for student questions ever really.
Stefano
Yuchen explained concepts very clearly and was willing to engage with confusion and talk through it during discussion.
Manuel Veras
Manuel was great and very smart. 100% a professional in his field
Manuel, he was fine.
Yuchen
Stefano Bruzzo–Gallardo. He contributed nothing to my learning.
Stefano Bruzzo–Gallardo
Yuchen Du
Manuel Veras
Manuel Veras

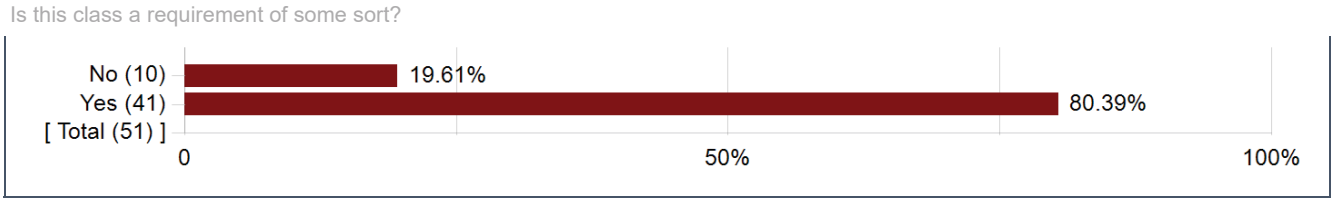
The TA/CA or Intern. . .

	Mean	Median	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree	N/A
Facilitated discussions that supported your learning.	3.64	4.00	4.44%	11.11%	22.22%	37.78%	22.22%	2.22%
Gave you useful feedback on your work.	3.60	4.00	4.44%	11.11%	22.22%	35.56%	20.00%	6.67%
Stimulated your interest in the core ideas of the class.	3.55	4.00	6.67%	11.11%	26.67%	28.89%	24.44%	2.22%
Challenged you to learn.	3.59	4.00	4.44%	13.33%	20.00%	40.00%	20.00%	2.22%
Helped you succeed in the class.	3.61	4.00	8.89%	6.67%	24.44%	31.11%	26.67%	2.22%
Was available and helpful outside of class.	4.05	4.00	2.22%	2.22%	17.78%	37.78%	33.33%	6.67%
Overall, this individual made a significant contribution to your learning.	3.57	4.00	6.67%	8.89%	26.67%	33.33%	22.22%	2.22%

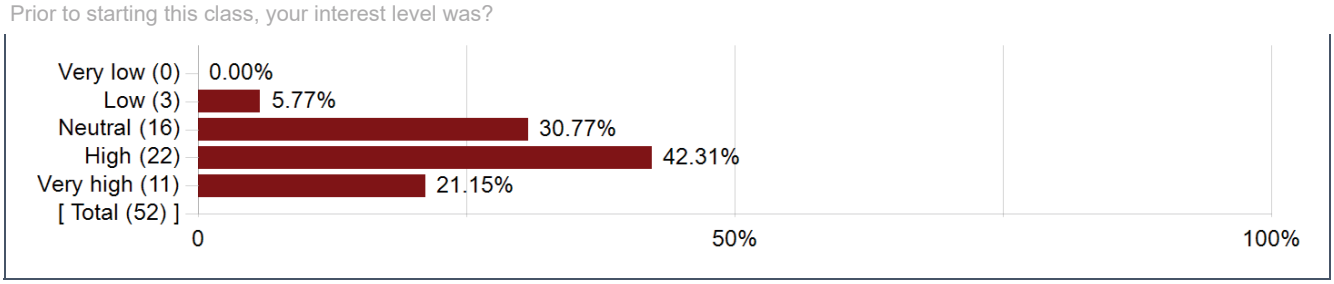
How much did the following elements of the course contribute to your learning gains?

	Mean	Median	No Gain	A Little Gain	Moderate Gain	Good Gain	Great Gain	N/A
Laboratory Experience	5.00	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	16.67%	83.33%
Field Trips	5.00	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	16.67%	83.33%
Library Sessions	5.00	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	16.67%	83.33%
Review Sessions	3.00	3.00	14.29%	14.29%	42.86%	14.29%	14.29%	0.00%
Writing Seminars	5.00	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	16.67%	83.33%

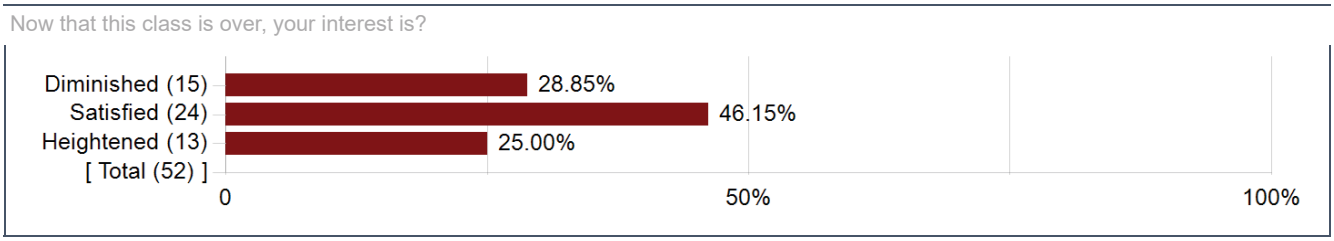
Is this class a requirement of some sort?



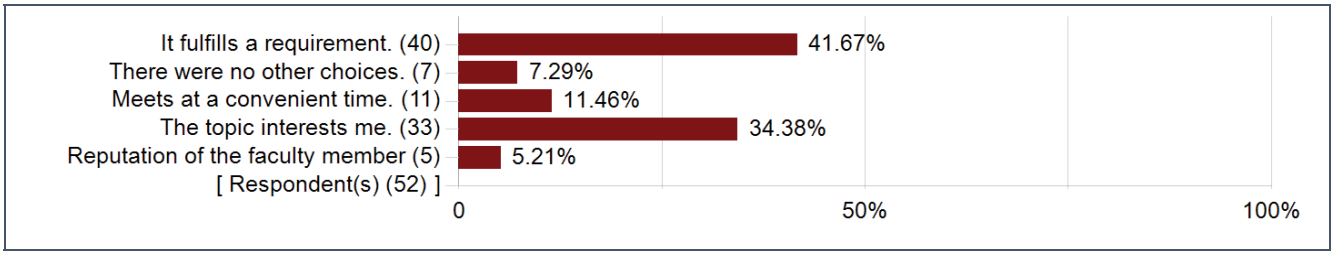
Prior to starting this class, your interest level was?



Now that this class is over, your interest is?

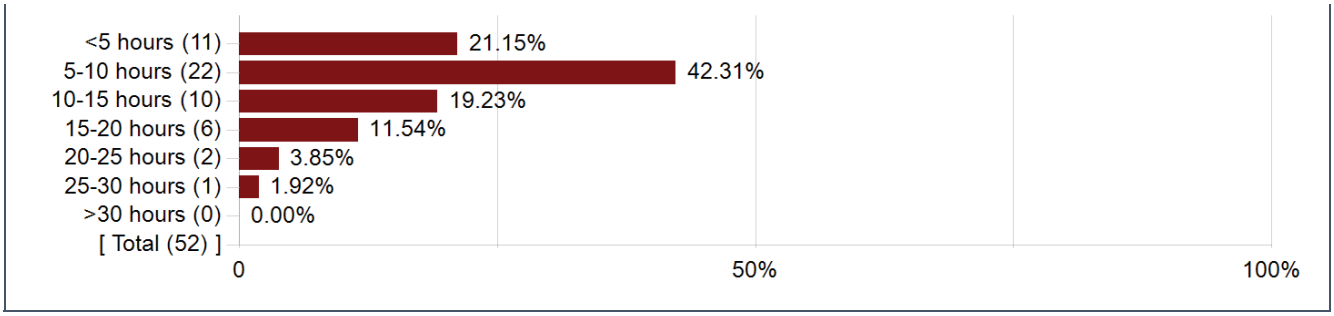


Why did you choose to take this course? (Select all that apply)



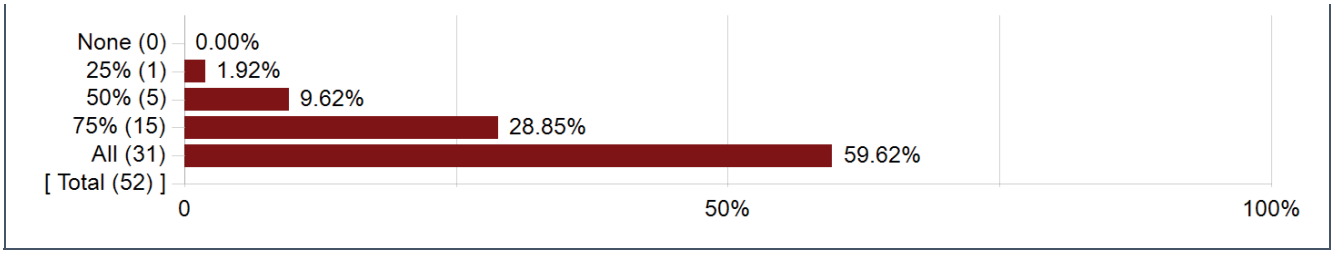
How many hours per week outside of attending required sessions did you spend on this course?

How many hours per week outside of attending required sessions did you spend on this course?



What proportion of classes did you attend?

What proportion of classes did you attend?



Please comment on the level of difficulty of the course relative to your background and experience.

Comments
The course itself is not difficult, but Prof Pieters artificially enhances the difficulty level.
Without previous economic knowledge the minutia could be challenging/overwhelming.
I have never take macreconomics before, but it is still fairly manageable. It is a matter of developing the right study skills that will help you excel in this course.
This course was one of the more challenging courses I've taken, solely due to not initially understanding what was expected of my answers.
Having no prior experience in economics, I think the learning curve was a bit intense at first. I adjusted after the first quiz went badly.
Shouldn't be hard, worst teacher I've had at the school thus far, also TA's are absolutely horrendous.
Fairly difficult. Nothing crazy though and I have zero background. I didn't take micro first either. Just properly prepare for quizzes and you're fine
Course is relatively difficult to an econ major that has taken multiple ECON classes before.
Extremely difficult. Nearly impossible, actually. I almost failed and studied for over 13 hours for each quiz
Challenging, but I think adequate.
Was impossibly hard and the profesor sought to lower all of our gpas. I also would like to not that the teacher put a poll out for extra credit that 110/190 students filled out with a resounding 'Yes' to wanting extra credit, the teacher then decided that the results were somehow not conclusive enough and removed any extra credit. Furthermore, she laughed at student survey responses in front of the class and brushed off legitmate concerns from students and used it as a stand up comedy special.
Tough course to keep up with especially with little knowledge of economics plus being a student–athlete and attending other activities.
Quizzes are very hard. Its applied learning, not memorization!
I did not take any economics classes in high school, and I found this class challenging, both because of the new content/fast pace and because quizzes are designed to test how well you can apply the concepts to new scenarios
As a fourth year who was taking this class as a last econ elective, it was fine.
Definitely a step up from previous course difficulty
took micro w sanderson, but this calss is way more difficult and less A's are given out
As long as you do the homework and listen to the lectures it is not super difficult, but sometimes the concepts are a bit hard to put into practice and the test questions take some time to get used to
No economics experience and haven't taken a math class in two years; concepts were understandable and expectations were reasonable, but you definitely had to work (OH, practice problems, etc) to make sure you were prepared for quizzes
Take micro first, trust me
seemed similar in difficulty to other Uchicago courses (take that however you will)
took micro but with a different prof with a very different teaching style. it was a bit of a weird adjustment at first, but i really liked the set up of this class. the quizzes were also difficult at first but after two or three you really get the hang of it (especially if you go through all the practice problems)
The difficulty was where it should be for a course like this
Somewhat difficult because of the grading system in the class. Accessible for people without a background knowledge in economics though.
I felt it was extremely difficult to do well in the class, considering I got an A in micro.

ECON 17110 1 - International Monetary Systems - Instructor(s): Gina Pieters

Project Title: **College Course Feedback - Autumn 2022**

Number Enrolled: **54**
Number of Responses: **17**

Report Comments

Opinions expressed in these evaluations are those of students enrolled in the specific course and do not represent the University.

Creation Date: **Tuesday, January 10, 2023**

What are the most important things that you learned in this course? Please reflect on the knowledge and skills you gained.

Comments
I learned about different models that help to explain many macro–economic variables like inflation, GDP, exchange rates, ROA, etc.
what causes exchange rate movements
asset fx market model
when something happens in one country it affects another country. monetary policy is very important.
The basics of common monetary policies and their impacts on the economy were covered.
How money supply/interest rates effect the market in many ways
Interest rates, exchange rates, and inflation
Open economies make things messy

Describe how aspects of this course (lectures, discussions, labs, assignments, etc.) contributed to your learning.

Comments
The QRE was very valuable
The lectures and slides were very helpful.
lectures
the lecture slides are very helpful and i like that prof pieters records her lectures so i can rewatch them.
Lectures and discussions were the most useful.
Lectures were really helpful along with the pratice problems
recorded lectures are great
Great lectures

Please respond to the following:

	Mean	Median	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
This course challenged me intellectually.	4.67	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	33.33%	66.67%
I understood the purpose of this course and what I was expected to gain from it.	4.08	4.00	0.00%	8.33%	16.67%	33.33%	41.67%
I understood the standards for success on assignments.	4.08	4.00	8.33%	0.00%	8.33%	41.67%	41.67%
Class time enhanced my ability to succeed in graded assignments.	4.18	4.00	0.00%	9.09%	0.00%	54.55%	36.36%
I received feedback on my performance that helped me improve my subsequent work.	4.08	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	16.67%	58.33%	25.00%
My work was evaluated fairly.	4.17	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	25.00%	33.33%	41.67%
I felt respected in this class.	4.62	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	38.46%	61.54%
Overall, this was an excellent course.	4.31	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	15.38%	38.46%	46.15%

Additional comments about the course:

Comments
the grading rubrics and class organization is a course to learn in itself; also the instructor makes quite a few mistakes on the lecture slides that make one doubt the content during reviews
it's a great course and prof pieters is a great professor but it is a difficult course
NA
First few classes were easy, and then it started to get much harder. Need to stay on your toes
This class was very very challenging if you do not have micro background. Especially because there are so many new terms in this class that are so incredibly foreign, this class is very very hard.
More sample exams would be useful

I would recommend this course to:

	No	Yes
Highly-motivated and well-prepared students	7.69%	92.31%
Anyone interested in the topic	23.08%	76.92%

Thinking about your time in the class, what aspect of the instructor's teaching contributed most to your learning?

Comments
The lectures were definitely helpful along with the in–class QREs.
Pieters was very prepared and organized, lectures were very well structured
Dr. Pieters is a wonderful professor. She is strict but fair, and her ability to break down difficult concepts to us is one that not many other professors have. I highly recommend taking classes with her
She is a very nice person, very willing to answer questions, and very knowledgeable.
recorded lectures and lecture slides. easy to meet with her to ask questions.
The questions to answer during and after each lecture were engaging and contributed to my learning.
She had great visuals on her slides
recorded lectures, QREs

What could the instructor modify to help you learn more?

Comments
maybe correct mistakes on the slides; when drawing graphs during lectures, make them more legible; check to make sure lecture recordings actually pick up the audio; make the exam questions more straightforward to help students understand what's being asked
post midterm and final practice questions. the homework assignments are nothing like the exams.
NA
the class was really easy and then it grew in intensity, which threw me off
rubric for paper needs to be much more clearer.

The Instructor . . .

	Mean	Median	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree	N/A
Organized the course clearly.	4.58	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	16.67%	8.33%	75.00%	0.00%
Presented lectures that enhanced your understanding.	4.50	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	8.33%	33.33%	58.33%	0.00%
Facilitated discussions that were engaging and useful.	4.36	5.00	0.00%	9.09%	0.00%	36.36%	54.55%	0.00%
Stimulated your interest in the core ideas of the course.	4.45	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	9.09%	36.36%	54.55%	0.00%
Challenged you to learn.	4.64	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	36.36%	63.64%	0.00%
Helped you gain significant learning from the course content.	4.55	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	9.09%	27.27%	63.64%	0.00%
Was available and helpful outside of class.	4.50	5.00	0.00%	10.00%	0.00%	20.00%	70.00%	0.00%
Motivated you to think independently.	4.73	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	27.27%	72.73%	0.00%
Worked to create an inclusive and welcoming learning environment.	4.82	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	18.18%	81.82%	0.00%
Overall, this instructor made a significant contribution to your learning.	4.73	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	27.27%	72.73%	0.00%

Please include the name of the TA/CA/Intern you are evaluating. What aspects of the TA's teaching contributed most to your learning? What could the TA modify to help you learn more? Please include any additional feedback for the TA/CA/Intern.

Comments
Nimisha, she is very nice and kind, also patient with our questions through emails.
nimisha. somewhat helpful but taught things differently from prof pieters that made things confusing.
Nimisha
nimisha
TA okay but since it was her first time TA'ing the course she didn't have an intimate grip on the course specific material so sometimes it was hard to learn

The TA/CA or Intern. . .

	Mean	Median	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree	N/A
Facilitated discussions that supported your learning.	3.83	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	33.33%	50.00%	16.67%	0.00%
Gave you useful feedback on your work.	3.67	3.50	0.00%	0.00%	50.00%	33.33%	16.67%	0.00%
Stimulated your interest in the core ideas of the class.	3.83	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	33.33%	50.00%	16.67%	0.00%
Challenged you to learn.	3.83	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	33.33%	50.00%	16.67%	0.00%
Helped you succeed in the class.	3.83	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	33.33%	50.00%	16.67%	0.00%
Was available and helpful outside of class.	4.17	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	16.67%	50.00%	33.33%	0.00%
Overall, this individual made a significant contribution to your learning.	4.00	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	33.33%	33.33%	33.33%	0.00%

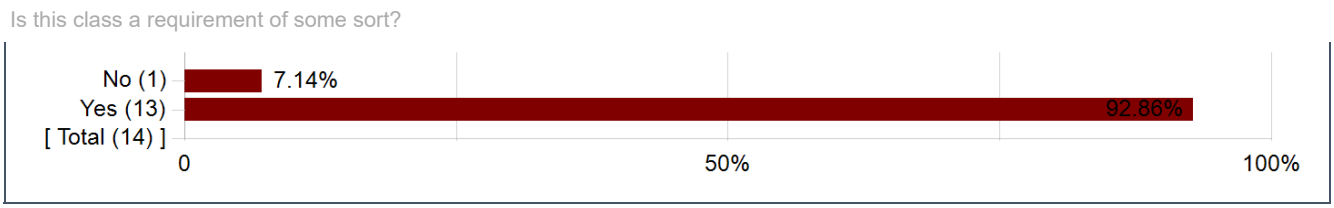
How much did the following elements of the course contribute to your learning gains?

	Mean	Median	No Gain	A Little Gain	Moderate Gain	Good Gain	Great Gain	N/A
Laboratory Experience	N/A	N/A	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	100.00%
Field Trips	N/A	N/A	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	100.00%
Library Sessions	N/A	N/A	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	100.00%
Review Sessions	2.00	2.00	0.00%	100.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%
Writing Seminars	N/A	N/A	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	100.00%

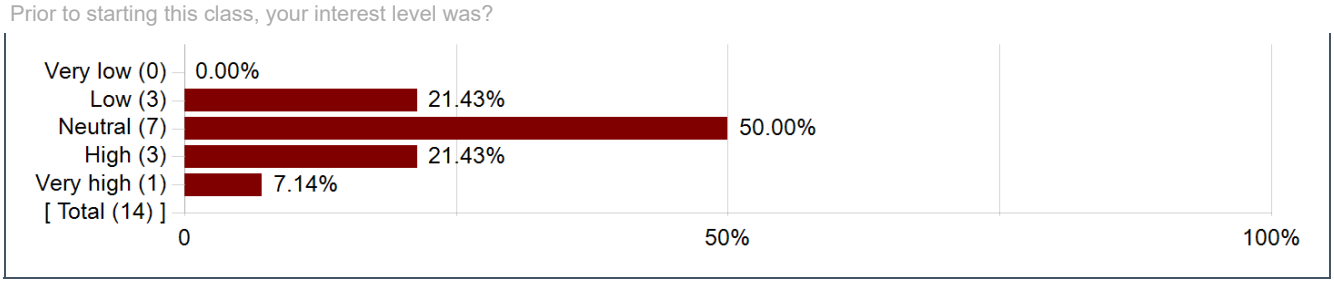
Other course elements not mentioned above:

Comments
writing a final paper—stressful experience

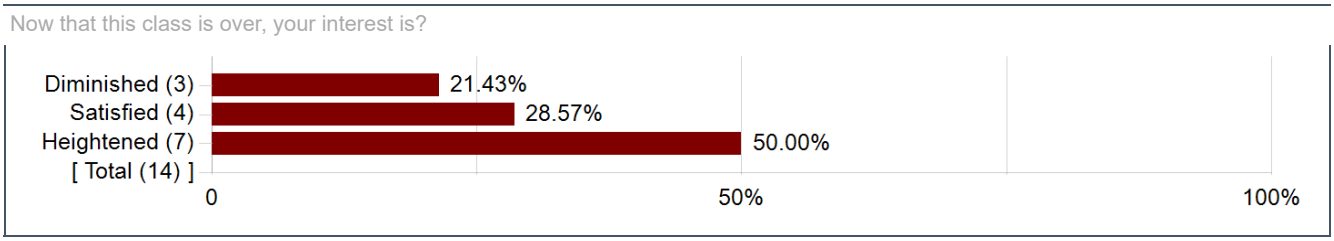
Is this class a requirement of some sort?



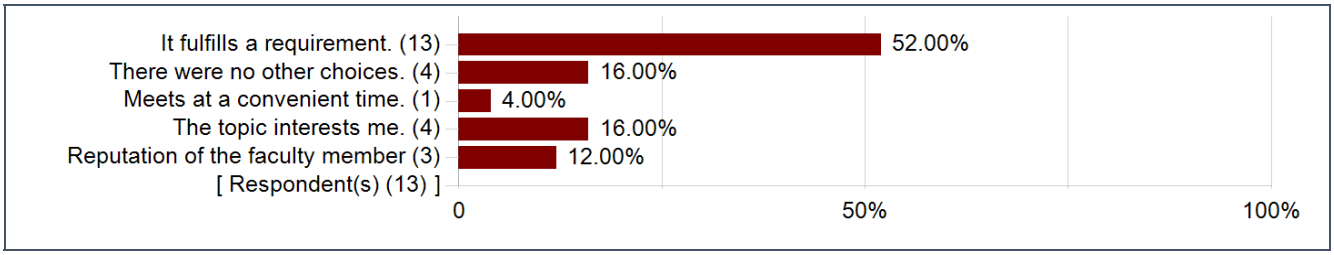
Prior to starting this class, your interest level was?



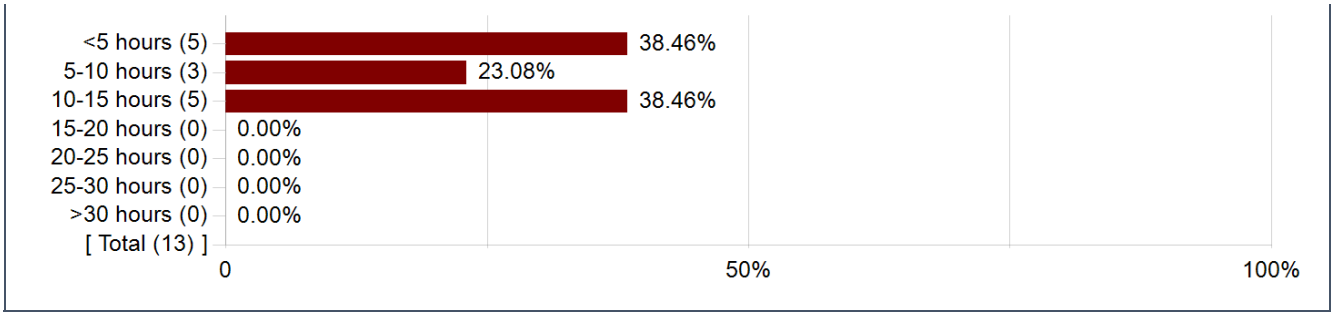
Now that this class is over, your interest is?



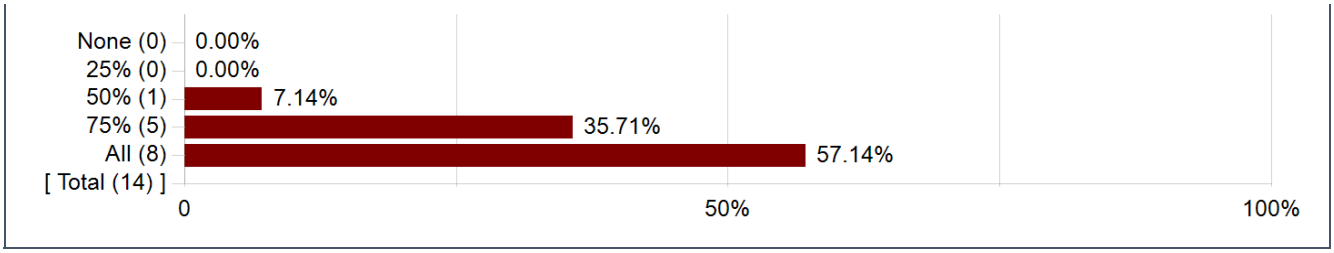
Why did you choose to take this course? (Select all that apply)



How many hours per week outside of attending required sessions did you spend on this course?



What proportion of classes did you attend?



Please comment on the level of difficulty of the course relative to your background and experience.

Comments
Not very difficult if you put the time in
fine but exams are obscure
was overall difficult, but very interesting, you need to have some outside knowledge of economics that isn't stressed in the classroom
If you want an easy A do not take

THE UNIVERSITY OF CHICAGO

ECON 20100 1 - The Elements of Economic Analysis II - Instructor(s): Gina Pieters

Project Title: **College Course Feedback - Autumn 2022**

Number Enrolled: **46**
Number of Responses: **18**

Report Comments

Opinions expressed in these evaluations are those of students enrolled in the specific course and do not represent the University.

Creation Date: **Tuesday, January 10, 2023**

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What are the most important things that you learned in this course? Please reflect on the knowledge and skills you gained.

Comments
I learned more about economic analysis and the firm–side of markets.
General equilibrium, game theory, firm/consumer relationships, supply/demand
Microeconomics: firm's cost minimization, profit maximization, supply decisions. Also some game theory concepts, types of industrial organization, and solving for equilibrium solutions.
Firm's problem, general equilibrium, game theory, externalities, and government intervention. Lagrangians play a key role in every aspect of this course.
The producer side of economic theory, general equilibrium, and market failures.
Economics of firm
Game Theory, general equilibrium
Partial+general equilibrium and the social planner's problem, monopolies, game theory, public goods
How to think about economics in a general sense, and how to turn anything and everything into a math problem
How to apply Lagrangians to partial and general equilibrium problems, monopolies, different types of oligopolies, introductory game theory, how to complete a Social Planner Problem
how to solve economic problems using the lagrangian model.

Describe how aspects of this course (lectures, discussions, labs, assignments, etc.) contributed to your learning.

Comments
The lectures were very informative, and the assignments were helpful.
Lectures and practice problems were very helpful. The QREs were great for helping me apply my understanding to real–world problems.
Lectures are by far the most important. Prof. Pieters does a great job of making sure questions are asked and is very non–judgemental in answering, which encourages it. Having practice problems and homework assignments with answer keys is the best way to learn and is very helpful. Recorded lecture, discussion board, and especially the point system for grading are incredible accommodating. I got very sick and was easily able to catch up given all these resources. Also, not having midterms and having quizzes every two–weeks instead is way more helpful in retaining information and actually learning the content.
Lectures largely explained concepts and introduced the math; homework and especially practice problems were necessary for learning how to approach problems.
Lectures contributed directly.
Practice questions were useful for applying the content from lectures.
Lectures were helpful, practice problems helped me understand stuff
The sheer accessibility of all course materials helped me more than anything.
The lectures were really good, and the professor kept the class engaged
Lectures were good for taking notes to study from, discussions were not that helpful (though I found that consistent with Econ 200 as well). The main resource that helped me learn in this class was completing the practice problems corresponding to each lecture outside of class – they were critical to understanding the basis of the material and its applications.
Professor Gina's lectures are really great. Her practice problems and assignments also pushed me to think and learn.

Please respond to the following:

	Mean	Median	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
This course challenged me intellectually.	4.50	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	11.11%	27.78%	61.11%
I understood the purpose of this course and what I was expected to gain from it.	4.39	5.00	0.00%	11.11%	0.00%	27.78%	61.11%
I understood the standards for success on assignments.	3.94	4.00	0.00%	11.11%	22.22%	27.78%	38.89%
Class time enhanced my ability to succeed in graded assignments.	4.11	4.00	5.56%	5.56%	5.56%	38.89%	44.44%
I received feedback on my performance that helped me improve my subsequent work.	3.94	4.00	5.56%	11.11%	5.56%	38.89%	38.89%
My work was evaluated fairly.	4.06	4.00	5.56%	0.00%	16.67%	38.89%	38.89%
I felt respected in this class.	4.11	5.00	11.11%	0.00%	11.11%	22.22%	55.56%
Overall, this was an excellent course.	3.83	4.00	16.67%	0.00%	5.56%	38.89%	38.89%

Additional comments about the course:

Comments
This course is well–managed but challenging. Although theoretical and mechanical topics are really well developed and explained through lectures and homework assignments, the quizzes are incredibly difficult to finish on time and do well on, especially with unnecessarily tedious algebra. I also feel like doing the quizzes during discussion section really limited the TA's helpfulness, as someone who works a job part time as well, I could not attend most office hours. Although lectures are nice, I wish there was set course reference material like a textbook with chapters so notations, formulas, exceptions, etc. can be standardized. There were several times where the same variable in the same topic denoted two different things. However, Prof. Pieters is incredibly friendly and understanding and really great at explaining course material. If exams were verbal (not suggesting this), I know I could confidently explain concepts accurately and in depth.
The class has too much meaningless algebra
Standards for success were very clear
Professor Pieters has kept this course very well organized, which I appreciated.
This class is a bit hard. I would say it's more time–consuming and challenging than other professors' econ201. It focuses a lot on the mechanical and computational parts of ECON problems. However, I also learned a lot throughout the process. Though I did not do well in this class, I had a lot of fun learning all the different economic models.

I would recommend this course to:

	No	Yes
Highly-motivated and well-prepared students	11.76%	88.24%
Anyone interested in the topic	35.29%	64.71%

Thinking about your time in the class, what aspect of the instructor's teaching contributed most to your learning?

Comments
Really great lecturer. Reviewing the slides and videos was very helpful for studying.
Everything was well organized and consistent, so I definitely understood what was expected. The homework assignments forced us to apply the lecture materials in more complicated ways, which was difficult, but the grading structure made those low–stress.
Mostly lectures, drawing on slides especially. Asking for questions or clarifications is also helpful. Recording lectures and the grading scheme allows for illness/emergencies.
Lectures were very informative.
Class lectires
The connection between the equations/math were were using and their applications. The combination of mathematical, verbal and graphical representation of the material was very useful.
Lectures were good at teaching stuff
The amount of resources.
Her lectures were nice and she explained everything pretty clearly
Professor Pieters was very helpful in office hours. Additionally, I found that the QREs were a nice form of practice to be completed in class.
The lectures, homework assignments, and practice problems

What could the instructor modify to help you learn more?

Comments
The lectures could include more examples of how the informative is applied to problems.
– The slides, answer keys, and assignments have an incredible amount of typos in them, so much to the point where much of my study time was verifying whether my intuition was correct that there was an error. This severely limited my confidence in my mastery of the subjects and caused about half of my study time to be wasted. Answer keys really should be reliable and explanatory or else there is no point to having them. – Structure quizzes such that time is not the main reason people score low. Most points lost on quizzes were due to not completing them. Although I do think quizzes are conceptually challenging, they're very fair in every aspect but the time constraint and unnecessarily annoying algebra – Standardize notations across the course or with reference of a textbook/source material. When I shift from the lectures to the homework/practice problems, it is especially confusing to have inconsistent notations and variables. – A list of concepts and applications needed for each topic (and therefore evaluated on quizzes) would be incredibly helpful. Lots of time was spent explaining ideas that were either never asked about again or were very minutely referenced. – If the course had a more generous curve, I would think it is much more fair just because of the difficulty of quizzes. I learn a lot from the quizzes so I do not think they should be easier.
Be more concise. Prof often made supposedly simple concepts convoluted and complicated.
Nothing
Make more of a connection between what's being tested versus what's presented in class. Some of the questions one exams didn't seem to reflect the information taught.
I really disliked the instructor because of many of her policies and how lazy she was: 1. There were soooo many errors on literally everything, even answer keys that were wrong and actively hurt my ability to learn. When I pointed out errors, she always took a while to change the answer key and wouldn't trust me telling her what the right answers to things were. All course materials were prepared far too hastily. 2. She doesn't trust her students at all. Like you can't use the bathroom during an exam without prior SDS accommodation, which is just absolutely bonkers. Also I had a fever at one point, and when I asked for a makeup quiz the Monday following the Friday quiz, she outright refused, forcing me to show up to take the quiz with a 102 fever because of her lack of trust in her students not to share information about the exam and her laziness in writing a makeup exam. Absolutely disgraceful. I get that there are two "makeup" exams that constitute the final, but seriously I don't think that is an excuse to not give a sick student a makeup exam.
I honestly think the six–quiz (drop two) model is flawed, although I'm not sure how to improve it. Ultimately, 80% of your grade in this class (kindly, the other 20% is nearly guaranteed with the class's forgiving approach to homework and in–person assessments) will come down to how you perform on your better four of six quiz grades– but these are fairly high stakes considering that they're called quizzes. These quizzes are scored out of 30, and the final is the last two quizzes (so if you had A–worthy quizzes the first four times, you could theoretically skip the final!). To me, the problem with this comes in that it doesn't matter at all how you perform on a quiz that needs to be dropped. In that sense, getting two 20s and two 10s on the first four quizzes is actually different from getting four 15s, as even though both case have had the same average performance across the four quizzes, the person with four 15s will have less of an opportunity to improve going into their final than the person with two 20s and two 10s. If these students wanted to have a total quiz component score of, say, 80 for their target grades, despite having the same average performance, the first student just needs to get two 20s to get there, whereas the second student needs two 25s. I understand that there might be some justification for preferring high scores with a few low scores to several moderate scores, but in the above scenario, getting 15–15–15–15–25–24 (total of 109) is a worse final score than getting 10–10–20–20–20–20 (total of 100), which strikes me as a bummer. I wonder if there would be a way to model grades to compensate for this issue (although whether it is an issue is a matter of perspective, I guess). Soapbox aside, Prof. Pieters is a great and approachable professor who does a great job making the most fair class possible, although her grading model is rigid. I appreciated the course and really did learn a lot about economics. There's going to be some opaque–ish math, but if you took 200, I guess you can see that coming.
Honestly nothing
N/A
maybe less workload, or an easier curve.

The Instructor . . .

	Mean	Median	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree	N/A
Organized the course clearly.	4.61	5.00	0.00%	5.56%	0.00%	22.22%	72.22%	0.00%
Presented lectures that enhanced your understanding.	4.33	5.00	5.56%	0.00%	11.11%	22.22%	61.11%	0.00%
Facilitated discussions that were engaging and useful.	4.18	4.00	5.56%	0.00%	11.11%	33.33%	44.44%	5.56%
Stimulated your interest in the core ideas of the course.	4.22	5.00	11.11%	0.00%	0.00%	33.33%	55.56%	0.00%
Challenged you to learn.	4.44	5.00	5.56%	5.56%	0.00%	16.67%	72.22%	0.00%
Helped you gain significant learning from the course content.	4.44	5.00	5.56%	0.00%	5.56%	22.22%	66.67%	0.00%
Was available and helpful outside of class.	4.67	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	5.56%	22.22%	72.22%	0.00%
Motivated you to think independently.	4.44	5.00	5.56%	0.00%	5.56%	22.22%	66.67%	0.00%
Worked to create an inclusive and welcoming learning environment.	4.17	5.00	11.11%	0.00%	5.56%	27.78%	55.56%	0.00%
Overall, this instructor made a significant contribution to your learning.	4.22	5.00	11.11%	5.56%	0.00%	16.67%	66.67%	0.00%

Please include the name of the TA/CA/Intern you are evaluating. What aspects of the TA's teaching contributed most to your learning? What could the TA modify to help you learn more? Please include any additional feedback for the TA/CA/Intern.

Comments
Elliot was clearly very passionate about the subject. I would have appreciated a faster pace during discussion sections.
Eliot; he did not help when I had questions because he did not know the answers and just showed me the slides instead
Elliot Weinstein
Elliot
Eliot
Eliot was helpful for individual questions. However, the TA sessions could have been slightly better organized.
Eliot Weinstein
Eliot Weinstein was a great TA! He was very helpful with answering questions both during office hours and after class.
Elliot
Eliot Weinstein
Eliot

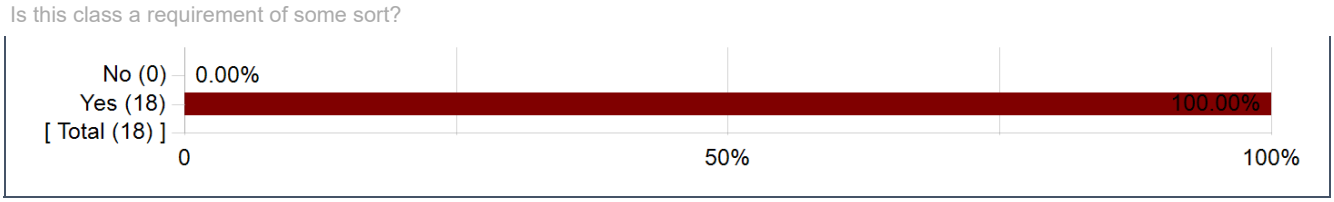
The TA/CA or Intern. . .

	Mean	Median	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree	N/A
Facilitated discussions that supported your learning.	3.53	3.00	6.67%	13.33%	33.33%	13.33%	33.33%	0.00%
Gave you useful feedback on your work.	4.00	4.00	7.14%	7.14%	7.14%	35.71%	42.86%	0.00%
Stimulated your interest in the core ideas of the class.	3.80	4.00	6.67%	6.67%	26.67%	20.00%	40.00%	0.00%
Challenged you to learn.	3.86	4.00	7.14%	0.00%	35.71%	14.29%	42.86%	0.00%
Helped you succeed in the class.	3.60	4.00	13.33%	0.00%	33.33%	20.00%	33.33%	0.00%
Was available and helpful outside of class.	4.21	4.50	7.14%	0.00%	7.14%	35.71%	50.00%	0.00%
Overall, this individual made a significant contribution to your learning.	3.67	4.00	13.33%	0.00%	26.67%	26.67%	33.33%	0.00%

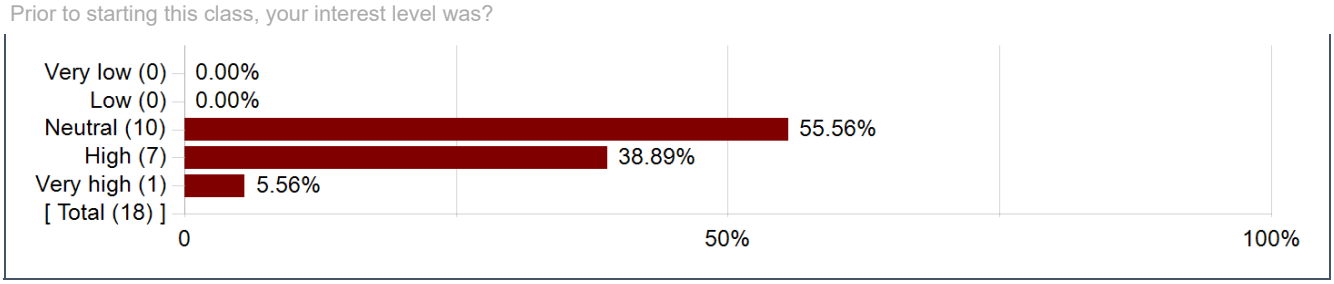
How much did the following elements of the course contribute to your learning gains?

	Mean	Median	No Gain	A Little Gain	Moderate Gain	Good Gain	Great Gain	N/A
Laboratory Experience	N/A	N/A	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	100.00%
Field Trips	N/A	N/A	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	100.00%
Library Sessions	N/A	N/A	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	100.00%
Review Sessions	3.00	3.00	0.00%	0.00%	50.00%	0.00%	0.00%	50.00%
Writing Seminars	N/A	N/A	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	100.00%

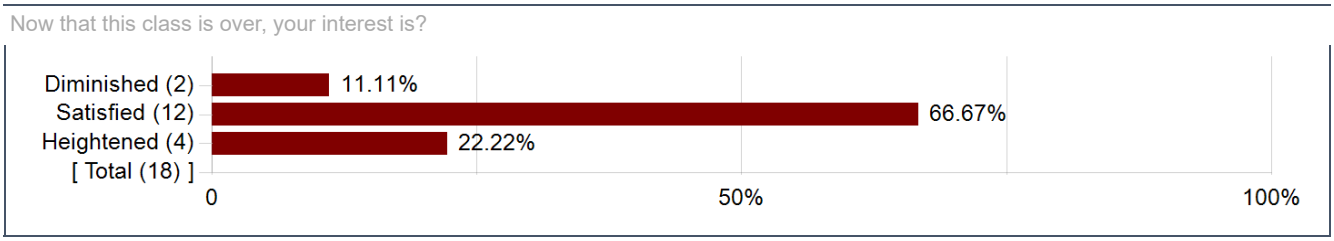
Is this class a requirement of some sort?



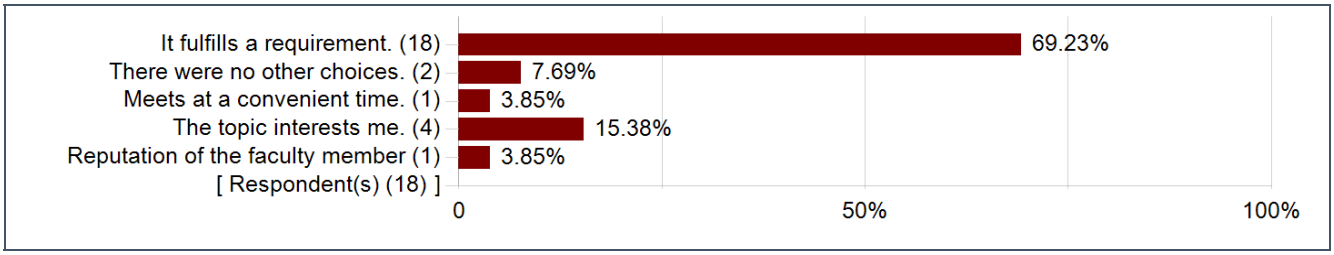
Prior to starting this class, your interest level was?



Now that this class is over, your interest is?

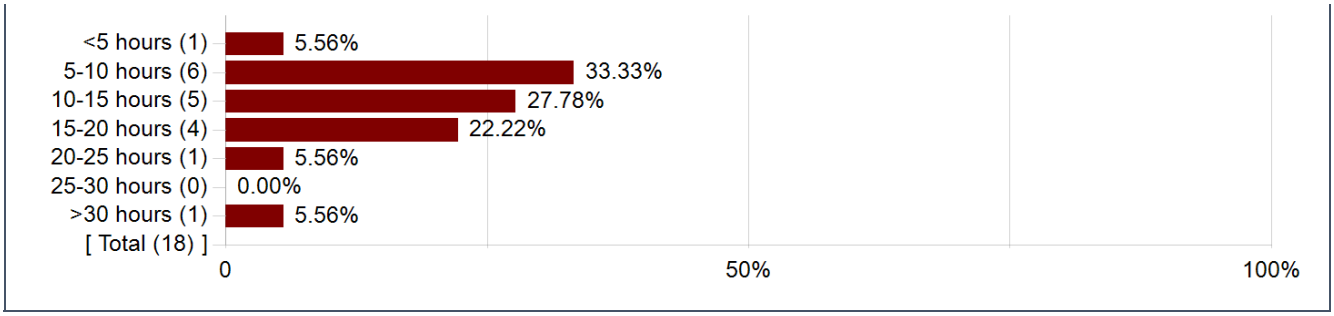


Why did you choose to take this course? (Select all that apply)



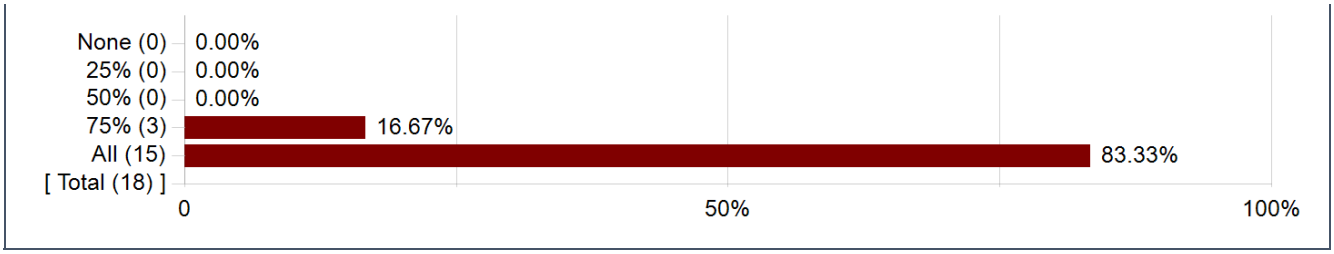
How many hours per week outside of attending required sessions did you spend on this course?

How many hours per week outside of attending required sessions did you spend on this course?



What proportion of classes did you attend?

What proportion of classes did you attend?



Please comment on the level of difficulty of the course relative to your background and experience.

Comments
This course is much more difficult compared to the prior class in the sequence.
Econ 200 is a prerequisite, but as long as you've done that, this class isn't too hard.
Strong algebra and analytical background is very important. Having taken intro to micro, intro to macro, and econ 200 I still thought this course was hard not because I didn't understand the content, but because it is difficult to demonstrate your understanding in exams given the time constraint
The course was challenging but manageable if you studied and asked questions.
I found it hard!
All you really need is ECON 200 but principles would help I imagine
I found it more difficult than Econ 200 given the amount of work required to succeed in this class.

ECON 17110 1 - International Monetary Systems - Instructor(s): Gina Pieters

Project Title: **College Course Feedback - Winter 2023**

Number Enrolled: **42**
Number of Responses: **17**

Report Comments

Opinions expressed in these evaluations are those of students enrolled in the specific course and do not represent the University.

Creation Date: **Tuesday, April 18, 2023**

What are the most important things that you learned in this course? Please reflect on the knowledge and skills you gained.

Comments
Learned more about foreign exchange markets and how currencies interact with each other
I have learned a great deal about international markets, particularly the relationship between exchange rates and monetary policy. Dr. Pieters' class is one of the most practical courses I have taken at the University of Chicago, as it ties lecture/theory to real world applications.
Understanding the markets and systems that drive exchange rate fluctuations. Essentially understanding how to connect several macroeconomic variables and how they work together.
Coming into this class with no experience in this topic, I learned a lot about foreign exchange and the foreign exchange market as well as how to apply the skills that we learned to real–world examples through policy reports and applied questions in the homework.
Foreign exchange market, how to appreciate currency through changes in monetary policy.
How monetary authorities function and affect a country's macroeconomic policy, international trade, exchange rates, interest rates, models for depicting the flow of goods in and out of a country, real and nominal trade variables, etc. etc.
I found the j–curve, which related net exports and appreciation/depreciation (IR) most interesting.
International monetary policy and the various factors effecting it
The interplay between international monetary systems.
Honestly, it's less intl monetary systems and more "how does monetary policy, exchange rates, and interest rates interact in an intl context (ie there are two countries rather than just looking at home country)" . I guess I was personally expecting more trade content and more "systems" as all the models were mostly limited to two countries.
Monetary systems on global scale & exchange rates
Exchange rates/monetary systems
Impact of monetary policies, currency market analysis, different models of financial institutions.

Describe how aspects of this course (lectures, discussions, labs, assignments, etc.) contributed to your learning.

Comments
Depending on the specific lectures, some can be amazing at facilitating understanding, and other lectures can have weird pacing. Sometimes there's just way too many slides which means harder concepts towards the end get rushed when we go up against time. Discussion sections tended to be pretty hit or miss since the TA didn't really know the course material. Ed discussion was generally helpful at answering questions outside of class but sometimes answers were confusing.
Policy Reports were incredibly helpful for learning, as we tied theory to real world events.
Lecture slides clear and easy to understand. Also enjoyed the QREs (essentially concept checks mid class) that helped me too. By far was the lectures though.
I really enjoyed the variety of materials and assignments that are given in this class as it makes it easier to not only learn the material, but to apply it in different contexts. It's clear that the professor really wants you to learn and understand the material instead of just memorize it for the purposes of the class.
Loved the QRE's (in class single question quiz). Homework component was very helpful, as were the practice problems. The policy reports forced me to learn how excel works at a basic level and how to construct a basic explanation about a current event.
The lectures were recorded, which was insanely helpful as there was a lot of material to cover and she goes very fast in class. Each lecture had a corresponding set of practice problems, which ground the concepts, and the instructor had well–established office hour sessions where she helped explain concepts. She's very intelligent and goes very fast so it's important to attend class to see the live lecture and do the in–class exercise she gives and then go home and see the recorded lecture to fill in the inevitable blanks in your notes. Homework assignments were kind of superfluous, but the policy reports, while difficult, also helped ground the concepts via real–world applications.
The lectures were essential as was homework/policies.
Lectures were extremely important, very rich with content. Necessary to attend them all
Lectures and Policy Papers.
Prof. Pieters is a GREAT lecturer and she's very engaging, she also gives so many resources to help students succeed BUT it's really up to the student to utilize those resources and go to OH or post questions on Ed.
very helpful
Lecture based!
Lectures were the most helpful in going deep on topics.

Please respond to the following:

	Mean	Median	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
This course challenged me intellectually.	4.67	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	33.33%	66.67%
I understood the purpose of this course and what I was expected to gain from it.	4.67	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	6.67%	20.00%	73.33%
I understood the standards for success on assignments.	4.47	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	6.67%	40.00%	53.33%
Class time enhanced my ability to succeed in graded assignments.	4.47	5.00	0.00%	6.67%	0.00%	33.33%	60.00%
I received feedback on my performance that helped me improve my subsequent work.	4.67	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	33.33%	66.67%
My work was evaluated fairly.	4.67	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	33.33%	66.67%
I felt respected in this class.	4.73	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	26.67%	73.33%
Overall, this was an excellent course.	4.73	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	6.67%	13.33%	80.00%

Additional comments about the course:

Comments
Despite it being a challenging course, I absolutely loved this class and what we learned from it. Gina is an AMAZING teacher. Yes, her classes get a little tough at times, but she provides every student the tools for success. I wish I had her for micro / macro instead of Sanderson to be honest! My advice for success in this class would be to attend every lecture, do all the homeworks, and lightly review concepts each week. An A is challenging, but not impossible.
Concepts are hard, but it's actually totally manageable if you work in groups with your fellow students, attend OH, and put the time that's needed to understand them. This class will not be an easy A, but it's an achievable A for everyone.
Prof was amazing.
Great professor, very difficult class if you don’t stay caught up

I would recommend this course to:

	No	Yes
Highly-motivated and well-prepared students	0.00%	100.00%
Anyone interested in the topic	20.00%	80.00%

Thinking about your time in the class, what aspect of the instructor's teaching contributed most to your learning?

Comments
All the supplementary material she posted on canvas like topic summaries, practice problems, slides, and class recordings helped greatly with digesting content.
QREs were super helpful.
Lectures 100%
Professor Pieters is a challenging but really great professor. Her lectures and assignments are designed to push you to apply what you've learned in class, but they also provide you with important skills that can be applied beyond this course. I also appreciated that she was often available to answer questions outside of class.
Gina's lectures are extremely well–organized and her office hours are really helpful.
Instructor is a fantastic lecturer and increased my interest in course materials. The QRE's and in–class conversations were very helpful.
Recorded lectures and policy papers.
She is really passionate and she cares about us knowing what is going on. Her lectures were well done, and her QRE's were great lecture supplementals.
She was very thorough in answering questions and explaining complex material
Prof. Pieters has her own unique way of teaching the material in such a that you retain the information. The up to date examples she gives provides you with a way to reason the recent updates within global financial markets.
The lectures are GREAT. And every assignment contributed to my learning greatly. Highly recommend this course if you want to sharpen your econ critical thinking skills. Ignore all the warnings about how difficult this course is! It really isn't as hard as people make it out to be, the content is quite digestable! If you're good at graphs in econ, you'll breeze through this course. Honestly, the hardest part was the policy papers which are probably the most valuable thing you can learn as a business econ major at UChicago—to be able to clearly explain cause and effect with theory and data given a news event or policy change—so it's worth it to learn that.
very helpful
Lectures

What could the instructor modify to help you learn more?

Comments
Slow down during lectures and cut some content out so students have more time to grasp concepts. Also make answer keys for previous exams.
Can't say!
Nothing I can think of.
Nothing! Gina is amazing!
Go slower in class and fix typos in the slides. They seem innocuous but they can seriously screw up your understanding of a concept if you don't clarify (that's why I also think Bug Bounties should be worth test points, not homework points).
More answer keys to old tests in preparation for exam!
Maybe quizzes to keep testing knowledge of the material to prepare for final
Policy Paper 4 due on finals week is a bit strenuous.
I enjoyed policy papers but honestly felt like there needed to be more guidelines and hints to get the correct answer even though it counts for "little" of the grade, it helps us solidify our understanding more if we could know how to correctly apply it rather than searching in the dark. Also, Prof. Pieters sometimes gives non–answers, and you really have to shamelessly ask multiple times to get a clear–cut answer.
nothing
N/A

The Instructor . . .

	Mean	Median	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree	N/A
Organized the course clearly.	4.69	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	30.77%	69.23%	0.00%
Presented lectures that enhanced your understanding.	4.57	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	7.14%	28.57%	64.29%	0.00%
Facilitated discussions that were engaging and useful.	4.85	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	15.38%	84.62%	0.00%
Stimulated your interest in the core ideas of the course.	4.64	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	7.14%	21.43%	71.43%	0.00%
Challenged you to learn.	4.85	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	15.38%	84.62%	0.00%
Helped you gain significant learning from the course content.	4.71	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	7.14%	14.29%	78.57%	0.00%
Was available and helpful outside of class.	4.85	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	15.38%	84.62%	0.00%
Motivated you to think independently.	4.85	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	15.38%	84.62%	0.00%
Worked to create an inclusive and welcoming learning environment.	4.85	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	15.38%	84.62%	0.00%
Overall, this instructor made a significant contribution to your learning.	4.85	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	15.38%	84.62%	0.00%

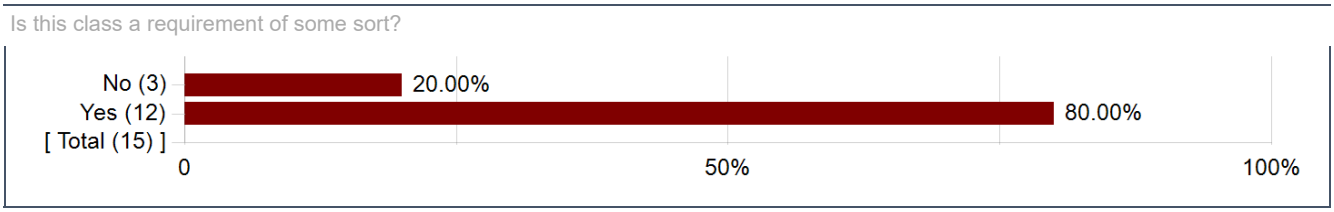
Please include the name of the TA/CA/Intern you are evaluating. What aspects of the TA's teaching contributed most to your learning? What could the TA modify to help you learn more? Please include any additional feedback for the TA/CA/Intern.

Comments
Hanbin — overall, a nice, funny person, but sometimes a struggle to clear up concepts with her given she got confused by the concepts herself.
Hanbin Kim
Hanbim Kim. She hosted discussions outside of class that I found very useful, but I did not attend every single one. Thought she was great!
HanBin was a great TA! She was very understanding and helpful, and I really appreciated that she was willing to be available to answer questions in office hours and over email.
Hanbin.
Hanbin
Hanbin Kim. She was always available and worked hard to present concepts to students. She did not, however, seem to grasp concepts immediately and watching her struggle with an answer made the class topics seem more difficult in office hours. She also seemed to have a full plate of courses and other activities that limited the amount of time she could give as a TA, which was understandable, but difficult to deal with. I also wish her office hours were later in the week as that's when most students worked on assignments/had time to rewatch lectures.
I didn't really work w TA.
Hanbin Kim was very helpful, had strong discussions that she led
Hanbin. She was great.
Hanbin
Han Bin Kim
Hanbin Kim

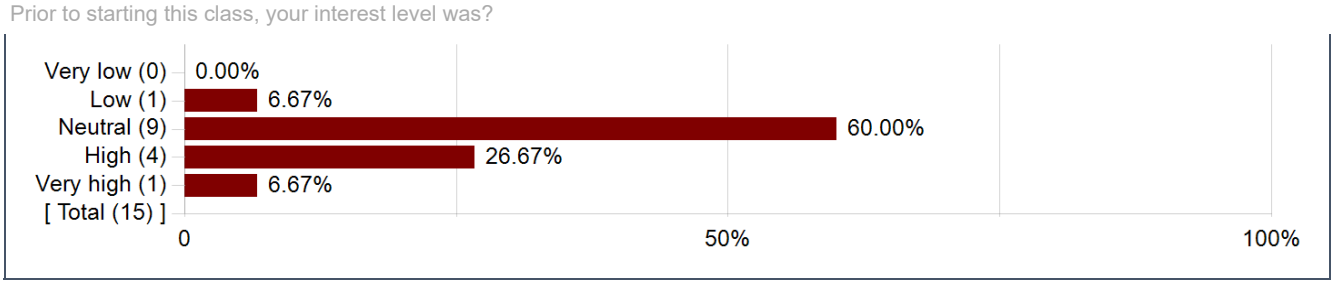
The TA/CA or Intern. . .

	Mean	Median	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree	N/A
Facilitated discussions that supported your learning.	4.25	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	15.38%	38.46%	38.46%	7.69%
Gave you useful feedback on your work.	4.67	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	30.77%	61.54%	7.69%
Stimulated your interest in the core ideas of the class.	4.33	4.50	0.00%	0.00%	15.38%	30.77%	46.15%	7.69%
Challenged you to learn.	4.42	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	15.38%	23.08%	53.85%	7.69%
Helped you succeed in the class.	4.33	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	23.08%	15.38%	53.85%	7.69%
Was available and helpful outside of class.	4.58	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	7.69%	23.08%	61.54%	7.69%
Overall, this individual made a significant contribution to your learning.	4.25	4.50	0.00%	0.00%	23.08%	23.08%	46.15%	7.69%

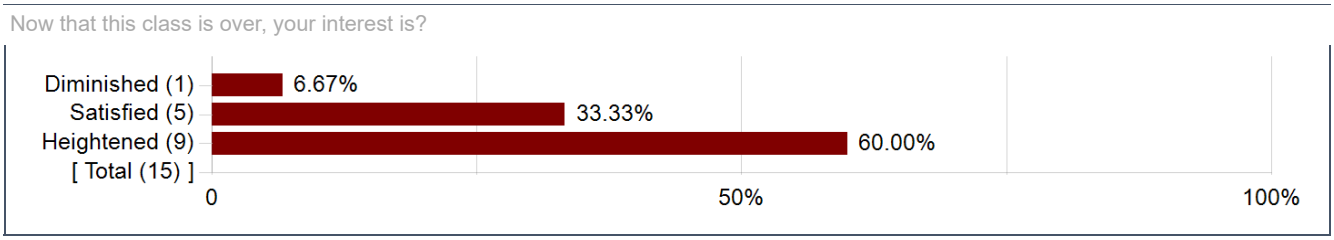
Is this class a requirement of some sort?



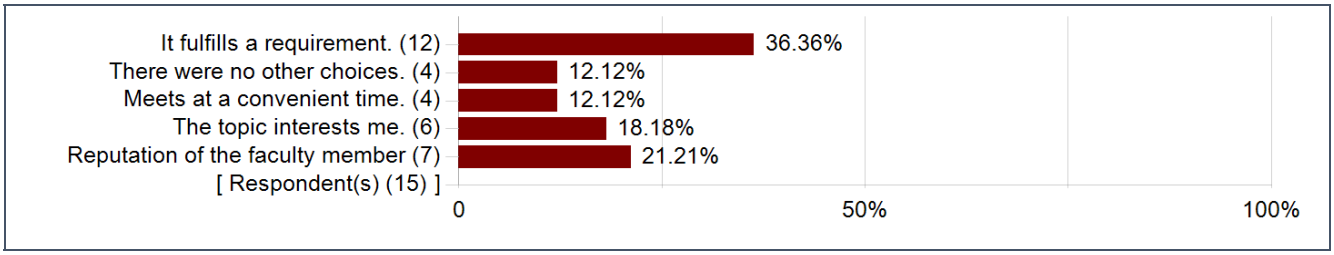
Prior to starting this class, your interest level was?



Now that this class is over, your interest is?

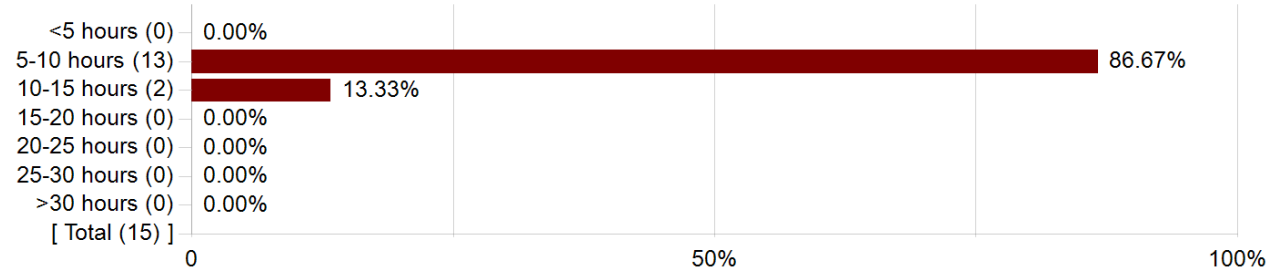


Why did you choose to take this course? (Select all that apply)



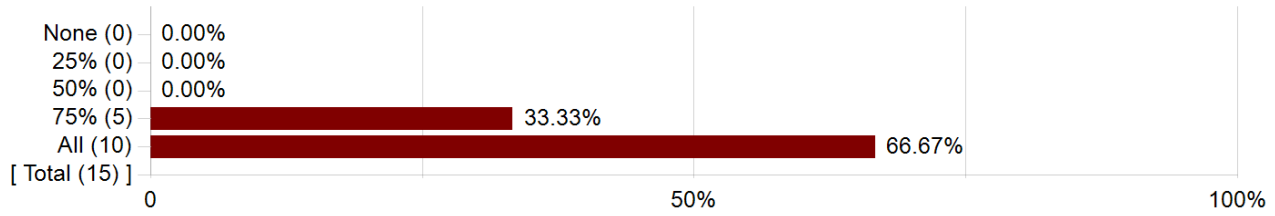
How many hours per week outside of attending required sessions did you spend on this course?

How many hours per week outside of attending required sessions did you spend on this course?



What proportion of classes did you attend?

What proportion of classes did you attend?



Please comment on the level of difficulty of the course relative to your background and experience.

Comments
The course was difficult for me given the three year gap from taking ECON102, not to mention the course is very fast paced. Compared to my other econ classes, we probably learned 2–3x as much information.
Challenging course but definitely more than manageable. I would recommend taking the class after strengthening your knowledge of macroeconomic principles. I took Money and Banking which I think helped me a lot.
Though this class can be challenging, the skills and knowledge that you learn from it (if you work hard and focus on understanding the material) are extremely useful for your future courses and career goals.
Very little understanding of economics needed to enjoy the lectures.
As a Bus Econ major, it was difficult but not insurmountable. Sometimes the concepts could be incredibly, incredibly difficult but nothing seemed impossible as long as you put the time in to understand it. It's not an easy A, but it's def an achievable one.
Called back to some classes that helped, but very tough all the same
Not an easy class even if you're doing the standard econ track. If you put in the effort and follow the lectures on a weekly basis, you should not get worse than an A–/B+.
Medium
difficult

ECON 20200 1 - The Elements of Economic Analysis III - Instructor(s): Gina Pieters

Project Title: **College Course Feedback - Winter 2023**

Number Enrolled: **42**
Number of Responses: **15**

Report Comments

Opinions expressed in these evaluations are those of students enrolled in the specific course and do not represent the University.

Creation Date: **Tuesday, April 18, 2023**

What are the most important things that you learned in this course? Please reflect on the knowledge and skills you gained.

Comments
creating and solving economic models, dealing with models across time periods
Macroeconomics
Calculus–based understanding of macroeconomics
Asset markets, infinitely lived agents, models for economic growth, business cycles, MATLAB
In–depth macroeconomics, bond and equity markets, economic growth and steady state, business cycles, money and inflation
Modelling the economy with budget constraints and utility functions
how to read a model
Macroeconomics based on micro–driven analysis
The mindset behind creating optimization problems in an economic setting.
The ability to interpret and create economic models that solve different problems. Most of the topics in the course have a lot in common, so it's possible to gain a holistic understanding of the course once the fundamentals are understood.

Describe how aspects of this course (lectures, discussions, labs, assignments, etc.) contributed to your learning.

Comments
QRE's, detailed lecture slides, practice problems
Lecture recordings and discussion sections are very helpful
Practice problems are the most helpful
Lectures were helpful for understanding the concepts behind what we were learning. I learned most of the math/MATLAB by doing the practice problems/homework assignments and going to discussion sections.
Lectures and the accompanying slides were very helpful in terms of understanding the content. The quizzes and homework are based on the terminology and concepts specific to this class, so textbooks or online resources aren't super useful. The discussion sections were more like TA office hours to go over questions that people had or specific ways of solving homework problems, so that was good if you had specific issues.
The lectures are good and the homeworks and practice problems are extremely useful.
Lectures were very clear and really interesting, and I learned a lot from them. Homeworks were difficult but little pressure was put on them. TA sessions went over the homework. The materials being online was also really useful.
Lectures were really helpful and I really appreciated that she recorded them so I could go back and watch them when I was studying for the quizzes. The QREs she gives in class helps us think through problems. The homework and especially the practice problems were extremely helpful in practicing and making sure we understood the material.
This is the most well–organized class I have taken at UChicago. Dr. Pieters's lectures were phenomenal and extremely clear. She spends a significant amount of extra effort in designing practice problems for us to better understand the topic.
Lectures are very insightful
The lectures go over the conceptual and mathematic aspects of the material, while the assignments are designed to test practical problem solving. Discussions and office hours are important for asking questions and catching up with anything you might have missed.

Please respond to the following:

	Mean	Median	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
This course challenged me intellectually.	4.79	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	21.43%	78.57%
I understood the purpose of this course and what I was expected to gain from it.	4.64	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	35.71%	64.29%
I understood the standards for success on assignments.	4.71	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	28.57%	71.43%
Class time enhanced my ability to succeed in graded assignments.	4.57	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	7.14%	28.57%	64.29%
I received feedback on my performance that helped me improve my subsequent work.	4.64	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	7.14%	21.43%	71.43%
My work was evaluated fairly.	4.71	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	7.14%	14.29%	78.57%
I felt respected in this class.	4.79	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	21.43%	78.57%
Overall, this was an excellent course.	4.57	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	7.14%	28.57%	64.29%

Additional comments about the course:

Comments
I think the grading scale is very transparent. I think it can be tough to evaluate where you are in other courses because some professors don't tell you fixed cutoffs or how they determine the curve, so it was nice to be able to get a sense of where I was in the class. I recommend anyone who has difficulty with the math section of the course go through practice problems and write down why each step occurs because I realized some gaps in my knowledge when I did that. Stefano's discussion section on Lagrangians were very helpful and I think it should be a permanent part of the course (even if just a recorded lecture). Overall I think it was tough but fair. I never felt like it was an easy course, but I also felt like Prof. Pieters & Stefano were there if I needed help and there were enough resources on Canvas to succeed on the quizzes.
Prof Pieters is incredibly thorough and highly intentional about her teaching. Having been in 3 different sections, and hearing about my peers' experience with other profs, I would say that her class is the most challenging but it feels so rewarding at the end.
This class is difficult, but the grading is extremely fair and clear.

I would recommend this course to:

	No	Yes
Highly-motivated and well-prepared students	0.00%	100.00%
Anyone interested in the topic	14.29%	85.71%

Thinking about your time in the class, what aspect of the instructor's teaching contributed most to your learning?

Comments
QREs
Lectures and slides
QREs were helpful and a good test of understanding Practice problems were pretty similar to exam expectations
The lectures and slides were very helpful. I also liked that classes were recorded/slides were posted so I could go back and review before quizzes.
Just everything.
Professor Pieters did a good job of organizing the class: making it clear exactly what material we were expected to know on each homework and quiz. The topic summaries are concise and useful. I appreciate that the quizzes don't stray much from the material taught in class, and if it does, it's explained why knowing how the deviation works is actually important.
Lectures – they were very well organised, taught complicated topics clearly and made these topics interesting. QREs helped us see if we were understanding the material correctly part–way through each lecture.
Lectures and recorded lectures.
Everything. Dr. Pieters is phenomenal.
Lectures are very comprehensive and excellently organized.
You can tell Prof. Pieters genuinely cares about her students.

What could the instructor modify to help you learn more?

Comments
More detailed instruction on MATLAB from the professor and actual examples of the correct code in the homework answer key. It felt unfair to have the MATLAB tested on the quizzes but not really taught in class.
Less exams
Nothing. Maybe the difficulty level caused me to skip some of the quizzes out of anxiety, but this is my own problem.
I think it's a common concern that the quizzes are too big of a factor in the final grade, but it's still true. Making the homework component worth more (i.e. the cutoff score higher) would encourage people to actually do all four assignments rather than coasting at the end, so that they would be better prepared for the quizzes. It would also take some pressure off the quizzes themselves.
Sometimes it was hard to hear the recordings because the mic didn't pick up on her voice.
More practice maybe.
Sometimes explanations get a little long winded. Could be good to add guiding questions in the outline slides!

The Instructor . . .

	Mean	Median	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree	N/A
Organized the course clearly.	4.79	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	21.43%	78.57%	0.00%
Presented lectures that enhanced your understanding.	4.57	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	7.14%	28.57%	64.29%	0.00%
Facilitated discussions that were engaging and useful.	4.50	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	21.43%	0.00%	64.29%	14.29%
Stimulated your interest in the core ideas of the course.	4.57	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	7.14%	28.57%	64.29%	0.00%
Challenged you to learn.	4.64	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	7.14%	21.43%	71.43%	0.00%
Helped you gain significant learning from the course content.	4.57	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	7.14%	28.57%	64.29%	0.00%
Was available and helpful outside of class.	4.69	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	28.57%	64.29%	7.14%
Motivated you to think independently.	4.50	5.00	0.00%	7.14%	0.00%	28.57%	64.29%	0.00%
Worked to create an inclusive and welcoming learning environment.	4.64	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	7.14%	21.43%	71.43%	0.00%
Overall, this instructor made a significant contribution to your learning.	4.57	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	7.14%	28.57%	64.29%	0.00%

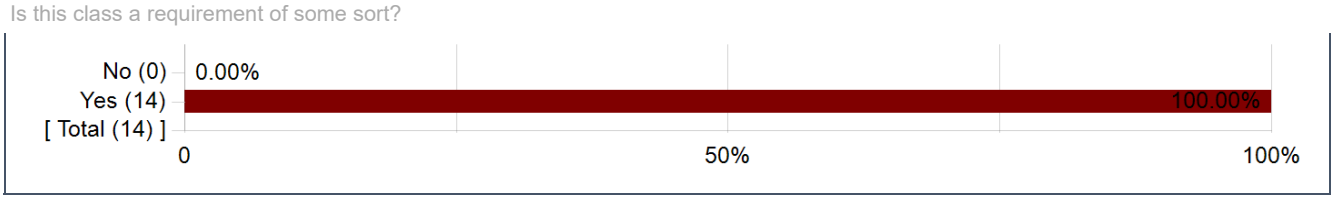
Please include the name of the TA/CA/Intern you are evaluating. What aspects of the TA's teaching contributed most to your learning? What could the TA modify to help you learn more? Please include any additional feedback for the TA/CA/Intern.

Comments
Stefano was a great TA and his tutorials really helped me understand how to solve the problems.
Stefano. Super nice and helpful!
Stefano
Stefano
Stefano It is clear he wants the students to succeed and he is very helpful in clarifying concepts / coding problems.
Stefano Bruzzo–Gallardo was very helpful in answering all of my questions, and he provided well–organized TA sessions to answer questions and to expand on class topics.
The TA was Mr. Stefano Bruzzo–Gallardo. He hosts the discussion sections and also has office hours, both of which are very helpful. There's really nothing bad to say about him.

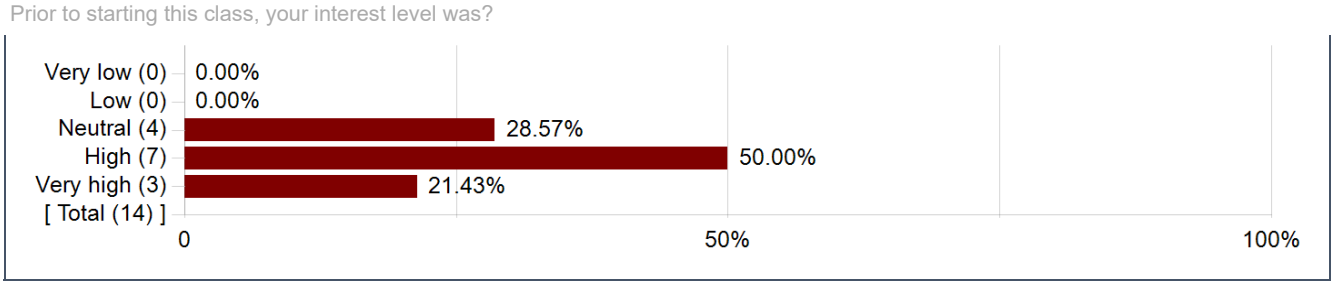
The TA/CA or Intern. . .

	Mean	Median	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree	N/A
Facilitated discussions that supported your learning.	4.89	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	9.09%	72.73%	18.18%
Gave you useful feedback on your work.	4.91	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	9.09%	90.91%	0.00%
Stimulated your interest in the core ideas of the class.	4.73	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	27.27%	72.73%	0.00%
Challenged you to learn.	4.73	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	27.27%	72.73%	0.00%
Helped you succeed in the class.	4.82	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	18.18%	81.82%	0.00%
Was available and helpful outside of class.	5.00	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	90.91%	9.09%
Overall, this individual made a significant contribution to your learning.	4.82	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	18.18%	81.82%	0.00%

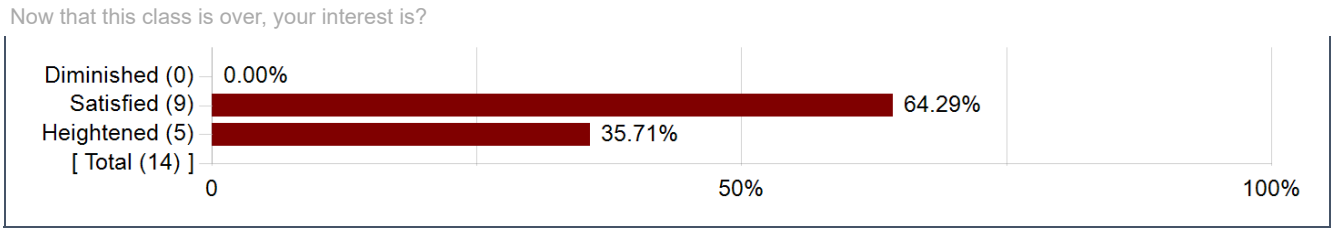
Is this class a requirement of some sort?



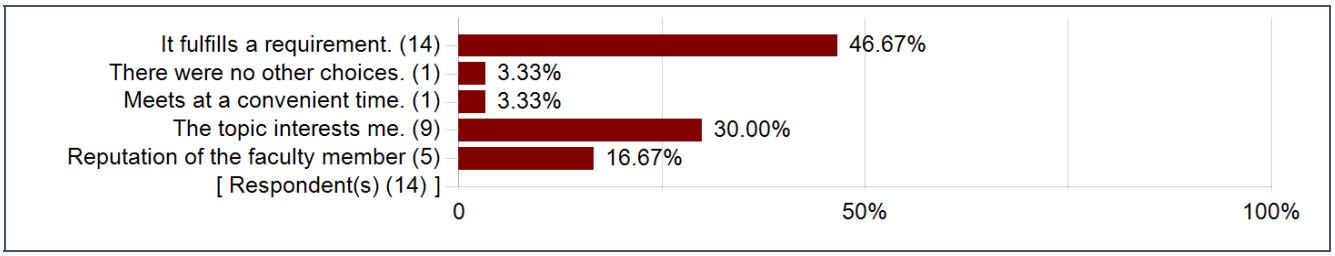
Prior to starting this class, your interest level was?



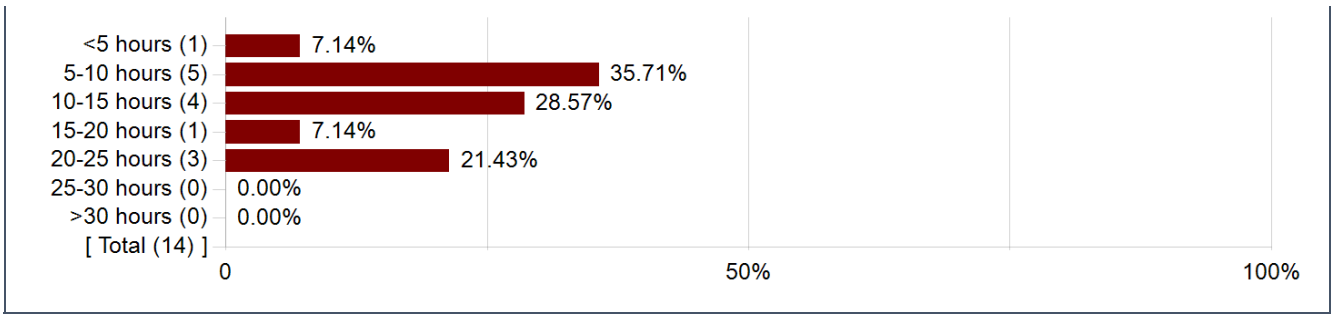
Now that this class is over, your interest is?



Why did you choose to take this course? (Select all that apply)

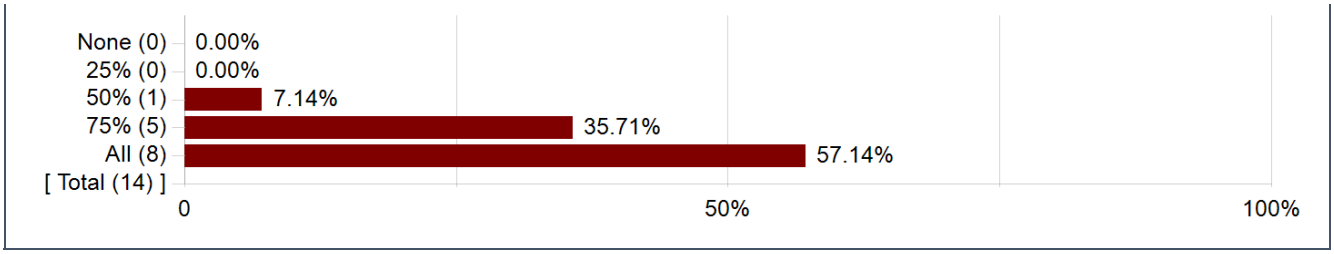


How many hours per week outside of attending required sessions did you spend on this course?



What proportion of classes did you attend?

What proportion of classes did you attend?



Please comment on the level of difficulty of the course relative to your background and experience.

Comments
Similar to 200, 201
Difficult but worth it!
It follows pretty naturally from Econ 201. The material isn't that similar but it asks similar things of you (especially if you have the same professor for both). If you did fine in 201 then this won't be much of an additional stretch.
Harder than 20100
Easier because lots of materials were online
It was kind of hard since I had not taken econ 201 since last year, but I think I managed to do well
Difficult but very fair
As an Econ major student, the course is challenging for me. I'm sure there are many people who do better than me, though.

ECON 10200 1 - Principles of Macroeconomics - Instructor(s): Gina Pieters

Project Title: **College Course Feedback - Spring 2023**

Number Enrolled: **137**
Number of Responses: **36**

Report Comments

Opinions expressed in these evaluations are those of students enrolled in the specific course and do not represent the University.

Creation Date: **Tuesday, October 24, 2023**

What are the most important things that you learned in this course? Please reflect on the knowledge and skills you gained.

Comments
Basic Macroeconomic theories, Understanding commonly used basic economic equations
I learned about how the economy works and what GDP is, how different things affect it, and the impact of it worldwide.
Topics on Macroeconomics. Definitions, background, and policies.
the basics of economics
Demand and Supply
Fiscal/Monetary Policies Calculations and implications of GDP ADAS Graph Countries trade and people rationale behind
Defending my answers; economic reasoning; thinking on my feet instead of memorizing concepts.
Various macroeconomic graphs: the Solow model, the LRAS–AD and AD–AS graphs, the interest rate / loanable funds graph, among others. Learning how changing variables on or not on the graph would affect the lines on the graph was really interesting: I learned general rules for how these relationships work. Also, I appreciated how we covered almost every topic in macroeconomics: from why recessions happen, inflation, the relationship between AD, LRAS, and SRAS, how unemployment and the labor force is represented in macroeconomics, and more. We covered a breadth of topics and gained a very useful systematic, analytical skillset with which to examine these topics. Overall, I gained a lot of graphical analysis skills, analyzing economic relationships in a mathematical way (i.e. PPF, trade, and ADAS), and I learned how to apply macroeconomic concepts to ambiguous or more creative/out–of–the–box scenarios.
Macro economic stuff, yeah. Interest rates, Solow model, circular flow diagram...
I learned a lot of information about how the economy works on a macroscopic scale.
This course is a general survey of basic macroeconomic analysis and policy.
Everything about macroeconomics. The purpose of the fed, Inflation, GDP, economic trends.
how to read macro graphs and apply concepts
The most important thing I learned in this course is generally an idea of what macroeconomics is and manipulating aspects of it like interest rates, etc. can impact our everyday and future lives (how much we choose to consume/spend, etc.)
I learned the basics of macroeconomics. This included essential graphs and important concepts of GDP.
solow model
Macroecon.
Drawing and understanding models, understanding the causes and impact of monetary and fiscal policies.
Learned about many different macroeconomics concepts, good introduction to broad range of topics
Principles of macro tools, ideas, different macro concepts like the solos model, policies, classical vs Keynesian.

Describe how aspects of this course (lectures, discussions, labs, assignments, etc.) contributed to your learning.

Comments
No labs, homework assignments are on a 30–point system – once you get to thirty points you don't have to do any more homework, very easy to get thirty points and not have homework the entire quarter, lectures are good to ask questions but you do not have to go, she also records all of the lectures, discussion sections are once every 2 weeks and not mandatory but can be helpful when you have homework help. Homework can be done with peers. There is a quiz every other week, these are difficult but they are open note.
Lectures were helpful because they were very detailed and had graphs that would help explain the current state of whatever term or topic we were covering that day. The discussions also helped because they provided a good review of the material learned in class, and gave example problems that further helped my understanding.
Lectures were slightly faced paced, but very well organized and maintaining interesting
lectures and discussions were both very helpful
Lectures and PSETS
The past papers and practice problems with specific answers
Lectures and practice problems were most helpful in terms of preparing for the quizzes and understanding the course's material.
The lectures were super helpful! I thought Professor Pieters was a very engaging lecturer. She would draw on the slides frequently, which gave me helpful visual cues to supplement the things I was learning about via auditory/verbal teaching. I also appreciated the QREs, because they compelled students to immediately apply the concepts we were learning to a test–style question each class. Apart from lectures, I found the problem sets extremely helpful for gaining practice with the concepts and developing the deeper understanding necessary to do well on the tests.
Discussions where not very helpful in my opinion, they turned out to be regurgitation sessions for lectures. I didn't go to any of them and still did great in the class so...
Discussions helped a lot in deepening my understanding in some aspect, and lectures by far contributed the most to my learning, as all of the info to be learned was through them.
Lectures were the primary means of learning in this course, and were very effective.
Lectures and reviewing on my own.
I found things to be explained clearly and thoroughly in lecture and the slides were easy to follow
Lectures were incredibly helpful. I missed many discussion sections due to outside involvement so cannot speak to them. I think the homework assignments were helpful altho some aspects of them (like readings) were a little time consuming (altho insightful). The practice problems were the most useful aspect of the course outside of class itself.
Assignments helped me learn because they used real–world data, like FRED, to help us further grasp the information we were given.
discussions
It was all great.
Both lectures and discussion sections were helpful.
Professor gave great lectures, interactive too
Lectures, discussions, office hours, PowerPoints, practice problems

Please respond to the following:

	Mean	Median	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree
This course challenged me intellectually.	4.43	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	14.29%	28.57%	57.14%
I understood the purpose of this course and what I was expected to gain from it.	4.68	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	32.14%	67.86%
I understood the standards for success on assignments.	4.50	5.00	3.57%	0.00%	3.57%	28.57%	64.29%
Class time enhanced my ability to succeed in graded assignments.	4.36	5.00	0.00%	7.14%	7.14%	28.57%	57.14%
I received feedback on my performance that helped me improve my subsequent work.	4.36	5.00	3.57%	3.57%	0.00%	39.29%	53.57%
My work was evaluated fairly.	4.50	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	7.14%	35.71%	57.14%
I felt respected in this class.	4.50	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	7.14%	35.71%	57.14%
Overall, this was an excellent course.	4.36	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	10.71%	42.86%	46.43%

Additional comments about the course:

Comments
There are four quizzes, one every other week, they are somewhat hard but they are open notes. You have to be very specific on homework and quizzes do get points which can be annoying but you do have access to notes and books during quizzes and homework.
– Sometimes the lectures were meant to be challenging and hard
Course is pretty good, would recommend. Prof Pieters makes the lectures engaging enough. She's funny, but not as funny as a certain professor whose last name begins with S; perhaps that's a good thing
It is not a difficult course, but is very informative and enjoyable.
Not an easy course but professor is fair and outlines what you need to succeed. If you put in the work, you can get the grade you want.
Although I absolutely loved this course, I had one major problem with it: the quizzes were very unpredictable at times. For every topic, there was a provided topic summary and practice problems link that we could go to for extra practice. 2 of the 4 quizzes rewarded the student for doing these. By this I mean, if the topic summary was understood and the practice problems were done, it was likely to get a good score on the quiz. Two of the quizzes (particularly 1 and 3) were not directed toward the practice problems as much, meaning a lot of time was spent studying for the wrong material. When everything is expected to be understood in–depth, it can be quite hard to study every topic to that extent. I understand that the Professor cannot just take exactly what is on the topic summary or practice problems, but I think it is fair to make the quizzes more likely those to ensure we aren't wasting time studying topics that won't be assessed at all.
great class
TAKE PIETERS OVER SANDERSON!!! She is an incredible professor, very responsive, delineates the curve of the class, grading, expectations, etc. There is no ambiguity that you have with Sanderson.
It’s a course where if you put in the right amount of effort, you will be able to gain the amount you expected and achieve a fairly good grade.

I would recommend this course to:

	No	Yes
Highly-motivated and well-prepared students	0.00%	100.00%
Anyone interested in the topic	7.14%	92.86%

Thinking about your time in the class, what aspect of the instructor's teaching contributed most to your learning?

Comments
She gives a lot of information as to how the course works which is really helpful. She posts quizzes from the previous year, study guides for the quizzes, and review sheets. Her slides are also really informative. All of this (if printed) can be used on quizzes).
The QRE's I would say helped the most for me in class because they were sort of "real–world applications" of the topics we were learning in class, which helped me understand the material better.
Professor Pieters organizes the class well. She posts not just class slides, but also recordings.
Her lectures
lecture
– QRE and the Section Summary
posting lecture slides and topic summaries
Lectures and practice problems
Recording lectures and providing summaries of the rather dense topics.
Lectures were the most helpful. Professor Pieters was a great lecturer, teaching us advanced concepts while going at a very reasonable pace and always being willing to answer questions. Office hours and the question portal (EDStem) were also very helpful, as Pieters was consistently very responsive and would be willing to answer questions up until mere hours before tests were administered.
Lecture slides, subsequent topic summaries and practice problems
The way she answered questions well, and just went through every slide/topic on the course.
The instructor has a brilliant teaching style, which is extremely helpful in communicating the key concepts of the course.
Lectures, PRACTICE PROBLEMS!!!!
She is very well spoken and explains and answers questions thoughtfully
Prof. Pieters made sure to cover content the class was interested in and was very engaging during lecture, giving examples and additional context to certain topics.
Professor Pieters is extremely (and I mean extremely) organized. She covered grade distributions and different topics of studying based on the questions frequently missed and also gave quizzes in 2–week time frames that are relevant to the concepts previously learned. She also has her class structured to where if you put in the time early on in the quarter, it is possible to skip the last few assignments to focus on time commitments in other classes. That was very generous of her. Professor also used many graphs and real–world examples, as well as provided QREs to ensure you understood the topic more than just at the surface level. Best structured class I've had on this campus so far.
lectures
Everything.
Uploading EVERYTHING online made the class a lot more accessible. Also homework was mainly used for practice as it was not that important for the grade.
The QREs were great (quick response exercises). They were little activities we did once every class that basically made sure we were processing what was happening in the lecture
Her lectures, office hours, PowerPoints, and always making sure we understand the grading system throughout the quarter. Shes also super good at replying when you ever has questions, lots of people find her a bit intimidating but she’s actually super friendly and helpful!

What could the instructor modify to help you learn more?

Comments
Sometimes I feel like the slides give too much information so I wish she would be slightly more specific on things. I also think she could post more videos about specific concepts that she knows are helpful instead of having to find them on our own and share with everyone.
Nothing really.
N/A
Better standards for how to do well on the quizzes
–Sometimes I get kind of lost while reviewing the course material on what should be the emphasis and focus. I would be more helpful to include more content on the key ideas instead of including some irrelevant material
I thought the course was very well–designed and I had no specific comments. I think making some of the problem sets mandatory / available for points could be helpful, as I often found that the Homework assignments were less related to the quizzes than the problem set questions.
Nothing, very good!
Speak a little slower, she did speed up at times.
The instructor needs make no modifications, as the teaching style and course are excellent as are.
Sometimes going slower and teaching in a bit more of a digestible way.
I feel that the latter half of the class was a little rushed compared to the first half. I wish we had had a little more time for the latter half.
No further modifications are needed.
more discussion time
Nothing, she was great.
N/A
I wish the homework included more exam like questions instead of just real life, research type questions.

The Instructor . . .

	Mean	Median	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree	N/A
Organized the course clearly.	4.74	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	25.93%	74.07%	0.00%
Presented lectures that enhanced your understanding.	4.63	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	3.70%	29.63%	66.67%	0.00%
Facilitated discussions that were engaging and useful.	4.31	4.50	0.00%	3.70%	11.11%	33.33%	48.15%	3.70%
Stimulated your interest in the core ideas of the course.	4.56	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	7.41%	29.63%	62.96%	0.00%
Challenged you to learn.	4.67	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	7.41%	18.52%	74.07%	0.00%
Helped you gain significant learning from the course content.	4.67	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	7.41%	18.52%	74.07%	0.00%
Was available and helpful outside of class.	4.62	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	7.41%	22.22%	66.67%	3.70%
Motivated you to think independently.	4.61	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	10.71%	17.86%	71.43%	0.00%
Worked to create an inclusive and welcoming learning environment.	4.59	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	7.41%	25.93%	66.67%	0.00%
Overall, this instructor made a significant contribution to your learning.	4.54	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	10.71%	25.00%	64.29%	0.00%

Please include the name of the TA/CA/Intern you are evaluating. What aspects of the TA's teaching contributed most to your learning? What could the TA modify to help you learn more? Please include any additional feedback for the TA/CA/Intern.

Comments
3 TA's, they facilitated the quizzes and discussion sections. They could not give specific help on homework but they can answer questions similar to the HW and were able to explain concepts that were difficult to understand.
Kathy Zhang was the TA for my discussion and the discussion sections she led helped me a lot because she would go review the material thoroughly and answer any questions the section had regarding homework or QREs we didn't understand.
Han Bin Kim, she was great!
Kathy
Hanbin (?) did a pretty good job with the discussion sections, but they were kind of orthogonal to the class as a whole, going off on tangents. Helpful with the homework, though!
Han–Bin Kim. They went super fast through review sessions which is fine if you don't really care about the material or if you are already doing well in the class, but if you're not, then the sessions are kinda pointless.
HanBin Kim, Kathy Zhang, and Madhukar Battula were the three TAs for this course. All three were very responsive over email to answer any questions I had, which was extremely helpful. My discussion section was TA'd by HanBin, and I found her teaching style to be extremely engaging, funny, and enjoyable. The only thing that could've been modified in my opinion was office hours location: I think it would've been helpful if they were located in a more convenient place / in a classroom.
Hanbin
Kim Hanbin
HanBin Kim
HanBin — the way she organized discussion section was very participation–dependent and fast–paced which was a little stressful but also helpful.
Kathy Zhang was my TA for this course. Kathy had a clear and deep understanding of the topics at hand. She did a fantastic job presenting example questions in the discussion sections and is extremely approachable. I have no complaints about Kathy, very well done.
Kathy Zhang
Hanh Bin
Han Bin Kim. Her discussions were helpful and she was accommodating when I couldn't attend a discussion section.
Kathy and Hanbin

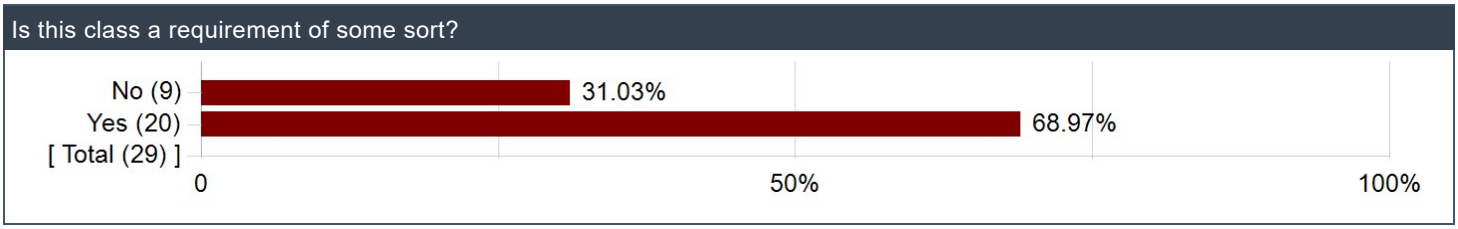
The TA/CA or Intern. . .

	Mean	Median	Strongly Disagree	Disagree	Neutral	Agree	Strongly Agree	N/A
Facilitated discussions that supported your learning.	4.21	4.00	0.00%	5.26%	15.79%	31.58%	47.37%	0.00%
Gave you useful feedback on your work.	4.47	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	5.88%	41.18%	52.94%	0.00%
Stimulated your interest in the core ideas of the class.	4.33	4.50	0.00%	0.00%	16.67%	33.33%	50.00%	0.00%
Challenged you to learn.	4.26	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	15.79%	42.11%	42.11%	0.00%
Helped you succeed in the class.	4.26	4.00	0.00%	0.00%	15.79%	42.11%	42.11%	0.00%
Was available and helpful outside of class.	4.39	4.50	0.00%	0.00%	10.53%	36.84%	47.37%	5.26%
Overall, this individual made a significant contribution to your learning.	4.33	4.50	0.00%	0.00%	16.67%	33.33%	50.00%	0.00%

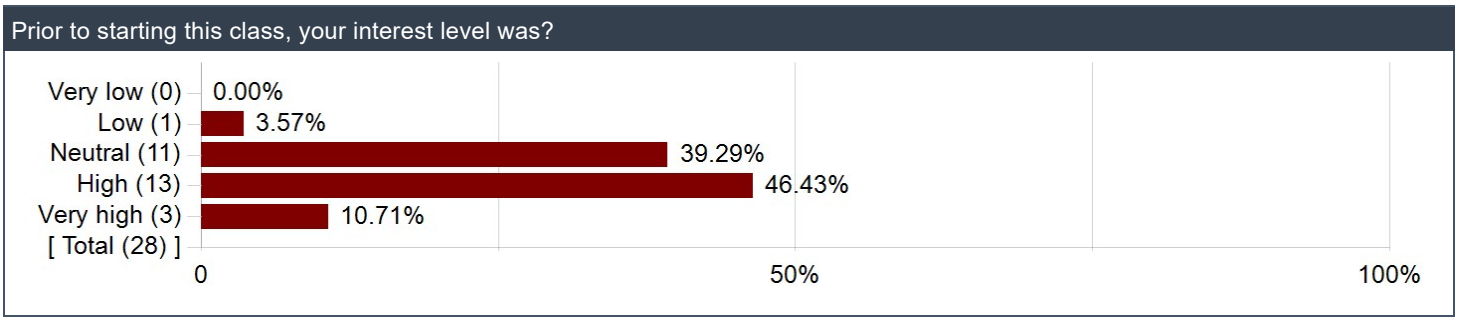
How much did the following elements of the course contribute to your learning gains?

	Mean	Median	No Gain	A Little Gain	Moderate Gain	Good Gain	Great Gain	N/A
Laboratory Experience	N/A	N/A	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	100.00%
Field Trips	N/A	N/A	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	100.00%
Library Sessions	N/A	N/A	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	100.00%
Review Sessions	5.00	5.00	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	100.00%	0.00%
Writing Seminars	N/A	N/A	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	0.00%	100.00%

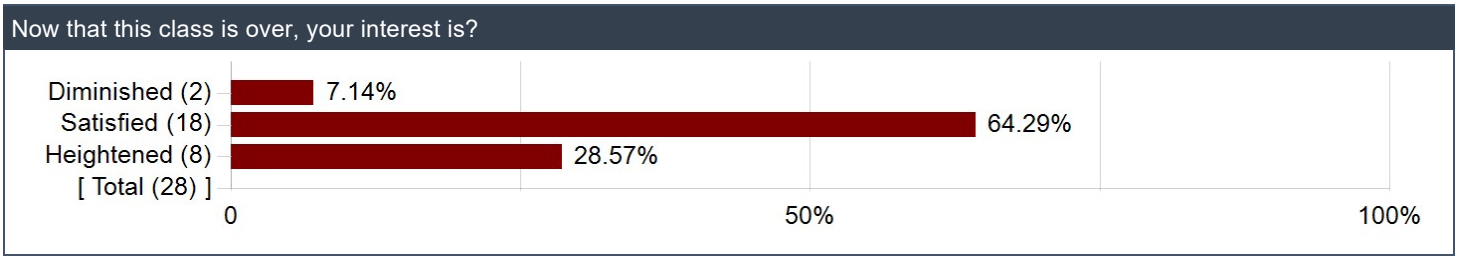
Is this class a requirement of some sort?



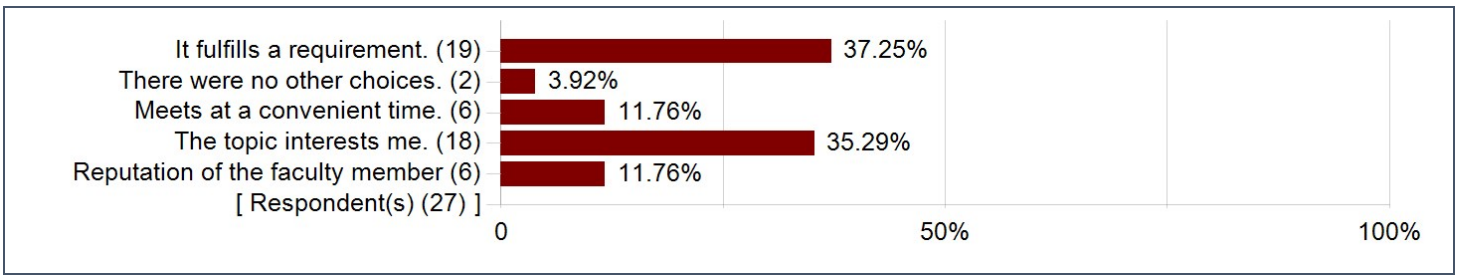
Prior to starting this class, your interest level was?



Now that this class is over, your interest is?

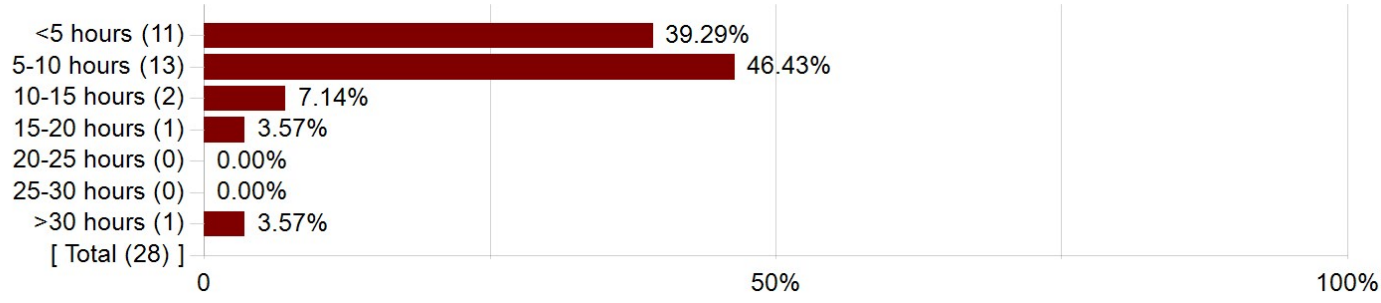


Why did you choose to take this course? (Select all that apply)



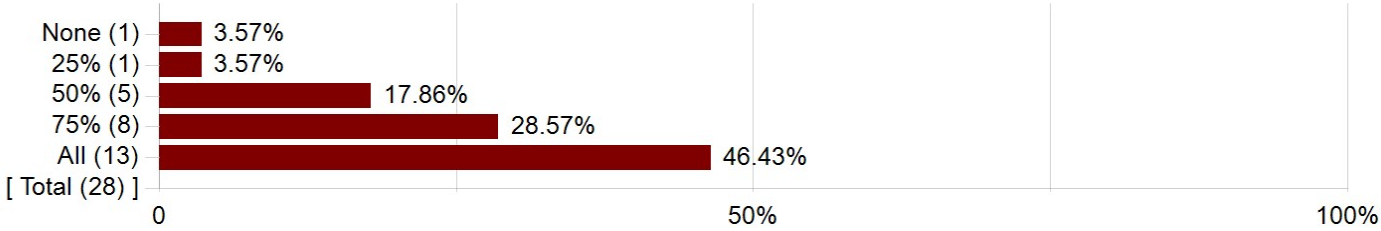
How many hours per week outside of attending required sessions did you spend on this course?

How many hours per week outside of attending required sessions did you spend on this course?



What proportion of classes did you attend?

What proportion of classes did you attend?



Please comment on the level of difficulty of the course relative to your background and experience.

Comments
I had taken AP Macro in high school. The course is somewhat difficult because of the quizzes but you get to retake 2 of the quizzes. No midterm, no final. The homework can be done with as many other people as you would like, it is really easy to get all of your homework points at the beginning of the quarter. Concepts can all be learned in class and you can watch videos on youtube if you don't understand anything. All quizzes are open notes/book. I recommend Pieters over other professors because she has no midterm or final.
It was a bit difficult, but definitely a beginner level course going into Economics, as I had no prior knowledge of Economics before this.
I had no experience with economics in any capacity before this class, however, the way Dr. Pieters teaches made the information easy to understand and enjoyable to learn about. The expectations of the class are very clear, there are 4 quizzes that make up your grade with no midterm or final (aside from 2 replacement quizzes taken during finals week that you can use to replace a low score on one of the other quizzes). This allows the class to have a very reasonable workload. It is very possible to do well without having any experience with economics.
I have no background in Macro, but overall it is an acceptable level of difficulty as long as you reviewed the practice problems and the past papers
Easy
I took AP Macro and high school and scored a 5. That being said, this class was still challenging for me. We delved a lot into the theory of macro, and talked about many nuances in the theory that destabilized what I had learned in AP Macro. The quizzes are pretty hard, and I would spend about a week studying for them just to not always know what to expect. Still, Pieters is an excellent lecturer, and this has been one of the best courses I've taken at UChicago. If you're looking to get an A, it's probably easier to take Sanderson (I got an A in Micro with Sanderson, and I'm a tad worried about my grade for Pieters)
Having taken Econ 1000 will help you GREATLY! The professor does like to keep you on your toes and there are a few times when answers seem a little unfair, imo.
If you took Sanderson's class or you in general are really good at critical thinking and can argue you will be fine. If you're more of a memorization person, you will struggle.
As a sophomore who had taken Principles of Microeconomics first, I found the course to be very manageable. I certainly don't think you need any prior economics experience to take this course: in fact, coming in with a blank slate and open mind could actually benefit you a lot when learning macroeconomics at a college level, which involves more nuance than earlier–level courses.
It's an intro class, not very hard. If one tries, they can do well.
No background, but wasn't the worst compared to my inexperience.
The course is easy relative to my background and experience.
This was the first economics class I have taken so it was a bit challenging. Just required more time to get the hang of it compared to classmates who were experienced in the topic
This was my first ever Econ course and I would say that it is definitely difficult but a good challenge.
I have taken AP Marco in high school prior to this course. The difficulty of this course isn't too bad but it takes a deep understanding to do well on quizzes. I remember on one of the quizzes, there was a modification to a graph (PPF) that was never talked about or seen in class. I felt that this was a bit unfair to put on a quiz because it was never talked about (although I heard it was briefly discussed in office hours), but many students probably didn't know that the graph could be modified in the way the correct answer wanted. Since it was never discussed in class, and it was never mentioned in discussion sections, this took a deeper and better understanding of the topic that many students may not be prepared for.
very manageable
If you have are taking this class for the major requirement, take it with Pieters. It doesn't get much better than her ability to reach, relay expectations, provide immediate feedback, etc. For someone with legitimately barely any econ background, she makes the course passable. Also, she does this thing called "bug bounties" which are amazing. You are allowed to achieve points for the homework section of the course by correcting errors in her lecture slides, practice problems, etc.
I had never taken an econ class in high school nor done any self studying on the topic and I received an A in the class. I thought it was pretty easy but I have heard conflicting things from certain "brothers"
Had no Econ experience. Definitely difficult but doable. Wouldn’t take again as I did it just for fun and it ended up being a big commitment, but if if you have the time and interest it won’t be that bad.
I took 202 before this, so this class was pretty light
It’s a course that definitely requires you to put work in–it’s not an easy A. But if you try and actually work and makes notes and do all the practice problem you’ll be totally fine.